

Letter Writing Master Notes

Formats, terminology and official correspondence — with complete model letters, ready-to-use templates and exam practice, in one place.

17 sections **61** letter & document types in detail **34** complete model letters **17** ready templates **130** glossary terms
135 practice questions



Fundamentals of Letter Writing

1.1 What is a letter?

Definition	A letter is a written message that one person or office sends to another person, office or organisation - by post, by hand or by email. It conveys information, a request, a feeling or a decision in an accepted format. It also remains as a permanent record of what was said.
In one line	A letter is a written, addressed, purposeful and permanent message that follows a fixed format.

Key features

Feature	What it means	Exam point
Written	It is written or typed, not spoken.	Spelling, grammar and a neat layout matter as much as the content.
Addressed to someone	It has a definite receiver - a person, an office or an organisation.	The receiver decides the register, the salutation and the close.
Purposeful	It is written for a clear reason - to request, complain, apply, inform, thank or share news.	In a formal letter, state the purpose in the first paragraph.
Permanent record	It can be kept, filed, quoted later and used as proof.	Give exact facts - dates, numbers, amounts - and list the enclosures.
Follows a format	Each type has a fixed layout and a fixed order of parts.	The format is part of the answer - learn the order of parts (see 1.7).

1.2 Purpose of letter writing

Purpose	Example letter
To share news and feelings	Letter to a friend describing your first week in the hostel
To apply	Application for a job, admission, scholarship or leave
To request	Request to the Principal for a bonafide certificate
To complain and seek action	Complaint to the Municipal Commissioner about irregular garbage collection
To ask for information	Enquiry to a coaching centre about course fees and batch timings
To buy or sell goods	Order letter to a supplier for 500 notebooks
To inform	Letter to a bank about a change of address
To invite, thank, congratulate or console	Invitation to a friend for a wedding; condolence letter to a friend
To express an opinion on a public issue	Letter to the editor about traffic congestion in Chennai
To keep an official record	Appointment letter; letter confirming a telephone conversation

1.3 Types of letters - overview

Category	Written to	Register	Examples
Personal / informal (see 2.1)	Family, relatives, close friends	Informal	Letter to parents; invitation to a friend; congratulations; condolence
Semi-formal (see 2.2)	People you know, but not closely - teacher, landlord, neighbour, a known official	Semi-formal	Request to a landlord for repairs; thank-you letter to a former teacher
Formal / official (see 2.3)	Officials, offices, institutions, editors, unknown persons	Formal	Complaint to the Municipal Commissioner; leave letter; letter to the editor
Business (Section 3)	Firms, suppliers, customers	Formal	Inquiry, quotation, order, complaint, claim, adjustment, credit and collection letters

Category	Written to	Register	Examples
Banking / financial (Section 4)	Banks and financial institutions (customer ↔ bank)	Formal	New cheque book; stop-payment request; loan application; change of address; closing an account
Transactional (Section 5)	The other party in one deal (buyer ↔ seller, customer ↔ service provider)	Formal	The chain of one transaction: inquiry → quotation → order → dispatch → invoice → payment
Government / administrative (Section 6)	Government offices, officials, other departments, the public	Formal	Official letter; D.O. letter; Office Memorandum; Circular; Notification; G.O.

EXAM TIP: First ask "WHO will read this letter?" The receiver decides the category, the register, the salutation and the close.

1.4 Personal vs official letters

Basis	Personal letter	Official letter
Written to	Family, relatives, friends	Officials, offices, organisations, unknown persons
Purpose	Share news, feelings and personal matters	Apply, request, complain or inform - an official or business purpose
Tone and language	Warm and casual; contractions allowed	Polite, impersonal and precise; no contractions, no slang
Layout	Short address, date, salutation, body, close, first name	Fixed order: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, body, close, name, Encl.
Receiver's address and subject	Not written	Both written
Salutation → Close	"Dear Priya," → "Your loving friend,"	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"
Length and content	Free and flexible; personal details welcome	Brief and to the point; facts only
Name at the end	First name only	Full name, with designation if any

MUST REMEMBER: NO CONTRACTIONS in formal letters. Write "I am", "do not", "cannot", "will not", "I would" - never "I'm", "don't", "can't", "won't", "I'd". Also no slang, no exclamation marks, no SMS language ("pls", "u", "thx") and no emoji. Contractions are allowed only in informal letters.

1.5 Formal vs semi-formal vs informal - at a glance

Point	Formal	Semi-formal	Informal
Written to	Officials, offices, unknown persons	Known persons, not close - teacher, landlord, neighbour	Family and close friends
Receiver's address	Yes - begins with "To"	Yes - name and address	No
Subject line	Yes - always in exam letters	Optional	No
Salutation → Close	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,"	"Dear Priya," → "Your loving friend,"
Name at the end	Full name (with designation, if any)	Full name	First name only

This is only a summary. The detailed high-yield comparison table is in Section 12.

MUST REMEMBER: The salutation and the close are a PAIR. "Dear Sir/Madam," / "Sir," / "Respected Sir," → "Yours faithfully," (official or unknown receiver). "Dear Mr. Raman," (a named person, in a formal or semi-formal letter) → "Yours sincerely,". "Dear Priya," / "Dear Appa," → "Your loving friend," / "Your loving son,". Write "Yours" with a capital Y and the next word with a small letter, with no apostrophe and with a comma after it.

MEMORY TRICK: "Sir" and "sincerely" never sit together. No name (Sir/Madam) → faithfully; a name (Mr. Raman) → sincerely.

1.6 Anatomy of a formal letter **HIGH-FREQUENCY**

Model: a complaint to the Municipal Commissioner in full-block, exam style. Each number marks one part; the legend below explains it.

1

12, Gandhi Road,
K.K. Nagar,
Madurai - 625 020

2

12 October 2026

3

To
The Commissioner,
Madurai City Municipal Corporation,

Madurai - 625 001

- 4 Subject: Complaint regarding non-functioning street lights in K.K. Nagar
- 5 Reference: My complaint No. 4521 dated 14 September 2026
- 6 Dear Sir/Madam,
- 7 I am a resident of Gandhi Road, K.K. Nagar. I am writing to bring to your notice that the street lights in our area have still not been repaired, although I reported the problem in my complaint cited above.
- 8 For the past four weeks, most of the street lights on Gandhi Road and Nehru Street have not worked after sunset. The dark streets are unsafe for women, students and elderly people, and there is a risk of accidents and theft. I enclose a copy of my earlier complaint and photographs of the affected streets.
- 9 I request you to have the street lights repaired at the earliest and to arrange regular checks in future. Thank you for your time.
- 10 Yours faithfully,
- 11 R. Karthik
- 12 Encl.: 1. Copy of my complaint No. 4521 dated 14 September 2026
2. Photographs of the affected streets (4 nos.)
Copy to: The Assistant Engineer (Electrical), Madurai City Municipal Corporation

Legend - the 12 parts

No.	Part	Where it goes	Rule to remember
1	Sender's address	Top, at the left margin - the first block	Address only, NO name. No address in the question? Write "Examination Hall".
2	Date	Below the sender's address, after one blank line	"12 October 2026" - month in words; never all-numeric.
3	Receiver's address	Below the date; "To" on its own line, then the address	Designation first ("The Commissioner;"). A comma at the end of each line except the last; no full stop after the PIN code.
4	Subject	Below the receiver's address, before the salutation	"Subject:" + a short noun phrase; no full stop. "Sub:" is also accepted.
5	Reference	Below the subject - only when needed	Only when you refer to an earlier letter, notice or complaint; give its number and date.
6	Salutation	Below the subject / reference	"Dear Sir/Madam," with a comma. It decides the close.
7	Opening paragraph	First paragraph of the body	Say WHY you are writing, in one or two sentences.
8	Main paragraph (body)	Middle of the letter	Facts: what, where, since when, what effect. One idea per paragraph.
9	Closing paragraph	Last paragraph of the body	The action you want + a polite line of thanks. No separate "Thanking you," line in our model letters.
10	Complimentary close	Below the body, at the left margin	"Yours faithfully," pairs with "Dear Sir/Madam,". Capital Y, small f, no apostrophe, comma after.
11	Signature and name	Directly below the close	Sign above the name in a real letter. In the exam, use the given name or "ABC" / "XYZ".
12	Enclosure and copy	Last lines, at the left margin	"Encl.:" only if something is attached (number the items); "Copy to:" only if copies are sent.

MUST REMEMBER: The sender's NAME is never written at the top of a formal letter - only the address. The name goes below the complimentary close. (Only the "From-To" variant in 1.7 writes the name at the top.)

MUST REMEMBER: EXAM IDENTITY RULE - if the question does not give a name or an address, write "Examination Hall" as your address and sign as "ABC" or "XYZ". Never reveal your real name, roll number or address in an exam answer. If the question gives a name and an address, use exactly those.

1.7 Correct order of components **HIGH-FREQUENCY**

Read each column from top to bottom, one step per row. The Formal column uses the same numbers as the anatomy in 1.6.

Formal	Semi-formal	Informal	Business
1. Sender's address (no name)	1. Sender's address	1. Sender's address (short)	1. Letterhead - FIRM NAME in capitals, address, phone, email, GSTIN
2. Date	2. Date	2. Date	2. Ref. No.
3. "To" + receiver's designation and address	3. Receiver's name and address	3. Salutation - "Dear Priya,"	3. Date
4. Subject	4. Subject (optional)	4. Body (contractions allowed)	4. Inside address (receiver)
5. Reference (only when referring to earlier correspondence)	5. Salutation - "Dear Mr. Raman,"	5. Close - "Your loving friend,"	5. "Kind Attention: ..." line (optional)
6. Salutation - "Dear Sir/Madam,"	6. Body	6. First name	6. Subject
7. Opening paragraph	7. Close - "Yours sincerely,"	–	7. Salutation
8. Main paragraph(s)	8. Full name	–	8. Body
9. Closing paragraph	–	–	9. Complimentary close
10. Complimentary close - "Yours faithfully,"	–	–	10. "For FIRM NAME" (optional)
11. Name (signature above it)	–	–	11. Name (signature above it)
12. Encl. and Copy to (only if needed)	–	–	12. Designation
–	–	–	13. Encl.
–	–	–	14. CC

MEMORY TRICK: S-D-R-S-S-B-C-S = "Sunday Dinner Remains Special - Sambar, Biryani, Curd, Sweet": **S**ender's address, **D**ate, **R**eceiver's address, **S**ubject, **S**alutation, **B**ody, **C**lose, **S**ignature. (A Reference line, when needed, sits between Subject and Salutation; Encl. comes after the Signature.)

DO NOT CONFUSE: The position of the subject line. In the exam-style formal letter used in this book, the Subject comes BEFORE the salutation (receiver's address → Subject → "Dear Sir/Madam,"). In the traditional British / commerce-textbook business layout, it comes AFTER the salutation ("Dear Sir/Madam," → Subject → body). That is an accepted variant; choose one layout and use it consistently.

MUST REMEMBER: The subject line begins "Subject:" (or "Sub:"), is a short noun phrase and has NO full stop - e.g. "Subject: Request for a bonafide certificate". Write it in every formal and business letter. It is optional in semi-formal letters and never used in informal letters.

Accepted variant: the "From-To" format

This format is widely taught in Tamil Nadu schools. How it differs from our full-block layout:

- "From" + the sender's NAME and address at the top (our layout writes only the address).
- "To" + the receiver's address.
- The salutation comes first, then the subject ("Sub:").
- "Thanking you," is written on a separate line before the close (accepted Indian usage).
- "Place:" and "Date:" are written at the bottom-left instead of the date at the top.

From
R. Karthik,
12, Gandhi Road,
K.K. Nagar,
Madurai - 625 020

To
The Headmaster,
Government Higher Secondary School,
K.K. Nagar,
Madurai - 625 020

Respected Sir,

Sub: Request for a bonafide certificate

I am studying in Class XII-A in your school. I need a bonafide certificate to apply for a scholarship. I request you to issue the certificate at the earliest.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,
R. Karthik

Place: Madurai
Date: 12 October 2026

Recognise and accept this variant. The model letters in this book use the full-block layout of 1.6 (see also Sections 9 and 13).

Address on the envelope

School examinations often ask for the "Address on the envelope" after the letter. Write "To" and then the receiver's name (or designation) and full address exactly as in the letter, ending with the PIN code (Postal Index Number - six digits). The sender's name and address go under "From" at the top-left of the front or on the back. The stamp goes at the top-right corner. See the example in 1.9.

1.8 Terminology of letter parts

This table covers the parts of a letter. The full glossary of letter-writing terms is in Section 7.

Term	Simple definition	When it is used	Important exam point	Example
Sender's address	The writer's own address, written first.	All letters (a short form in informal letters)	Address only - no name above it. No address given? Write "Examination Hall".	12, Gandhi Road, K.K. Nagar, Madurai - 625 020
Date	The day on which the letter is written.	All letters, below the sender's address	Month in words; no all-numeric dates (see 1.10).	12 October 2026
Receiver's (inside) address	The designation or name and the address of the receiver, written inside the letter.	Formal, semi-formal and business letters; never in informal letters	Formal: "To" on its own line, then the designation. It must match the envelope address.	The Principal, Government Higher Secondary School, Vellore - 632 001 (after a "To" line)
Letterhead	The printed heading of an organisation - name, logo, address, phone, email, GSTIN.	Business and office letters on printed stationery	With a letterhead, the sender's address is not written again. Firm name in capitals.	KAVERI PAPER MILLS, Erode - 638 011; GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5
Reference number	A file or letter number used to trace correspondence.	"Ref. No." at the top = the sender's own file number (business, official). "Reference:" below the subject = the receiver's earlier letter or notice.	When replying, always quote the number and date of the earlier letter.	Ref. No. KPM/SAL/2026/118; Reference: Your letter No. 45/2026 dated 2 October 2026
Attention line	A line that directs a letter addressed to a firm to a particular person or department.	Business letters	After the inside address, before the subject. The salutation still suits the firm: "Dear Sir/Madam,".	Kind Attention: The Purchase Manager

Term	Simple definition	When it is used	Important exam point	Example
Subject line	A one-line summary of the purpose of the letter.	Formal, business and official letters; optional in semi-formal; never in informal	"Subject:" (or "Sub:") + short noun phrase; no full stop; before the salutation.	Subject: Request for a bonafide certificate
Salutation	The greeting at the start of the letter.	All letters; not used in office memoranda, office orders, notifications, government circulars and notices	Comma after it; it must match the close. "Respected Sir," is Indian usage for superiors. Do not combine "Dear" and "Respected".	Dear Sir/Madam,
Opening paragraph	The first paragraph; it says why you are writing.	All letters	Come to the point in one or two sentences. No "I am fine here" in a formal letter.	I am writing to bring to your notice the poor condition of the road in our area.
Body	The main part; it gives details, facts and reasons.	All letters	One idea per paragraph; exact facts (place, date, amount); polite even in a complaint.	The road has had deep potholes for three months, and two accidents have taken place.
Closing paragraph	The last paragraph; it states the action wanted and ends politely.	All letters	Say clearly what you want done. "Thanking you," on a separate line is accepted Indian usage; better: "Thank you for your time." inside this paragraph.	I request you to repair the road at the earliest. Thank you for your time.
Complimentary close	The polite phrase that ends the letter, just before the name.	All letters; not used in office memoranda, office orders, notifications, government circulars and notices	Must match the salutation. Capital Y, small second word, no apostrophe, comma after. Variant: "Yours truly," (business).	Yours faithfully, / Yours sincerely,
Signature	The writer's handwritten sign.	Formal, business and official letters - just above the written name	In an exam, never sign your real name; use the given name or "ABC" / "XYZ".	(signature) above "R. Karthik"
Name and designation	The writer's full name, and the post when writing for an office or firm.	Formal and business letters; designation in office letters	No title (Mr./Dr.) before your own name. The designation goes on the line below the name.	S. Senthil, Purchase Manager
Enclosures (Encl.)	Documents sent along with the letter.	When certificates, bills, photographs or forms are attached	Below the name, numbered. Mention them in the body too.	Encl.: 1. Copy of the bill 2. Photographs (4 nos.)
Copies (CC / Copy to)	A note that copies of the letter have been sent to others.	When other persons or offices must also be informed	CC = carbon copy (today also read as "courtesy copy"). Official letters write "Copy to:". Placed after Encl.	Copy to: The Assistant Engineer (Electrical)
Postscript (P.S.)	A short afterthought added below the signature (Latin <i>post scriptum</i> = written after).	Mainly personal letters	Avoid in formal exam letters - plan the letter so that nothing is left out.	P.S. Do bring the photos of the trip.
Through proper channel	An employee's letter to a higher authority, sent through the immediate superior.	Employees' applications and representations - transfer, promotion, permission	Write a "Through: ..." line above or below the addressee.	Through: The Headmaster, Government High School, Vellore
Addressing conventions	The accepted titles and forms used for the receiver.	Receiver's address, salutation and envelope	Designation when the name is unknown; never two titles together (see 1.9).	Tmt. K. Lakshmi; M/s. Kaveri Traders; The Branch Manager
Envelope address	The receiver's address (and the sender's) written on the envelope.	Posted letters; school exams ask for the "Address on the envelope"	Same as the inside address; PIN code on the last line; stamp at the top-right.	See the example in 1.9

1.9 Addressing conventions

Titles and forms of address used in the receiver's address, in the salutation and on the envelope.

Form	Use	Example
Mr.	Any man, married or unmarried	Mr. R. Karthik
Mrs.	A married woman	Mrs. S. Meena
Ms.	A woman, when her marital status is unknown or not relevant; the safe choice in business	Ms. K. Divya
Miss	An unmarried woman or a girl. No full stop - it is not an abbreviation.	Miss S. Anitha
Dr.	A medical doctor or the holder of a doctorate (Ph.D.)	Dr. P. Suresh
Prof.	A professor	Prof. V. Arun
Shri	Mr. - Central Government and Hindi usage	Shri Ramesh Kumar

Form	Use	Example
Smt.	Shrimati = Mrs. - Central Government usage	Smt. Lakshmi Devi
Kumari	Kumari (Km.) = Miss - Central Government usage	Kumari Priya Sharma
Thiru	Mr. - Tamil Nadu Government usage	Thiru K. Senthil
Thirumathi / Tmt.	Mrs. - Tamil Nadu Government usage	Tmt. R. Kavya
Selvi	Miss - Tamil Nadu Government usage	Selvi M. Divya
Hon'ble	Honourable - used for ministers and judges	The Hon'ble Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu; the Hon'ble Chief Justice, Madras High Court
M/s. (Messrs)	Plural of Mr.; written before the name of a firm, never for one person	M/s. Kaveri Traders, Erode
"The" + designation	Writing to a post or an office, especially when the name is unknown	The Principal; The Branch Manager; The Editor; The District Collector
c/o (care of)	The receiver is staying at another person's address	Ms. K. Priya, c/o Mr. S. Arun, 14, Anna Street, Salem - 636 007

Rules

- Name not known? Use the designation:** "The Branch Manager, Southern Commercial Bank, ..." with "Dear Sir/Madam, ". Official letters are addressed to the POST, so the designation is used even when you know the officer's name. (Exception: a D.O. letter between officers uses the name - "Dear Thiru Kumar," - see Section 6.)
- Through proper channel:** an employee writing to an authority above the immediate superior sends the letter through that superior. Write a "Through: ..." line (e.g. "Through: The Headmaster, Government High School, Vellore") above or below the addressee.
- Never two titles together:** "Mr. Dr. Suresh" is wrong; write "Dr. P. Suresh". Do not write "Dr." before a name and "Ph.D." after it.
- No title for yourself:** sign as "R. Karthik", not "Mr. R. Karthik".
- The salutation follows the address:** a named person → "Dear Mr. Raman," + "Yours sincerely,"; a designation → "Dear Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully,".
- Each form in its place:** M/s. only for firms; Hon'ble for ministers and judges; Thiru / Tmt. / Selvi in Tamil Nadu Government letters; Shri / Smt. / Kumari in Central Government letters.
- Full stops:** Indian usage writes Mr., Mrs., Ms., Dr. and Prof. with a full stop; British English often drops it (Mr, Dr) - accepted variant. "Miss" never takes a full stop.

Example: address on the envelope

To

Ms. K. Priya,
c/o Mr. S. Arun,
14, Anna Street,
Salem - 636 007

From

R. Karthik,
12, Gandhi Road,
K.K. Nagar,
Madurai - 625 020

Place the "To" block in the centre or on the right half of the front, the "From" block at the top-left of the front (or on the back), and the stamp at the top-right corner. For a formal letter, copy the inside address exactly - e.g. "The Commissioner, Madurai City Municipal Corporation, Madurai - 625 001".

1.10 Date formats

Style	Example	Verdict
Day, month in words, year (British / modern Indian)	12 October 2026	Recommended - used in every model letter in this book
Traditional Indian (ordinal + comma)	12th October, 2026	Acceptable
American (month, day, year)	October 12, 2026	Acceptable - American style; do not mix styles in one letter

Style	Example	Verdict
All-numeric with slashes	12/10/2026	Avoid - ambiguous: 12 October (Indian / British reading) or 10 December (American reading)
All-numeric with a short year	12.10.26 / 12-10-26	Avoid - ambiguous and incomplete
Abbreviated month or no year	12 Oct. 2026 / 12 October	Avoid - write the month in full and always give the year

MUST REMEMBER: In every letter write the date as "12 October 2026" - day, month in words, year. It goes below the sender's address, at the left margin. "12th October, 2026" is also accepted, but never use an all-numeric date such as 12/10/2026.

2

Types of Letters

Letters fall into three registers - informal, semi-formal and formal. This section lists the common types in each register. Business, banking, transactional and government letters have their own sections (Sections 3 to 6). Full model letters are in Section 10.

2.1 Personal / informal letters Informal

Features

- Written to family members, relatives and close friends.
- Warm, friendly, conversational tone; contractions ("I'm", "don't") are allowed.
- Layout: short sender's address → date → salutation → body → close → first name.
- NO receiver's address and NO subject line.
- The salutation uses the first name or the relationship ("Dear Priya,", "Dear Appa,"); the close shows the relationship ("Your loving son,", "Your loving friend,").
- The body moves from a friendly opening, to the news or purpose, to regards for the family and a request to reply.

Type	Purpose	Sample opening line	Sample closing line	Salutation → Close
Letter to parents	Share news of studies or hostel life; ask for money or permission; reassure them	I reached the hostel safely on Sunday, and I've settled in well.	Give my love to Thambi, and please take care of your health.	"Dear Appa," → "Your loving son,"
Letter to a friend	Keep in touch; share news, plans and feelings	It was lovely to get your letter after such a long time.	Do write back soon and tell me all your news.	"Dear Priya," → "Your loving friend,"
Letter to a relative	Share family news; enquire about health; thank or invite	I was happy to hear from Amma that you have fully recovered.	Please convey my regards to Aunty and my love to the children.	"Dear Uncle," → "Your loving nephew,"
Invitation letter	Invite a friend or relative to a function - wedding, birthday, house-warming	I'm happy to invite you to my sister's wedding at Thanjavur on 15 November 2026.	Do come a day early. We're all looking forward to seeing you.	"Dear Kevin," → "Your loving friend,"
Thank-you letter	Thank someone for a gift, help or hospitality	Thank you so much for the lovely watch you sent for my birthday.	Thanks once again for remembering my birthday.	"Dear Meena," → "With love,"
Congratulations letter	Congratulate someone on a success - exam result, new job, prize, marriage	I was delighted to hear that you have cleared the Group 4 examination.	Once again, my heartiest congratulations and best wishes for your new job.	"Dear Arun," → "Your loving friend,"
Condolence letter	Express sympathy and offer support after a death or a great loss	I was deeply saddened to hear about the sudden passing of your grandfather.	Please take care of yourself and your family. I'll visit you this weekend.	"Dear Vignesh," → "Your loving friend,"
Apology letter	Say sorry for a mistake - missing a function, breaking a promise, a harsh word	I'm really sorry that I couldn't attend your birthday party last Sunday.	I hope you'll forgive me. Let's meet soon.	"Dear Divya," → "Your loving friend,"
Advice letter	Guide a younger brother, sister or friend - studies, health, habits, career	Amma tells me that you're spending too much time on your mobile phone these days.	Follow a timetable, and I'm sure you'll do well. My best wishes are always with you.	"My dear Kevin," → "Yours affectionately,"
Letter describing an experience	Share a memorable event - a festival, a match, an exhibition, the first day at college	I must tell you about the wonderful day I spent at the science exhibition in our college.	I wish you and Appa had been there with me.	"Dear Amma," → "Your loving daughter,"
Letter about a travel/visit	Describe a trip or a visit to a place - what you saw, did and felt	Last week our family visited Kanyakumari, and I'm still thinking about the sunrise we saw there.	Let's plan a trip there together next summer.	"Dear Priya," → "With love,"

Type	Purpose	Sample opening line	Sample closing line	Salutation → Close
Letter requesting personal help	Ask a friend or relative for a favour - books, notes, a place to stay, guidance	I need a small favour from you, and I'm sure you won't mind.	I'll be very grateful for your help. Please reply soon.	"Dear Suresh," → "Your loving friend,"

EXAM TIP: Plan an informal body in three parts: (1) a greeting or a reference to the last letter, (2) the main news or purpose, (3) regards to the family and a request to reply. Even an informal letter needs the sender's address and the date.

2.2 Semi-formal letters **Semi-formal**

What it is	A letter to a person you know, but not closely, or to whom you must show respect. It is polite and respectful, yet more personal than a formal letter.
When it is used	When you know the receiver by name and the matter is partly personal and partly official - a request, thanks, a polite complaint or some information.
Layout	Sender's address → date → receiver's name and address → Subject (optional) → "Dear Mr. Raman," → body → "Yours sincerely," → full name.

Features

- The receiver's name and address are written; the subject line is optional.
- Salutation with title and name - "Dear Mr. Raman," / "Dear Mrs. Lakshmi,"; close - "Yours sincerely,".
- Polite and respectful, but warm; one friendly line of greeting or thanks is allowed.
- No slang; contractions are best avoided.
- Short, clear paragraphs that come to the point.
- Signed with the full name (e.g. "K. Divya"), not the first name alone.

Letter	Typical situation	Salutation → Close	Sample opening line
Letter to a teacher	Thank a former teacher; ask for guidance or a recommendation	"Dear Mrs. Lakshmi," → "Yours sincerely,"	I am writing to thank you for guiding me through my Class 12 examinations.
Letter to a landlord	Ask for repairs; explain a delay in paying rent; give notice of vacating	"Dear Mr. Senthil," → "Yours sincerely,"	I am writing about the leaking water tank in the house I rent from you.
Letter to a neighbour	Raise a problem politely (noise, parking, an overhanging tree); thank for help	"Dear Mr. Suresh," → "Yours sincerely,"	I hope you and your family are well. I am writing about the parking space in front of our houses.
Letter to a known authority	A request or suggestion to an official who knows you - ward councillor, Panchayat President, head of the residents' association	"Dear Mr. Kumar," → "Yours sincerely,"	Thank you for meeting our residents last Sunday. As discussed, I am sending our suggestions for the new park.
Letter to an acquaintance	Someone you met briefly - thank for help, or ask about a course or a job	"Dear Mr. Vignesh," → "Yours sincerely,"	We met at the career fair in Coimbatore last month, where you kindly told me about your company's internship scheme.
Letter to a former employer	Ask for an experience certificate or a reference; inform about a new job	"Dear Mr. Arun," → "Yours sincerely,"	I worked in your accounts department from 2022 to 2025, and I am writing to request an experience certificate.
Letter to a known professional (doctor / lawyer / auditor)	Ask for an appointment, a report or advice; thank for services	"Dear Dr. Meena," → "Yours sincerely,"	Thank you for treating my father last month. I am writing to request a copy of his medical report.

EXAM TIP: The same person can receive a formal or a semi-formal letter. A request to the Principal for a Transfer Certificate is FORMAL ("The Principal, ...", "Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"). A thank-you letter to a teacher who knows you well is SEMI-FORMAL ("Dear Mrs. Lakshmi," → "Yours sincerely,").

Formal vs semi-formal vs informal - compact comparison

Point	Formal	Semi-formal	Informal
Relationship	No personal relationship - an official, an office or an unknown person	Known, but not close; respect needed	Close - family and friends
Tone	Polite, impersonal, precise	Polite, respectful, warm	Friendly, casual
Salutation	"Dear Sir/Madam," / "Sir,"	"Dear Mr. Raman,"	"Dear Priya," / "Dear Appa,"
Close	"Yours faithfully,"	"Yours sincerely,"	"Your loving friend," / "With love,"
Language	No contractions, no slang, no exclamation marks	No slang; contractions best avoided	Contractions and everyday words allowed

Point	Formal	Semi-formal	Informal
Example	Complaint to the Municipal Commissioner	Letter to a landlord about repairs	Letter to a friend about a trip

For the full high-yield comparison, see Section 12.

2.3 Formal / official letters Formal

Formal (official) letters are written to officials, offices, organisations, editors and unknown persons for an official or business purpose. Default pair: "Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,". To a named person: "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,". "Respected Sir," / "Respected Madam," (Indian usage for superiors) also take "Yours faithfully,"; a school student writing to the Principal may use the traditional "Yours obediently,". Layout: see 1.6 and 1.7. Templates: Section 9. Worked examples: Section 10.

Type	Purpose	Addressed to	Key opening phrase
A. Requests and complaints			
Complaint letter HIGH-FREQUENCY	Report a problem or grievance and ask for action	The officer or office responsible - Commissioner, Manager, Inspector of Police	"I am writing to complain about ..." / "I wish to lodge a complaint regarding ..."
Application letter HIGH-FREQUENCY	Apply for a post, admission, scholarship, licence or certificate	Employer, Principal, Registrar, licensing officer	"I wish to apply for the post of ... advertised in The Hindu dated ..."
Request letter	Ask for something to be done or given - information, a facility, a document	The office or officer concerned	"I am writing to request ..." / "I would be grateful if you could ..."
Permission letter	A student or citizen asks an AUTHORITY for permission - to use a hall, hold a function, visit a factory	Principal, Commissioner, Inspector of Police, factory manager	"I request your permission to use the school auditorium on ... for ..."
Enquiry / Inquiry letter	Ask for information - courses, fees, prices, services. Both spellings are accepted (British: enquiry = asking for information, inquiry = formal investigation; American: inquiry for both).	An institution, firm or office	"I would be grateful if you could send me details of ..."
Reply to inquiry	Give the information asked for, often with a brochure or a price list	The person or firm that made the inquiry	"Thank you for your letter dated ... enquiring about ..."
B. Commercial			
Order letter	Place an order for goods - items, quantity, price, delivery and payment terms	Supplier / seller (Sales Manager)	"Please supply the following items at the prices given in your quotation No. ... dated ..."
Cancellation letter	Cancel an order, a booking, a subscription or a membership, with the reason	Supplier or service provider	"We regret that we have to cancel our order No. ... dated ..., as ..."
Adjustment letter	The SELLER's reply that settles a complaint or claim - full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons	The buyer / customer who complained	"Thank you for your letter dated ... We regret the inconvenience caused and are pleased to ..."
Claim letter	The BUYER demands a specific remedy or compensation - refund, replacement, price reduction	Seller / supplier	"We request a full refund (or a replacement) for the defective goods supplied under your invoice No. ... dated ..."
Apology letter (formal)	Apologise for an error, a delay or poor service, and state the corrective step	The customer, client or authority affected	"Please accept our sincere apologies for ..."
C. Employment			
Recommendation letter	Recommend a person for a SPECIFIC job, course or award, stating his or her strengths	A named selection committee, employer or university	"It gives me great pleasure to recommend Ms. K. Divya for ..."
Reference letter	Give GENERAL information about a person's character, conduct and work	"To Whom It May Concern" or a prospective employer	"I have known Mr. S. Vignesh for the past four years as ..."
Appointment letter	The employer appoints a selected candidate - post, pay, date of joining, conditions	The selected candidate	"With reference to your application and the interview held on ..., we are pleased to appoint you as ..."
Resignation letter	The employee formally informs the employer that he or she is leaving the job	Immediate superior / appointing authority	"I wish to resign from the post of ... with effect from ..."
Joining letter	The employee reports that he or she has joined duty (joining report)	Appointing authority / Head of Office	"With reference to your appointment order No. ... dated ..., I report for duty as ... on the forenoon of ..."

Type	Purpose	Addressed to	Key opening phrase
Leave letter HIGH-FREQUENCY	Ask for leave - casual, medical or earned - giving the dates and the reason	Principal, Head of Office or Manager	"I request you to grant me leave for two days, from ... to ..., as ..."
Transfer request	The employee asks to be moved to another place, branch or section, with reasons	Appointing authority, through proper channel	"I request you to transfer me from ... to ... on the following grounds: ..."
Promotion request	The employee asks to be considered for promotion, giving service details and qualifications	Appointing / competent authority, through proper channel	"I request you to consider my case for promotion to the post of ..."
Permission request (employee to employer)	The EMPLOYEE seeks the employer's permission - to join a course, appear for an examination, apply for another post	Head of Office / employer, through proper channel	"I request permission to appear for the ... examination to be held on ..."
D. Public authorities and media			
Letter to a government authority	Representation, request or grievance on a matter handled by a department - education, health, transport	Secretary, Director or Head of Department	"I wish to draw your attention to ..."
Letter to the District Collector	District-level problems - drinking water, roads, flood relief, land records, public grievances	The District Collector, ... District	"I am writing on behalf of the residents of ... village to request ..."
Letter to a municipal authority	Civic problems - garbage, drainage, street lights, roads, stray dogs, mosquitoes	The Commissioner, ... Corporation / Municipality; the Executive Officer, ... Town Panchayat	"I wish to bring to your notice the poor condition of ..."
Letter to a police authority	Report a theft or a loss; complain about traffic, noise or nuisance; request permission or protection	The Inspector of Police, ... Police Station; the Superintendent / Commissioner of Police	"I wish to report the theft of my motorcycle (Reg. No. ...) from ..."
Letter to the editor HIGH-FREQUENCY	Express an opinion on a public issue FOR PUBLICATION, to draw the attention of the public and the authorities	The Editor, (newspaper), city - e.g. The Editor, The Hindu, Chennai	"Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities concerned to ..."
Letter to a newspaper	A business matter with the newspaper office - subscription, delivery, advertisement, correction of an advertisement - NOT for publication	The Circulation Manager / Advertisement Manager, (newspaper), city	"I wish to subscribe to ..." / "I wish to complain about the irregular delivery of ..."
Letter to an institution	Admission, fees, certificates (Transfer Certificate, bonafide), course details, library membership	The Principal, Registrar, Director or Secretary	"I wish to seek admission to ..." / "I request you to issue my Transfer Certificate ..."
Letter to a public officer	Request a service or a certificate, or raise a grievance within the officer's powers	The Tahsildar, Block Development Officer, Village Administrative Officer, Postmaster	"I request you to issue me an income certificate, which I need for ..."

DO NOT CONFUSE: Letter to the editor vs letter to a newspaper. A letter to the editor is written FOR PUBLICATION: it raises a public issue (bad roads, pollution, water shortage) so that readers and the authorities notice it. It is addressed to "The Editor, The Hindu, Chennai" and often begins "Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper ...". A letter to a newspaper is a BUSINESS matter with the newspaper office - subscription, delivery, advertisement, correction of an advertisement. It is NOT for publication and goes to the Circulation Manager or the Advertisement Manager.

DO NOT CONFUSE: Permission letter vs permission request. A permission letter (group A): a student or citizen asks an AUTHORITY - e.g. a student asks the Principal to use the school hall for a quiz. A permission request (group C): an EMPLOYEE asks his or her EMPLOYER - e.g. to appear for an examination or join an evening course - usually through proper channel.

EXAM TIP: Decide the receiver first. Officials and offices are addressed by DESIGNATION ("The Inspector of Police, ..."), with "Dear Sir/Madam," and "Yours faithfully, ". Use "Dear Mr. Raman," and "Yours sincerely," only when the question names the receiver.

EXAM TIP: Let the first sentence state the purpose - use the "Key opening phrase" column. Never begin a formal letter with "I am fine here" or "Hope you are doing well".

EXAM TIP: An employee writing to an authority above the immediate superior (transfer, promotion, permission) adds a "Through proper channel" line - see 1.8 and 1.9. Government formats are in Section 6.

3.1 What is a Business Letter?

Definition: A business letter is a formal written communication between firms, or between a firm and its customers, suppliers, banks or government offices, on matters of trade. It is written in the firm's name and signed by an authorised person.

Purposes of a business letter

Purpose	What it means
To communicate	Ask for or give information on goods, prices, terms and payments
To get action	Place orders, settle complaints, collect dues
To keep a record	The office copy is a permanent record and evidence in a dispute
To build goodwill	Prompt, courteous letters create lasting relations
To expand business	Sales letters and circulars reach distant customers cheaply
To save time and money	Replaces personal visits

Features of a good business letter

Inner qualities (content and language)	Outer qualities (appearance)
Clear, simple and concise language	Good paper with a printed letterhead
Complete, correct facts, figures and dates	Neat full-block layout with proper margins
Courteous, even when complaining or refusing	Typed or printed; no overwriting
"You-attitude" - the reader's point of view	Reference number and date on every letter
One subject per letter; prompt reply	Correct folding and envelope (posted letters)

The 7 Cs of business communication

C	Meaning (one line)	Weak	Better
1. Completeness	Give every fact the reader needs; answer all questions.	"Please send the paper."	"Please send 100 reams of A4 paper (70 GSM) by 25 October 2026."
2. Conciseness	Fewest words that keep the full meaning; no repetition.	"Please find enclosed herewith our price list for your kind perusal."	"We enclose our price list."
3. Consideration	Reader's side ("you-attitude"); show what the reader gains.	"We allow 5% discount for early payment."	"You save 5% when you pay within 10 days."
4. Concreteness	Specific facts, figures and dates, not vague words.	"The goods will reach you soon."	"The goods will reach you on 22 October 2026."
5. Clarity	Familiar words and short sentences; only one meaning.	"Please do the needful."	"Please replace the damaged carton."
6. Courtesy	Polite, tactful and respectful, even when refusing.	"You have failed to pay us."	"Our invoice No. 512 is still unpaid; perhaps it has escaped your notice."
7. Correctness	Correct facts, figures, grammar, spelling and level of language.	"Your's faithfully"	"Yours faithfully,"

MEMORY TRICK: 3 CON + 3 CO + 1 CL = 7 Cs. CONciseness, CONsideration, CONcreteness; COMpleteness, COurtesy, CORrectness; CLarity.

EXAM TIP: "You-attitude" = Consideration - a favourite MCQ. Some books list Coherence instead of Consideration (accepted variant).

Layout of a business letter (full block)

Every line starts at the left margin. The parts, in order:

- Letterhead** - firm name in capitals, address, phone, email, GSTIN (e.g. 33XXXXXXXXX1Z5; Tamil Nadu numbers begin with 33)
- Ref. No.** - the firm's reference, e.g. Ref. No. KPM/SAL/2026/145 (in a reply, also quote "Your Ref.")
- Date** - e.g. 12 October 2026
- Inside address** - receiver's designation or name, firm and address; "M/s." before a firm's name
- "Kind Attention: ..." line** (optional) - e.g. Kind Attention: The Purchase Manager

6. **Subject** - short noun phrase, no full stop
7. **Salutation** - "Dear Sir/Madam," or "Dear Mr. Raman,"
8. **Body** - opening (reference, purpose), main (details), closing (action wanted)
9. **Complimentary close** - "Yours faithfully," or "Yours sincerely," to match the salutation
10. **"For FIRM NAME"** (optional) - the person signs on behalf of the firm
11. **Name** - of the signatory (signature above it)
12. **Designation** - e.g. Proprietor, Sales Manager
13. **Encl.** - enclosures, e.g. Encl.: Price list
14. **CC** (carbon copy) - others who receive a copy

DO NOT CONFUSE: Position of the subject line. Our model letters put the Subject BEFORE the salutation (modern full block). In the traditional British / commerce-textbook layout it comes AFTER the salutation - an accepted variant.

How the cards are arranged: Before the sale (3.2–3.3) → Order and supply (3.4–3.7) → Problems (3.8–3.10) → Money (3.11–3.16) → Cancellation (3.17) → Promotion and relations (3.18–3.21) → Courtesy (3.22). Most examples (addresses left out) follow one deal: Sri Murugan Stationers, Madurai (buyer) and Kaveri Paper Mills (seller). Full transaction chain and delivery terms: Section 5.

3.2 Business Inquiry Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A letter in which a prospective buyer asks a seller for information about goods or services - prices, quality, discounts, payment and delivery terms. "Inquiry letter" and "enquiry letter" are both accepted (British tradition: enquiry = asking for information, inquiry = formal investigation; American English uses "inquiry" for both).
Purpose	To collect prices, samples and terms from suppliers and compare them before ordering.
Sender	Prospective buyer (a firm or an individual)
Receiver	Seller - manufacturer, wholesaler or supplier
Key phrases	"We saw your advertisement in ..."; "Please send us your latest price list and catalogue."; "Kindly quote your lowest prices for ..."; "Please let us know your terms of payment and delivery."
Structure	Introduce your firm and say where you found the supplier → State exactly what you need (item, quality, quantity) → Ask about prices, discounts, payment and delivery → Ask for samples or a catalogue → Request an early reply
Exam vocabulary	<i>price list</i> - list of current prices; <i>catalogue</i> - illustrated list of goods; <i>trade discount</i> - reduction allowed to traders; <i>cash discount</i> - reduction for prompt payment; <i>solicited inquiry</i> - prompted by seller's advertisement; <i>unsolicited inquiry</i> - made on buyer's initiative

Subject: Inquiry for A4 copier paper

Dear Sir/Madam,

We are a stationery shop in Madurai and wish to stock your A4 copier paper (70 GSM and 75 GSM), which we saw advertised in a trade journal.

Please send us your latest price list, with your trade discount, terms of payment and delivery time for about 100 reams a month, and samples of both varieties.

We look forward to your early reply.

Yours faithfully,
For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
S. Senthil
Proprietor

3.3 Quotation Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions, sent in reply to an inquiry (before the order). It has a validity period (firm offer).
Purpose	To give the prices and terms asked for and win the order.
Sender	Seller - manufacturer or supplier
Receiver	The prospective buyer who sent the inquiry

Key phrases	"Thank you for your inquiry dated ..."; "We are pleased to quote as follows:"; "This quotation is valid until ..."; "We are sending samples under separate cover."
Structure	Thank the buyer and refer to the inquiry → Give prices, discounts and taxes → State terms of payment and delivery → State validity; mention samples or enclosures → Invite the order
Exam vocabulary	<i>firm offer</i> - offer open for fixed period; <i>estimate</i> - approximate cost; <i>tender</i> - formal (often sealed) offer; <i>proforma invoice</i> - preliminary bill before supply; <i>E&OE</i> - Errors and Omissions Excepted; <i>under separate cover</i> - in a separate packet

Subject: Quotation for A4 copier paper

Dear Mr. Senthil,

Thank you for your inquiry dated 5 October 2026. We are pleased to quote as follows:

A4 copier paper, 70 GSM - Rs. 240 per ream

A4 copier paper, 75 GSM - Rs. 265 per ream

Prices include GST and delivery to your shop. Trade discount: 10% on orders of 100 reams or more. Payment: within 30 days of delivery. This quotation is valid until 31 October 2026.

Samples follow under separate cover. We look forward to your order.

Yours sincerely,

For KAVERI PAPER MILLS

R. Karthik

Sales Manager

3.4 Order Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A letter placing an order: the buyer asks the seller to supply stated goods at stated prices and terms. A Purchase Order (PO) is the formal numbered document issued by the buyer; it is binding once accepted by the seller.
Purpose	To buy goods, stating quantity, quality, price, delivery and payment terms exactly, so that no dispute arises later.
Sender	Buyer
Receiver	Seller / supplier
Key phrases	"With reference to your quotation dated ..."; "Please supply the following goods:"; "Payment will be made within 30 days of delivery, as agreed."; "Kindly confirm this order."
Structure	Refer to the quotation, catalogue or sample → List the goods (description, quantity, rate) → State delivery date, place and transport → State the payment terms → Ask for confirmation of the order
Exam vocabulary	<i>purchase order (PO)</i> - buyer's formal numbered order; <i>trial order</i> - small first order; <i>repeat order</i> - same order placed again; <i>consignee</i> - person receiving the goods; <i>execute an order</i> - supply the goods ordered; <i>back order</i> - order awaiting fresh stock

Subject: Order for 100 reams of A4 copier paper

Dear Sir/Madam,

Thank you for your quotation dated 8 October 2026. Please supply the following under our Order No. SMS/145:

A4 copier paper, 70 GSM - 60 reams at Rs. 240 per ream

A4 copier paper, 75 GSM - 40 reams at Rs. 265 per ream

The 10% trade discount in your quotation will apply. Please deliver the goods to our shop by 25 October 2026. Payment will be made within 30 days of delivery, as agreed.

Kindly confirm this order.

Yours faithfully,

For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS

S. Senthil

Proprietor

3.5 Confirmation Letter (order confirmation / acceptance of order)

Definition	The seller's letter that confirms ACCEPTANCE of the buyer's order on the stated terms (goods, price, delivery date); once accepted, the order becomes a binding contract. It goes further than an acknowledgement, which confirms only RECEIPT of the order (see 3.22). A confirmation letter may also put an oral or telephone agreement on record.
Purpose	To assure the buyer that the order will be executed (not merely that it has been received), restate the details to avoid misunderstanding, and give the dispatch date.
Sender	Seller
Receiver	Buyer
Key phrases	"Thank you for your Order No. ... dated ..."; "We are pleased to confirm your order for ..."; "We confirm the prices and terms stated in your order."; "The goods will be dispatched on ... and should reach you by ..."
Structure	Thank the buyer for the order (No. and date) → Confirm acceptance and restate the key details → Give the dispatch or delivery date and mode → Close with thanks
Exam vocabulary	<i>order acknowledgement</i> - seller's note that the order is received (receipt only, not acceptance); <i>acceptance</i> - seller's consent to supply; <i>binding contract</i> - legally enforceable agreement; <i>counter-offer</i> - reply that changes the terms; <i>lead time</i> - time from order to delivery

Subject: Confirmation of your Order No. SMS/145

Dear Mr. Senthil,

Thank you for your Order No. SMS/145 dated 12 October 2026 for 100 reams of A4 copier paper.

We are pleased to confirm the order at the prices and terms of our quotation dated 8 October 2026, including the 10% trade discount. The goods will be dispatched by road on 20 October 2026 and should reach you by 22 October 2026.

We look forward to serving you regularly.

Yours sincerely,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
R. Karthik
Sales Manager

3.6 Dispatch Letter (dispatch advice)

Definition	A letter (advice) from the seller telling the buyer that the ordered goods have been sent, with details of the consignment, the carrier and the documents. Also spelt "despatch".
Purpose	To let the buyer prepare to receive the goods, send the invoice and the transport receipt needed to take delivery, and record the dispatch date.
Sender	Seller (consignor)
Receiver	Buyer (consignee)
Key phrases	"We are pleased to inform you that your order was dispatched today."; "The goods have been sent by road under LR No. ..."; "We enclose our invoice No. ... and the lorry receipt."; "The goods are insured against transit risks."
Structure	Refer to the order → Give the dispatch date, mode, carrier, receipt No. and number of packages → List the enclosures (invoice, LR / RR / B/L / AWB) → Mention insurance and the payment due → Ask the buyer to confirm receipt
Exam vocabulary	<i>consignment</i> - goods sent in one lot; <i>invoice</i> - seller's bill for goods; <i>Lorry Receipt (LR)</i> - road transporter's receipt; <i>Railway Receipt (RR)</i> - railway's receipt for goods; <i>Bill of Lading (B/L)</i> - receipt for sea shipment; <i>Airway Bill (AWB)</i> - document for air cargo

Subject: Dispatch of your Order No. SMS/145

Dear Mr. Senthil,

We are pleased to inform you that the 100 reams of A4 copier paper against your Order No. SMS/145 were dispatched today by road, in 10 cartons, under Lorry Receipt No. 4471.

We enclose our Invoice No. KPM/512 for Rs. 22,500 and the lorry receipt. The goods are insured against transit risks. Please confirm receipt when the consignment reaches you.

Yours sincerely,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
R. Karthik
Sales Manager

Encl.: 1. Invoice No. KPM/512
2. Lorry Receipt No. 4471

3.7 Delivery Letter (delivery intimation / confirmation of receipt)

Definition	A letter about the delivery of goods: the seller's (or transporter's) intimation that the goods have arrived or will be delivered on a stated date, or the buyer's confirmation that they have been received, and in what condition.
Purpose	To fix the date, time and place of delivery so that someone receives and checks the goods; the buyer's confirmation closes the order.
Sender	Seller or transporter (intimation); buyer (confirmation of receipt)
Receiver	Buyer (intimation); seller (confirmation of receipt)
Key phrases	"Your consignment will be delivered at your premises on ..."; "Please take delivery from the transporter's godown on presenting the LR."; "Kindly sign and return the delivery challan."; "We confirm receipt of the goods in good condition."
Structure	Refer to the order and dispatch (LR No., invoice No.) → Give the delivery date, time and place, or confirm receipt and condition → Mention the documents to be signed → Ask for any damage or shortage to be reported at once
Exam vocabulary	<i>delivery challan</i> - document travelling with goods; <i>Goods Received Note (GRN)</i> - buyer's record of receipt; <i>proof of delivery (POD)</i> - signed record of delivery; <i>take delivery</i> - collect goods from carrier; <i>door delivery</i> - goods brought to premises

Subject: Delivery of your Order No. SMS/145

Dear Mr. Senthil,

The 10 cartons sent under LR No. 4471 have reached our transporter's Madurai godown. They will be delivered at your shop on 22 October 2026 between 10 a.m. and 1 p.m.

Please arrange for someone to check the cartons and sign the delivery challan. If any carton is damaged, kindly note it on the challan and inform us at once.

Yours sincerely,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
R. Karthik
Sales Manager

3.8 Complaint Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A letter in which the buyer reports a problem (defect, delay, shortage, wrong goods) to the seller and asks for it to be set right. Customers also write complaint letters about poor service.
Purpose	To draw the seller's attention to the problem, get it corrected and keep a written record. Tone: firm, factual and polite - never rude.
Sender	Buyer / customer
Receiver	Seller, supplier or service provider
Key phrases	"We regret to inform you that ..."; "On opening the cartons, we found that ..."; "The goods are not up to the sample."; "We shall be glad if you will look into this matter at once."

Structure	Refer to the order and invoice (No. and date) → State the problem clearly, with facts → Explain the inconvenience or loss caused → Ask for corrective action → Close politely, expecting early action
Exam vocabulary	<i>grievance</i> - cause for complaint; <i>defective</i> - having faults; <i>shortage</i> - less than invoiced; <i>damaged in transit</i> - harmed while being carried; <i>not up to sample</i> - poorer than sample shown

Subject: Paper not up to sample - Order No. SMS/145

Dear Sir/Madam,

We received the goods against our Order No. SMS/145 on 22 October 2026. On opening the cartons, we found that 10 reams marked "75 GSM" contain thinner paper that is not up to the sample you sent us. The sheets jam in our customers' copiers.

We shall be glad if you will look into this matter at once and let us know what you propose to do.

Yours faithfully,
For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
S. Senthil
Proprietor

3.9 Claim Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A letter in which the buyer demands a specific remedy or compensation (refund, replacement, price reduction) for defective, short, damaged or late goods. A claim for loss or damage in transit is made on the carrier or the insurance company.
Purpose	To recover the loss by stating the exact remedy or amount claimed, supported by evidence.
Sender	Buyer (the claimant)
Receiver	Seller; for transit loss, the carrier or the insurance company
Key phrases	"We therefore claim ..."; "Please replace the defective goods free of cost."; "Please send us a credit note for Rs. ..."; "We are holding the goods at your disposal."
Structure	Refer to the order, invoice and earlier complaint → State the loss with evidence (test report, photographs) → State the exact remedy or amount claimed → Say what you will do with the defective goods → Ask for early settlement
Exam vocabulary	<i>claimant</i> - person making the claim; <i>compensation</i> - payment for loss; <i>refund</i> - money paid back; <i>allowance</i> - price reduction for defect; <i>at your disposal</i> - held for your instructions

Subject: Claim for 10 reams of sub-standard paper - Invoice No. KPM/512

Dear Sir/Madam,

Further to our letter dated 23 October 2026, we have tested the 10 reams of "75 GSM" paper supplied under your Invoice No. KPM/512. The paper is only 68 GSM.

We therefore claim a credit of Rs. 2,385 (10 reams at Rs. 265, less 10% trade discount) and request you to take back these reams at your cost. We are holding them at your disposal and look forward to early settlement.

Yours faithfully,
For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
S. Senthil
Proprietor

3.10 Adjustment Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	The seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim: full grant, partial grant, or polite refusal with reasons.
Purpose	To settle the matter fairly and keep the customer's goodwill. Tone: apologetic when at fault, tactful when refusing; never rude.
Sender	Seller
Receiver	Buyer (the complainant or claimant)
Key phrases	"We are sorry for the inconvenience caused to you."; "We accept your claim in full."; "As a special case, we are allowing you a discount of ..."; "We regret that we cannot accept responsibility, because ..."

Structure	Thank the customer and refer to the letter → Apologise, or explain what your inquiry found → State the decision: full grant, partial grant or refusal with reasons → Say what action is being taken (replacement, credit note, refund) → Rebuild goodwill for future business
Exam vocabulary	<i>full adjustment</i> - claim granted completely; <i>partial adjustment</i> - claim granted in part; <i>credit note</i> - seller's note reducing buyer's dues; <i>ex gratia</i> - as a favour, without obligation; <i>goodwill</i> - customers' favourable attitude

Subject: Your claim dated 26 October 2026 - Invoice No. KPM/512

Dear Mr. Senthil,

Thank you for your letter dated 26 October 2026. We are sorry that 10 reams of lighter paper were packed in your order by mistake.

We accept your claim in full. Please return the 10 reams through our transporter at our cost; we shall send you a credit note for Rs. 2,385 as soon as they reach us. We have tightened our packing checks.

We value your continued business.

Yours sincerely,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
R. Karthik
Sales Manager

3.11 Credit Letter (credit request, credit status inquiry, grant or refusal of credit)

Definition	A letter about CREDIT: a request to open a credit account, a credit (status) inquiry to referees, or a letter granting or refusing credit. Business (trade) credit means the supplier allows the buyer to pay later (e.g. 30 / 60 days).
Purpose	Buyer: to buy now and pay later. Seller: to check the buyer's creditworthiness, then state the decision and terms (credit limit and period). A refusal must be tactful and invite cash orders.
Sender	Buyer (request); seller (status inquiry, grant or refusal)
Receiver	Seller (request); referees - other suppliers or the buyer's bank (status inquiry); buyer (grant or refusal)
Key phrases	"We shall be glad if you will open a credit account for us."; "We shall be grateful for your opinion, in confidence, on the standing of ..."; "We are pleased to allow you credit up to Rs. ... on 30 days' terms."; "We regret we cannot offer credit at present but welcome your cash orders."
Structure	Introduce the firm and its trading record → State the credit wanted (limit and period) → Give trade and bank references → Assure prompt payment and request a favourable reply
Exam vocabulary	<i>credit limit</i> - maximum amount on credit; <i>credit period</i> - days allowed to pay; <i>creditworthiness</i> - ability to repay; <i>trade reference</i> - opinion from other suppliers; <i>bank reference</i> - bank's statement on customer; <i>status inquiry</i> - check on financial standing

Subject: Request to open a credit account

Dear Sir/Madam,

We have bought paper from you on cash terms for the past year. As our orders are now regular, we shall be glad if you will open a credit account for us with a limit of Rs. 1,00,000 on 30 days' terms.

For our standing, you may refer to Southern Commercial Bank, Egmore, Chennai, and to Anbu Printers, Madurai. We assure you of prompt payment.

Yours faithfully,
For PAVAI BOOK HOUSE
K. Meena
Partner

DO NOT CONFUSE: A **credit letter** is about buying on credit. A **Letter of Credit (L/C)** is a BANK's written undertaking to pay the seller/exporter against documents; a **credit note** is the SELLER's document that reduces what the buyer owes; a **credit advice** is a bank's intimation of a credit - see Section 4.

3.12 Debit Letter (debit advice / debit-note covering letter)

Definition	A letter about a DEBIT. (a) Debit advice : an intimation (usually from a bank) that an account has been debited. (b) Debit-note covering letter : sent with a debit note, which is issued by the BUYER to the seller when returning goods or claiming a deduction (it tells the seller that his account has been debited); a seller may also send a debit note to charge an extra amount (undercharge). Side note only: under GST law both notes are issued by the supplier.
Purpose	To tell the other party the amount and reason for a debit entry (goods returned, shortage, overcharge, undercharge, bank charges) so that both accounts agree.
Sender	Buyer (returns, deductions); seller (undercharge); bank (debit advice)
Receiver	Seller (buyer's debit note); buyer (seller's debit note); account holder (bank's debit advice)
Key phrases	"We enclose our Debit Note No. ... for Rs. ..."; "We have debited your account with Rs. ... for the goods returned."; "The freight of Rs. ... was left out of our invoice No. ... by mistake."; "Your account has been debited with Rs. ... towards ..."
Structure	Refer to the invoice or transaction → State the reason for the debit → Give the amount and the debit note number, and enclose the note → Ask for a matching credit note or confirmation
Exam vocabulary	<i>debit note</i> - buyer's note claiming a deduction; <i>debit advice</i> - bank's intimation of debit; <i>undercharge</i> - billed less than due; <i>overcharge</i> - billed more than due; <i>purchase returns</i> - goods returned to supplier; <i>statement of account</i> - summary of dealings and balance

Subject: Return of 10 reams - our Debit Note No. 12

Dear Sir/Madam,

As agreed in your letter dated 28 October 2026, we have today returned, through your transporter, the 10 reams of sub-standard paper supplied under your Invoice No. KPM/512.

We enclose our Debit Note No. 12 for Rs. 2,385 and have debited your account with this amount. Please send us your credit note for Rs. 2,385.

Yours faithfully,
For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
S. Senthil
Proprietor

Encl.: Debit Note No. 12

DO NOT CONFUSE: A **debit letter** only explains or covers a debit. The **debit note**, the **credit note** and the **Letter of Credit** (a bank's undertaking to pay) are explained in Section 4. Quick check: debit note - mainly the BUYER's document; credit note - the SELLER's.

3.13 Collection Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A letter written by a seller (creditor) to a customer whose payment is overdue, asking for payment. Collection letters are usually sent as a series, each firmer than the last (the collection series).
Purpose	To recover overdue money while keeping goodwill as long as possible, to learn the reason for delay and, at the last stage, to warn of legal action.
Sender	Seller / creditor (accounts or credit department)
Receiver	Buyer / debtor who has not paid
Key phrases	"May we remind you that our invoice No. ... for Rs. ... was due on ..."; "We are surprised that we have had no reply to our earlier letters."; "Unless we receive payment by ..., we shall be compelled to take legal action."; "If you have already sent the payment, please ignore this letter."
Structure	State the amount, invoice No. and due date → Refer to earlier reminders (in later letters) → Ask for payment or the reason for delay → Fix a final date → State the consequence (final notice only)
Exam vocabulary	<i>overdue</i> - not paid by due date; <i>outstanding</i> - still unpaid; <i>debtor</i> - one who owes money; <i>creditor</i> - one owed money; <i>final notice</i> - last demand before action; <i>legal notice</i> - lawyer's formal demand

Subject: Final notice - Invoice No. JE/318 for Rs. 48,600

Dear Sir/Madam,

Our Invoice No. JE/318 for Rs. 48,600 fell due on 31 July 2026. We have received neither payment nor a reply to our reminders dated 16 August 2026 and 10 September 2026.

Unless the full amount reaches us by 15 October 2026, we shall be compelled to hand over the matter to our lawyers without further notice. We hope you will settle the account and spare us this unpleasant step.

Yours faithfully,
For JOTHI ELECTRICALS
V. Divya
Accounts Manager

The collection series - the tone rises step by step:

Stage	Tone	Typical line
1. First reminder	Polite - assumes an oversight	"Perhaps this has escaped your notice."
2. Second reminder	Firmer - asks for payment or the reason for delay	"May we know why the account is still unpaid?"
3. Final notice / demand	Firm - warns of legal action	"... we shall hand over the matter to our lawyers."

Some books show more stages (e.g. reminder, inquiry, appeal, ultimatum) - accepted variant; the tone still rises: polite → firm → final.

3.14 Reminder Letter

Definition	A polite letter that reminds the receiver of something promised or due but not yet done - a payment, a reply, a delivery, a renewal or a document.
Purpose	To get the pending action without giving offence and to keep a written record of the follow-up. Tone: polite; assume it is an oversight.
Sender	Whoever is waiting for action (seller, buyer or any contact)
Receiver	The person or firm that has not yet acted
Key phrases	"This is to remind you that ..."; "We would like to draw your attention to our letter dated ..."; "We have not yet received ..."; "We shall be glad to hear from you by ..."
Structure	Refer to the earlier letter, order or due date → State what is still pending → Explain why it is urgent → Request action by a definite date
Exam vocabulary	<i>pending</i> - not yet done; <i>follow-up</i> - checking on progress; <i>due date</i> - last date for action; <i>renewal</i> - extension for another period; <i>at the earliest</i> - as soon as possible

Subject: Reminder - delivery against Order No. PBH/77

Dear Sir/Madam,

We would like to draw your attention to our Order No. PBH/77 dated 1 September 2026 for 40 steel bookshelves, which you promised to deliver by 20 September 2026. We have not yet received the goods or any word from you.

As we need the shelves for our new branch, please let us know the date of dispatch by 30 September 2026.

Yours faithfully,
For PAVAI BOOK HOUSE
K. Meena
Partner

3.15 Payment Request Letter

Definition	A letter in which a seller or service provider asks the customer to pay an amount that is due (or an agreed advance or part payment), usually enclosing the bill.
Purpose	To get payment on time by stating the amount, due date and mode of payment clearly. Tone: routine and courteous - the money is due, not yet overdue.

Sender	Seller / service provider (accounts department)
Receiver	Buyer / client
Key phrases	"We enclose our invoice No. ... for Rs. ..."; "The amount is payable by ..."; "Please remit the amount by NEFT to our account ..."; "Kindly quote the invoice number with your payment."
Structure	Refer to the goods or services supplied and the invoice → State the amount and the due date → Give payment details (mode, bank account) → Request payment by the due date and thank the customer
Exam vocabulary	<i>remit</i> - send money; <i>remittance</i> - money sent; <i>NEFT</i> - National Electronic Funds Transfer; <i>RTGS</i> - Real Time Gross Settlement; <i>part payment</i> - paying only a portion

Subject: Payment for annual maintenance - Invoice No. BCS/2026/88

Dear Mr. Raman,

We enclose our Invoice No. BCS/2026/88 dated 1 October 2026 for Rs. 18,880 (including GST) for the annual maintenance of your 20 computers for 2026-27.

As agreed, the amount is payable by 15 October 2026. Please remit it by NEFT to our account with Southern Commercial Bank (details on the invoice), quoting the invoice number.

Thank you for your continued support.

Yours sincerely,
For BRIGHT COMPUTER SYSTEMS
A. Vignesh
Accounts Officer

Encl.: Invoice No. BCS/2026/88

3.16 Payment Confirmation Letter

Definition	A letter confirming that a payment has been received and credited against the correct bill, and stating any balance. A payer may also write to confirm a payment made, giving the transaction details.
Purpose	To give written proof of payment, close the bill, prevent disputes and repeated demands, and thank the customer.
Sender	Payee - seller or creditor (or the payer, confirming a payment made)
Receiver	Payer - buyer or client (or the payee)
Key phrases	"We confirm receipt of your payment of Rs. ... by NEFT on ..."; "The amount has been adjusted against our invoice No. ..."; "Your account now shows a nil balance."; "Our official receipt No. ... is enclosed."
Structure	Confirm the amount, date, mode and reference (UTR or cheque No.) → Say which bill it settles → State the balance → Enclose the receipt and thank the customer
Exam vocabulary	<i>receipt</i> - written proof of payment; <i>UTR</i> - Unique Transaction Reference; <i>nil balance</i> - nothing remains due; <i>subject to realisation</i> - valid once cheque clears; <i>settle</i> - pay in full

Subject: Confirmation of payment - Invoice No. BCS/2026/88

Dear Mr. Raman,

We confirm receipt of Rs. 18,880 by NEFT on 12 October 2026 (UTR ending 7093).

The amount has been adjusted in full against our Invoice No. BCS/2026/88, and your account now shows a nil balance. Our official Receipt No. 1142 is enclosed.

Thank you for your prompt payment.

Yours sincerely,
For BRIGHT COMPUTER SYSTEMS
A. Vignesh
Accounts Officer

Encl.: Receipt No. 1142

3.17 Cancellation Letter

Definition	A letter that cancels (withdraws) an order, booking, contract or subscription already placed, usually giving the reason.
Purpose	To stop the supplier before the goods are dispatched or the service is given, to avoid later disputes, and to get back any advance paid. Tone: prompt, clear and polite.
Sender	Buyer / customer who placed the order or booking
Receiver	Seller, supplier or service provider
Key phrases	"We regret that we have to cancel our Order No. ... dated ..."; "owing to unforeseen circumstances"; "Please do not dispatch the goods."; "Kindly refund our advance of Rs. ..."
Structure	Identify the order (No., date, goods) → Cancel it clearly and give a brief reason → Ask the seller not to dispatch and to confirm the cancellation → Ask for a refund of any advance → Close politely to keep goodwill
Exam vocabulary	<i>countermand</i> - cancel an earlier order; <i>unforeseen circumstances</i> - unexpected events; <i>cancellation charges</i> - fee for cancelling; <i>refund</i> - money returned; <i>advance</i> - payment before supply

Subject: Cancellation of Order No. PBH/77

Dear Sir/Madam,

We regret that we have to cancel our Order No. PBH/77 dated 1 September 2026 for 40 steel bookshelves. The goods were due by 20 September 2026 and have not been delivered even after our reminder dated 25 September 2026.

Please do not dispatch the goods now, and kindly refund our advance of Rs. 20,000 at the earliest.

Yours faithfully,
For PAVAI BOOK HOUSE
K. Meena
Partner

3.18 Sales Letter

Definition	A persuasive letter to prospective or existing customers that introduces a product or service and persuades the reader to buy. It follows the AIDA plan and is often sent to many readers by post or email (direct mail), each copy personalised.
Purpose	To create demand, increase sales, announce offers and reach many customers at low cost.
Sender	Seller, manufacturer or service provider (sales or marketing department)
Receiver	Prospective and existing customers
Key phrases	"Would you like to ...?"; "Here is good news for ..."; "This offer is open only till ..."; "Call us today to book a free demonstration."
Structure	Attention - a striking opening → Interest - what the product is and does → Desire - benefits, proof, guarantee, offer → Action - tell the reader exactly what to do now
Exam vocabulary	<i>AIDA</i> - Attention, Interest, Desire, Action; <i>USP (Unique Selling Proposition)</i> - feature that beats rivals; <i>prospect</i> - likely customer; <i>direct mail</i> - letters sent straight to customers; <i>call to action</i> - line urging reader to act

Subject: Free installation of solar water heaters till 30 November 2026

Dear Mr. Venkatesan,

Would you like free hot water every morning?

Our Surya 200-litre solar water heater is fitted on your roof in one day and supplies hot water for a family of five.

It cuts your power bill every month and carries a five-year warranty. Till 30 November 2026, installation is free.

Call us today to book a free roof inspection.

Yours sincerely,
For SURYA SOLAR SYSTEMS
G. Priya
Sales Manager

AIDA - the plan of every sales letter (lines from the example above):

Step	What it does	Example line
A - Attention	Catches the eye with a question, a fact or an offer	"Would you like free hot water every morning?"
I - Interest	Describes the product and how it works	"... fitted on your roof in one day ..."
D - Desire	Makes the reader want it: benefits, proof, guarantee, offer	"... five-year warranty ... installation is free."
A - Action	Tells the reader exactly what to do, now	"Call us today to book a free roof inspection."

3.19 Circular Letter (business circular: new branch, change of address, admission/retirement of a partner, price revision) HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A letter with the same content sent to many readers at once - customers, suppliers, dealers, bankers - with news of common interest: a new branch, a change of address, the admission or retirement of a partner, a price revision. (A government circular is different - see Section 6.)
Purpose	To inform many people quickly, cheaply and in the same words, and keep their goodwill. A circular on a partner's retirement also serves as notice to the firm's customers and suppliers.
Sender	The firm (proprietor, partners or management)
Receiver	Many readers at once - customers, suppliers, dealers, bankers
Key phrases	"We are pleased to announce that ..."; "We are opening a new branch at ... on ..."; "With effect from ..., our office will function at ..."; "Owing to the rise in raw-material costs, we have to revise our prices from ..."
Structure	Announce the news and the date it takes effect → Give details (address, branch, partner's background, new prices) → Explain the reason or the benefit → Assure continued quality and service → Request continued support
Exam vocabulary	<i>with effect from (w.e.f.)</i> - from the stated date; <i>specimen signature</i> - sample signature for records; <i>partnership deed</i> - partners' written agreement; <i>price revision</i> - change in prices; <i>retirement (of a partner)</i> - leaving the firm

Subject: Admission of a new partner

Dear Sir/Madam,

We are pleased to inform you that Mr. P. Arun, our Sales Manager for the past ten years, has been admitted as a partner in our firm with effect from 1 November 2026.

The firm will continue under the same name, and our policies remain unchanged. Mr. Arun will sign for the firm as shown below.

We trust you will continue to support us as before.

Yours faithfully,
For NOYYAL TEXTILES
T. Suresh
Managing Partner

Specimen signature of Mr. P. Arun:

3.20 Recommendation / Reference Letter (business context: recommending a firm or person; trade reference)

Definition	A letter giving an opinion on the standing, reliability or ability of a firm or person. It may (a) recommend a firm or person to a third party, or (b) be a trade reference - a reply to a credit (status) inquiry about a firm's creditworthiness. Credit references also come from credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL).
Purpose	To help the receiver decide whether to trade with, give credit to, or appoint the firm or person; the opinion must be honest and confidential.
Sender	Referee - a supplier (trade referee), a bank (bank reference) or a firm that knows the person
Receiver	The firm that asked for the reference, or a prospective business partner
Key phrases	"In reply to your inquiry of ..., we are pleased to give the following information."; "We have much pleasure in recommending ... to you."; "We consider them good for credit up to Rs. ..."; "This information is given in strict confidence and without any responsibility on our part."
Structure	Refer to the inquiry (usually without naming the firm: "the firm named in your letter") → State how long you have known the firm → Give facts: payment record, reliability, standing → Give your opinion (cautiously if unfavourable) → Add the confidentiality and no-responsibility clause

Exam vocabulary	<i>referee</i> - person giving the reference; <i>credit reference</i> - information on creditworthiness; <i>in strict confidence</i> - not to be disclosed; <i>without responsibility</i> - no liability for opinion; <i>unfavourable reference</i> - cautious negative opinion
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Subject: Confidential - your status inquiry dated 2 November 2026

Dear Sir/Madam,

In reply to your inquiry, we are pleased to inform you that the firm named in your letter has bought from us on credit for the past six years. They have always settled our bills within the agreed 30 days, and we consider them good for credit up to Rs. 1,00,000.

This information is given in strict confidence and without any responsibility on our part.

Yours faithfully,
For ANBU PRINTERS
M. Lakshmi
Manager

3.21 Introduction Letter (introducing a new firm or a representative)

Definition	A letter that introduces a new firm, or a firm's representative (salesperson, agent), to customers and business contacts. It only introduces; a recommendation letter (3.20) also vouches for reliability.
Purpose	To open new business contacts and help a new firm or a representative to be received and trusted.
Sender	The new firm, or the firm that employs the representative
Receiver	Existing or prospective customers, dealers and business contacts
Key phrases	"We have pleasure in introducing ..., our new Sales Representative for ..."; "We have started business as ... at ..."; "The bearer of this letter, Mr. ..., is ..."; "We shall appreciate any courtesy you extend to her."
Structure	Name the person or firm being introduced → Give brief background (experience, role, products) → State the purpose of the visit or the business offered → Request co-operation and close with thanks
Exam vocabulary	<i>representative</i> - person acting for a firm; <i>call on</i> - visit formally; <i>bearer</i> - person carrying this letter; <i>credentials</i> - proof of identity and authority; <i>territory</i> - area assigned to salesperson

Subject: Introducing our new Sales Representative

Dear Mr. Senthil,

We have pleasure in introducing Ms. N. Anitha, who has joined us as Sales Representative for Madurai and Tirunelveli.

Ms. Anitha will call on you during the first week of November 2026 to show you our new range of coloured paper and to take your orders. She is authorised to quote prices and delivery dates.

We shall appreciate any courtesy you extend to her.

Yours sincerely,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
R. Karthik
Sales Manager

3.22 Acknowledgement Letter

Definition	A short letter telling the sender that a letter, order, payment, application, documents or goods have been received and, where needed, when a full reply or action will follow. It confirms RECEIPT only: acknowledging an order does not accept it - acceptance is given in a confirmation letter (3.5).
Purpose	To assure the sender that the item has arrived, to keep a record of receipt, and to gain time politely when a full reply needs checking.
Sender	The receiver of the letter, goods or payment
Receiver	The person or firm that sent it
Key phrases	"We acknowledge with thanks receipt of your letter dated ..."; "The matter is receiving our attention."; "We shall write to you in detail within ... days."; "Please quote our reference No. ... in future correspondence."

Structure	Acknowledge receipt (what, date, reference) → Thank the sender → Say what will happen next and when → Give a reference number and close courteously
Exam vocabulary	<i>acknowledge</i> - admit receiving something; <i>interim reply</i> - temporary reply before full answer; <i>inward register</i> - record of letters received; <i>reference number</i> - number for tracing correspondence; <i>under consideration</i> - being examined

Subject: Your letter dated 23 October 2026 - Invoice No. KPM/512

Dear Mr. Senthil,

We acknowledge with thanks receipt of your letter dated 23 October 2026 about 10 reams of paper supplied under our Invoice No. KPM/512.

The matter is receiving our immediate attention. We have asked our quality-control section to check the batch, and we shall write to you in detail within three days.

Yours sincerely,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
R. Karthik
Sales Manager

3.23 Quick Revision Table

Letter	Written by	Sent to	One-line purpose
Inquiry (3.2)	Prospective buyer	Seller / supplier	Ask for prices, samples and terms
Quotation (3.3)	Seller	Buyer who inquired	Give prices, terms and validity period
Order (3.4)	Buyer	Seller	Place an order with exact details
Confirmation (3.5)	Seller	Buyer	Accept the order and restate its terms
Dispatch (3.6)	Seller (consignor)	Buyer (consignee)	Goods sent; invoice and LR / RR enclosed
Delivery (3.7)	Seller or transporter; buyer (receipt)	Buyer; seller (receipt)	Fix delivery, or confirm receipt
Complaint (3.8)	Buyer / customer	Seller / service provider	Report defect, delay, shortage or wrong goods
Claim (3.9)	Buyer (claimant)	Seller; carrier or insurer	Demand a specific remedy or compensation
Adjustment (3.10)	Seller	Buyer (complainant)	Settle the complaint: grant, part-grant or refuse
Credit (3.11)	Buyer; seller	Seller; referees; buyer	Request, check, grant or refuse credit
Debit (3.12)	Buyer (mainly); seller; bank	Seller; buyer; account holder	Explain a debit or cover a debit note
Collection (3.13)	Seller / creditor	Buyer who has not paid (debtor)	Recover overdue money (series of letters)
Reminder (3.14)	Party waiting for action	Party that has not acted	Remind about any pending matter
Payment request (3.15)	Seller / service provider	Buyer / client	Ask for payment that is due
Payment confirmation (3.16)	Payee (seller)	Payer (buyer)	Confirm payment received; state balance
Cancellation (3.17)	Buyer / customer	Seller / service provider	Withdraw an order or booking
Sales (3.18)	Seller / marketer	Prospective customers	Persuade the reader to buy (AIDA)
Circular (3.19)	Firm	Many readers at once	Announce branch, address, partner or price news
Recommendation / Reference (3.20)	Referee (supplier, bank or firm)	Firm that asked	Give an opinion on reliability or credit
Introduction (3.21)	Firm	Customers / business contacts	Introduce a new firm or a representative
Acknowledgement (3.22)	Receiver of a letter, goods or payment	Its sender	Say it has been received; action to follow

3.24 Do Not Confuse

Full comparison tables: Section 15.

DO NOT CONFUSE: **Complaint** (buyer) reports the problem; **claim** (buyer) demands a specific remedy or compensation; **adjustment** (SELLER) is the reply that settles it - full grant, partial grant or polite refusal.

DO NOT CONFUSE: A **reminder** can be about ANY pending matter (payment, reply, delivery) and is usually one polite letter; a **collection letter** is only about OVERDUE MONEY and comes in a series that gets firmer (first reminder → second reminder → final notice).

DO NOT CONFUSE: A **circular** INFORMS many readers of the same news (new branch, new address, new partner, new prices); a **sales letter** PERSUADES readers to buy, using AIDA.

DO NOT CONFUSE: An **acknowledgement** only says something has been RECEIVED (action to follow); a **confirmation** says it is ACCEPTED or FINAL (order accepted, payment credited, terms agreed). An "acknowledgement of order" only reports that the order has been received; the letter that accepts it is the confirmation letter (3.5).

MUST REMEMBER: The BUYER writes the inquiry, order, complaint, claim and cancellation; the SELLER writes the quotation, confirmation, dispatch advice, adjustment, payment request and collection letters. Business cycle: Inquiry → Quotation → Order → Confirmation → Dispatch → Delivery → (Complaint → Claim → Adjustment) → Payment request → Reminder / Collection (only if unpaid) → Payment confirmation.

MUST REMEMBER: Model business letters use full block, with the Subject BEFORE the salutation. Pair correctly: "Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"; "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,". "For FIRM NAME" goes above the signatory's name and designation. No contractions, no exclamation marks, no "do the needful".

4 Banking and Financial Letters

Banking and financial letters deal with accounts, cheques, cards, loans, credit and payments. Most go from a **customer to the Branch Manager**; a few come from the **bank** (bank reference) or from one **firm** to another (credit reference, reminders, cheque dishonour notice). All are **Formal**. Full exam-style banking letters: see Section 10.

4.1 General Rules for Bank Letters

Rule	Details
Addressee	"The Branch Manager, <bank>, <branch>, <city>" - write to the branch where your account is kept (your home branch). Address the manager by designation, not by name.
Details to include	Account holder's name (exactly as in the bank records), account number (masked, e.g. XXXXXXXX4521), account type (Savings / Current / Loan / Fixed Deposit), customer ID (CIF number) if any, and the registered mobile number.
Subject	Precise - the request plus the account, e.g. "Subject: Request for a new cheque book - SB A/c No. XXXXXXXX4521". Never just "Subject: Request".
Salutation and close	"Dear Sir/Madam," (or "Sir," / "Madam,") → "Yours faithfully,".
Body	Short and factual, in three parts: (1) who you are and which account; (2) the facts - dates, amounts, cheque or reference numbers; (3) the action you want. One request per letter.
Enclosures	Self-attested ID proof (and address proof where needed) and supporting papers (statement, SMS alert, return memo), listed below the name: "Encl.: 1. ... 2. ...". Self-attested = you sign the photocopy yourself.
Signature	Sign as per the bank records (your specimen signature); a mismatch can lead to rejection. Firm: authorised signatory with the firm's seal. Joint account: as per the mode of operation.
SAFETY	Never write your PIN, OTP, CVV or passwords - not in a letter, email, form or phone call. Mask the account number where the full number is not needed; give only the last four digits of a card.
In the exam	Use the bank, branch and names given in the question. If your name and address are not given, write "Examination Hall" as your address and sign as "ABC" / "XYZ".

Addressee block (full-block style):

To
The Branch Manager,
Southern Commercial Bank,
Anna Nagar Branch,
Chennai - 600 040

4.2 Request for Bank Statement

Purpose	To get a statement of account for a stated period - e.g. for income-tax filing, a loan, a visa or an audit.
Written by → to	Account holder → The Branch Manager (home branch)
Must include	Masked A/c No. and account type; the exact period ("from ... to ..."); the purpose; how you will receive it (branch / post / registered email); consent to pay charges, if any.
Key phrases	"I request you to issue a statement of my account for the period from ... to ..."; "duly signed and sealed by the bank"; "Please debit the applicable charges, if any, to my account."

Subject: Request for account statement - SB A/c No. XXXXXXXXX4521

Dear Sir/Madam,

I hold a savings bank account in your branch (A/c No. XXXXXXXXX4521, Customer ID 40318827). I request you to issue a statement of this account for the period from 1 April 2025 to 31 March 2026.

I need the statement, duly signed and sealed by the bank, to file my income-tax return.

I shall collect it from the branch in person. Please debit the applicable charges, if any, to my account.

Yours faithfully,

R. Karthik

4.3 Request for Cheque Book

Purpose	To ask for a new cheque book when the present one is nearly used up. (A letter is used when the requisition slip in the cheque book is not available.)
Written by → to	Account holder (individual or firm) → The Branch Manager
Must include	Masked A/c No. and account type; number of leaves; delivery (collect at the branch / send to the registered address); for a firm, the authorised signatory's signature with the seal.
Key phrases	"Please issue a cheque book of 50 leaves for my current account No. ..."; "Our present cheque book will be used up shortly"; "Please send it to our address registered with the bank."

Subject: Request for a new cheque book - Current A/c No. XXXXXXXXX7788

Dear Sir/Madam,

We maintain a current account in your branch in the name of Sri Murugan Stationers (A/c No. XXXXXXXXX7788).

Our present cheque book will be used up shortly. Please issue a new cheque book of 50 leaves for this account.

Please send it by courier to our address registered with the bank.

Yours faithfully,

S. Senthil

Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers

4.4 Stop-Payment Request HIGH-FREQUENCY

Purpose	The account holder instructs the bank NOT to pay a cheque that is lost, stolen, wrongly written or issued by mistake. It works only if the cheque has not yet been paid - so act at once (if urgent, use net banking or the helpline, then confirm in writing).
Written by → to	Account holder (drawer of the cheque) → The Branch Manager
Must include	Masked A/c No.; cheque number, date, amount and payee's name ; the reason; a request for written confirmation; consent to pay the charges.
Key phrases	"Please stop payment of Cheque No. ... dated ... for Rs. ... in favour of ..."; "The cheque has been lost / was issued by mistake"; "Please confirm that the payment has been stopped."

Subject: Request to stop payment of Cheque No. 245817

Dear Sir/Madam,

I request you to stop payment of Cheque No. 245817 dated 20 September 2026 for Rs. 12,500, drawn on my savings bank account No. XXXXXXXX3196 in favour of M/s. Kaveri Traders.

The cheque was lost in the post and has not reached the payee.

Please record this instruction immediately and confirm it to me in writing. The stop-payment charges may be debited to my account.

Yours faithfully,
K. Priya

4.5 ATM / Debit-Card Complaint HIGH-FREQUENCY

Purpose	To report an ATM or debit-card problem - cash not dispensed but account debited, wrong amount, card retained by the machine, card lost / stolen - and ask for reversal, blocking or a new card.
Written by → to	Card holder → The Branch Manager (home branch) or the bank's card / grievance cell
Must include	Masked A/c No.; last four digits of the card only; date, time and amount; ATM location and ID; transaction reference number (from the SMS or slip); what went wrong; complaint number, if any; copies of the SMS / statement. Never the PIN, OTP or CVV.
Key phrases	"Cash was not dispensed, but my account was debited with Rs. ..."; "Please reverse the amount to my account"; "Please block my card immediately and issue a new one"; "compensation, if applicable, as per current RBI rules [VERIFY CURRENT RULE]".

Subject: Cash not dispensed at ATM but account debited - SB A/c No. XXXXXXXX5083

Dear Sir/Madam,

On 25 September 2026 at 7.40 p.m., I tried to withdraw Rs. 10,000 from your ATM at Gandhipuram, Coimbatore (ATM ID: SCB0412), with my debit card ending 3057. No cash was dispensed, but my account was debited with Rs. 10,000 (transaction reference No. 626807412345).

I reported this to your customer care the same evening (Complaint No. 772145). Copies of the SMS alert and my account statement are enclosed.

Please credit Rs. 10,000 back to my account as soon as possible.

Yours faithfully,
N. Arun

Encl.: 1. Copy of the SMS alert
2. Copy of the account statement

4.6 Address-Change Request

Purpose	To update a new address in the bank's records (a KYC update) after shifting house.
Written by → to	Account holder → The Branch Manager
Must include	Masked A/c No. / customer ID; old and new address with pin code; date of shifting; self-attested proof of the new address (e.g. Aadhaar, passport, voter ID, driving licence); a request to update all accounts.
Key phrases	"I have shifted my residence to the following address with effect from ..."; "Please update my address in your records for all my accounts"; "I enclose a self-attested copy of my ... as proof of my new address."

Subject: Change of address - SB A/c No. XXXXXXXXX2764

Dear Sir/Madam,

I request you to change the address recorded for my savings bank account No. XXXXXXXXX2764, as I have shifted my residence with effect from 1 September 2026.

My new address is 18, Lake View Road, Velachery, Chennai - 600 042. I enclose a self-attested copy of my Aadhaar card as proof of the new address.

Please update this address for all my accounts and send future letters and statements to it.

Yours faithfully,
T. Meena

Encl.: Self-attested copy of Aadhaar card

4.7 Account-Closing Letter

Purpose	To close a bank account (moving to another town, account no longer needed) and have the balance paid out or transferred.
Written by → to	Account holder (for a joint account, usually all holders sign) → The Branch Manager
Must include	Masked A/c No.; a brief reason; how the balance should be paid (transfer - enclose a cancelled cheque of the other account - or a pay order); unused cheque leaves (with numbers) and the debit card returned. Clear dues and stop auto-debits first.
Key phrases	"I request you to close my savings bank account No. ..."; "Please transfer the closing balance, after deducting charges if any, to ..."; "I am returning the unused cheque leaves (Nos. ... to ...) and my debit card, cut into two."

Subject: Request to close SB A/c No. XXXXXXXXX6419

Dear Sir/Madam,

As I have been transferred to Tirunelveli, I request you to close my savings bank account No. XXXXXXXXX6419 with your branch.

Please transfer the closing balance, after deducting charges if any, to the account shown in the enclosed cancelled cheque.

I am returning the unused cheque leaves (Nos. 318406 to 318420) and my debit card, cut into two.

Yours faithfully,
G. Suresh

Encl.: 1. Cancelled cheque
2. Unused cheque leaves (Nos. 318406 to 318420)
3. Debit card (cut into two)

4.8 Loan Application HIGH-FREQUENCY

Purpose	To apply for a loan - education, home, vehicle, business or crop - stating the amount, purpose, repayment ability and security. Usually sent with the bank's loan application form.
Written by → to	Applicant → The Branch Manager
Must include	Purpose and amount; details of the course / house / vehicle / business; income and co-applicant details; repayment period; security or guarantor; enclosures (admission letter or quotation, income proof, ID and address proof).
Key phrases	"I request you to sanction an education loan of Rs. ... for ..."; "My father, Mr. ..., will be the co-applicant"; "I undertake to repay the loan in EMIs (equated monthly instalments) after the moratorium period" (moratorium = a period when no repayment is due, e.g. during the course).

Subject: Application for an education loan of Rs. 4,50,000

Dear Sir/Madam,

I have been admitted to the four-year B.E. (Civil Engineering) course at a government-aided college in Coimbatore from 2026-27. The total cost, including tuition, hostel and books, is Rs. 5,60,000, of which my family will meet Rs. 1,10,000.

I request you to sanction an education loan of Rs. 4,50,000. My father, Mr. K. Selvam, who has held a savings account in your branch for ten years, will be the co-applicant.

I enclose the admission letter, the fee structure, my father's income certificate and our self-attested ID and address proofs. I undertake to repay the loan in EMIs after the moratorium period, as per the bank's rules.

Yours faithfully,
S. Divya

Encl.: 1. Admission letter
2. Fee structure
3. Father's income certificate
4. Self-attested ID and address proofs

4.9 Loan Repayment Request (Rescheduling / EMI Date / Pre-closure and NOC)

Purpose	To change how a loan is repaid: (a) rescheduling EMIs during a temporary difficulty (longer tenure, smaller EMI or a short break); (b) changing the EMI date to suit the salary date; (c) pre-closure - repaying the whole loan early - and a No Objection Certificate (NOC) , the lender's letter that no dues remain.
Written by → to	Borrower → The Branch Manager (loan section)
Must include	Masked loan A/c No.; type of loan; the exact request; the reason (with proof for rescheduling, e.g. crop loss, salary cut, illness); for pre-closure, the exact amount payable and the NOC; for a vehicle loan, removal of the bank's hypothecation (its charge on the vehicle) from the registration certificate (RC).
Key phrases	"Please reschedule my loan by extending the tenure and reducing the EMI"; "Please change my EMI date from the 5th to the 10th of every month"; "I wish to pre-close my loan; please let me know the total amount payable"; "Please issue a No Objection Certificate (NOC) after the loan is closed."

Subject: Pre-closure of two-wheeler loan A/c No. XXXXXXXX6620 and issue of NOC

Dear Sir/Madam,

I have a two-wheeler loan with your branch (Loan A/c No. XXXXXXXX6620), sanctioned in June 2024, and I wish to pre-close it in full this month.

Please let me know the exact amount payable, including charges if any, so that I can pay it before 31 October 2026.

After the loan is closed, please issue a No Objection Certificate (NOC) and a letter to remove the bank's hypothecation from the registration certificate (RC) of my vehicle.

Yours faithfully,
A. Vignesh

4.10 Interest Certificate Request

Purpose	To get a certificate of the interest paid on a loan (home / education) or earned on deposits, with TDS (tax deducted at source) details, for a financial year - usually for the income-tax return.
Written by → to	Borrower / depositor → The Branch Manager
Must include	Masked loan or deposit A/c No.; the financial year (e.g. 2025-26); what it must show (principal repaid and interest paid, or interest earned and TDS); the purpose; how it should be sent.
Key phrases	"Please issue an interest certificate for the financial year 2025-26"; "showing the principal repaid and the interest paid during the year"; "I need it to file my income-tax return."

Subject: Request for interest certificate - Home Loan A/c No. XXXXXXXXX9034

Dear Sir/Madam,

I have a home loan with your branch (Loan A/c No. XXXXXXXXX9034).

Please issue an interest certificate for the financial year 2025-26 showing the principal repaid and the interest paid during the year. I need it to file my income-tax return.

Please send the certificate to my registered email address, lakshmi@example.com.

Yours faithfully,

M. Lakshmi

4.11 Bank Reference Letter

Purpose	A bank's statement about its customer's account and general standing, given on request - e.g. to a new supplier who wants to know whether the customer is reliable.
Written by → to	The customer's bank (Branch Manager) → the firm or person who asked, with the customer's consent
Must include	Since when and what type of account; how it has been conducted; a general opinion in careful words (usually no exact balances); a "strict confidence, without responsibility" clause.
Key phrases	"has maintained a current account with us since ..."; "The account has been conducted satisfactorily"; "given in strict confidence and without any responsibility on the part of the bank or its officials".

Subject: Bank reference - M/s. Sri Murugan Stationers, Madurai

Dear Sir/Madam,

At the request of our customer, M/s. Sri Murugan Stationers, Madurai, we confirm that the firm has maintained a current account with our branch since 2015.

The account has been conducted satisfactorily. In our opinion, the firm is respectable and good for its normal business engagements.

This information is given in strict confidence and without any responsibility on the part of the bank or its officials.

Yours faithfully,

K. Ramesh

Branch Manager

4.12 Credit Reference Letter

Purpose	Information about a person's or firm's creditworthiness from trade referees (other suppliers) or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL). The usual letter is a trade referee's reply to a credit (status) inquiry.
Written by → to	Trade referee (an existing supplier of the firm) → the supplier who made the inquiry
Must include	How long you have dealt with the firm; the usual credit (amount and period); the payment record; your opinion of a safe credit limit; "in confidence and without responsibility".
Key phrases	"They have always settled their accounts on time"; "In our opinion, they are good for credit up to Rs. ..."; unfavourable reply: "We would advise caution in granting credit of this size."

Subject: Credit reference - M/s. Vetri Stationers, Tiruchirappalli

Dear Sir/Madam,

Thank you for your letter of 2 October 2026 about M/s. Vetri Stationers, Tiruchirappalli, who have given our name as a trade reference.

They have bought paper from us for the last six years on 30 days' credit, usually for about Rs. 60,000 a month, and have always paid on time.

In our opinion, they are good for credit up to Rs. 1,00,000. This information is given in confidence and without any responsibility on our part.

Yours faithfully,
P. Anitha
Accounts Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills

4.13 Letter of Credit - Importer's Request to Open an L/C HIGH - FREQUENCY

Purpose	The importer (applicant) asks his bank to open a Letter of Credit (L/C) - the bank's written undertaking to pay the exporter (beneficiary) when the specified documents are presented.
Written by → to	Importer (applicant) → his bank (the issuing bank), with the bank's L/C application form
Must include	Beneficiary's name and address; amount and currency; goods, quantity and price; proforma invoice No. and date; type of credit (irrevocable; sight or usance; confirmed if required); FOB / CIF and ports; latest shipment date and expiry date; documents required (commercial invoice, bill of lading, packing list, certificate of origin; insurance policy under CIF); advising bank; how margin and charges will be paid.
Key phrases	"Please open an irrevocable Letter of Credit for ... in favour of ..."; "available against presentation of the following documents"; "Please debit our current account for the margin money and your charges."

Subject: Request to open an irrevocable Letter of Credit for USD 24,000

Dear Sir/Madam,

We have ordered two packaging machines from M/s. Orchid Machinery Co., Singapore (Proforma Invoice No. OM/PI/318 dated 10 September 2026). Please open an irrevocable sight Letter of Credit for USD 24,000 in their favour, on FOB Singapore terms.

The credit should be available against the commercial invoice, a full set of clean on-board bills of lading, the packing list and a certificate of origin. The latest date of shipment is 15 November 2026 and the expiry date 30 November 2026.

Please advise the credit through your correspondent bank in Singapore and debit our current account No. XXXXXXXX8842 for the margin money and your charges. Our L/C application form is enclosed.

Yours faithfully,
R. Ganesh
Partner, Kaveri Traders

Encl.: L/C application form

EXAM TIP: L/C parties: **applicant** (importer), **issuing bank** (the importer's bank), **beneficiary** (exporter), **advising / confirming bank** (usually in the exporter's country). Types: **irrevocable** (cannot be cancelled or changed without the agreement of the beneficiary and the banks concerned), **confirmed** (a second bank adds its own promise to pay), **sight** (paid when the documents are presented), **usance** (paid after a fixed period, e.g. 90 days).

4.14 Credit Facility Request (Overdraft / Cash Credit)

Purpose	A business asks its bank for working capital: an overdraft (withdrawing more than the balance in a current account, up to a sanctioned limit) or cash credit (a limit against hypothecation of stock and book debts - the goods stay with the borrower but are charged to the bank). Interest is charged only on the amount used.
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Written by → to	Proprietor / partner / director → The Branch Manager
Must include	Firm's name, type and years in business; nature of business and turnover; facility and limit required; purpose; security offered (stock, fixed deposit, property, guarantor); enclosures - financial statements, income-tax and GST returns, stock statement.
Key phrases	"We request you to sanction a cash credit limit of Rs. ... against hypothecation of our stock and book debts"; "to meet our working capital requirements"; "an overdraft facility of Rs. ... against our fixed deposit".

Subject: Request for a cash credit limit of Rs. 15,00,000

Dear Sir/Madam,

Vaigai Textiles, our proprietary concern, has traded in cotton fabrics in Erode since 2012 and has maintained a current account (A/c No. XXXXXXXX1407) with your branch for ten years. Our turnover for 2025-26 was about Rs. 1.8 crore.

To meet our working capital needs for the coming season, we request you to sanction a cash credit limit of Rs. 15,00,000 against hypothecation of our stock and book debts.

We offer our fixed deposit of Rs. 3,00,000 as additional security. Our financial statements for the last three years and our income-tax and GST returns are enclosed.

Yours faithfully,
L. Mohan
Proprietor, Vaigai Textiles

Encl.: 1. Financial statements for the last three years
2. Income-tax and GST returns

4.15 Payment Reminder

Purpose	A polite letter reminding a customer that a payment is overdue - the first step of the collection series: first reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer) → final notice / demand (warns of legal action).
Written by → to	Seller / creditor → Buyer / debtor
Must include	Invoice number, date, amount and due date; a polite request to pay; a copy of the invoice or statement; an "ignore if already paid" line. No threats in a first reminder.
Key phrases	"This is a friendly reminder that our Invoice No. ... dated ... for Rs. ... was due on ..."; "Perhaps this has been overlooked"; "If you have already made the payment, please ignore this letter."

Subject: Payment reminder - Invoice No. KPM/2026/418

Dear Sir/Madam,

This is a friendly reminder that our Invoice No. KPM/2026/418 dated 10 August 2026 for Rs. 86,400 was due for payment on 9 September 2026. We have not yet received your payment.

Perhaps this has been overlooked. A copy of the invoice is enclosed for your reference.

Please arrange the payment at your earliest convenience. If you have already paid, please ignore this letter.

Yours faithfully,
P. Anitha
Accounts Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills

Encl.: Copy of Invoice No. KPM/2026/418

4.16 Outstanding-Payment Letter

Purpose	A firm letter to a customer whose dues remain unpaid after reminders: it states the total outstanding, fixes a final date and says what will follow (the final notice / demand stage).
Written by → to	Seller / creditor → Buyer / debtor who has not paid

Must include	Statement of account (invoices, payments, balance outstanding); dates of earlier reminders; a final date; the consequence (stopping supplies / legal action); an offer to discuss any genuine difficulty. Firm but courteous.
Key phrases	"Despite our reminders dated ... and ..., the amount of Rs. ... remains outstanding"; "Please settle the account on or before ..."; "Failing this, we shall be compelled to take legal action to recover the amount."

Subject: Outstanding balance of Rs. 1,24,900 - final notice

Dear Sir/Madam,

Despite our reminders dated 20 September 2026 and 5 October 2026, the balance of Rs. 1,24,900 on your account remains unpaid. A statement of account covering our Invoice Nos. KPM/2026/418 and KPM/2026/472 is enclosed.

We value your business and do not wish to take any unpleasant step. If you have any difficulty, please contact us at once.

Please settle the full amount on or before 31 October 2026. Otherwise, we shall be compelled to stop further supplies and take legal action to recover the amount.

Yours faithfully,
P. Anitha
Accounts Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills

Encl.: Statement of account

4.17 Cheque Dishonour Letter (Notice under Section 138, NI Act) HIGH-FREQUENCY

Purpose	The payee's written demand after the drawer's cheque is dishonoured. The bank returns the cheque with a return memo ; the payee may send a legal demand notice under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881 within 30 days of receiving the return memo ; the drawer then has 15 days to pay.
Written by → to	Payee (often through an advocate) → Drawer of the cheque
Must include	Cheque number, date, amount, bank and branch; what it was given for; date of presentation; the reason in the return memo (e.g. "Funds insufficient") and the date the memo was received; a demand to pay within 15 days of receiving the notice. Send it by Registered Post with Acknowledgement Due (RPAD) and keep the proof.
Key phrases	"returned unpaid with a return memo stating 'Funds insufficient'"; "We hereby demand payment of Rs. ... within 15 days of your receiving this notice"; "failing which we shall be constrained to initiate legal proceedings against you under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881".

Subject: Dishonour of Cheque No. 508341 - demand notice under Section 138, NI Act, 1881

Dear Sir/Madam,

You gave us Cheque No. 508341 dated 30 October 2026 for Rs. 1,24,900, drawn on Southern Commercial Bank, Fairlands Branch, Salem, in settlement of your outstanding dues. We presented it through our bank on 2 November 2026, but it was returned unpaid with a return memo stating "Funds insufficient", which we received on 5 November 2026.

We hereby demand payment of Rs. 1,24,900 within 15 days of your receiving this notice.

If you fail to pay within this period, we shall be constrained to initiate legal proceedings against you under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881.

Yours faithfully,
P. Anitha
Authorised Signatory, Kaveri Paper Mills

4.18 Transaction-Related Correspondence (Wrong Debit / Failed Transfer / Disputed Transaction)

Purpose	To report a wrong or double debit, a failed NEFT / UPI transfer (money debited but not received by the beneficiary) or a disputed (unauthorised) transaction, and ask the bank to investigate and set it right. Complain to the bank first; if unresolved, the customer may approach the RBI Ombudsman as per current RBI rules [VERIFY CURRENT RULE].
Written by → to	Account holder → The Branch Manager (or the bank's grievance redressal officer)

Must include	Masked A/c No.; date, time and amount; mode (NEFT / UPI / card); UTR (Unique Transaction Reference) number or UPI transaction ID; beneficiary details (for transfers); what went wrong; complaint number, if any; copies of the statement / SMS / screenshot; the action wanted. For fraud: report at once and block the card / UPI.
Key phrases	"My account has been debited twice for the same transaction"; "The transfer failed, but my account has been debited"; "I did not authorise this transaction and have not shared any OTP or PIN"; "Please investigate and reverse the amount to my account."

Subject: Failed UPI transfer - amount debited but not credited to the beneficiary

Dear Sir/Madam,

On 22 September 2026, I transferred Rs. 8,000 by UPI from my savings account No. XXXXXXXX2208 to my brother's account (UPI transaction ID 626512345678). The app showed "Transaction failed", but my account was debited.

The amount has neither reached my brother nor been reversed to my account. I reported this to your customer care on 23 September 2026 (Complaint No. 45871).

Please investigate and credit Rs. 8,000 back to my account as soon as possible. My account statement and a screenshot of the failed transaction are enclosed.

Yours faithfully,
S. Kavya

Encl.: 1. Account statement
2. Screenshot of the failed transaction

4.19 Clear Distinctions HIGH-FREQUENCY

The seven most-confused credit terms. Learn the "Issued by" column first (more pairs: see Section 15).

Term	What it is	Issued by	Issued to	Purpose	One-line example
Credit letter	A letter about CREDIT: a request to open a credit account, a credit (status) inquiry to referees, or a letter granting or refusing credit	Buyer (request); seller (inquiry, grant or refusal)	Seller; referees; buyer	To arrange, check, grant or refuse credit	Sri Murugan Stationers ask Kaveri Paper Mills to allow them 30 days' credit.
Letter of Credit (L/C)	A BANK's written undertaking to pay the seller / exporter (beneficiary) when specified documents are presented; used mainly in foreign trade	The buyer's bank (issuing bank), at the request of the buyer / importer (applicant)	Seller / exporter (beneficiary), usually through an advising bank	To assure the seller of payment and the buyer of the documents	Southern Commercial Bank opens an L/C for Kaveri Traders in favour of a Singapore exporter.
Credit reference	Information about a person's or firm's creditworthiness from trade referees (other suppliers) or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL)	Trade referees or credit information companies	The supplier or lender who asks	To decide whether, and how much, credit can be given	Kaveri Paper Mills writes that Vetri Stationers have always paid within 30 days.
Bank reference	A bank's statement about its customer's account and general standing, given on request	The customer's bank	The inquirer (supplier, business partner), with the customer's consent	To confirm the customer's account and general standing	"The firm's current account has been conducted satisfactorily since 2015."
Business (trade) credit	The supplier allows the buyer to pay later (e.g. 30 / 60 days); bank credit facilities for business include overdraft and cash credit	Supplier (trade credit); bank (overdraft, cash credit)	Buyer; business borrower	To let a business buy now and pay later, or meet its working capital needs	Kaveri Paper Mills allows 30 days' credit; Vaigai Textiles gets a cash credit limit from its bank.
Debit note	Tells the seller that his account has been debited (goods returned or a deduction claimed); a seller may also send one to charge an extra amount (undercharge)	Buyer (usually); seller for an undercharge	Seller; buyer for an undercharge	To claim a deduction (or charge an extra amount)	The buyer returns 10 damaged reams of paper and sends a debit note for Rs. 4,500.
Credit note	REDUCES the amount the buyer owes (goods returned, overcharge, allowance)	Seller	Buyer	To reduce the buyer's dues	The seller accepts the 10 returned reams and sends a credit note for Rs. 4,500.

MEMORY TRICK: Credit NOTE cuts the bill (seller gives relief); Debit NOTE deducts (buyer claims back).

MEMORY TRICK: L/C = the bank's promise to pay. A credit LETTER is a letter ABOUT credit; a Letter OF Credit is the bank's promise.

MEMORY TRICK: Bank reference: the bank speaks. Credit reference: the market speaks (other suppliers, CIBIL).

DO NOT CONFUSE: Credit advice / debit advice = an intimation (usually from a bank) that an account has been credited / debited. It is neither a credit note (seller to buyer) nor a credit letter.

EXAM TIP: Side note only - under GST law, both debit notes and credit notes are issued by the supplier; for letter-writing and commerce questions, use the rule in the table above.

4.20 Must Remember

MUST REMEMBER: Every bank letter: "The Branch Manager, <bank>, <branch>, <city>" → precise subject with the masked account number → "Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully," → signature as per the bank records.

MUST REMEMBER: Never write your PIN, OTP, CVV or passwords in any letter. Mask the account number (e.g. XXXXXXXX4521) and give only the last four digits of a card.

MUST REMEMBER: Stop-payment letter = cheque number + date + amount + payee's name. It works only before the cheque is paid.

MUST REMEMBER: Cheque dishonour: the bank returns the cheque with a return memo → the payee may send a demand notice under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881 within 30 days of receiving the return memo → the drawer then has 15 days to pay.

MUST REMEMBER: L/C = a bank's written undertaking to pay the exporter (beneficiary) against documents, opened at the request of the importer (applicant).

MUST REMEMBER: Credit note: SELLER → buyer, reduces the bill. Debit note: BUYER → seller, claims a deduction. Collection series: first reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer) → final notice / demand (warns of legal action).



Transactional Letters

5.1 What is a Transactional Letter?

A **transactional letter** is a business letter written at one stage of a buying-and-selling deal - from the buyer's first inquiry to the seller's final receipt. Each letter moves the deal one step forward and keeps a written record of what was offered, ordered, sent, received and paid.

- **Register:** **Formal** - "Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"; to a named person, "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,".
- **Linked:** every letter quotes the earlier references - inquiry date, quotation number, order number, invoice number.
- **Exact:** quantities, prices, dates and document numbers must be correct.
- **Binding:** an order accepted by the seller becomes a binding contract, so state the terms clearly.

Who Writes What

Buyer's letters	Seller's letters
Inquiry - asks for prices, samples and terms	Quotation - gives prices, discounts, terms and validity
Order / Purchase Order - places the order	Acceptance or Rejection of the order (order confirmation)
Acknowledgement of goods received (GRN; shortage / damage report)	Dispatch advice; Delivery (goods with the delivery challan)
Query on the invoice, if any	Invoice and invoice-related communication
Payment letter (advice of payment)	Reminder (if payment is late); Receipt (acknowledges payment)
Complaint and Claim (if something goes wrong)	Adjustment - settles the complaint or claim
Cancellation of the order (before dispatch)	Refund, Replacement or Credit note

MEMORY TRICK: The buyer ASKS, ORDERS, PAYS and COMPLAINS; the seller QUOTES, CONFIRMS, SENDS, BILLS and SETTLES.

5.2 The Transaction Flow **HIGH-FREQUENCY**

A typical trade transaction passes through nine stages. Each stage has its own letter or document.



One line: INQUIRY → QUOTATION → ORDER → CONFIRMATION → DISPATCH → DELIVERY → INVOICE → PAYMENT → RECEIPT

EXAM TIP: In real trade the tax invoice often travels with the goods; the chain lists INVOICE after DELIVERY because it starts the payment stage - learn the order as given.

5.3 Stage-by-Stage Terminology

MCQs and fill-in-the-blank questions often test these meanings.

Stage 1: INQUIRY

Term	Meaning
Inquiry / enquiry	A letter asking for information - prices, terms, samples. Both spellings are accepted (British: "enquiry" = asking for information, "inquiry" = a formal investigation; American English: "inquiry" for both).
Catalogue	A booklet or file listing the seller's goods with pictures, descriptions and code numbers.
Price list	A list of the seller's current prices for each item.
Samples	Small quantities or specimens sent to show the quality of the goods.
Trade terms	The conditions of sale - price basis, discounts, payment period, packing and delivery.

Typical phrase: "Please send us your latest catalogue and price list, together with your best trade terms for regular orders."

Stage 2: QUOTATION

Term	Meaning
Quotation	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions, sent in reply to an inquiry (before the order).
Firm offer / validity	A quotation that holds good for a stated period - its validity (e.g. "valid for 30 days"); orders received within it get the quoted prices.
Trade discount	A deduction from the list price allowed to traders who buy for resale, often for bulk orders; shown on the invoice itself.
Cash discount	A deduction allowed for prompt payment within a stated period, e.g. "2% if paid within 10 days".
Estimate	An approximate cost of goods or work; the final bill may differ.
Tender	A formal (often sealed) offer in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies.
Proforma invoice	A preliminary bill sent before supply - for advance payment or import formalities.

Typical phrase: "We are pleased to quote as follows. This quotation is valid for 30 days from the date of this letter."

Stage 3: ORDER

Term	Meaning
Indent	An order for goods: in foreign trade, an order placed by an importer through an agent (indent house); in offices, an internal requisition for stores.
Purchase order (PO)	A formal numbered document issued by the buyer; binding once accepted by the seller.
Order number	The reference number of the order; the seller quotes it on all later letters, delivery documents and invoices.
Specifications	Exact details of the goods - size, grade, model, colour, quantity and packing.

Term	Meaning
Delivery schedule	When, where and in what lots the goods must be delivered.
Trial order	A small first order placed to test the quality of the goods and service.

Typical phrase: "Please supply the following items as per our Purchase Order No. 245 dated 5 October 2026."

Stage 4: CONFIRMATION

Term	Meaning
Order acknowledgement	The seller's reply confirming only that the order has been RECEIVED; by itself it does not mean the order is accepted (acceptance comes in the order confirmation).
Acceptance	The seller agrees to supply as ordered; the accepted order becomes a binding contract.
Rejection	The seller politely declines the order (e.g. goods out of stock, prices changed, credit not possible), usually suggesting an alternative.
Order confirmation	A formal confirmation of the accepted order - items, prices, delivery date and payment terms.
Counter-offer	The seller agrees but with changed terms (price, date, quantity); there is no contract until the buyer accepts the new terms.

Typical phrase: "Thank you for your Order No. 245 dated 5 October 2026. We are pleased to confirm that the goods will be dispatched by 10 October 2026."

Stage 5: DISPATCH

Term	Meaning
Consignment	The goods sent in one lot to a buyer.
Consignor	The person who sends the goods (usually the seller).
Consignee	The person to whom the goods are sent (usually the buyer).
Dispatch advice	The seller's notice that the goods have been sent - date, carrier, number of packages and the LR / RR / B/L / AWB number.
Packing list	A list of the packages and what each contains (quantity, weight, marks).
LR / RR	Lorry Receipt (goods sent by road) / Railway Receipt (goods sent by rail) - the carrier's receipt for the goods.
Bill of lading (B/L) / Airway bill (AWB)	The carrier's receipt for goods sent by sea / by air (see 5.6).

Typical phrase: "We have today dispatched 20 cartons by lorry through Vaigai Roadways; the LR (No. 4587) and the packing list are enclosed."

Stage 6: DELIVERY

Term	Meaning
Delivery challan	A document that travels with the goods, listing the items and quantities; the buyer signs a copy on receipt.
Proof of delivery (POD)	The signed and dated challan or carrier's receipt showing that the buyer has received the goods.
Inspection	Checking the goods on arrival for quantity, quality and damage.
Goods Received Note (GRN)	The buyer's own record of the goods received, their quantity and condition.
Shortage / damage report	The buyer's note of goods missing or damaged on arrival; it supports a complaint or claim (and an insurance claim, if any).

Typical phrase: "We acknowledge receipt of the 20 cartons sent under your Delivery Challan No. 312 in good condition."

Stage 7: INVOICE

Term	Meaning
Invoice	The bill issued by the seller for goods supplied - quantity, price, taxes, total and due date.
Tax invoice	The invoice issued by a GST-registered seller, showing the GSTIN, HSN code, taxable value and the GST charged.
GSTIN	Goods and Services Tax Identification Number - the 15-character number of a GST-registered business (e.g. 33XXXXXXXXX1Z5; 33 = Tamil Nadu).
HSN code	Harmonised System of Nomenclature code - the code that classifies goods for tax (services use SAC codes).
E&OE	Errors and Omissions Excepted - printed on invoices and quotations; the seller keeps the right to correct errors later.
Due date	The last date by which payment must be made.
Credit period	The number of days allowed for payment after the invoice date, e.g. 30 days.

Typical phrase: "Please find enclosed our Tax Invoice No. 1123 dated 12 October 2026 for Rs. 48,260, payable within 30 days."

Stage 8: PAYMENT

Term	Meaning
Remittance	Money sent by the buyer to the seller in payment.
NEFT / RTGS	Electronic bank transfers: NEFT (National Electronic Funds Transfer) is settled in batches; RTGS (Real Time Gross Settlement) is settled one by one in real time and is meant for large amounts. Each transfer has a UTR number.
Demand draft (DD)	A prepaid instrument issued by a bank, payable to the named payee; safer than a cheque because the bank has already received the money.
Cheque	A written, unconditional order by an account holder (drawer) to his bank (drawee) to pay a stated sum on demand to the payee.
Advice of payment	The buyer's letter telling the seller that payment has been made - amount, mode, UTR / cheque number and the invoices covered.
Part payment	Payment of only a part of the amount due.
Balance due	The amount still to be paid after a part payment.

Typical phrase: "We have today remitted Rs. 48,260 by NEFT (UTR No. SCBN262851234567) in full settlement of your Invoice No. 1123."

Stage 9: RECEIPT

Term	Meaning
Receipt	A written acknowledgement by the payee that money has been received - amount, date, mode and the invoice covered.
Acknowledgement of payment	The seller's letter confirming that the payment has been received and credited to the buyer's account.
Voucher	A document that supports an entry in the books of account (e.g. receipt voucher, payment voucher).
Statement of account	A statement listing the invoices, payments and the balance due.
Full and final settlement	A payment that clears all dues, leaving no further claim.
Closing the account	Settling all dues so that the balance is nil; the transaction is complete.

Typical phrase: "We acknowledge with thanks the receipt of Rs. 48,260 by NEFT in full settlement of our Invoice No. 1123; your account now shows a nil balance."

DO NOT CONFUSE: Quotation (prices offered, before the order) - Proforma invoice (preliminary bill before supply, for advance payment or import) - Tax invoice (the actual bill for goods supplied).

DO NOT CONFUSE: Trade discount = for being a trader (deducted from the list price on the invoice). Cash discount = for paying quickly (allowed only if paid within the stated period).

MEMORY TRICK: -OR / -ER gives, -EE receives: the consignor sends, the consignee receives; the payer pays, the payee is paid; the endorser transfers, the endorsee receives. (Careful: the drawee of a cheque is the BANK that is ordered to pay.)

5.4 The 16 Transactional Letters

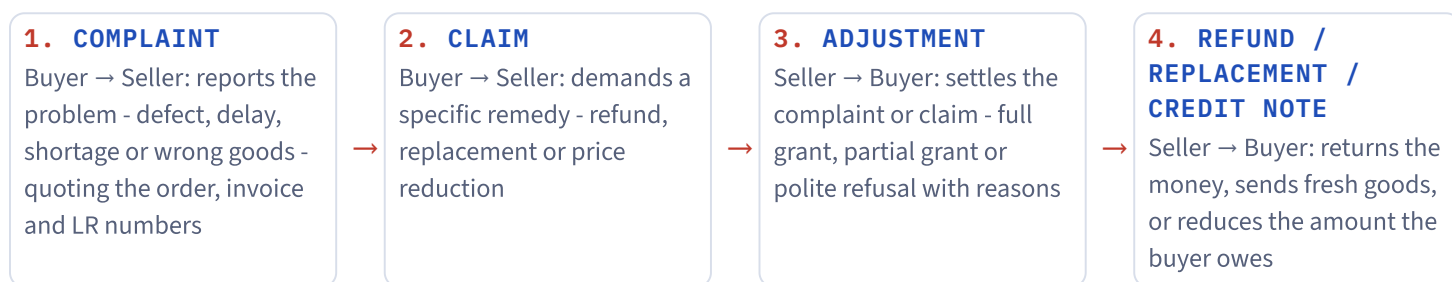
Quick-revision table; most of these letters have full cards and model letters in Section 3.

Letter	Written by	Purpose	Key phrase
Inquiry	Buyer	Asks for prices, catalogue, samples and terms	"Please send us your latest price list and terms of supply."
Quotation	Seller	States prices, discounts, delivery and payment terms, and validity	"We are pleased to quote as follows; this offer is valid for 30 days."
Order	Buyer	Places a definite order - quantity, specifications, price, delivery schedule	"Please supply the following items as per our Purchase Order No. ..."
Acceptance	Seller	Accepts the order and confirms the delivery date and terms	"We are pleased to accept your Order No. ... and will dispatch the goods by ..."
Rejection	Seller	Declines the order politely, gives the reason and suggests an alternative	"We regret that we are unable to accept your order because ..."
Dispatch	Seller	Informs the buyer that the goods have been sent - carrier, packages, LR / RR / B/L / AWB number	"We have today dispatched the goods by lorry; the LR is enclosed."
Delivery	Seller or transporter (buyer confirms receipt)	Fixes the delivery date, or confirms that the goods have arrived and in what condition	"The goods will be delivered at your godown on ... against our Delivery Challan No. ..."
Invoice-related communication	Seller (buyer may query)	Sends the invoice, corrects errors or answers queries on the bill	"Please find enclosed our Invoice No. ... for Rs. ..., due for payment on ..."
Payment	Buyer	Sends the payment with its details (advice of payment)	"We have remitted Rs. ... by NEFT (UTR No. ...) in full settlement of your Invoice No. ..."

Letter	Written by	Purpose	Key phrase
Reminder	Seller (buyer, for a late delivery - see 3.14)	Reminds the buyer of an overdue payment - polite first, then firmer (see 4.15 and 4.16)	"This is a reminder that our Invoice No. ... is now overdue."
Complaint	Buyer	Reports a problem - defect, delay, shortage or wrong goods	"We regret to inform you that ten of the cartons received were damaged."
Claim	Buyer	Demands a specific remedy - refund, replacement or price reduction	"We request you to replace the damaged goods or refund Rs. ..."
Adjustment	Seller	Settles the complaint or claim - full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons	"We apologise for the inconvenience and are sending replacements free of cost."
Cancellation	Buyer	Cancels an order before dispatch, giving the reason	"We regret that we have to cancel our Order No. ... dated ..."
Refund	Seller	Returns money to the buyer - after a claim, a cancelled order or an overpayment	"We have refunded Rs. ... to your account by NEFT today."
Replacement	Seller	Sends fresh goods in place of defective or wrong ones	"Replacements for the defective items have been dispatched today, free of charge."

5.5 When Things Go Wrong

If the goods are defective, late, short or wrong, the letters follow this chain:



One line: COMPLAINT → CLAIM → ADJUSTMENT → REFUND / REPLACEMENT / CREDIT NOTE

DO NOT CONFUSE: CANCELLATION is not part of this chain. The buyer cancels an order BEFORE dispatch (e.g. delay in confirmation, change in requirement): quote the order number and date, give the reason and ask for written confirmation (and a refund of any advance). After dispatch, use complaint → claim → adjustment.

EXAM TIP: A buyer returning goods may send a debit note; the seller settles it with a credit note (see 4.19).

5.6 Delivery Terms and Transport Documents

Delivery Terms

Term	Full form	Meaning	In a quotation
Ex-works	Ex-works (also ex-factory / ex-godown)	The buyer collects the goods from the seller's premises; transport cost and risk from there are the buyer's.	"Rs. 450 per unit, ex-works Coimbatore"
FOR	Free on Rail	The seller bears all expenses up to loading the goods on the railway wagon at the named station; the railway freight is paid by the buyer.	"Rs. 465 per unit, FOR Coimbatore"
FOB	Free on Board	The seller's cost and risk end when the goods are loaded on board the ship at the port of shipment; the buyer pays sea freight and insurance.	"USD 12 per unit, FOB Chennai"
CIF	Cost, Insurance and Freight	The seller pays cost, insurance and freight up to the destination port.	"USD 13.50 per unit, CIF Singapore"

DO NOT CONFUSE: FOB names the port of SHIPMENT ("FOB Chennai"); CIF names the port of DESTINATION ("CIF Singapore"). Under CIF the seller PAYS up to the destination port, but the risk passes to the buyer once the goods are on board.

Transport and Delivery Documents

Document	Mode	Issued by	Use
Lorry Receipt (LR)	Road	Road transport company	Receipt for goods booked by lorry; the consignee presents it to take delivery.
Railway Receipt (RR)	Rail	Railway	Receipt for goods booked by rail; the consignee presents it to take delivery.
Bill of Lading (B/L)	Sea	Shipping company (carrier)	Receipt for goods shipped, evidence of the contract of carriage and a document of title to the goods.

Document	Mode	Issued by	Use
Airway Bill (AWB)	Air	Airline or its agent	Receipt for goods sent by air; it is not a document of title.
Delivery challan	Travels with the goods	Seller (consignor)	Lists the items and quantities; the buyer signs a copy as proof of delivery.
Goods Received Note (GRN)	Buyer's own record	Buyer (stores department)	Records the goods actually received and their condition; checked against the order and invoice before payment.

EXAM TIP: LR = road, RR = rail, B/L = sea, AWB = air. The bill of lading is a document of title and a key document under a Letter of Credit; the airway bill is not a document of title.

5.7 Memory Trick and Must Remember

MEMORY TRICK: "Intelligent **Q**ueens **O**rder **C**ostly **D**iamonds; **D**elivery Includes **P**roper **R**ceipts" = I-Q-O-C-D-I-P-R = Inquiry, Quotation, Order, Confirmation, Dispatch, Delivery, Invoice, Payment, Receipt. (Dispatch before Delivery: goods leave before they arrive.)

MUST REMEMBER: Complaint = the buyer reports; Claim = the buyer demands a remedy; Adjustment = the seller's reply that settles it; then Refund / Replacement / Credit note. Cancellation comes BEFORE dispatch.

MUST REMEMBER: Quote the reference numbers - quotation, order, LR / B/L, invoice and UTR numbers - in every later letter. An order accepted by the seller becomes a binding contract.



Government and Administrative Correspondence

6.1 Introduction

Government offices do not use one kind of "letter" for everything. Each purpose has its own **fixed form**, with a fixed layout, a fixed opening phrase and a fixed rule for the salutation, the close and the signature. In the Government of India these forms are prescribed by the *Central Secretariat Manual of Office Procedure* (CSMOP); Tamil Nadu offices follow their own office manuals. For every form, learn four things: **when it is used**, **who sends it to whom**, **its format** and **how it differs from a similar form**.

Forms of official communication

Group	Forms (see)	Direction / use
Letters	Official letter (6.25 a), D.O. letter (6.9), reminder (6.11), acknowledgement (6.16), forwarding letter (6.23), covering letter (6.24)	Office → other governments, public bodies, officers and the public
Inter-office communications	Office Memorandum (6.3), memo (6.2), endorsement (6.10), inter-departmental note (U.O. note; U.O. = unofficial)	Department ↔ department; within one office
Orders	Government Order (G.O.), Order, Office Order (6.4), Proceedings (6.8)	Authority → officers, staff and persons concerned
Announcements	Notification (6.6), Resolution, circular (6.5), notice (6.7), press communique / press note	Government → many offices or the public
Requests and grievances	Application (6.14), representation (6.12), petition (6.13), requisition (6.15)	Citizen, employee or section → authority
Meetings and reports	Agenda (6.19), minutes (6.18), report (6.17)	Secretary → members; officer → superior
Parts of a communication	Reference (6.20), enclosure (6.21), annexure (6.22)	Link a communication to earlier papers; attach documents

EXAM TIP: A **press communique** is formal, and the press is expected to print it exactly as issued; a **press note** is less formal, and the press may edit or shorten it. Both give wide publicity to a Government decision.

First person or third person?

Each form uses a fixed "person". In an **official letter** the officer writes "I am directed to ...": the "I" is the officer, but the decision belongs to the Government or the head of office, not to the writer. In an **Office Memorandum** the officer refers to himself or herself as "the undersigned" (third person). **Orders, notifications, circulars and notices** are impersonal. Only the **D.O. letter** is written in a personal, first-person voice.

Person	Standard opening	Used in
First person, on behalf of an authority	"I am directed to ..."	Official letter; reminders and forwarding letters sent by an office
First person, personal	"I would like to draw your personal attention to ..."	D.O. letter; also an individual's application or representation ("I request ...")
Third person ("the undersigned")	"The undersigned is directed to ..."	Office Memorandum
Third person / impersonal	"It is hereby notified that ...", "It has been decided ...", "Sanction is hereby accorded to ..."	Notification, Resolution, Order, Office Order, circular, notice, minutes

Formal and impersonal tone

Official writing is **formal, impersonal, brief and exact**. Write facts, not feelings. The passive voice is common because the decision belongs to the office, not to the person who signs ("Sanction is accorded", "It has been decided"). Standard phrases: *with immediate effect; until further orders; for information and necessary action; under intimation to this office* (= and inform this office); *of even number* (= bearing the same file number); *vide* (= see / as per); *the letter cited* (= the letter quoted in the Ref: line). Avoid outdated phrases: write "take the necessary action", not "do the needful"; write "reply", not "revert back" (see Section 8).

Feature	Official correspondence rule
Number and date	Every communication carries a file number and a date: "No. 1234/A2/2026, dated 12 October 2026".
Addressee	Officers are addressed by designation ("The District Collector, Madurai"), not by name - except in a D.O. letter.
Person	Official letter and D.O. letter: first person. Office Memorandum: third person ("the undersigned"). Orders, notifications, circulars, notices: impersonal.
Tone and voice	Formal, polite, firm and impersonal; the passive voice is common. Only the D.O. letter is personal and friendly.
Subject	One communication deals with one subject. A short "Subject:" / "Sub:" line, with no full stop.
References	Earlier communications are quoted by number and date in a "Ref:" line.
Paragraphs	Short. Long communications have numbered paragraphs; in usual Government of India practice the first paragraph is not numbered and the rest are numbered 2, 3, ...
Salutation and close	Only in letters: official letter "Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully,"; D.O. letter "Dear Thiru X," + "Yours sincerely,". Office Memorandum, orders, notifications, circulars, notices and memos have neither.
Signature	Name and designation. An officer signing on behalf of the head of office writes "for" before the designation ("for District Collector, Madurai").
Copies	A "Copy to:" list, or a signed endorsement: "Copy forwarded to ... for information and necessary action."
Channel	An employee writes to a higher authority through proper channel: the paper goes through the immediate superior (a "Through: ..." line is written above or below the addressee).

6.2 Memorandum

Definition	A short internal written communication within an organisation. It has a To / From / Date / Subject header and no salutation and no complimentary close . Short form: <i>memo</i> ; plural: <i>memoranda</i> or <i>memorandums</i> .
Purpose	To pass information, instructions, requests or reminders quickly to people in the same organisation, and to keep a written record. In Indian offices a memo is also issued to an employee to call for an explanation (e.g. for unauthorised absence).
Who issues it	Any officer or manager, or the head of a section or department of the organisation.
Who receives it	Staff, colleagues, sections or departments of the same organisation.
Differs from	Letter : goes outside the organisation and has a salutation and a close; a memo stays inside and has neither. Office Memorandum : a Government form sent between Ministries/Departments in the third person (6.3). (In Indian news, "submitted a memorandum to the Minister" means a written statement of demands, like a petition.)
Example	MEMORANDUM To: All Section Heads From: S. Meena, Administrative Officer Date: 12 October 2026 Subject: Submission of attendance registers Please send the attendance registers for September to this office by 15 October 2026.

6.3 Office Memorandum (O.M.) HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A Government form of communication used between Ministries/Departments (also with attached offices and with employees). It is written in the third person ("The undersigned is directed to ..."), has no salutation and no complimentary close , and is signed with the officer's name and designation.
Purpose	To convey decisions, instructions or information to other Departments; to call for information; to reply to employees (e.g. on their requests). An O.M. addressed to all Ministries works as a circular.
Who issues it	A Ministry/Department; signed by an authorised officer (e.g. an Under Secretary or a Deputy Secretary).
Who receives it	Other Ministries/Departments, attached and subordinate offices, and the Department's own employees. The addressee ("To") is written at the bottom left , below the signature.
Differs from	Official letter : first person ("I am directed to ..."), with "Sir/Madam," and "Yours faithfully,"; used for other governments, public bodies and the public. The O.M. is third person, with no salutation and no close. Memorandum (memo) : a short internal note in any organisation (6.2).
Example	"The undersigned is directed to refer to this Department's O.M. of even number dated 1 September 2026 and to say that ..." (<i>of even number</i> = bearing the same file number)

6.4 Office Order

Definition	A written order about the internal administration of an office: distribution of work, grant of leave, postings within the office and similar matters. No salutation, no close.
Purpose	To give binding instructions to the staff of the office on internal matters, and to keep a record of them.
Who issues it	The Head of Office, or an officer authorised by him or her (e.g. the Administrative Officer).
Who receives it	The employees concerned in the same office; copies go to the sections concerned and to the employees' personal files.
Differs from	Order : used for financial sanctions and disciplinary matters; an Office Order deals with routine internal administration. Circular : gives the same information to many offices or persons; an Office Order is a binding instruction within one office.
Example	"Thiru R. Arun, Junior Assistant, Establishment Section, is posted to the Accounts Section with immediate effect."

6.5 Circular HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A communication that carries the same information or instructions to many offices or persons at the same time. A government circular has no salutation and no complimentary close .
Purpose	To make sure that everyone concerned gets the same message at once: new instructions, rules, holidays, meetings, campaigns. Receivers are often asked to acknowledge receipt.
Who issues it	A Government department or a Head of Office; also companies, banks, schools and associations.
Who receives it	A group: all offices under a department, all staff, all members, or all students and parents.
Differs from	Notice : displayed on a notice board or published for people to read; a circular is sent to each office or person. Notification : published in the Official Gazette; a circular is not. A business circular letter (e.g. to customers) is different: it has a salutation such as "Dear Customer,".
Example	"All Heads of Offices are requested to send the list of vacant posts in their offices to this office by 30 October 2026."

6.6 Notification HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A formal Government communication that publishes rules, orders, appointments, promotions, etc. in the Official Gazette (the Gazette of India or the Tamil Nadu Government Gazette).
Purpose	To make a rule, order or appointment known officially to everyone. Publication in the Gazette is the official, legal way of announcing it; statutory rules and orders are "notified".
Who issues it	A Ministry/Department of the Central or State Government, in the name of the President or the Governor; signed by an authorised officer (e.g. a Secretary or Joint Secretary to Government).
Who receives it	The public at large (through the Gazette); copies go to the offices and persons concerned.
Differs from	Notice : a simple announcement on a notice board or in a newspaper, usually not in the Gazette. Resolution : also published in the Gazette, but announces important policy decisions or the appointment of committees or commissions. In everyday use, a recruitment advertisement (e.g. a TNPSC recruitment notification) is also called a "notification".
Example	"It is hereby notified that Thiru S. Suresh, Deputy Secretary to Government, is promoted as Joint Secretary to Government with effect from 1 October 2026."

6.7 Notice

Definition	A short formal announcement of an event, decision, rule or warning, put up on a notice board, published in a newspaper, or served on a particular person . A public notice has the name of the office, the word "NOTICE", a date, a title, the message, and the name and designation of the issuing authority; no salutation, no close. (A legal notice served on one person is often written as a letter, with a salutation and a close - see Section 4.)
Purpose	To inform a group or the public (meeting, holiday, tender, auction), or to give a formal warning or intimation to a person (legal notice; show-cause notice, which asks a person to explain why action should not be taken).
Who issues it	The head of an office or institution, the secretary of an association, a Government authority, a court, or an advocate on behalf of a client.
Who receives it	The persons concerned (staff, students, members, the general public), or one named person (legal notice, show-cause notice).
Differs from	Circular : sent to each office or person; a notice is displayed or published for all to read. Notification : published in the Official Gazette. Agenda : a notice of a meeting gives the date, time and place; the agenda lists the items to be discussed.
Example	"NOTICE: The office will remain closed on 2 October 2026 on account of Gandhi Jayanti."

6.8 Proceedings

Definition	In Tamil Nadu, the form in which Heads of Departments and District officers issue orders. It is headed "Proceedings of the ..." (e.g. "Proceedings of the District Collector, Madurai") and has fixed parts: Present :, Rc. No. , Dated , Sub :, Ref : and ORDER ..
Purpose	To record a decision and issue orders on a matter (appointment, transfer, posting, leave, sanction), together with the references on which the order is based.
Who issues it	A Head of Department or a District officer such as the District Collector. The "Present:" line names the officer who passes the order.
Who receives it	The person or office concerned ("To"), with copies to the other offices concerned ("Copy to").
Differs from	Government Order (G.O.) : issued by the Secretariat departments of the State Government; Proceedings are issued below the Secretariat, by Heads of Departments and District officers. (In general English, "proceedings" also means the events of a meeting or a legal case, e.g. "court proceedings".)
Example	"Proceedings of the District Collector, Madurai. Present: Tmt. K. Priya, I.A.S. Rc. No. 1234/A2/2026, Dated 12 October 2026." (full format: 6.25 g)

6.9 D.O. Letter (Demi-official letter) HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A letter from one officer to another , written in the first person singular in a personal, friendly tone. It begins "Dear Shri X," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru X,"), ends "Yours sincerely," and carries a D.O. No. at the top.
Purpose	To draw the personal attention of the officer addressed; to expedite a delayed matter; to exchange views or information without the formality of official correspondence.
Who issues it	A Government officer, in his or her own name; the sender's name and designation are printed at the top.
Who receives it	Another officer, addressed by name . The addressee's name and address are usually written at the bottom left , below the signature.
Differs from	Official letter : impersonal; addressed by designation; "Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully,"; "I am directed to ...". The D.O. letter is personal; addressed by name; "Dear Thiru X," + "Yours sincerely,"; written in the officer's own voice.
Example	"Dear Thiru Vignesh, I shall be grateful if you could personally look into the pension papers of Thiru M. Ganesan, retired Tahsildar, which have been pending with your office since June."

6.10 Endorsement HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	(Government) a short note written at the foot of a communication to forward copies ("Copy forwarded to ... for information / necessary action") or to return a paper to the sender. (Banking) a signature on the back of a cheque or other negotiable instrument to transfer it.
Purpose	To send copies, pass a paper on, or return it quickly - without writing a separate letter.
Who issues it	The office that issues (or has received) the communication; the endorsement carries the file number and date and is signed separately.
Who receives it	Offices or persons other than the main addressee (for copies); the original sender (when a paper is returned).
Differs from	Forwarding / covering letter : a separate letter; an endorsement is only a note on the same paper. "Copy to" : a plain list of copy holders; an endorsement is numbered, dated, signed and states the purpose ("for information", "for necessary action").
Example	"Copy forwarded to the Tahsildar, Madurai North, for information and necessary action." (full format: 6.25 h)

6.11 Reminder

Definition	A follow-up communication sent when a reply or action on an earlier communication is still awaited . It quotes the number and date of the earlier communication.
Purpose	To draw attention to the pending matter and ask for an early reply or action.
Who issues it	The office or person that sent the original communication.
Who receives it	The office or person from whom the reply or action is due.
Differs from	Fresh letter : explains the whole matter; a reminder only refers to the earlier letter and asks for the reply. D.O. letter : if formal reminders fail, a D.O. letter is often sent to draw the officer's personal attention. (A seller's payment reminders to a buyer form a separate collection series.)
Example	"I am directed to invite your attention to this office letter No. 1234/A2/2026 dated 1 September 2026 and to request you to send a reply at an early date."

6.12 Representation HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A formal written statement by an individual (usually an employee or a citizen) to an authority, presenting a grievance or asking for reconsideration of a decision . An employee usually sends it through proper channel .
Purpose	To seek redress of a personal grievance (pay, seniority, promotion, transfer) or to ask the authority to reconsider an order.
Who issues it	One person - usually an employee (service matters) or a citizen (his or her own case).
Who receives it	The competent or higher authority; an employee's representation goes through the immediate superior, who forwards it with remarks.
Differs from	Petition : often signed by many people and seeks redress or action on a common problem; a representation is usually one person's own case . Application : asks for something new under the rules (leave, a certificate); a representation states a grievance or questions a decision already taken.
Example	"I request you to reconsider my transfer to Tirunelveli, as my mother is undergoing treatment in a hospital in Madurai."

6.13 Petition HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A formal request to an authority seeking redress or action , often signed by many people . It is also a legal term for a formal application to a court (e.g. a writ petition).
Purpose	To seek relief or action on a common problem (roads, drinking water, street lights, a bus service) or, in a court, to seek legal relief.
Who issues it	A group of citizens, residents or members (sometimes one person); in a court, the petitioner.
Who receives it	An authority such as the District Collector, a Commissioner, a Minister or the Chief Minister; in legal use, a court.
Differs from	Representation : usually one person's own grievance (often an employee's service matter), sent through proper channel; a petition is often collective and goes directly to the authority. In law, a writ petition is filed in a High Court (Article 226) or in the Supreme Court (Article 32).
Example	"We, the undersigned residents of Anna Nagar, Salem, request you to provide street lights on the main road, as the area is unsafe after dark." (the residents' signatures follow)

6.14 Application

Definition	A formal written request by a person to an authority for something he or she is eligible for : a job, leave, a certificate, a licence, admission, a loan, or information (e.g. under the Right to Information Act, 2005).
Purpose	To obtain a benefit, a permission or a service allowed by the rules.
Who issues it	An individual: a candidate, employee, student or citizen.
Who receives it	The authority competent to grant it (employer, Head of Office, Principal, Tahsildar, Public Information Officer). An employee's application to a higher authority goes through proper channel.
Differs from	Representation : states a grievance or asks for reconsideration of a decision already taken; an application asks for something new. Requisition : an office's demand for supplies, staff or an action; an application is an individual's request.
Example	"I request you to grant me casual leave for two days, on 14 and 15 October 2026, to attend my sister's wedding."

6.15 Requisition

Definition	A formal written demand or request for supplies, staff or an action - e.g. a requisition to the stores for stationery, or a requisition by members for convening a meeting.

Purpose	To obtain what the office officially needs (stationery, equipment, vehicles, staff), or to require an action such as calling a special meeting.
Who issues it	A section, department or officer that needs the items or staff; members of a company, society or association (for a meeting).
Who receives it	The stores or purchase section, the appointing or recruiting authority, or the Secretary / Board (for a meeting).
Differs from	Application: an individual's request for a personal benefit; a requisition is an official demand for the office's needs or for an action. Purchase order: goes to an outside supplier; a requisition is an internal request that usually comes before the purchase order.
Example	"We, the undersigned members, request you to convene a special general body meeting of the Association to discuss the revision of the annual subscription."

6.16 Acknowledgement

Definition	A short communication (or a receipt slip) confirming that a letter, application, document, payment or goods has been received.
Purpose	To assure the sender that the item has reached; to give a reference number and date for follow-up. It may add that a detailed reply will follow.
Who issues it	The receiving office or person (in offices, the receipt section that registers incoming mail - called "dak" in Central Government offices and "tapal" in Tamil Nadu offices).
Who receives it	The sender of the original item.
Differs from	Reply: deals with the matter itself; an acknowledgement only confirms receipt. Acknowledgement Due (AD) card: the postal card sent with registered post, signed by the addressee and returned to the sender as proof of delivery.
Example	"Your application dated 5 October 2026 has been received and registered as No. 1234/A2/2026. A reply will be sent in due course."

6.17 Report

Definition	A formal written account of facts, findings or progress (or of the result of an inspection or inquiry), usually with conclusions and recommendations , submitted to the authority that asked for it or at fixed intervals (e.g. a monthly progress report).
Purpose	To give the authority accurate facts so that it can decide or act.
Who issues it	An officer, inspector, inquiry officer or committee.
Who receives it	The superior authority, or the body that called for it.
Differs from	Minutes: the record of one meeting's discussions and decisions; a report presents facts and findings on a subject, often with recommendations. Letter: a report is longer, arranged under headings (Introduction, Findings, Conclusions, Recommendations) and written in an impersonal style.
Example	"As directed in the reference cited, the undersigned inspected the Panchayat Union Middle School, Pudur, on 9 October 2026 and submits the following report."

6.18 Minutes HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	The official written record of a meeting's proceedings and decisions , prepared after the meeting and confirmed at the next meeting . Minutes are written in the past tense and in the third person (reported speech).
Purpose	To keep a permanent, authentic record of who attended, what was discussed, what was decided (resolutions) and who will act.
Who issues it	The Secretary (or convener) of the meeting prepares them; the Chairperson signs them after they are confirmed.
Who receives it	All members (present and absent) and the officers who must act on the decisions; the original is kept in the minute book.
Differs from	Agenda: the list of items circulated before the meeting; minutes are written after it. Report: deals with a subject or an inquiry; minutes cover one meeting only.
Example	Minutes of the Staff Welfare Committee meeting held on 9 October 2026 Present: Tmt. R. Kavya (Chairperson) and eight members 1. The minutes of the last meeting were read and confirmed. 2. Resolved that the Annual Day be held on 18 December 2026.

6.19 Agenda HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	The list of items to be discussed at a meeting , in the order in which they will be taken up. It is circulated before the meeting, with the notice of the meeting.
Purpose	To let members prepare in advance, and to keep the meeting orderly and on time.

Who issues it	The Secretary or convener, with the approval of the Chairperson.
Who receives it	All members entitled to attend the meeting.
Differs from	Minutes: the record written after the meeting. Notice of meeting: gives the date, time and place; the agenda gives the items (the two are usually sent together). Grammar: "agenda" is used as a singular noun today ("The agenda is ready"; plural "agendas").
Example	AGENDA 1. Confirmation of the minutes of the last meeting 2. Arrangements for the Annual Day 3. Any other matter with the permission of the Chair

6.20 Reference

Definition	In official correspondence, the number and date of an earlier letter, order or document on the same matter , quoted in a "Ref:" line (or in the text) so that the receiver can trace the file.
Purpose	To link the present communication with earlier ones, and to save time in finding the background of the matter.
Who issues it	The writer of the communication, who quotes the earlier papers.
Who receives it	The addressee, who uses it to find the file.
Differs from	Subject: says what the letter is about; the reference says which earlier communication it follows. In job applications, a "reference" (referee) is a person who can speak about the candidate's character and work - a different meaning.
Example	"Ref: Your letter No. 567/B1/2026 dated 21 September 2026." In the body, "the letter cited" means the letter quoted in the Ref: line.

6.21 Enclosure

Definition	A separate document sent along with a letter (e.g. a copy of a certificate, a bill, a cheque, a form). It is listed at the foot of the letter, below the signature, after " Encl. ".
Purpose	To send supporting papers and tell the receiver exactly what is attached, so that nothing is missed.
Who issues it	The sender of the letter.
Who receives it	The addressee, together with the letter.
Differs from	Annexure: attached at the end of a main document (report, order, form), numbered (Annexure I, II) and referred to in the text; an enclosure is any separate paper sent with a letter . Attachment: the e-mail form of an enclosure.
Example	Yours faithfully, R. Karthik Encl.: 1. Copy of the transfer certificate 2. Copy of the community certificate

6.22 Annexure HIGH-FREQUENCY

Definition	A document attached at the end of a main document (report, G.O., circular, agreement, application form), numbered Annexure I, Annexure II ... and referred to in the text .
Purpose	To give supporting details (lists, tables, statements, forms) without breaking the flow of the main text.
Who issues it	The author or office that prepares the main document.
Who receives it	Everyone who receives the main document; the annexure is a part of it.
Differs from	Enclosure: a separate document sent with a letter, shown as "Encl."; an annexure forms part of the main document and is quoted by number in the text ("vide Annexure II").
Example	"The list of selected candidates is given in Annexure I to this order."

6.23 Forwarding letter

Definition	A letter by which an intermediate officer passes an application or document (received from someone else) to a higher authority , usually with remarks such as " forwarded and recommended ".

Purpose	To send an employee's application, representation or proposal up the proper channel, after checking it and adding the forwarding officer's remarks.
Who issues it	The intermediate officer or Head of Office (e.g. a Headmaster forwarding a teacher's application to the District Educational Officer).
Who receives it	The higher or competent authority that will decide.
Differs from	Covering letter: written by the sender of the documents to explain them; a forwarding letter is written by an intermediate officer passing on another person's papers with remarks. Endorsement: a short forwarding note on the paper itself, not a separate letter.
Example	Subject: Request of Thiru S. Vignesh, Junior Assistant, for No Objection Certificate - forwarded Sir/Madam, The application of Thiru S. Vignesh, Junior Assistant of this office, for a No Objection Certificate to appear for a TNPSC examination is sent for your orders. His work and conduct are satisfactory. Forwarded and recommended. Yours faithfully, S. Anitha Tahsildar, Salem

6.24 Covering letter

Definition	A letter that accompanies enclosed documents and explains them : what is sent, why, and what action is expected.
Purpose	To introduce the enclosures so that they are understood and dealt with correctly (e.g. a job application sent with a resume; an office sending returns, bills or a report).
Who issues it	The sender (owner) of the documents.
Who receives it	The person or office to whom the documents are sent.
Differs from	Forwarding letter: written by an intermediate officer passing on someone else's papers with remarks; a covering letter is written by the sender of his or her own documents. (American English: "cover letter".)
Example	"I enclose the audited accounts of the Society for 2025-26 for your approval."

6.25 Model formats

Short model formats in full-block style (names and file numbers are illustrative). In each one, note where the salutation and the complimentary close appear - and where they do not. For blank templates and full exam answers, see Sections 9 and 10.

(a) Official letter

Key features: file number, office and date at the top; addressee by designation; Subject and Reference before the salutation; "Sir/Madam,"; first person "I am directed to ..."; "Yours faithfully,"; signed with designation ("for" = signing on behalf of the head of office).

No. 1234/A2/2026

Office of the District Collector, Salem

Dated 12 October 2026

To

The Commissioner,

Salem City Municipal Corporation,

Salem - 636 001

Subject: Installation of street lights on Anna Nagar Main Road - approval

Reference: Your letter No. 567/H1/2026 dated 30 September 2026

Sir/Madam,

I am directed to refer to your letter cited and to inform you that the proposal to install street lights on Anna Nagar Main Road has been approved. You are requested to complete the work within one month and to send a completion report to this office.

Yours faithfully,
R. Divya
for District Collector, Salem

(b) D.O. letter

Key features: the sender's name and designation at the top; "D.O. No." and date; addressed by name ("Dear Thiru Senthil,"; Central Government: "Dear Shri ...,"); personal, first-person tone; "Yours sincerely,"; the addressee's name and address at the bottom left.

S. Arun, I.A.S.
District Collector, Salem

D.O. No. 1234/A2/2026
Dated 12 October 2026

Dear Thiru Senthil,

The repair of the Omalur Main Road has been pending for some months for want of technical clearance from your office. The road is used every day by a large number of school students, and its poor condition has already caused minor accidents.

I shall be grateful if you could look into the matter personally and arrange to issue the clearance at an early date.

Yours sincerely,
S. Arun

Thiru P. Senthil,
Superintending Engineer,
Highways Department,
Salem - 636 001

(c) Office Memorandum

Key features: file number, Ministry, place and date at the top; the words "OFFICE MEMORANDUM"; subject; third person "The undersigned is directed to ..."; paragraphs after the first are numbered; no salutation, no close; name and designation; "To" at the bottom left.

No. 1234/A2/2026
Government of India
Ministry of [MINISTRY]
New Delhi, dated 12 October 2026

OFFICE MEMORANDUM

Subject: Nomination of officers for training in office procedure

The undersigned is directed to state that a five-day training programme in office procedure will be held in New Delhi from 16 to 20 November 2026.

2. All Ministries/Departments are requested to nominate two Section Officers each for the programme and to send their names to this Ministry by 30 October 2026.

S. Lakshmi
Under Secretary to the Government of India

To
All Ministries/Departments of the Government of India

(d) Office Order

Key features: file number, office and date; the words "OFFICE ORDER"; an impersonal order in the third person; no salutation, no close; signed by the Head of Office or "for" him

or her; "To" and "Copy to" at the bottom.

No. 1234/A2/2026
Office of the District Collector, Madurai
Dated 12 October 2026

OFFICE ORDER

Thiru R. Arun, Junior Assistant, Establishment Section, is posted to the Accounts Section with immediate effect. He will hand over charge of his present work to Tmt. K. Meena, Junior Assistant, Establishment Section, before 15 October 2026.

V. Suresh
for District Collector, Madurai

To
Thiru R. Arun, Junior Assistant
Tmt. K. Meena, Junior Assistant
Copy to: Superintendents, Establishment and Accounts Sections; personal files

(e) Circular

Key features: file number, office and date; the word "CIRCULAR"; subject; impersonal wording ("It has been decided ..."; "All ... are requested to ..."); no salutation, no close; "To" names the whole group; receipt to be acknowledged.

No. 1234/A2/2026
Office of the District Collector, Madurai
Dated 12 October 2026

CIRCULAR

Subject: Time-bound disposal of petitions from the public

It has been decided that every petition received from the public should be disposed of within 30 days of its receipt. All district-level officers are requested to follow this instruction strictly.

2. A monthly report on the petitions received and disposed of should be sent to this office by the 5th of every month. The receipt of this circular should be acknowledged.

K. Priya
District Collector, Madurai

To
All District-level Officers, Madurai District

(f) Notice

Key features: name of the office; the word "NOTICE"; date; a short title in capitals; the message in the third person; name and designation of the issuing authority; no salutation, no close.

OFFICE OF THE DISTRICT COLLECTOR, MADURAI

NOTICE

12 October 2026

PUBLIC GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL MEETING

Notice is hereby given that a public grievance redressal meeting will be held at the Collectorate, Madurai, on 19 October 2026 at 10 a.m. Members of the public may submit their petitions in person at the meeting.

K. Priya
District Collector, Madurai

(g) Tamil Nadu Proceedings format

Key features: the heading "PROCEEDINGS OF THE ..."; "Present:" (the officer passing the order); Rc. No. and date; Sub: and Ref;; the word "ORDER:"; the order in the third person; signature and designation; "To" and "Copy to"; no salutation, no close.

PROCEEDINGS OF THE DISTRICT COLLECTOR, MADURAI
Present: Tmt. K. Priya, I.A.S.

Rc. No. 1234/A2/2026
Dated 12 October 2026

Sub: Establishment - Revenue Department - Transfer of Junior Assistant on request - Orders issued
Ref: Request of Thiru R. Karthik, Junior Assistant, Taluk Office, Melur, dated 5 October 2026

ORDER:

In the reference cited, Thiru R. Karthik, Junior Assistant, Taluk Office, Melur, has requested a transfer to Usilampatti on family grounds. His request is accepted, and he is transferred and posted as Junior Assistant, Taluk Office, Usilampatti, with immediate effect.

K. Priya
District Collector, Madurai

To
Thiru R. Karthik, Junior Assistant, Taluk Office, Melur
Copy to: The Tahsildar, Melur; the Tahsildar, Usilampatti

(h) Endorsement at the foot of a letter

Key features: only the end of the letter is shown. The endorsement comes below the signature of the main letter; it repeats the file number and date, says "Copy forwarded to ... for information and necessary action." and is signed again.

I am directed to request you to complete the repairs to the Panchayat Union Middle School building, Pudur, before 30 November 2026.

Yours faithfully,
V. Suresh
for District Collector, Madurai

No. 1234/A2/2026, dated 12 October 2026

Copy forwarded to:
1. The Block Development Officer, Madurai East, for information and necessary action.
2. The Headmaster, Panchayat Union Middle School, Pudur, for information.

V. Suresh
for District Collector, Madurai

The same form is used to **return a paper** to its sender, e.g. "Returned in original to Thiru S. Vignesh, Junior Assistant, as the application has not been sent through proper channel."
On copies of a signed communication, "Sd/-" (= signed) is written before the officer's name to show that the original was signed.

6.26 Quick comparison table

Form	Salutation?	Complimentary close?	Person (1st/3rd)	Typical opening words	Signed as
Official letter	Yes: "Sir/Madam,"	Yes: "Yours faithfully,"	1st	"I am directed to ..."	Name + designation ("for" the head of office when signed on his or her behalf)

Form	Salutation?	Complimentary close?	Person (1st/3rd)	Typical opening words	Signed as
D.O. letter	Yes: "Dear Thiru X," (Central: "Dear Shri X,")	Yes: "Yours sincerely,"	1st (personal)	"Please refer to ..." / "I would like to draw your personal attention to ..."	Officer's own name (name and designation printed at the top)
Office Memorandum	No	No	3rd	"The undersigned is directed to ..."	Name + designation
Office Order	No	No	3rd	"Thiru X, Assistant, is posted to ..." / "It is hereby ordered that ..."	Head of Office, or "for" him or her (name + designation)
Order	No	No	3rd	"Sanction is hereby accorded to ..."	Competent authority (name + designation)
Notification	No	No	3rd	"It is hereby notified that ..."	Authorised officer (e.g. Secretary to Government), in the name of the President / Governor
Resolution	No	No	3rd	"It has been decided to constitute a Committee ..."	Secretary / Joint Secretary to Government (name + designation)
Circular	No	No	3rd	"It has been decided ..." / "All Heads of Offices are requested to ..."	Issuing officer (name + designation)
Notice	No	No	3rd	"Notice is hereby given that ..."	Issuing authority (name + designation)
Endorsement	No	No	3rd (impersonal)	"Copy forwarded to ..."	Signature + designation, below the endorsement
Memo (internal)	No	No	1st or 3rd (direct)	"Please refer to ..." / "Please send ..."	Sender's name in the "From" line (may be initialled)

Note: a *resolution* passed at a meeting (recorded in the minutes) is not the same as a Government *Resolution* published in the Gazette.

6.27 Do not confuse and must remember

DO NOT CONFUSE: **Petition** = request to an authority for redress or action, often signed by many people (also an application to a court); **representation** = usually one individual's grievance or request for reconsideration, sent through proper channel.

DO NOT CONFUSE: **Memorandum (memo)** = short internal note in any organisation (To / From / Date / Subject); **Office Memorandum** = Government form between Ministries/Departments, in the third person ("The undersigned is directed to ...").

DO NOT CONFUSE: **Circular** = sent to many offices or persons; **notice** = displayed or published for people to read; **notification** = published in the Official Gazette (rules, orders, appointments).

DO NOT CONFUSE: **Enclosure** = separate paper sent with a letter ("Encl."); **annexure** = numbered attachment at the end of a main document (Annexure I, II), referred to in its text.

DO NOT CONFUSE: **Forwarding letter** = written by an intermediate officer passing someone else's application to a higher authority with remarks ("forwarded and recommended"); **covering letter** = written by the sender to explain his or her own enclosed documents.

DO NOT CONFUSE: **Minutes** = record of discussions and decisions, written after the meeting and confirmed at the next; **agenda** = list of items circulated before the meeting with the notice.

DO NOT CONFUSE: **D.O. letter** = personal, officer to officer by name, "Dear Thiru X," ... "Yours sincerely,"; **official letter** = impersonal, addressed by designation, "Sir/Madam," ... "Yours faithfully,".

MUST REMEMBER: No salutation and no complimentary close in an Office Memorandum, Office Order, Order, Notification, Resolution, government circular, notice or internal memo.

MUST REMEMBER: "I am directed to ..." = official letter (first person); "The undersigned is directed to ..." = Office Memorandum (third person); "It is hereby notified that ..." = Notification.

MUST REMEMBER: Official letter: "Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully,". D.O. letter: "Dear Thiru X," (Central: "Dear Shri X,") + "Yours sincerely," with a D.O. No. at the top.

MUST REMEMBER: Notifications and Resolutions are published in the Official Gazette; circulars and notices usually are not.

MUST REMEMBER: Order = financial sanctions and disciplinary matters; Office Order = internal administration (distribution of work, leave, postings within the office).

MUST REMEMBER: Tamil Nadu: a G.O. is issued by a Secretariat department; Proceedings (Present: / Rc. No. / Dated / Sub: / Ref: / ORDER:) are issued by Heads of Departments and District officers.

MUST REMEMBER: An employee's application or representation to a higher authority goes through proper channel - the immediate superior forwards it with remarks.

MUST REMEMBER: Endorsement (government) = note at the foot forwarding copies or returning a paper; endorsement (banking) = signature on the back of a cheque to transfer it.

EXAM TIP: Article 350 of the Constitution: every person may submit a representation for the redress of any grievance to any officer or authority of the Union or a State in any of the languages used in the Union or in the State.

EXAM TIP: All executive action of the Union Government is expressed to be taken in the name of the President (Article 77), and that of a State Government in the name of the Governor (Article 166); so Government orders and notifications are issued in their name.

MEMORY TRICK: A comes before M: the **A**genda comes before the meeting, the **M**inutes after it.

MEMORY TRICK: "Demi" means half: a **demi-official** letter is half official (it is about office work) and half personal (friendly, addressed by name).



Letter-Writing Terminology

Key terms in five groups. Learn the meaning AND the correct use; revise the HIGH-FREQUENCY terms first. "(Avoid: ...)" marks outdated or wrong usage; "(Note: ...)" marks a common confusion.

7.1 Parts and layout terms

The parts of a letter in order, then the layout styles. Full anatomy: Section 1; templates: Section 9.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
A. Top of the letter		
Letterhead	The printed heading on an organisation's stationery: name, logo, address, phone, email (and GSTIN for firms).	All replies to customers must be printed on the company letterhead.
Sender's address	The writer's address at the top of the letter. In formal letters write only the address here; your name goes below the complimentary close.	If the question gives no address, write "Examination Hall" as the sender's address.
Date line	The date of writing, placed below the sender's address. Book style: 12 October 2026. (Avoid: all-numeric dates such as 12/10/2026 - they are ambiguous.)	The date line reads "12 October 2026", not "12/10/26".
Inside address	The receiver's designation or name and full address, written after "To" below the date.	The inside address must match the address on the envelope.
Reference (Ref.)	(1) A line quoting the number and date of an earlier letter, order or notice that this letter follows up; (2) the file number printed at the top of business letters ("Our Ref." / "Your Ref.").	Reference: Your letter No. ACC/112/2026 dated 2 October 2026.
Attention line	A line such as "Kind Attention: The Purchase Manager" that directs a letter addressed to a firm to one person or department.	Add "Kind Attention: The Purchase Manager" so that the letter reaches the right desk quickly.
Subject (Sub:) HIGH-FREQUENCY	A one-line summary of the purpose: a short noun phrase after "Subject:", with no full stop. This book places it before the salutation (after it in the traditional British layout - accepted variant).	Subject: Request for a duplicate fee receipt
B. Greeting, body and close		
Salutation HIGH-FREQUENCY	The greeting that opens the letter, followed by a comma, e.g. "Dear Sir/Madam,". It must match the complimentary close. (Note: never put "Dear" and "Respected" together - see 8.15.)	Use "Dear Sir/Madam," when you do not know the name of the officer.
Body	The main part of the letter: opening paragraph (why you are writing), main paragraph(s) (facts and details) and closing paragraph (the action you want).	Keep the body to three or four short paragraphs.
Complimentary close HIGH-FREQUENCY	The polite phrase before the signature, e.g. "Yours faithfully,": capital Y, small f or s, no apostrophe, comma after. It must match the salutation. Older grammar books call it the "subscription" or "leave-taking".	"Dear Sir," takes "Yours faithfully,"; "Dear Mr. Raman," takes "Yours sincerely,".
Signature	The writer's own handwritten sign, placed below the complimentary close, with the name written clearly under it.	In an exam, sign as "ABC" unless the question gives a name.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
Signature block	Everything below the close: signature, full name, designation and, in business letters, "For FIRM NAME" above the signature.	For Kaveri Paper Mills, the signature, S. Senthil, Sales Manager.
Designation	The official post of a person (e.g. Branch Manager, Tahsildar). Official letters are usually addressed to the designation, not the name.	Address the letter to "The District Collector", not to the officer by name.
C. Below the signature		
Enclosure (Encl.) HIGH-FREQUENCY	A paper sent in the same envelope as the letter; all enclosures are listed at the foot after "Encl.:".	List every enclosure at the foot, e.g. "Encl.: 1. Copy of the fee receipt".
Annexure	A numbered supporting document attached to a letter, report or application and referred to in the text (Annexure I, Annexure II); common in government, legal and tender papers. (Note: books usually say "appendix".)	The list of beneficiaries is given in Annexure II.
Attachment	A file sent with an email. (Note: in emails write "attached"; in paper letters write "enclosed".)	Please see the attached PDF of the purchase order.
CC (Copy to) HIGH-FREQUENCY	"Carbon copy" (now often read as "courtesy copy"): lists the other people who receive a copy; every receiver can see these names. Paper letters usually write "Copy to:".	The complaint to the Commissioner ended with "Copy to: The Zonal Officer, Ward 12".
BCC	"Blind carbon copy": a copy sent without the other receivers knowing; used mainly in email.	The school sent the circular to all parents in BCC to keep their email addresses private.
P.S. (postscript)	Latin post scriptum, "written after": a short note added below the signature. (Avoid in formal letters - put the point in the body; fine in informal letters.)	P.S. Do bring the photo album when you come for Pongal.
D. Layout styles		
Full-block format	A layout in which every line (addresses, date, paragraphs, close) starts at the left margin, with no indentation. All model letters in this book use it.	In full-block format, even the date and the complimentary close begin at the left margin.
Semi-block format	An older layout: the first line of each paragraph is indented, and the date, close and signature are placed towards the right. (Note: accepted variant.)	Some older textbooks print their model letters in semi-block format.
From-To format	The school format widely taught in Tamil Nadu: "From" (sender's name and address) and "To" (receiver's address) at the top, "Thanking you," before the close, "Place:" and "Date:" at the bottom left. (Note: accepted variant - see Section 9.)	In the From-To format, the sender's name is written at the top after "From".
Envelope address	The receiver's address written on the envelope; school exams often ask for it. Older grammar books call it the "superscription".	Copy the envelope address exactly from the inside address, with the pin code on the last line.

DO NOT CONFUSE: Enclosure = a paper in the same envelope (listed after "Encl."); Annexure = a numbered supporting document referred to in the text ("see Annexure I"); Attachment = a file sent with an email. CC = copy with names visible to all receivers; BCC = hidden copy (see Section 15).

7.2 Office and procedure words

Words for receiving, recording, checking and deciding letters in government offices, banks and firms. For the forms of official correspondence see Section 6.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
A. Receiving, recording and sending		
Correspondence	Letters and messages exchanged between persons or offices. (Note: uncountable - not "correspondences" for letters.)	Please quote the file number in all future correspondence.
Forwarded	Sent on to another person or office, usually with a short note; a "forwarding letter" passes on another person's papers with brief remarks (see 6.23).	The application is forwarded to the District Educational Officer for necessary action.
Covering letter	A short letter sent with documents or goods, stating what is enclosed and why.	Send a covering letter with your CV when you apply for a job.
Acknowledgement HIGH-FREQUENCY	A written confirmation that a letter, application, payment or goods have been received; also the receipt itself. (Note: "acknowledgment" without the e is also correct, mainly American.)	The office issued an acknowledgement with a receipt number for my application.
Dispatch (despatch)	Sending letters or goods; also the office section that sends them. (Note: both spellings are correct; "dispatch" is more common.)	The reply was dispatched by registered post on 5 October 2026.
Docket	A short summary or record entry of a document's details (number, date, sender, subject), written on the paper or its cover or in a register; "docketing" means making this entry.	The clerk docketed each letter with its inward number and date before filing it.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
Inward register	The register in which every letter received by an office is entered with a serial (inward) number, date and sender's name.	Your letter was entered in the inward register as No. 1452 on 6 October 2026.
Outward register	The register (also called the dispatch register) that records every letter sent out: number, date, addressee and mode of sending.	The outward register shows that the reply was posted on 8 October 2026.
File number	The number given to the file on a subject; every letter on that subject quotes it so that replies reach the right file.	Please quote File No. EST/245/2026 in your reply.
Draft	The first version of a letter, prepared for checking and approval before the final copy is signed.	The assistant put up a draft reply for the officer's approval.
Fair copy	The clean final version made after the draft is corrected and approved; this copy is signed and sent.	After the officer approved the draft, a fair copy was typed and signed.
B. Requests, complaints and follow-up		
Requisition	A formal written request for supplies, staff, services or information, often on a fixed form.	The laboratory assistant sent a requisition for chemicals for the next term.
Representation	A formal written statement of a grievance or claim sent to an authority, asking it to reconsider or act (common in service matters).	The teacher submitted a representation to the Director seeking correction of her seniority.
Petition	A formal written appeal to an authority (government, court) for a specific action, often signed by many people.	The residents sent a petition signed by 300 families to the Collector for a new bus stop.
Grievance	A complaint about unfair treatment or a problem that affects you.	She registered her grievance online and received a reference number.
Redressal	Setting right a grievance; the remedy given. (Note: mainly Indian usage; international English uses "redress".)	Write to the grievance redressal officer if the branch does not reply.
Reminder	A follow-up letter sent when an earlier letter, order or payment has received no response.	This is our second reminder; our letter dated 1 September 2026 is still unanswered.
Intimation	Formal information or notice about an event or decision. (Note: common in Indian official letters; plain English: "information", "notice".)	Please give prior intimation of your visit to the branch.
Clarification	An explanation that removes a doubt or confusion.	The candidate sought clarification on the age limit given in the notification.
Confirmation	A statement that something is true, correct or definitely arranged.	Please send written confirmation of the hall booking by email.
Through proper channel HIGH-FREQUENCY	Sending an employee's application to a higher authority through his or her immediate superior; a "Through: ..." line is written above or below the addressee.	Teachers must send transfer requests through proper channel, that is, through the Headmaster.
C. Permission and proof		
Authorization (authorisation)	Official permission for a person to act, or the document that gives it (an authority letter).	The account holder gave written authorization to her son to collect the cheque book.
Verification	Checking that facts or documents are true and correct.	Original certificates will be returned after verification.
Certification	An official written statement that something is true or meets a standard; also the certificate itself.	The form needs certification by the head of the institution.
Attested copy	A photocopy signed as a true copy of the original by an authorised person (e.g. a Gazetted Officer or notary). (Note: many offices now accept self-attested copies.)	Enclose attested copies of your mark sheets.
Affidavit	A written statement made on oath or affirmation before a notary or oath commissioner.	The applicant filed an affidavit stating that the original certificate was lost.
Undertaking	A written promise to do or not to do something (not made on oath).	Every student gave an undertaking to follow the hostel rules.
Testimonial	A written statement about a person's character, conduct or ability, given by a teacher or employer. (Note: in business it also means a customer's praise of a product.)	The Principal gave her a testimonial for the scholarship application.
D. Decisions and orders		
Recommendation	A suggestion that something be done; in offices, a lower officer's written support for a request, sent to the authority that decides.	The Headmaster forwarded the leave letter with his recommendation.
Endorsement HIGH-FREQUENCY	(Government) a note at the foot of a communication forwarding copies ("Copy forwarded to ... for information / necessary action") or returning a paper to its sender. (Banking) a signature on the back of a cheque or other negotiable instrument to transfer it.	The endorsement at the foot read: "Copy forwarded to the Tahsildar for necessary action."

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
Approval	Formal agreement that a plan, request or proposal may go ahead (the general word).	The proposal was sent to the Director for approval.
Sanction HIGH-FREQUENCY	Formal authorisation by the competent authority, especially for spending money (financial sanction); also for leave, loans or posts. (Note: in the news, "sanctions" also means penalties on a country - a different meaning.)	The Government has accorded sanction for Rs. 25 lakh for the new school building.
Ratification HIGH-FREQUENCY	Formal approval of an action ALREADY taken, e.g. an urgent decision confirmed later by the council or board.	The purchase made during the flood emergency was placed before the council for ratification.
Compliance	Acting as a rule, order or request requires; a "compliance report" states the action taken.	Please send a compliance report on the audit objections within 15 days.
Non-compliance	Failure to follow a rule, order or request; it may lead to a penalty.	Non-compliance with this order will lead to disciplinary action.

MEMORY TRICK: Sanction comes BEFORE (permission to spend or act); Ratification comes AFTER (approval of an action already taken). Recommendation = a lower officer supports a request; approval or sanction = the higher authority says yes.

7.3 Formal linking words

Connectors used in official, legal and business letters. Use the common ones freely; use the "here-/there-" words and Latin forms sparingly - plain English is clearer.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
A. Linking to a topic or an earlier letter		
Regarding	About; on the subject of. (Note: "regarding" already means "about" - never write "regarding about".)	I am writing regarding the delay in issuing my community certificate.
Concerning	About; relating to (slightly more formal than "about").	We have received several complaints concerning the new billing system.
With regard to	About; in connection with. (Note: "with regard to" or "as regards" - NOT "with regards to".)	With regard to your request for a refund, we have credited Rs. 1,200 to your account.
With reference to	Links your letter to an earlier letter, advertisement or notice.	With reference to your advertisement in The Hindu dated 5 October 2026, I wish to apply for the post of Accountant.
In response to	As a reply to (a letter, request, inquiry or advertisement).	In response to your inquiry dated 2 October 2026, we enclose our latest price list.
Further to	Following on from (an earlier letter, call or meeting).	Further to our telephone conversation this morning, I confirm our order for 50 chairs.
B. Rules, conditions and reasons		
Pursuant to	In accordance with; as required by (a rule, order or agreement).	Pursuant to clause 7 of the agreement, we are returning the damaged goods.
In accordance with	Following; in the way required by (rules, instructions, a contract).	The goods have been packed in accordance with your instructions.
As per	According to. (Note: common in Indian business letters; "according to" or "as stated in" is plainer.)	As per your order dated 3 October 2026, we have dispatched 100 cartons.
Subject to	Depending on a condition; only if something else happens.	The appointment is subject to verification of original certificates.
In view of	Because of; considering.	In view of the heavy rain, the camp has been postponed.
Notwithstanding	In spite of; even though.	Notwithstanding the holiday, the fee counter will remain open.
In lieu of	Instead of; in place of.	Staff who worked on the holiday will get a day off in lieu of it.
C. Acting for others and dates		
On behalf of	As the representative of; for (another person or organisation).	I am writing on behalf of the Residents' Welfare Association, K.K. Nagar.
Per pro (p.p.) HIGH-FREQUENCY	Latin per procuracionem, "by agency": used when a person signs a letter on behalf of another person who has authorised it. (Note: p.p. is now usually written before the name of the person being signed for.)	In the manager's absence, his assistant signed the letter "p.p. R. Suresh, Manager".
With effect from (w.e.f.) HIGH-FREQUENCY	From the stated date, when an order or change starts to apply. (Note: never "w.e.f. from" - "from" is already inside.)	Thiru R. Arun is transferred to Salem with effect from 1 November 2026.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
Henceforth	From now on.	Henceforth, all leave applications must be submitted online.
inst. / ult. / prox.	Old commercial short forms: instant = this month, ultimo = last month, proximo = next month. (Avoid: write the month name.)	Write "your letter of 5 October", not "your letter of the 5th inst."
D. "Here-" and "there-" words		
Herewith	With this letter. (Note: "Please find enclosed herewith" is redundant - write "Please find enclosed" or "I enclose".)	I send herewith a copy of the lease deed.
Hereby	By this (statement or document); used when the words themselves perform the act.	I hereby declare that the information given above is true.
Hereto	To this (document).	The terms of supply are given in the schedule attached hereto.
Hereinafter	From this point on in this document; used to introduce a short name.	Kaveri Paper Mills (hereinafter called "the Supplier") shall deliver the paper by 30 November 2026.
Thereof	Of that; of it (the thing just mentioned).	The contract, or any part thereof, shall not be transferred.
Therein	In that (place, document or matter).	Read the notification and follow the instructions given therein.
Aforesaid	Mentioned earlier in the same document.	The aforesaid amount of Rs. 5,000 will be refunded within 30 days.
Aforementioned	Mentioned before; same meaning as aforesaid. (Note: "the above" or simply "this" is often plainer.)	The aforementioned candidates should report for certificate verification on Monday.
E. Latin short forms		
Vide	HIGH-FREQUENCY Latin for "see / refer to": points the reader to an order, letter, page or annexure. (Note: officialese; Indian letters often use it to cite an order - "vide G.O. No. 45 dated ..." means "see / under G.O. No. 45".)	The revised rates are given in the table (vide Annexure II).
Re:	"In the matter of; about" (from Latin); email programs add "Re:" to the subject of a reply. (Note: in formal letters write "Subject:".)	Re: Your application for a new electricity connection
Inter alia	Latin for "among other things".	The report recommends, inter alia, a new water tank for the school.
Viz.	Latin videlicet, "namely": introduces the exact items just mentioned; read it aloud as "namely".	Two documents, viz. the invoice and the delivery challan, are missing.

EXAM TIP: Latin in letters: vide = see; viz. = namely; inter alia = among other things; re = in the matter of; p.p. (per pro) = signed on behalf of; P.S. (post scriptum) = written after. The "here-" words point to THIS document (herewith, hereby, hereto); the "there-" words point to THAT thing just mentioned (thereof, therein).

7.4 Polite formula expressions

Fixed polite expressions for requesting, informing, enclosing and closing. Section 8 gives many more phrases, arranged by purpose.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
A. Requesting		
Kindly	A polite word for "please" in requests. (Note: use it once; do not add "please" as well, and never write "kindly be informed".)	Kindly issue me a duplicate hall ticket before 20 October 2026.
I request you to	A formal way to ask for an action. (Note: not "request you to please"; the verb takes no "for": "I request leave", not "I request for leave".)	I request you to grant me leave for three days from 14 October 2026.
I shall be grateful if	A very polite formal request, usually followed by "you would" or "you could".	I shall be grateful if you would send me the prospectus for 2027.
I shall be obliged if	Same as "I shall be grateful if"; very formal.	I shall be obliged if you could refund the excess amount of Rs. 450.
At your earliest convenience	As soon as you can (polite). (Note: vague - give a date when the matter is urgent.)	Please let me know at your earliest convenience whether the hall is available.
Please acknowledge receipt	A request to confirm that the letter, payment or goods have reached the receiver.	Please acknowledge receipt of this letter and the enclosed cheque.
B. Informing		

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
We wish to inform you that	A neutral formal way to give information.	We wish to inform you that our office has moved to Anna Nagar, Chennai.
We are pleased to inform you that	The formal way to give good news.	We are pleased to inform you that you have been selected for the post of Clerk.
We regret to inform you that	The formal way to give bad news.	We regret to inform you that the book you ordered is out of print.
This is to bring to your notice that	Draws an authority's attention to a problem; used in complaints and reports.	This is to bring to your notice that the street lights on Gandhi Road have not worked for two weeks.
I am directed to	The opening of an official Government letter, written on the orders of a higher authority.	I am directed to inform you that your request for transfer has been accepted.
This is to certify that	The standard opening of a certificate or testimonial.	This is to certify that Selvi R. Kavya studied in this school from 2020 to 2026.

C. Enclosing and closing

Please find enclosed HIGH-FREQUENCY	The standard phrase for sending papers with a letter. (Note: do not add "herewith"; a modern alternative is "I enclose".)	Please find enclosed a copy of my mark sheet.
I look forward to hearing from you	The standard polite closing sentence. (Note: "look forward to" + -ing: "hearing", not "hear".)	I look forward to hearing from you soon.

D. Handle with care

Please be informed	An old formula for giving information. (Avoid: write "This is to inform you that" or "I wish to inform you that".)	Better: "This is to inform you that the office will remain closed on 2 October 2026."
Do the needful HIGH-FREQUENCY	Indian officialese for "take the necessary action". (Avoid: vague and dated - say exactly what you want done.)	Better: "Please take the necessary action to repair the pipeline."
Thanking you	A stand-alone line before the close. (Note: accepted Indian usage; better modern style is "Thank you for your time." inside the last paragraph.)	Thank you for your prompt attention to this matter.

7.5 Commercial and banking words

Words used in business and bank letters; the meanings match Sections 3 to 5. For cheque dishonour, stop-payment and transport documents see Sections 4 and 5.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
A. Buying and selling		
Quotation HIGH-FREQUENCY	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions, sent in reply to an inquiry before any order; it is valid for a stated period (a firm offer).	Our quotation is valid for 30 days from the date of this letter.
Estimate	An approximate statement of cost; the final bill may differ.	The contractor gave an estimate of Rs. 2 lakh for repairing the roof.
Tender	A formal, often sealed, offer to supply goods or do work, made in response to an invitation, usually from a public body.	The Corporation has invited sealed tenders for road repair work.
Purchase Order (PO)	A formal numbered document issued by the buyer to order goods; binding once the seller accepts it.	Please quote our PO No. 2026/118 on the invoice and the delivery challan.
Proforma invoice	A preliminary bill sent before supply, for advance payment or import formalities.	Kindly send a proforma invoice so that we can arrange advance payment.
Invoice (tax invoice)	The bill issued by the seller for goods supplied, showing quantity, price, taxes, total and due date.	Payment is due within 30 days of the invoice date.
E&OE	"Errors and Omissions Excepted": printed on invoices and quotations so that the seller may correct mistakes later.	The words "E&OE" at the foot of the invoice allow the seller to correct clerical errors.
Consignment	A batch of goods sent to a buyer or agent. (Note: consignor = sender; consignee = receiver.)	The consignment of 200 cartons was dispatched by lorry today.
Credit note	Issued by the SELLER to the buyer; it reduces the amount the buyer owes (goods returned, overcharge, allowance).	We have issued a credit note for Rs. 600 for the damaged items.
Debit note	Issued by the BUYER to the seller when returning goods or claiming a deduction; it tells the seller that his account has been debited. (Note: under GST law both notes are issued by the supplier.)	We are returning 10 defective fans with a debit note for Rs. 12,000.
B. Payments and dues		
Remittance	Money sent to someone, usually by bank transfer, draft or cheque; also the act of sending it.	We acknowledge with thanks your remittance of Rs. 15,000 by NEFT.

Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
Dues	Money that must be paid (fees, charges, bills).	Please clear your hostel dues before the examination.
Arrears	Payments that are overdue and still unpaid; also pay due from an earlier date (e.g. salary arrears after a pay revision).	The tenant is two months in arrears with his rent.
Outstanding	(Of an amount) still unpaid; not yet settled. (Note: it also means "excellent" - the context decides.)	An amount of Rs. 8,400 is still outstanding against your account.
Instalment	One part of a debt or price paid at regular intervals. (Note: EMI = Equated Monthly Instalment; American spelling "installment".)	The loan is repayable in 24 monthly instalments.
Default	Failure to repay a loan or pay a bill on time.	If the borrower defaults, the bank may recover the amount from the guarantor.
C. Banking and loans		
Overdraft	A bank facility that lets an account holder (usually of a current account) withdraw more than the balance, up to an agreed limit; interest is charged on the amount overdrawn.	The firm applied for an overdraft of Rs. 5 lakh to meet festival-season expenses.
Collateral	An asset (land, gold, deposits) pledged to a lender as security for a loan; the lender may sell it if the loan is not repaid.	The bank asked for the house documents as collateral for the loan.
Hypothecation	A charge on movable property (such as a vehicle or stock) given as security for a loan while the borrower keeps using it.	The registration certificate shows the car as hypothecated to the bank until the loan is repaid.
Guarantor	A person who promises to repay a loan if the borrower fails to. (Note: in law the guarantor is called the "surety".)	My uncle signed the loan papers as guarantor.
NOC (No Objection Certificate)	A certificate stating that the issuing authority has no objection to a proposed action.	After the car loan was closed, the bank issued an NOC to remove the hypothecation.
KYC (Know Your Customer)	The process by which a bank verifies a customer's identity and address with documents.	The bank asked me to update my KYC by submitting a copy of my Aadhaar card.
Nominee	The person named by an account holder to receive the money in the account after the holder's death.	Please register my wife as the nominee for my savings account.
Demand draft (DD)	A prepaid instrument issued by a bank, payable to a named payee; it cannot bounce for lack of funds.	The application fee of Rs. 500 must be paid by demand draft.
Letter of Credit (L/C)	A bank's written undertaking, issued at the buyer's (importer's) request, to pay the seller (exporter) when specified documents are presented; used mainly in foreign trade.	The importer opened a letter of credit in favour of the exporter in Singapore.

DO NOT CONFUSE: Quotation (firm prices) / Estimate (approximate cost) / Tender (formal, often sealed, offer); Proforma invoice (before supply) / Invoice (after supply); Credit note (from the seller) / Debit note (from the buyer). See Section 15.



8 High-Frequency Formal Phrases

Ready-made phrases for each job a letter does. Learn the **Formal** ones for exams; **Semi-formal** and **Informal** ones are shown only for contrast (full comparison: Section 12).

8.1 How to judge register

Register means the level of formality. Decide it from WHO will read the letter and WHY you are writing. Officials, organisations, editors and strangers: formal. People you know but must respect (a neighbour, landlord, colleague or former teacher): semi-formal. Family and friends: informal. When unsure in an exam, choose formal.

Signal	Formal	Semi-formal	Informal
Reader	Officials, firms, editors, unknown persons	Known persons you respect	Family and friends
Salutation	Dear Sir/Madam, / Sir, / Respected Sir, (named person: Dear Mr. Raman,)	Dear Mr. Raman,	Dear Priya, / Dear Appa,
Close	Yours faithfully, (named person: Yours sincerely,)	Yours sincerely,	Your loving friend, / With love,
Subject line	Always	Optional	Never
Contractions (I'm, don't)	Never	Usually avoided	Allowed

Signal	Formal	Semi-formal	Informal
Tone and words	Impersonal, precise: request, inform, regret, enclose	Polite, personal: I would like, please let me know	Chatty: can you, thanks a lot, see you soon
Exclamation marks	Never	Rarely	Allowed

8.2 A. Opening a letter

Phrase	Register	Example / use
I am writing to ...	Formal	I am writing to request a change in my examination centre.
I am writing with reference to ...	Formal	I am writing with reference to your letter No. EST/45/2026 dated 2 October 2026.
I wish to bring to your notice that ...	Formal	I wish to bring to your notice that the drainage in Ward 12 has been blocked for a week.
I am directed to ...	Formal	Government official letters only: I am directed to state that your request has been approved.
Thank you for your letter dated ...	Formal	Thank you for your letter dated 3 October 2026 regarding the delay in delivery.
On behalf of ..., I wish to ...	Formal	On behalf of the residents of K.K. Nagar, I wish to request a bus stop near the park.
In response to your advertisement ...	Formal	In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated 5 October 2026, I wish to apply for the post of Accountant.
I am a ... (one line about yourself)	Formal	I am a Class XII student of your school and wish to request a bona fide certificate.
I would like to ...	Semi-formal	I would like to thank you for your help during my project work.
Hope you are all doing well.	Informal	Hope you're all doing well. I got your letter yesterday.

8.3 B. Making a request

Phrase	Register	Example / use
I request you to ...	Formal	I request you to issue me a duplicate transfer certificate.
I shall be grateful if you would ...	Formal	I shall be grateful if you would send me the application form by post.
I shall be obliged if you could ...	Formal	I shall be obliged if you could extend the last date by one week.
I would be grateful if you could ...	Formal	I would be grateful if you could let me know the fee for 2027.
Kindly ...	Formal	Kindly grant me leave on 14 and 15 October 2026.
May I request you to ...?	Formal	May I request you to reconsider your decision?
You are requested to ...	Formal	Official letters and notices: You are requested to attend the meeting on 20 October 2026.
It is requested that ... be ...	Formal	Impersonal, official: It is requested that the report be sent by 20 October 2026.
Could you please ...?	Semi-formal	Could you please let me know if the community hall is free on Sunday?
Can you ...?	Informal	Can you send me your notes on Indian polity?

8.4 C. Giving information

Phrase	Register	Example / use
This is to inform you that ...	Formal	This is to inform you that the office will remain closed on 2 October 2026.
I wish to inform you that ...	Formal	I wish to inform you that I have changed my residential address.
We are pleased to inform you that ...	Formal	Good news: We are pleased to inform you that your loan has been sanctioned.
We regret to inform you that ...	Formal	Bad news: We regret to inform you that your application could not be accepted.
We write to inform you that ...	Formal	We write to inform you that your policy is due for renewal on 1 December 2026.
Please note that ...	Formal	Please note that our office hours are 10 a.m. to 5 p.m.
It has been decided that ...	Formal	Official decisions: It has been decided that the annual day will be held on 10 January 2027.
The details are as follows: ...	Formal	Use before a list of facts, e.g. the date, time and venue of a meeting.
You will be glad to know that ...	Semi-formal	You will be glad to know that I have joined a bank in Coimbatore.

Phrase	Register	Example / use
Just to let you know, ...	Informal	Just to let you know, I've passed the exam!

8.5 D. Making an inquiry

Phrase	Register	Example / use
I am writing to inquire about ...	Formal	I am writing to inquire about the admission procedure for the diploma course. ("Inquire" and "enquire" are both accepted.)
I would be grateful if you could inform me whether ...	Formal	I would be grateful if you could inform me whether hostel facilities are available.
Kindly let me know ...	Formal	Kindly let me know the last date for submitting the application.
Please send me details of ...	Formal	Please send me details of your evening courses in accountancy.
I would like to know whether ...	Formal	I would like to know whether the course is recognised by the university.
We are interested in ... and would like to know ...	Formal	We are interested in your steel almirahs and would like to know your trade discount.
We shall be glad to receive ...	Formal	We shall be glad to receive your latest catalogue and price list.
Please let us know your terms of ...	Formal	Please let us know your terms of payment and delivery.
Would it be possible to ...?	Semi-formal	Would it be possible to visit the factory next week?
Do you know if ...?	Informal	Do you know if the library is open on Sundays?

8.6 E. Complaining

Phrase	Register	Example / use
I am writing to complain about ...	Formal	I am writing to complain about the irregular supply of drinking water in our street.
This is to bring to your notice that ...	Formal	This is to bring to your notice that the bus shelter near our school has collapsed.
I wish to draw your attention to ...	Formal	I wish to draw your attention to the heaps of garbage near the market.
I regret to inform you that ...	Formal	I regret to inform you that the goods were damaged in transit.
We regret to point out that ...	Formal	We regret to point out that the goods do not match the sample.
Despite repeated requests, ...	Formal	Despite repeated requests, the street light has not been repaired.
This has caused great inconvenience to ...	Formal	This has caused great inconvenience to the residents, especially the elderly.
I must insist that ...	Formal	Firm, for a second complaint: I must insist that the defective machine be replaced at once.
I was rather disappointed with ...	Semi-formal	I was rather disappointed with the service at your restaurant last Sunday.
I'm really fed up with ...	Informal	I'm really fed up with the noise from the flats next door.

8.7 F. Apologizing

Spelling: "apologise" (British, used in this book) and "apologize" are both correct.

Phrase	Register	Example / use
We apologise for ...	Formal	We apologise for the delay in dispatching your order.
Please accept our sincere apologies for ...	Formal	Please accept our sincere apologies for the error in your bill.
We regret the inconvenience caused.	Formal	We regret the inconvenience caused to you and your family.
We sincerely regret ...	Formal	We sincerely regret the mistake in invoice No. 118.
The delay was due to ...	Formal	Give the reason briefly: The delay was due to a strike by transport workers.
Please excuse ...	Formal	Please excuse the delay in replying to your letter.
We assure you that ...	Formal	We assure you that such an error will not happen again.
We have taken steps to ensure that ...	Formal	We have taken steps to ensure that every order is checked before dispatch.
I am sorry that ...	Semi-formal	I am sorry that I could not attend your daughter's wedding reception.

Phrase	Register	Example / use
Sorry for ...	Informal	Sorry for not writing for so long. I've been busy with exams.

8.8 G. Giving clarification

Phrase	Register	Example / use
I wish to clarify that ...	Formal	I wish to clarify that the payment was made on 3 October 2026, not on 13 October.
This is to clarify that ...	Formal	This is to clarify that the offer applies only to orders above Rs. 10,000.
It is clarified that ...	Formal	Circulars and official letters: It is clarified that the order applies to aided schools also.
With reference to your query regarding ..., we wish to state that ...	Formal	With reference to your query regarding the late fee, we wish to state that it has been waived.
There seems to be a misunderstanding regarding ...	Formal	There seems to be a misunderstanding regarding the delivery date.
The discrepancy arose because ...	Formal	The discrepancy arose because the discount was not shown in the invoice.
The position is as follows: ...	Formal	Official letters: introduces the facts point by point.
For the sake of clarity, ...	Formal	For the sake of clarity, the revised timetable is enclosed.
To put it simply, ...	Semi-formal	To put it simply, the new rule changes only the last date, not the fee.
Let me explain ...	Informal	Let me explain what happened at the station.

8.9 H. Referring to previous correspondence

Phrase	Register	Example / use
With reference to your letter No. ... dated ...	Formal	With reference to your letter No. ACC/112/2026 dated 2 October 2026, I enclose the documents you asked for.
In reply to your letter dated ...	Formal	In reply to your letter dated 3 October 2026, we confirm delivery on 15 October.
I refer to your letter of ...	Formal	I refer to your letter of 3 October 2026 about the new delivery schedule.
Further to our letter dated ...	Formal	Further to our letter dated 1 October 2026, we send the revised price list.
We acknowledge with thanks receipt of your letter dated ...	Formal	Business replies: We acknowledge with thanks receipt of your letter dated 4 October 2026.
In continuation of this office letter of even number dated ...	Formal	Government letters; "of even number" means the earlier letter bears the same reference number.
Reference is invited to ...	Formal	Official letters: Reference is invited to this office letter dated 5 September 2026.
Our letter dated ... remains unanswered.	Formal	Reminders: Our letter dated 1 September 2026 remains unanswered.
As I mentioned in my last letter, ...	Semi-formal	As I mentioned in my last letter, I will be in Chennai next month.
Remember I told you about ...?	Informal	Remember I told you about my new job? I started last week.

8.10 I. Attaching documents

Phrase	Register	Example / use
Please find enclosed ...	Formal	Please find enclosed a copy of my Aadhaar card.
I enclose ...	Formal	I enclose a demand draft for Rs. 500 towards the application fee.
A copy of ... is enclosed for your reference.	Formal	A copy of the receipt is enclosed for your reference.
The following documents are enclosed: ...	Formal	List them in the body, then repeat the list after "Encl.:" at the foot.
A self-addressed stamped envelope is enclosed ...	Formal	A self-addressed stamped envelope is enclosed for your reply.
... is being sent under separate cover.	Formal	Our catalogue is being sent under separate cover.
Please find attached ...	Formal	Emails: Please find attached the minutes of the meeting.
Encl.: 1. ... 2. ...	Formal	The enclosure line at the foot of the letter, below the name.
I have attached ...	Semi-formal	I have attached the photographs you asked for.

Phrase	Register	Example / use
I'm sending you ...	Informal	I'm sending you some photos from our trip to Ooty.

8.11 J. Requesting action

Phrase	Register	Example / use
Please take the necessary action to ...	Formal	Please take the necessary action to repair the pipeline before the monsoon.
I request you to look into the matter ...	Formal	I request you to look into the matter personally.
I request you to direct the officials concerned to ...	Formal	I request you to direct the officials concerned to clear the drain.
Kindly arrange to ...	Formal	Kindly arrange to replace the damaged items within a week.
I urge you to ...	Formal	I urge you to take immediate steps to control the mosquito menace.
Please ensure that ...	Formal	Please ensure that the goods are insured in transit.
Please expedite ...	Formal	Please expedite the dispatch of our order. ("Expedite" = speed up.)
... for information and necessary action	Formal	Official endorsements: Copy forwarded to the Block Development Officer for information and necessary action.
Could you please sort this out ...?	Semi-formal	Could you please sort this out before the end of the week?
Can you get it fixed ...?	Informal	The tap's leaking again. Can you get it fixed soon?

8.12 K. Giving deadlines

Phrase	Register	Example / use
on or before ...	Formal	Please submit the form on or before 20 October 2026.
not later than ...	Formal	Your reply should reach this office not later than 31 October 2026.
within ... days of receipt of this letter	Formal	Please pay the amount within 15 days of receipt of this letter.
by ... at the latest	Formal	Please send the report by 23 October 2026 at the latest.
failing which ...	Formal	Final notices: Please pay by 30 November 2026, failing which we shall take legal action.
without further delay	Formal	Please remit the balance without further delay.
The last date for ... is ...	Formal	The last date for receipt of applications is 31 October 2026.
Kindly treat this as urgent.	Formal	Kindly treat this as urgent, as the examination begins on 2 November 2026.
by the end of next week	Semi-formal	Could you send the photographs by the end of next week?
ASAP	Informal	Send me the tickets ASAP. (Never in formal letters.)

8.13 L. Closing a formal letter

Phrase	Register	Example / use
Thank you for your time and consideration.	Formal	Job and request letters; the modern replacement for a stand-alone "Thanking you".
I look forward to hearing from you.	Formal	The safest last line for almost any formal letter.
I look forward to your early reply.	Formal	Use when you need a quick answer.
Please do not hesitate to contact me if you need any further information.	Formal	Offers help; common in replies and business letters.
I hope my request will receive favourable consideration.	Formal	Applications and requests. (British spelling: favourable.)
I trust that the matter will receive your prompt attention.	Formal	Complaints: polite but firm.
We value your business and look forward to serving you again.	Formal	Business replies to customers.
Yours faithfully, / Yours sincerely,	Formal	Yours faithfully after "Dear Sir/Madam," "Sir," or "Respected Sir,"; Yours sincerely after "Dear Mr. Raman,".
Looking forward to hearing from you.	Semi-formal	Common in emails; strictly not a full sentence, so write "I look forward to ..." in formal letters.

Phrase	Register	Example / use
Take care and write soon.	Informal	Friends and family only.

8.14 Same message in three registers

Each row says the same thing three ways. In exam letters, use only the first column.

Formal	Semi-formal	Informal
Thank you for your letter dated 3 October 2026.	Thank you for your letter of 3 October.	Thanks for your letter. It was lovely to hear from you.
I shall be grateful if you would send me details of the course.	Could you please send me details of the course?	Can you send me the course details?
We are pleased to inform you that your application has been approved.	I am happy to tell you that your application has been approved.	Great news: your application's been approved!
We regret to inform you that the post has already been filled.	I am sorry to tell you that the post has already been filled.	Sorry, but the job's already gone.
Please accept our apologies for the delay in replying.	I am sorry for the delay in replying.	Sorry I took so long to write back.
Please find enclosed a copy of the receipt.	I am enclosing a copy of the receipt.	I've put a copy of the receipt in with this letter.
I wish to complain about the poor quality of the service.	I was disappointed with the service.	The service was really bad.
You are cordially invited to the annual day celebrations on 10 January 2027.	We would be delighted if you could join us for our annual day on 10 January.	Do come for our annual day on 10 January. It'll be fun!
I regret that I shall not be able to attend the function owing to a prior engagement.	I am sorry that I will not be able to attend the function because of a prior commitment.	Sorry, I can't come. I've already got plans that day.
I request you to grant me an appointment at your convenience.	Could we meet sometime next week?	Let's meet up next week.
This is to remind you that the payment of Rs. 5,000 is overdue.	I would like to remind you that the payment of Rs. 5,000 is still due.	Don't forget you still owe me Rs. 5,000!
I am extremely grateful for your assistance.	Thank you very much for your help.	Thanks a lot for helping me out.
Please do not hesitate to contact me if you require any further information.	Please let me know if you need anything else.	Give me a call if you need anything.

8.15 Outdated or wrong phrases to avoid

Letter questions and error-spotting questions often test these. The left column shows the wrong or outdated form - never copy it.

Avoid	Use instead	Why
Please do the needful.	Please take the necessary action. / Say exactly what you want: "Please issue the certificate."	Vague, dated Indian officialese; the reader has to guess what "needful" means.
Kindly revert back. / I will revert back.	Please reply. / I will reply by Friday.	"Revert" means "go back to an earlier state", so "back" repeats it; using "revert" for "reply" is Indian usage that other readers may not follow.
Kindly be informed that ... / Please be informed that ...	This is to inform you that ... / I wish to inform you that ...	A stiff, old-fashioned passive formula.
Please find enclosed herewith ...	Please find enclosed ... / I enclose ...	"Enclosed" and "herewith" say the same thing twice.
We have received your letter and will reply to the same shortly.	We have received your letter and will reply to it shortly.	"The same" is not a pronoun in modern English; use it, them or this.
Thanking you in anticipation,	Thank you for considering my request.	Dated, and it presumes that the reader will agree. (The plain "Thanking you," line is accepted Indian usage.)
The meeting has been preponed to Monday.	The meeting has been brought forward to Monday.	"Prepone" is Indian English: understood in India, not internationally.
My cousin brother / cousin sister will collect the documents.	My cousin Arun / My cousin Meena will collect the documents.	"Cousin" already covers both male and female; add the name if you need to show who.
I am having two years of experience.	I have two years of experience.	"Have" meaning possession is a state verb; it is not used in the -ing form.
We discussed about the fee hike.	We discussed the fee hike.	"Discuss" takes a direct object - no "about" (but "a discussion about" is correct).

Avoid	Use instead	Why
I request you to please grant me leave.	I request you to grant me leave. / Please grant me leave.	Double politeness: "request" is already polite; use one polite word only.
Respected Sir, ... Yours sincerely,	Respected Sir, ... Yours faithfully,	Salutation and close must match: Sir/Madam forms take "Yours faithfully"; "Yours sincerely" goes with "Dear Mr./Ms. + name".
Your's faithfully, / Yours Faithfully,	Yours faithfully,	"Yours" is a possessive pronoun and never takes an apostrophe; capital Y, small f, comma after.
Dear Respected Sir,	Respected Sir, / Dear Sir,	"Dear" and "Respected" do the same job; use only one of them.
I beg to state that ...	I wish to state that ... / I am writing to ...	Old-fashioned and over-humble; modern formal English is polite but direct.
with regards to your letter	with regard to your letter / regarding your letter	The fixed phrase is "with regard to"; "regards" means good wishes ("Kind regards").
Please reply at your earliest.	Please reply at your earliest convenience. / Please reply by 20 October 2026.	Incomplete: "at your earliest" needs the noun "convenience". ("At the earliest" alone, meaning "as soon as possible", is accepted Indian usage; in standard English it usually follows a time: "on Monday at the earliest".)
I request for two days' leave.	I request two days' leave. / I request you to grant me two days' leave.	The verb "request" takes no "for"; the noun does ("a request for leave").

MUST REMEMBER: Match the close to the salutation: "Dear Sir/Madam," "Sir," or "Respected Sir," → "Yours faithfully,"; "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,". Write "Yours" with no apostrophe, and never put "Dear" and "Respected" together.

MUST REMEMBER: Formal letters use full, polite and precise phrases - "I request you to ...", "I shall be grateful if ...", "Please find enclosed ...", "on or before (date)", "I look forward to hearing from you." Never write "do the needful", "revert back", "please be informed" or "enclosed herewith", and use no contractions, slang or exclamation marks.

9

Letter Format Templates

This section gives **17 fill-in templates**, one for each main letter type. Each template is a complete skeleton: the layout, ready-made opening, main and closing sentences, and the correct salutation and close. Learn the skeleton; in the exam, replace every placeholder with the facts given in the question. Fully worked answers are in Section 10, phrases for the body in Section 8, and errors to avoid in Section 11.

9.0 How to Use These Templates

- Read the situation:** who writes, to whom, and why. This decides the register - formal, semi-formal or informal (see Section 12).
- Pick the template** from the Template finder below.
- Replace every placeholder** with facts from the question. A slash inside the brackets means "choose one"; words after a dash are hints. **Never** leave a bracket in your answer.
- Keep the ready-made sentences** of the opening and closing paragraphs; build the main paragraph from the points given in the question.
- Delete the optional lines** you do not need (see the Optional lines table).
- Final check:** date style, "To" block, Subject before the salutation, matching salutation and close, your name below the close.

Placeholder legend

Placeholder	What to write
A. Addresses and date	
[SENDER'S ADDRESS]	Your door number, street and area - one item per line, each line ending with a comma. Do not write your name here. Exam: "Examination Hall" if the question gives no address.
[CITY - PIN CODE]	The last line of any address, with no comma and no full stop: Madurai - 625 020
[DATE]	Day, month in words, year: 12 October 2026. ("12th October, 2026" is the traditional Indian style; avoid 12/10/2026 - all-numeric dates are ambiguous.)
[RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION]	The post, not the person's name, written after "The": The Commissioner, / The Branch Manager, / The Principal,
[ORGANISATION]	The office, company, bank or institution: Madurai City Municipal Corporation, / M/s. Kaveri Traders, (M/s. = Messrs, written before a firm's name)
[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS]	The receiver's street and area, ending with a comma; the next line is [CITY - PIN CODE]. For a newspaper, write only the city.

Placeholder	What to write
B. Subject, reference and body	
[SUBJECT]	A short noun phrase that shows the whole purpose, with no full stop: Complaint regarding irregular garbage collection in K.K. Nagar
[REFERENCE NUMBER]	The number of the earlier letter, notice, order or advertisement you are answering ("Reference: Your notice No. ... dated ..."), or your own file number in an office or business letter ("Ref. No.: ...")
[PURPOSE]	Why you are writing, in one clause: request a duplicate mark sheet
[PROBLEM]	The problem in one clause: the street lights on our road have not worked for two weeks
[REASON]	Why you need it: my father has been admitted to hospital
[DETAILS]	Facts only - who, what, where, when, how much. Short sentences, one idea per paragraph.
[ACTION REQUIRED]	The exact action you want: replace the defective fan / issue a new passbook
C. Money and numbers	
[ACCOUNT NUMBER]	As given in the question; mask it where sensible (XXXXXXXX4521). Never write a PIN, OTP, CVV or password.
[AMOUNT]	In figures, and in money letters in words as well: Rs. 12,500 (Rupees twelve thousand five hundred only)
[PO NUMBER] / [INVOICE NUMBER]	Exactly as printed on the Purchase Order or the invoice
[GSTIN]	The firm's 15-character GST Identification Number (Tamil Nadu numbers begin with 33); model letters show it as 33XXXXXXXXX1Z5
D. Signature block	
[SIGNATURE]	Real letter: your handwritten signature above your name. Exam: never sign your real name (see the identity rule below).
[NAME]	Your full name below the close (informal letters: first name only). Exam: the name given in the question, otherwise "ABC" / "XYZ".
[DESIGNATION]	Your post, when you write for an office or a firm: Purchase Manager / Junior Assistant
[ENCLOSURES]	Documents sent with the letter, numbered, one per line: 1. Copy of the invoice / 2. Photographs of the defect. Leave out the Encl. line if nothing is enclosed.
[COPY RECEIVER]	Designation and office of each person who gets a copy, with the purpose: The Assistant Engineer, Ward 12 - for information and necessary action
E. Personal and employment letters	
[SURNAME]	The name written after the title in semi-formal letters: Dear Mr. Raman, / Dear Dr. Meena, (for a name written with an initial, like R. Karthik: Dear Mr. Karthik,)
[FIRST NAME]	Informal letters only: Dear Priya, - and your own first name at the end
[POST]	The post applied for, held or appointed to: Junior Assistant / Sales Executive
[FROM DATE] / [TO DATE]	Start and end of a leave or service period, both written in full (12 October 2026)
[NOTICE PERIOD]	As fixed in the terms of appointment: one month / three months

Optional lines - keep them only when needed

Line	Keep it only when	Where it goes
Reference: Your ... No. ... dated ...	You reply to, or refer to, an earlier letter, notice, order or advertisement	After the Subject, before the salutation
Ref. No.: ...	An office or a firm writes (its own file number)	Below the letterhead, above the date
Kind Attention: ...	A letter to a firm must reach one particular officer	After the receiver's address, before the Subject
Through: ...	An employee writes to a higher authority "through proper channel" (via the immediate superior)	Above or below the addressee
Subject: ... (semi-formal)	Optional in semi-formal letters; never used in informal letters	Before the salutation
For [FIRM NAME]	You sign on behalf of a firm	Just below the complimentary close
[DESIGNATION]	You write in an official capacity	Below your name
Encl.: ...	Something is actually enclosed	Below the signature block
Copy to: ... / CC: ...	Copies go to other persons or offices	Last line, below Encl.

Template finder

Template	Register	Salutation	Close	Subject line
9.1 Formal letter	Formal	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Yes

Template	Register	Salutation	Close	Subject line
9.2 Semi-formal letter	Semi-formal	Dear Mr./Mrs. [SURNAME],	Yours sincerely,	Optional
9.3 Informal letter	Informal	Dear [FIRST NAME] / Dear Appa,	Your loving friend, / Your loving son, / Your loving daughter,	No
9.4 Business letter; 9.12 Order letter	Formal	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully, + For [FIRM NAME]	Yes (with letterhead and Ref. No.)
9.5 Complaint; 9.6 Inquiry; 9.7 Request; 9.8 Job application; 9.10 Editor; 9.11 Bank; 9.15 Resignation; 9.17(b) Joining report	Formal	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Yes
9.9 Government authority	Formal	Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Yes
9.13 Recommendation	Formal	Dear Sir/Madam, (named receiver: Dear Dr. [SURNAME],)	Yours faithfully, (named receiver: Yours sincerely,)	Yes
9.14 Reference	Formal	None - the heading TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN	Yours faithfully,	No
9.16 Leave	Formal	Respected Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Yes
9.17(a) Appointment	Formal	Dear Mr./Ms. [SURNAME],	Yours sincerely,	Yes

MUST REMEMBER: EXAM IDENTITY RULE - if the question does not give a name or address, write "Examination Hall" as the address and sign as "ABC" or "XYZ". Never reveal your real identity in an exam answer. If the question gives a name and address, use exactly those.

9.1 Formal Letter

Use for: Any letter to an official, office or organisation you do not know personally - the master pattern for the formal templates that follow.

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To
The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],
[ORGANISATION],
[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: [SUBJECT]

Reference: Your [LETTER / NOTICE] No. [REFERENCE NUMBER] dated [DATE]

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to [PURPOSE]. I am a [RESIDENT / CUSTOMER / STUDENT] of [PLACE / ORGANISATION].

[DETAILS - WHAT HAPPENED, WHERE AND WHEN]. [SUPPORTING FACTS - DATES, NUMBERS, ACTION ALREADY TAKEN]. This has caused [EFFECT ON YOU OR THE PUBLIC].

I therefore request you to [ACTION REQUIRED] at the earliest. Thank you for your time and attention.

Yours faithfully,
[SIGNATURE]
[NAME]

Encl.: [ENCLOSURES]
Copy to: [COPY RECEIVER]

EXAM TIP: Learn this skeleton first - the other formal templates change only the Subject, the body sentences and a few optional lines. Your name goes below "Yours faithfully," never above the address.

Accepted variant - the "From-To" format (widely taught in Tamil Nadu schools). This book's model letters use the full-block format above, but the From-To layout below is also correct.

From

[NAME],

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

To

The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],

[ORGANISATION],

[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Respected Sir/Madam,

Sub: [SUBJECT]

[BODY - OPENING, MAIN AND CLOSING PARAGRAPHS]

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

[NAME]

Place: [PLACE]

Date: [DATE]

Address on the envelope:

To

The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],

[ORGANISATION],

[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

DO NOT CONFUSE: From-To format = your name at the top, salutation BEFORE "Sub:", a "Thanking you," line, Place and Date at the bottom-left. Full-block format (this book) = date at the top, Subject BEFORE the salutation, name only below the close, thanks inside the last paragraph. Both are accepted - never mix the two in one letter.

9.2 Semi-formal Letter

Use for: A person you know but must address with respect - a teacher, neighbour, landlord, a friend's parent or a senior colleague (thanks, request, apology, invitation).

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

Mr./Mrs. [RECEIVER'S FULL NAME],

[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: [SUBJECT]

Dear Mr./Mrs. [SURNAME],

I hope you and your family are doing well. I am writing to [PURPOSE - THANK YOU / ASK FOR YOUR HELP / APOLOGISE / INVITE YOU].

[DETAILS - WHAT HAPPENED OR WHAT YOU NEED, WHEN AND WHY] [PERSONAL TOUCH - WHY THEIR HELP OR PRESENCE MATTERS TO YOU].

I would be grateful if you could [ACTION REQUIRED]. Thank you for your [KINDNESS / HELP / UNDERSTANDING]. Please convey my regards to [FAMILY MEMBERS].

Yours sincerely,

[SIGNATURE]

[FULL NAME]

EXAM TIP: Semi-formal = title + name ("Dear Mr. Raman,") with "Yours sincerely,"; a bare first name would make it informal. Be polite and warm, but use no slang or contractions; the Subject line is optional.

9.3 Informal Letter

Use for: Family members and close friends - sharing news, congratulating, advising, inviting, thanking or consoling.

[SENDER'S SHORT ADDRESS],

[CITY]

[DATE]

Dear [FIRST NAME / RELATION],

I hope you and everyone at home are fine. I was very happy to get your letter and to hear that [THEIR NEWS]. I'm sorry I couldn't reply earlier - [SHORT REASON].

I'm writing to tell you about [MAIN NEWS / EVENT]. [DETAILS - WHAT HAPPENED, WHO WAS THERE, HOW YOU FELT].

[ADVICE / INVITATION / REQUEST]. Why don't you [SUGGESTION - COME AND STAY WITH US THIS VACATION]?

Please give my regards to [ELDERS] and my love to [YOUNGER ONES]. Do write back soon.

Your loving [FRIEND / SON / DAUGHTER],

[FIRST NAME]

EXAM TIP: No "To", no receiver's address and no Subject; sign with your first name only. Contractions are fine here, but avoid slang and SMS language in an exam answer.

9.4 Business Letter

Use for: Letters written on behalf of a firm to another firm or to a customer - inquiries, quotations, orders, complaints, adjustments, credit and collection.

[FIRM NAME IN CAPITALS]

[FIRM ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Phone: [PHONE NUMBER] | Email: [EMAIL ADDRESS]

GSTIN: [GSTIN]

Ref. No.: [REFERENCE NUMBER]

[DATE]

To

M/s. [RECEIVER FIRM NAME],

[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Kind Attention: [OFFICER'S NAME AND DESIGNATION]

Subject: [SUBJECT]

Dear Sir/Madam,

We are writing to [PURPOSE], with reference to [YOUR LETTER / YOUR QUOTATION / OUR ORDER] No. [NUMBER] dated [DATE].

[DETAILS - GOODS OR SERVICE, QUANTITIES, PRICES, DATES, TERMS]. [WHAT YOU OFFER, NEED OR PROPOSE].

We shall be glad if you could [ACTION REQUIRED] by [DATE]. For any clarification, please contact [CONTACT PERSON] at [PHONE NUMBER]. We look forward to your early reply.

Yours faithfully,

For [FIRM NAME]

[SIGNATURE]

[NAME]

[DESIGNATION]

Encl.: [ENCLOSURES]

CC: [COPY RECEIVER]

EXAM TIP: The firm speaks, so write "we", not "I". Ref. No. at the top is your own file number; the number of the letter, quotation or order you are answering goes into the first sentence.

9.5 Complaint Letter

Use for: Reporting a defective product, poor service, delay, shortage or wrong goods to a company, shop or service provider, and asking for a remedy.

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],

[ORGANISATION],

[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Complaint regarding [DEFECTIVE PRODUCT / POOR SERVICE] - Invoice No. [INVOICE NUMBER]

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to bring to your notice that [PROBLEM]. I purchased the [PRODUCT / SERVICE] from [SHOP / WEBSITE] on [DATE] (Invoice No. [INVOICE NUMBER] Rs. [AMOUNT]).

[DETAILS - WHAT IS WRONG AND SINCE WHEN] I reported the problem to [SHOP / CUSTOMER CARE] on [DATE] (Complaint No. [COMPLAINT NUMBER]), but it has not been solved so far. This has caused me [INCONVENIENCE / LOSS].

I therefore request you to [REMEDY - REPLACE THE PRODUCT / REFUND THE AMOUNT / REPAIR IT FREE OF COST] within [NUMBER OF DAYS] days. If the matter is not settled by then, I shall be compelled to approach [HIGHER AUTHORITY / THE CONSUMER COMMISSION].

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]

[NAME]

Encl.: 1. Copy of Invoice No. [INVOICE NUMBER]

2. [PHOTOGRAPHS / WARRANTY CARD]

EXAM TIP: Give proof (invoice number, date, amount) and ask for ONE clear remedy with a time limit - firm but polite, no angry words. Civic problems (roads, water, garbage) go to an authority: use 9.9.

9.6 Inquiry Letter

Use for: Asking for information - prices, terms, course details, admission, or the availability of a product or service ("enquiry letter" is also accepted).

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To
The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],
[ORGANISATION],
[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Inquiry about [PRODUCT / SERVICE / COURSE]

Dear Sir/Madam,

I saw your advertisement for [PRODUCT / SERVICE / COURSE] in [NEWSPAPER / WEBSITE] dated [DATE]. I am interested in [WHAT YOU WANT] and would like some information before I decide.

I would be grateful if you could send me the following details:

1. [FIRST QUESTION - PRICE / FEES]
2. [SECOND QUESTION - TERMS / DURATION / ELIGIBILITY]
3. [THIRD QUESTION - DELIVERY / DATES / DISCOUNTS]

Kindly send these details, along with your [BROCHURE / PRICE LIST / APPLICATION FORM], to the above address or by email to [EMAIL ADDRESS]. I look forward to your early reply.

Yours faithfully,
[SIGNATURE]
[NAME]

EXAM TIP: Number your questions so that the reply can answer point by point, and end by asking for a brochure, price list or form. A firm's inquiry uses the business layout (9.4) and "we".

9.7 Request Letter

Use for: Asking an authority or organisation for permission, a document, a facility, a concession or a change (a duplicate certificate, a bus stop, the use of a hall).

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To
The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],
[ORGANISATION],
[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Request for [WHAT YOU NEED]

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to request you to [REQUEST IN ONE CLAUSE]. I am a [STUDENT / RESIDENT / MEMBER] of [INSTITUTION / AREA / ORGANISATION].

I need this because [REASON]. [DETAILS - DATES, NUMBERS, WHO WILL BENEFIT]. I am ready to [CONDITION - PAY THE PRESCRIBED FEE / PRODUCE THE DOCUMENTS / FOLLOW THE RULES].

I shall be grateful if you could [ACTION REQUIRED] by [DATE]. Thank you for considering my request.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]

[NAME]

Encl.: [ENCLOSURES]

EXAM TIP: One letter, one request: state it in the Subject ("Request for ...") and again in the first sentence. Give the reason and offer to meet any condition (fee, documents, rules).

9.8 Application Letter (Job Application)

Use for: Applying for an advertised job - the covering letter sent with your resume and certificates.

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],

[ORGANISATION],

[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Application for the post of [POST]

Reference: Your advertisement No. [REFERENCE NUMBER] in [NEWSPAPER / WEBSITE] dated [DATE]

Dear Sir/Madam,

In response to your advertisement cited above, I wish to apply for the post of [POST] in your [ORGANISATION / DEPARTMENT]. I believe that my qualifications and experience match your requirements.

I have completed [QUALIFICATION] from [INSTITUTION] in [YEAR] with [MARKS / GRADE]. I have [NUMBER OF YEARS] years of experience as [PREVIOUS POST] at [PREVIOUS EMPLOYER], where I [MAIN DUTIES / ACHIEVEMENT]. I am skilled in [SKILLS - COMPUTER, ACCOUNTS, LANGUAGES].

I enclose my resume and copies of my certificates for your consideration. I shall be glad to attend an interview on any date convenient to you. If selected, I shall discharge my duties with sincerity and dedication. Thank you for considering my application.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]

[NAME]

Encl.: 1. Resume (bio-data)

2. Copies of [EDUCATIONAL AND EXPERIENCE CERTIFICATES]

3. [OTHER DOCUMENTS - PHOTOGRAPH, IDENTITY PROOF]

EXAM TIP: Quote the advertisement and list every enclosure. Freshers replace the experience sentence with a project or internship; a serving employee applies "through proper channel" (add a "Through:" line).

9.9 Letter to a Government Authority

Use for: A citizen writing to an official (District Collector, Corporation Commissioner, Tahsildar, Inspector of Police, head of a department) with a civic complaint, petition or request.

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],
[OFFICE / DEPARTMENT],
[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: [COMPLAINT REGARDING / REQUEST FOR] [ISSUE] in [AREA]

Reference: [YOUR NOTICE / MY PETITION] No. [REFERENCE NUMBER] dated [DATE]

Sir/Madam,

I, [NAME], a resident of [AREA / VILLAGE], wish to bring to your kind notice that [PROBLEM OR NEED, IN ONE CLAUSE].

[DETAILS - SINCE WHEN, HOW MANY PEOPLE ARE AFFECTED, DANGER OR LOSS]. I gave a petition to [LOWER AUTHORITY] on [DATE], but no action has been taken so far.

I therefore request you to [ACTION REQUIRED] at the earliest. I shall be grateful for your prompt action in this matter.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]
[NAME]

Encl.: 1. Copy of the petition dated [DATE]

2. [PHOTOGRAPHS / SIGNATURES OF RESIDENTS]

Copy to: The [LOWER AUTHORITY] - for information and necessary action

EXAM TIP: Name the exact office (not just "the Government"), quote earlier petitions with dates, and add "Copy to:" when a lower office must also act. "Sir/Madam," and "Dear Sir/Madam," both pair with "Yours faithfully,".

9.10 Letter to the Editor

Use for: Raising a public issue (a civic problem, a social evil, safety, the environment) in a newspaper so that the public and the authorities take notice.

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

The Editor,
[NEWSPAPER NAME],
[CITY]

Subject: [PUBLIC ISSUE - SHORT NOUN PHRASE]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of [THE PUBLIC / THE AUTHORITIES CONCERNED] to [ISSUE].

[DETAILS - WHAT IS HAPPENING, WHERE, SINCE WHEN]. [EFFECTS ON THE PUBLIC - HEALTH, SAFETY, MONEY, TIME]. [ONE EXAMPLE OR INCIDENT].

[SUGGESTIONS - WHAT THE AUTHORITIES SHOULD DO AND WHAT CITIZENS CAN DO].

I hope the authorities concerned will take note of this problem and act without delay. I request you to publish this letter in your newspaper.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]

[NAME]

EXAM TIP: Write about a PUBLIC issue, not a private grievance. The letter is addressed to the Editor, not to the officials, and the newspaper's address is only its name and city.

9.11 Bank Letter

Use for: Requests and complaints to your bank branch - cheque book, change of address or mobile number, stop payment, account statement, wrong debit, lost passbook or card.

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

The Branch Manager,

[BANK NAME],

[BRANCH NAME] Branch,

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Request for [SERVICE] - Account No. [ACCOUNT NUMBER]

Dear Sir/Madam,

I hold a [SAVINGS / CURRENT] account in your branch. I request you to [ACTION REQUIRED] because [REASON].

The details are given below:

Name of the account holder: [NAME]

Account number: [ACCOUNT NUMBER]

Registered mobile number: [MOBILE NUMBER]

[OTHER DETAILS - CHEQUE NO., DATE, AMOUNT AND PAYEE / NEW ADDRESS / TRANSACTION DATE AND AMOUNT]

I have enclosed [SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS] for your reference. Kindly process my request at the earliest and confirm it by SMS or email. Applicable charges, if any, may be debited to my account.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]

[NAME]

Encl.: [SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS]

EXAM TIP: Put the account number in the Subject and sign exactly as in the bank's records. Never write a PIN, OTP, CVV or password in any letter or email (more bank letters: Section 4).

9.12 Business Transaction Letter (Order Letter with PO Details)

Use for: A buyer firm placing an order with a supplier, usually after receiving a quotation; the numbered Purchase Order (PO) is enclosed.

[BUYER FIRM NAME IN CAPITALS]

[FIRM ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Phone: [PHONE NUMBER] | Email: [EMAIL ADDRESS]

GSTIN: [GSTIN]

Ref. No.: [REFERENCE NUMBER]

[DATE]

To

M/s. [SUPPLIER FIRM NAME],
[SUPPLIER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Kind Attention: [OFFICER'S NAME], Sales Manager

Subject: Order for [GOODS] - Purchase Order No. [PO NUMBER]

Dear Sir/Madam,

With reference to your quotation No. [QUOTATION NUMBER] dated [DATE], we are pleased to place an order for the following goods under our Purchase Order No. [PO NUMBER] dated [DATE]:

1. [ITEM AND SPECIFICATION] - [QUANTITY] [UNIT] @ Rs. [RATE] per [UNIT] = Rs. [AMOUNT]
2. [ITEM AND SPECIFICATION] - [QUANTITY] [UNIT] @ Rs. [RATE] per [UNIT] = Rs. [AMOUNT]

Total value: Rs. [AMOUNT] (GST extra, as applicable)

Terms of the order:

Delivery: at [DELIVERY ADDRESS] on or before [DATE]

Delivery terms: [EX-WORKS / FOR / DOOR DELIVERY]

Mode of transport: [ROAD / RAIL / COURIER]

Payment: [PAYMENT TERMS]

Packing: [PACKING INSTRUCTIONS]

Please supply the goods strictly as per the specifications in your quotation. Goods found damaged or not as ordered will be returned at your cost.

Kindly acknowledge this order and confirm the date of dispatch. Please quote our PO No. [PO NUMBER] on your invoice, delivery challan and all correspondence.

Yours faithfully,

For [BUYER FIRM NAME]
[SIGNATURE]
[NAME]
[DESIGNATION]

Encl.: Purchase Order No. [PO NUMBER] dated [DATE]

EXAM TIP: Every order states the PO number, item and specification, quantity, rate, total, delivery date, delivery terms and payment terms. The PO becomes binding once the seller accepts it (see Section 5).

9.13 Recommendation Letter

Use for: A teacher, head of an institution or employer recommending a candidate to a specific organisation for a job, admission or scholarship.

[INSTITUTION / COMPANY NAME]

[INSTITUTION ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Phone: [PHONE NUMBER] | Email: [EMAIL ADDRESS]

[DATE]

To

The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],
[ORGANISATION],
[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Recommendation for [CANDIDATE'S NAME] - [POST / COURSE / SCHOLARSHIP]

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am pleased to recommend Mr./Ms. [CANDIDATE'S NAME] for [POST / COURSE / SCHOLARSHIP] in your [ORGANISATION]. I have known [HIM / HER] for [NUMBER OF YEARS] years as [HIS / HER] [TEACHER / HEAD OF DEPARTMENT / MANAGER] at [INSTITUTION / COMPANY].

[HE / SHE] [MAIN ACHIEVEMENTS - MARKS, PROJECTS, AWARDS, RESULTS] [HE / SHE] is [QUALITY 1], [QUALITY 2] and [QUALITY 3]. For example, [ONE INCIDENT THAT PROVES A QUALITY].

I am confident that [HE / SHE] will be an asset to your [ORGANISATION], and I recommend [HIM / HER] without reservation. Please feel free to contact me at [PHONE NUMBER] or [EMAIL ADDRESS] for any further information.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]
[NAME]
[DESIGNATION]

EXAM TIP: A recommendation goes to a specific receiver for a specific purpose; a reference letter is general ("To Whom It May Concern", 9.14). If you know the receiver's name, write "Dear Dr. [SURNAME]," and close with "Yours sincerely,".

9.14 Reference Letter ("To Whom It May Concern")

Use for: A general letter about a person's service, conduct or character that he or she can show to any employer or institution.

[ORGANISATION NAME IN CAPITALS]
[ORGANISATION ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]
Phone: [PHONE NUMBER] | Email: [EMAIL ADDRESS]

Ref. No.: [REFERENCE NUMBER]

[DATE]

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

This is to certify that Mr./Ms. [FULL NAME] worked in our [ORGANISATION / DEPARTMENT] as [POST] from [FROM DATE] to [TO DATE].

During this period, [HIS / HER] duties included [MAIN DUTIES]. [HE / SHE] was [QUALITY 1], [QUALITY 2] and [QUALITY 3], and [ONE SPECIFIC ACHIEVEMENT]. [HIS / HER] conduct and character were [GOOD / EXCELLENT].

We have no hesitation in recommending [HIM / HER] for [ANY SUITABLE POST / FURTHER STUDIES], and we wish [HIM / HER] every success in [HIS / HER] future career.

Yours faithfully,
For [ORGANISATION NAME]
[SIGNATURE]
[NAME]
[DESIGNATION]

EXAM TIP: No "To" block and no salutation - the heading TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN replaces both, but the close is still "Yours faithfully,". State only facts you can confirm: dates, post, duties, conduct.

9.15 Resignation Letter

Use for: An employee formally telling the employer that he or she is leaving the job, with the notice period and the last working day.

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],
[ORGANISATION],
[RECEIVER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Resignation from the post of [POST]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Please accept this letter as formal notice of my resignation from the post of [POST] in the [DEPARTMENT] department. As required by my terms of appointment, I am giving [NOTICE PERIOD] notice; my last working day will be [LAST WORKING DATE].

I have decided to resign because [REASON - SHORT AND POSITIVE]. I am grateful for the guidance and support I have received during my [NUMBER OF YEARS] years with [ORGANISATION], especially [ONE SPECIFIC THING - TRAINING / PROJECT / MENTORING].

Before I leave, I shall complete all pending work and hand over charge of [FILES / DUTIES] to [SUCCESSOR'S NAME / THE PERSON YOU NOMINATE]. I request you to accept my resignation, relieve me on [LAST WORKING DATE] and issue my relieving letter and experience certificate.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]
[NAME]
[DESIGNATION]
Employee ID: [EMPLOYEE ID]

EXAM TIP: State the post, the notice period and the exact last working day; keep the reason short and positive - never criticise the employer. If you address your manager by name ("Dear Mr. Raman,"), close with "Yours sincerely,".

9.16 Leave Letter

Use for: An employee asking the immediate superior for casual, earned or medical leave for a stated period.

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

The [SUPERIOR'S DESIGNATION],
[DEPARTMENT / SECTION],
[ORGANISATION],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Application for [TYPE OF LEAVE] leave from [FROM DATE] to [TO DATE]

Respected Sir/Madam,

I request you to grant me [TYPE OF LEAVE - CASUAL / EARNED / MEDICAL] leave for [NUMBER OF DAYS] days, from [FROM DATE] to [TO DATE], because [REASON].

[DETAILS - DOCTOR'S ADVICE / DATE OF THE FAMILY FUNCTION]. I have completed [URGENT WORK], and [COLLEAGUE'S NAME AND DESIGNATION] has agreed to look after my duties during my absence.

I shall rejoin duty on [REJOINING DATE]. I can be contacted on [PHONE NUMBER] if any urgent matter arises. I shall be grateful if you could sanction the leave.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]

[NAME]

[DESIGNATION]

Employee ID: [EMPLOYEE ID]

Encl.: [MEDICAL CERTIFICATE / INVITATION]

EXAM TIP: Give the type of leave, the exact dates, the number of days, the reason and who will handle your work. Students writing to the Principal use the same layout and may close with the traditional "Yours obediently,".

9.17 Appointment / Joining Letter

Use for: (a) An employer appointing a selected candidate; (b) the new employee's joining report to the employer on the day of joining.

(a) Appointment letter - employer to candidate

[COMPANY NAME IN CAPITALS]

[COMPANY ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Phone: [PHONE NUMBER] | Email: [EMAIL ADDRESS]

Ref. No.: [REFERENCE NUMBER]

[DATE]

To

Mr./Ms. [CANDIDATE'S FULL NAME]

[CANDIDATE'S ADDRESS],

[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Appointment as [POST]

Reference: Your application dated [DATE] and the interview held on [DATE]

Dear Mr./Ms. [SURNAME],

We are pleased to inform you that you have been selected for the post of [POST] in our [DEPARTMENT] department at [PLACE OF POSTING].

The main terms of your appointment are:

1. Salary: Rs. [AMOUNT] per month ([PAY DETAILS - BASIC PAY AND ALLOWANCES])
2. Probation: [PROBATION PERIOD] from the date of joining
3. Working hours: [WORKING HOURS]
4. Notice period: [NOTICE PERIOD] on either side
5. Other conditions: as per the enclosed terms of service and the company rules

Please report to [REPORTING OFFICER'S NAME AND DESIGNATION] at [PLACE OF REPORTING] on [DATE OF JOINING] at [TIME] with your original certificates, identity proof and [NUMBER] passport-size photographs. Please sign and return the duplicate copy of this letter as a token of your acceptance by [LAST DATE FOR ACCEPTANCE]. If you do not report by [DATE OF JOINING], this appointment will stand cancelled.

We welcome you to [COMPANY NAME] and wish you a successful career with us.

Yours sincerely,

For [COMPANY NAME]

[SIGNATURE]

[NAME]

[DESIGNATION]

- Encl.: 1. Terms and conditions of service
2. Duplicate copy of this letter (for acceptance)

(b) Joining report - employee to employer

[SENDER'S ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

[DATE]

To

The [RECEIVER'S DESIGNATION],
[DEPARTMENT],
[COMPANY NAME],
[COMPANY ADDRESS],
[CITY - PIN CODE]

Subject: Joining report - [POST], [DEPARTMENT] department

Reference: Your appointment letter Ref. No. [REFERENCE NUMBER] dated [DATE]

Dear Sir/Madam,

With reference to your appointment letter cited above, I hereby report for duty as [POST] in the [DEPARTMENT] department today, [DATE OF JOINING] ([FORENOON / AFTERNOON]).

I have signed and returned the duplicate copy of the appointment letter in acceptance of the terms. I have also submitted the following documents to the [HR / ADMINISTRATION] department: [LIST OF DOCUMENTS].

I thank you for giving me this opportunity. I request you to accept my joining report and take it on record. I assure you that I shall perform my duties with sincerity and dedication.

Yours faithfully,

[SIGNATURE]
[NAME]
[DESIGNATION]

EXAM TIP: Appointment letter: employer → a named candidate, so "Dear Mr./Ms. [SURNAME]" + "Yours sincerely," with post, salary, probation, joining date and a deadline for acceptance. Joining report: employee → employer on the day of joining, quoting the appointment letter's number and date.

MUST REMEMBER: All 17 templates share 5 things - (1) **full-block layout:** every line starts at the left margin, with one blank line between blocks; (2) **the sender's address (or letterhead) at the top and the date below it**, written as 12 October 2026 - your name never goes at the top; (3) **a salutation that matches the close:** Dear Sir/Madam, → Yours faithfully, | Dear Mr. Raman, → Yours sincerely, | Dear Priya, → Your loving friend, (the heading TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN also takes Yours faithfully,); (4) **a three-part body:** opening (why you write) → main (facts and details) → closing (the action you want and a polite end); (5) **a signature block:** close, signature and name - plus designation when you write in an official capacity. Formal and business templates also carry the "To" block and the Subject BEFORE the salutation.

10

Full Examination-Style Examples

Every example in this section follows the same six steps: **Question** → **Situation** → **Correct format** → **Complete answer** → **Important vocabulary** → **Why the format is correct**. The letter sheet in each example is the complete answer - learn its layout line by line. Examples 10.1 to 10.8 are informal (personal) letters and 10.9 to 10.11 are semi-formal; formal, official and business letters follow from 10.12. For blank templates, see Section 9; for register differences, see Section 12.

MUST REMEMBER: Exam identity rule - if the question gives a name and address, use exactly those (every example below does this). If it gives none, write "Examination Hall" as the address and sign as "ABC" or "XYZ" - in informal letters too ("Your loving son, ABC"). Never reveal your real identity in an exam answer.

10.1 Letter to a Parent Informal

Question: You are Arun, a first-year B.Sc. student staying in Room No. 21, Men's Hostel, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032. Write a letter to your father describing your hostel life and asking for his permission and Rs. 4,500 for a college educational tour. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: Arun, a first-year student in a Chennai college hostel | Receiver: his father | Relationship: son and father | Purpose: to share news of hostel life and ask for permission and money for an educational tour | Register: Informal

Correct format: Sender's address (short) → Date → "Dear Appa," → Body (home news; hostel life; the tour request; family greetings) → "Your loving son," → First name. No subject line and no receiver's address.

Room No. 21, Men's Hostel,
Guindy,
Chennai - 600 032

12 October 2026

Dear Appa,

I received your letter yesterday and I'm happy to know that everyone at home is well. I'm fine here, and I'm slowly getting used to hostel life.

The hostel is clean and the food is simple but tasty. I share my room with two classmates, Hari from Salem and Pradeep from Erode. We get up at six, go for a short walk and study together from seven to nine every night. The warden is strict about timings, but he's kind and helpful. On Sundays, I wash my clothes and play cricket with my friends.

Now I have some good news. Our college has organised a four-day educational tour to Bengaluru and Mysuru from 10 to 13 November. We'll visit a science museum, a dairy plant and a software company, and two of our professors will travel with us. The total cost is Rs. 4,500, including travel, food and stay, and it has to be paid by 25 October. Please give me your permission and send the amount to my bank account. I promise to spend it carefully.

Please convey my love to Amma and tell Meena to study well for her half-yearly exams. I'm eagerly waiting for your reply.

Your loving son,
Arun

Important vocabulary: *get used to* - become familiar with something new (followed by a noun or an -ing form: "getting used to hostel life"); *warden* - the person in charge of a hostel; *educational tour* - a trip arranged so that students can learn outside the classroom; *organise* - arrange, plan (British spelling; American "organize"); *permission* - approval to do something; *convey* - pass on (greetings or a message); *eagerly* - with keen interest and expectation.

Why this format is correct:

- A letter to a parent is personal, so it is informal: short address, date, "Dear Appa," and no subject line or receiver's address.
- "Dear Appa," pairs with "Your loving son,"; only the first name (Arun) follows. "Yours faithfully," never belongs in a family letter.
- One idea per paragraph: home news → hostel life → the request → family greetings.
- The request is specific - what (permission and Rs. 4,500), why (an educational tour) and by when (25 October) - so the father can act at once.
- Contractions (I'm, he's, we'll) are allowed in informal letters like this one; never use them in formal letters.

10.2 Congratulations Letter to a Friend Informal

Question: You are Kavya of 24, Anna Nagar, Madurai - 625 020. Your friend Nandhini has cleared the TNPSC Group 4 examination. Write a letter congratulating her. (about 150-200

words)

Situation: Writer: Kavya | Receiver: her close friend Nandhini | Relationship: friends |

Purpose: to congratulate Nandhini on clearing the TNPSC Group 4 examination and wish her well | Register: Informal

Correct format: Sender's address (short) → Date → "Dear Nandhini," → Body (congratulations at once; praise for her effort; good wishes; a plan to meet) → "Your loving friend," → First name. No subject line and no receiver's address.

24, Anna Nagar,
Madurai - 625 020

28 October 2026

Dear Nandhini,

Congratulations on clearing the TNPSC Group 4 examination! Your mother phoned mine this morning with the good news, and I was so happy that I decided to write to you at once.

You truly deserve this success. I still remember how you studied at the district library every day and revised your notes late into the night. Last time, you missed the cut-off by just a few marks, but you didn't lose heart. You worked on your weak areas, took a mock test every week and kept going. Your hard work and patience have finally paid off.

I'm sure you'll be an honest and caring public servant who treats every citizen with respect. Your success has inspired me too. I've decided to prepare seriously for the next Group 2 examination, and I'll need your guidance.

Please give my regards to your parents. They must be very proud of you. Let's celebrate together when you come home to Madurai next month. Once again, many congratulations and best wishes for a bright career!

Your loving friend,
Kavya

Important vocabulary: *clear* (an examination) - pass it successfully; *deserve* - have earned something by your own effort; *cut-off* - the minimum mark needed to be selected; *lose heart* - become discouraged; *mock test* - a practice test in the pattern of the real examination; *pay off* - (of effort) bring success; *public servant* - a person who works for the government and serves the public; *inspire* - make someone want to do something good.

Why this format is correct:

- A letter to a close friend is informal: short address, date, "Dear Nandhini," and no subject line or receiver's address.
- The congratulations come in the very first sentence, so the purpose is clear at once.
- Specific memories (the library, the missed cut-off, the weekly mock tests) make the praise sincere and personal.
- Preposition: congratulate someone *on* something - "Congratulations on clearing ...".
- Exclamation marks are acceptable in an informal letter to show joy; never use them in a formal letter.

10.3 Invitation Letter to a Friend Informal

Question: You are Meena of 7, Gandhiji Road, Thanjavur - 613 001. Write a letter inviting your friend Janani to your elder sister's wedding in Thanjavur. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: Meena | Receiver: her close friend Janani, who lives in another town | Relationship: friends | Purpose: to invite Janani to her elder sister's wedding and give the date, time and venue | Register: Informal

Correct format: Sender's address (short) → Date → "Dear Janani," → Body (the happy news; date, time and venue; stay and travel help; a warm request to come) → "Your loving friend," → First name. No subject line and no receiver's address.

7, Gandhiji Road,
Thanjavur - 613 001

5 November 2026

Dear Janani,

I hope you and your family are keeping well. I'm writing with some happy news: my elder sister Revathi is getting married to Prakash, a bank officer from Salem.

The wedding will take place on Sunday, 6 December 2026, at Sri Lakshmi Mahal, Medical College Road, Thanjavur. The *muhurtham* is between 9.00 and 10.30 a.m. There will be a reception at the same venue at 7.00 p.m. on the previous evening, Saturday, 5 December. I've enclosed the invitation card, but I wanted to invite you personally too.

Please come a day early with your parents and stay with us. Appa will pick you up from the railway station, so don't worry about the journey. After the wedding, I'll take you to see the Big Temple, which you've always wanted to visit.

It won't feel like a real celebration without you, so please don't say no. Revathi Akka has also asked me to tell you that she's expecting you. Do reply soon and let me know your travel plans.

Your loving friend,
Meena

Important vocabulary: *get married to* - marry ("married to", not "married with"); *take place* - happen (used for planned events); *muhurtham* - the auspicious time fixed for the wedding ceremony; *reception* - a party held to celebrate a wedding and welcome the guests; *venue* - the place where an event is held; *personally* - yourself, not only through a printed card; *pick (someone) up* - go and collect someone, usually in a vehicle.

Why this format is correct:

- An invitation to a friend is informal: short address, date, "Dear Janani," and no subject line or receiver's address.
- All the key facts - whose wedding, day, date, time and venue - are grouped in one paragraph, so the reader can plan her journey.
- The day, date and time are written in full ("Sunday, 6 December 2026"; "between 9.00 and 10.30 a.m.") so that there is no confusion.
- Personal touches (stay with us, a pick-up from the station, a visit to the Big Temple) are what a printed invitation card cannot give.
- It ends with a warm request for a reply, then "Your loving friend," and the first name.

10.4 Thank-You Letter to an Uncle Informal

Question: You are Karthik of 36, Race Course Road, Coimbatore - 641 018. Write a letter to your uncle thanking him for the English dictionary he sent you as a birthday gift. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: Karthik, a student | Receiver: his uncle | Relationship: nephew and uncle (an elder relative) | Purpose: to thank his uncle for the birthday gift and say how useful it is | Register: Informal

Correct format: Sender's address (short) → Date → "Dear Uncle," → Body (thanks for the gift; how you use it; family news; thanks again) → "Your loving nephew," → First name. No subject line and no receiver's address.

36, Race Course Road,
Coimbatore - 641 018

20 August 2026

Dear Uncle,

Thank you very much for the wonderful birthday gift. The English dictionary reached me on the morning of my birthday, and it was the best surprise of the day. I was also touched by the kind message you wrote on the first page.

It's exactly what I needed. As you know, I often find English spelling and pronunciation difficult. This dictionary gives the pronunciation of every word in phonetic symbols, along with its meanings, synonyms, antonyms and example sentences.

Every night, I learn ten new words and write a sentence with each of them in a notebook. I've also started to look up every new word I come across in the newspaper. My English teacher saw the dictionary last week and advised me to use it every day.

Amma and Appa send their regards to you and Auntie. We're all looking forward to your visit during the Deepavali holidays.

Thank you once again for such a thoughtful and useful gift. I'll treasure it always.

Your loving nephew,
Karthik

Important vocabulary: *thoughtful* - showing care for another person's needs;
pronunciation - the way a word is spoken (spelling: pronunciation, not "pronounciation");
phonetic symbols - signs that show how a word is pronounced; *synonym* / *antonym* - a word with the same / the opposite meaning; *look up* - search for a word in a dictionary; *come across* - find or meet by chance; *treasure* - keep something carefully because it is precious to you.

Why this format is correct:

- A letter to a relative is informal: short address, date, "Dear Uncle," and no subject line or receiver's address.
- A good thank-you letter names the gift and says HOW it is useful; this makes the thanks sincere, not a mere formality.
- "Your loving nephew," follows the family pattern "Your loving + relation" (son, daughter, nephew, niece); only the first name follows.
- Repeating the thanks in the last paragraph is a natural, polite way to end this type of letter.
- Grammar point: "Thank you for + noun or -ing form" - "Thank you for the wonderful gift", "Thank you for sending it" (never "Thank you for send ...").

10.5 Condolence Letter to a Friend Informal

Question: You are Divya of 10, Periyar Nagar, Erode - 638 001. Write a letter of condolence to your friend Harini, whose grandfather passed away last week. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: Divya | Receiver: her close friend Harini | Relationship: friends | Purpose: to express sympathy on the death of Harini's grandfather and offer comfort and help | Register: Informal (sensitive, dignified tone)

Correct format: Sender's address (short) → Date → "Dear Harini," → Body (sympathy; a warm memory of the grandfather; comfort and an offer of help; the family's sympathy) → "Your loving friend," → First name. No subject line and no receiver's address.

10, Periyar Nagar,
Erode - 638 001

16 September 2026

Dear Harini,

I was deeply saddened to hear that your grandfather passed away last week. Please accept my heartfelt condolences. You were very close to him, and I can only imagine how much you and your family must be missing him.

I have many happy memories of him. Whenever I visited your house, he welcomed me with a warm smile and told us stories from his years as a school headmaster. He always said that hard work is never wasted, and I still remember those words before every examination. He lived a full and meaningful life, and he was respected by everyone who knew him.

I know that no words can ease your grief at this time. Please take care of your health and stay strong for your grandmother, who needs your support now. I will come to see you next Sunday. Until then, if there is anything I can do, please do not hesitate to call me.

My parents join me in offering our deepest sympathy to you and your family.

Your loving friend,
Divya

Important vocabulary: *condolences* - words of sympathy when someone has died ("Please accept my heartfelt condolences"); *pass away* - die (a gentle, polite expression); *deeply saddened* - very sad; *heartfelt* - sincere, deeply felt; *grief* - deep sorrow, especially after a death; *ease* - make less painful; *hesitate* - pause before doing something because you are unsure; *sympathy* - sharing another person's sorrow.

Why this format is correct:

- It is a letter to a close friend, so the layout is informal: short address, date, "Dear Harini," and no subject line or receiver's address.
- The tone is dignified: no jokes, no exclamation marks, no news about yourself, and full forms (I will, do not) instead of contractions.
- A simple, safe order: sympathy first → a good memory of the person → comfort and a practical offer of help.
- Gentle expressions ("passed away", "Please accept my heartfelt condolences") are preferred to blunt ones.
- It is short and sincere; a condolence letter is not the place for long advice or philosophy.

10.6 Apology Letter to a Friend Informal

Question: You are Vignesh of 9, Bazaar Street, Salem - 636 001. Write a letter to your friend Gokul apologising for missing his birthday party. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: Vignesh | Receiver: his close friend Gokul | Relationship: friends | Purpose: to apologise for missing Gokul's birthday party, explain why and make amends | Register: Informal

Correct format: Sender's address (short) → Date → "Dear Gokul," → Body (apology; the honest reason; making amends; belated wishes) → "Your loving friend," → First name. No subject line and no receiver's address.

9, Bazaar Street,
Salem - 636 001

14 July 2026

Dear Gokul,

I'm really sorry that I missed your birthday party last Saturday. I know you were expecting me, and I feel very bad about letting you down.

Just as I was getting ready to leave that evening, my grandmother slipped in the bathroom and hurt her knee. Appa was away in Chennai, so I had to take her to the hospital. The doctor examined her and asked for an X-ray. Luckily, nothing was broken, but by the time we reached home, it was almost ten o'clock. In all the confusion, I forgot to call you, and my phone battery had run out too. I should have let you know, and I'm sorry that I didn't.

I've bought you a small gift: the book of detective stories that you've wanted for a long time. Let's meet for lunch next Sunday, and I'll give it to you then. It'll be my treat, and I promise to make up for missing your special day.

Please forgive me. Belated birthday wishes, and many happy returns!

Your loving friend,
Vignesh

Important vocabulary: *let (someone) down* - disappoint someone who was depending on you; *slip* - lose your balance on a smooth or wet surface; *run out* - be completely used up (battery, money, time); *should have + past participle* - shows regret about something not done in the past ("I should have let you know"); *make up for* - do something good to correct a mistake; *treat* - something special that you pay for to please someone ("It'll be my treat"); *belated* - coming late.

Why this format is correct:

- A letter to a friend is informal: short address, date, "Dear Gokul," and no subject line or receiver's address.
- Remember A-R-M for an apology: **A**pologise at once → give the **R**eason honestly → **M**ake amends (a gift, a plan to meet).
- The writer takes responsibility ("I should have let you know") instead of blaming others; this makes the apology sincere.
- One clear reason is enough; do not pile up excuses. Keep the focus on the friend's feelings ("I know you were expecting me").
- Belated wishes end the letter on a warm note before "Your loving friend," and the first name.

10.7 Advice Letter to a Younger Brother Informal

Question: You are Lakshmi of 18, Bharathi Street, Velachery, Chennai - 600 042. Your younger brother Kavin is in Class 12 and spends too much time on his mobile phone. Write a letter advising him on the wise use of the mobile phone in his board-exam year. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: Lakshmi, Kavin's elder sister | Receiver: her younger brother Kavin, a Class 12 student | Relationship: elder sister and younger brother | Purpose: to advise him to use his mobile phone wisely in his board-exam year | Register: Informal

Correct format: Sender's address (short) → Date → "My dear Kavin," → Body (reason for writing; a balanced view of the phone; practical advice; encouragement) → "Yours affectionately," → First name. No subject line and no receiver's address.

18, Bharathi Street,
Velachery,
Chennai - 600 042

2 November 2026

My dear Kavin,

I hope you're well and preparing seriously for your board examinations. Amma told me on the phone that you've been spending a lot of time on your mobile phone these days. That's why I'm writing to you.

Don't get me wrong. A mobile phone is a useful tool if you use it wisely. You can watch video lessons, look up difficult topics and download previous years' question papers. The problem begins when you open a game or social media "for just five minutes" and an hour disappears. Then the phone becomes a distraction. This is your board-exam year, and every hour counts.

Here's my advice. Keep your phone in the living room, not in your study room. Turn off notifications while you study. Limit entertainment to half an hour after dinner, and don't use the phone for an hour before bed, so that you can sleep well. You'll be surprised how much more you can finish in a day.

I'm not asking you to give up the phone. I'm only asking you to control it instead of letting it control you. I'm sure you'll make us all proud with your results. Take care of your health.

Yours affectionately,
Lakshmi

Important vocabulary: *Don't get me wrong* - do not misunderstand me; *wisely* - with good sense and judgement; *distraction* - something that takes your attention away from what you should be doing; *every hour counts* - every hour is important; *notifications* - alerts that a phone shows for new messages and updates; *limit* - keep within a fixed amount; *give up* - stop doing or using something completely.

Why this format is correct:

- A letter to a younger brother is informal: short address, date, "My dear Kavin," and no subject line or receiver's address.
- "Yours affectionately," suits an elder writing to a younger family member; the first name follows.

- The advice is balanced and practical: it accepts the phone's good uses and gives clear steps instead of only scolding.
- Short imperative sentences ("Keep your phone ...", "Turn off ...") make the advice easy to follow.
- It ends with encouragement and care, so the tone stays loving, not preachy.

10.8 Letter Describing a Visit Informal

Question: You are Suresh of 22, Gandhi Nagar, Vellore - 632 006. Write a letter to your friend Dinesh describing your visit to Mamallapuram (Mahabalipuram) during the Pongal holidays. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: Suresh | Receiver: his close friend Dinesh | Relationship: friends | Purpose: to describe a family trip to Mamallapuram and invite Dinesh to visit it | Register: Informal

Correct format: Sender's address (short) → Date → "Dear Dinesh," → Body (when and where; a little background; the places seen, in order; feelings; an invitation) → "Your loving friend," → First name. No subject line and no receiver's address.

22, Gandhi Nagar,
Vellore - 632 006

22 January 2026

Dear Dinesh,

I hope you had a wonderful Pongal. I spent the holidays with my family at Mamallapuram, and I must tell you all about it.

Mamallapuram, also called Mahabalipuram, is a small town on the coast, south of Chennai. It was an important seaport of the Pallava kings, who created most of its monuments in the seventh and eighth centuries. In 1984, UNESCO declared these monuments a World Heritage Site.

Our first stop was the Shore Temple. It stands right on the seashore, facing the Bay of Bengal, and we could hear the waves as we walked around it. Next, we saw Arjuna's Penance, a huge carving on two giant rocks, full of gods, people and animals. I loved the lifelike elephants most. Finally, we visited the Five Rathas. These temples are carved out of solid rock and are named after the Pandavas and Draupadi.

It was amazing to think that sculptors created all this over a thousand years ago without any modern machines. We ended the day with a long walk on the beach.

You must see Mamallapuram. Let's go there together during the summer holidays. I'd love to be your guide!

Your loving friend,
Suresh

Important vocabulary: *monument* - a building or structure of historical importance; *heritage* - valuable things handed down from the past; *UNESCO* - United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization; *sculptor* - an artist who makes figures by carving stone, wood or metal; *carved out of solid rock* - cut and shaped from the natural rock itself (rock-cut), not built from separate stones; *penance* - hard prayer and self-discipline for a spiritual purpose; *ratha* - chariot (the Five Rathas are also called the Pancha Rathas).

Why this format is correct:

- A letter to a friend is informal: short address, date, "Dear Dinesh," and no subject line or receiver's address.
- A descriptive letter follows a clear order: when and where → background → the places seen, one by one → feelings → an invitation.
- Sequence words ("Our first stop", "Next", "Finally") guide the reader from one place to the next.
- The facts are few and correct (Pallava kings, seventh and eighth centuries, UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1984); a letter is not a history essay, so the focus stays on what

the writer saw and felt.

- Tenses: the simple past for what happened on the trip ("we saw", "we visited"); the present tense for facts that are still true ("It stands right on the seashore", "These temples are carved ...").

10.9 Letter to a Former Teacher Requesting a Recommendation Letter for Postgraduate Admission

Semi-formal

Question: You are S. Anitha of 45, Kamarajar Street, Palayamkottai, Tirunelveli - 627 002.

You completed your B.Sc. in Chemistry this year. Write a letter to your former teacher, Dr. R. Sundaram, Associate Professor of Chemistry, Porunai Arts and Science College, Palayamkottai, Tirunelveli - 627 002, requesting a letter of recommendation for admission to an M.Sc. programme. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: S. Anitha, a recent B.Sc. graduate | Receiver: Dr. R. Sundaram, her former teacher and project guide | Relationship: former student and teacher (respectful but personal) | Purpose: to request a letter of recommendation for M.Sc. admission | Register: Semi-formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → Receiver's name and address → Subject → "Dear Dr. Sundaram," → Body (who you are; the request; details and deadline; thanks) → "Yours sincerely," → Full name.

45, Kamarajar Street,
Palayamkottai,
Tirunelveli - 627 002

15 June 2026

Dr. R. Sundaram,
Associate Professor of Chemistry,
Porunai Arts and Science College,
Palayamkottai,
Tirunelveli - 627 002

Subject: Request for a letter of recommendation

Dear Dr. Sundaram,

I hope you are keeping well. I am S. Anitha, and I completed my B.Sc. in Chemistry in your department this April. You taught me organic chemistry and guided my final-year project on the water quality of the Thamirabarani river.

I am applying for admission to the M.Sc. Chemistry programme at Coromandel University, Chennai, for the academic year 2026-2027. The university requires a letter of recommendation from a teacher who knows the applicant's academic work well. As you supervised my project, I would be grateful if you could write one for me.

The letter has to be sent directly to the university by email before 30 June 2026. If you agree, I will send you my mark statements, a copy of my project report and the university's recommendation form, so that you have all the details you need.

I know how busy you are, and I truly appreciate your time. Thank you for your guidance throughout my degree course. You can reach me at anitha@example.com.

Yours sincerely,
S. Anitha

Important vocabulary: *former* - earlier, previous ("my former teacher"); *letter of recommendation* - a letter in which a teacher or employer supports someone's application; *programme* - a course of study (British spelling; American "program"); *supervise* - guide and oversee someone's work; *grateful* - thankful; *mark statement* - an official record of a student's marks (also called a mark sheet); *appreciate* - value; be thankful for.

Why this format is correct:

- A letter to a former teacher is semi-formal - respectful but personal: it has the receiver's name and address and a subject line, but a warmer tone than an official letter.
- "Dear Dr. Sundaram," (title + name) pairs with "Yours sincerely," and the full name. If you begin with "Respected Sir," close with "Yours faithfully," - never mix the pairs.
- The first paragraph reminds the teacher who the writer is (degree, subject, project), because a teacher may have taught hundreds of students.
- The request is specific: what (a recommendation letter), for what (M.Sc. admission), how (by email) and by when (30 June 2026).
- No contractions: semi-formal letters use full forms (I am, I would).

10.10 Letter to the Landlord Requesting Repair of a Leaking Roof and a Broken Water Tap

Semi-formal

Question: You are R. Senthil, a tenant at 12/4, Nehru Street, Thillai Nagar, Tiruchirappalli - 620 018. Write a letter to your landlord, Mr. K. Ramasamy, 8, North Chitrai Street, Srirangam, Tiruchirappalli - 620 006, requesting him to repair the leaking roof and the broken water tap in your house. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: R. Senthil, a tenant | Receiver: Mr. K. Ramasamy, the owner of the house | Relationship: tenant and landlord (known to each other; a practical matter) | Purpose: to request urgent repair of a leaking roof and a broken water tap | Register: Semi-formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → Receiver's name and address → Subject → "Dear Mr. Ramasamy," → Body (purpose; problem 1: the roof; problem 2: the tap; the action requested; thanks) → "Yours sincerely," → Full name.

12/4, Nehru Street,
Thillai Nagar,
Tiruchirappalli - 620 018

4 November 2026

Mr. K. Ramasamy,
8, North Chitrai Street,
Srirangam,
Tiruchirappalli - 620 006

Subject: Repair of the leaking roof and the broken water tap

Dear Mr. Ramasamy,

I am writing to request two urgent repairs in your house at the above address, where I have been living as a tenant since June 2024.

Since the monsoon rains began last week, water has been leaking through the roof of the bedroom. There is a wide crack in the ceiling near the fan, and the wall below it has become damp. We have to keep buckets on the floor whenever it rains, and I am worried that the water may reach the electrical wiring.

In addition, the tap in the kitchen is broken. It does not close fully, and water keeps dripping day and night. As a result, the overhead tank empties quickly and a lot of water is wasted.

I would be grateful if you could arrange for a mason and a plumber to attend to these problems within the next few days, before the heavy rains of the coming weeks. I will be at home after 6.00 p.m. on weekdays and all day on Saturdays and Sundays to let them in.

Thank you for your understanding. I look forward to an early reply.

Yours sincerely,
R. Senthil

Important vocabulary: *tenant* - a person who pays rent to live in a house; *landlord* - a person who rents out a house (a woman owner: *landlady*); *leak* - (of water) come in

through a hole or crack; *damp* - slightly wet; *drip* - fall in drops; *mason / plumber* - a worker who builds with bricks, stone and cement / a worker who fits and repairs water pipes and taps; *attend to* - deal with, take care of.

Why this format is correct:

- Tenant and landlord know each other, but the matter is practical, so the letter is semi-formal: receiver's name and address, a subject line, "Dear Mr. Ramasamy," and "Yours sincerely," with the full name.
- The subject line shows the purpose at a glance; it is a short noun phrase with no full stop.
- Each problem gets its own paragraph with facts (where, since when, what damage) and a reason for urgency (monsoon, wiring, wasted water).
- The request is polite but clear: who is needed (a mason and a plumber), how soon (within a few days) and when the house is open to them.
- "I would be grateful if you could ..." is firm yet courteous - far better than "You must repair ...".

10.11 Letter to a Neighbour Politely Requesting That Loud Music Be Lowered during Exam Days Semi-formal

Question: You are K. Priya of 15, Anna Street, Dindigul - 624 001. Your neighbour, Mr. S. Rajan of 17, Anna Street, Dindigul - 624 001, plays loud music in the evenings. Write a letter politely requesting him to lower the volume during your examination days. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: K. Priya, a B.Com. student | Receiver: Mr. S. Rajan, her neighbour | Relationship: neighbours (known to each other, but not close) | Purpose: to request politely that the music be kept low during her examinations | Register: Semi-formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → Receiver's name and address → (Subject - optional, left out here) → "Dear Mr. Rajan," → Body (polite opening; the problem; a limited request; thanks and goodwill) → "Yours sincerely," → Full name.

15, Anna Street,
Dindigul - 624 001

10 November 2026

Mr. S. Rajan,
17, Anna Street,
Dindigul - 624 001

Dear Mr. Rajan,

I hope you and your family are well. I am writing to make a small request, and I hope you will not mind.

My B.Com. university examinations begin on 17 November and continue until 4 December. These are my final-year examinations, so they are very important to me. These days, I study every evening until about 11.00 p.m. Recently, the music from your house has been quite loud in the evenings, and I find it difficult to concentrate, especially when I am solving problems in accountancy.

I know that your family enjoys music, and I have no wish to spoil your evenings. However, I would be very grateful if you could keep the volume low after 8.00 p.m. until my examinations are over on 4 December. It would be a great help to me.

Thank you for your understanding and cooperation. My parents send their regards, and we would be happy to see you at our house whenever you are free.

Yours sincerely,
K. Priya

Important vocabulary: *I hope you will not mind* - a polite way to introduce a request; *concentrate* - give your full attention to something; *accountancy* - the subject of keeping

and checking financial accounts; *spoil* - make something less enjoyable; *volume* - the loudness of a sound; *cooperation* - willingness to help (also spelt co-operation); *regards* - good wishes ("My parents send their regards").

Why this format is correct:

- Neighbours who know each other but are not close write semi-formally: receiver's name and address, "Dear Mr. Rajan," and "Yours sincerely," with the full name.
- The subject line is optional in semi-formal letters. It is left out here to keep the tone neighbourly; "Subject: Request to lower the music volume during my examinations" would also be correct.
- The request is limited and reasonable - a fixed time (after 8.00 p.m.) and a fixed period (until 4 December) - so it is easy to accept.
- There are no blame words such as "nuisance" or "noise pollution"; polite forms ("I hope you will not mind", "I would be very grateful if you could ...") keep good relations.
- The friendly close (thanks, regards and an invitation to visit) protects the relationship for the future.

10.12 Complaint to the Municipal Commissioner

- Garbage and Blocked Drains Formal

Question: You are R. Karthik of 15, Bharathi Street, Ganapathy, Coimbatore - 641 006. Garbage has not been collected regularly in your street for three weeks, and the drains are blocked. Write a letter to the Commissioner, Coimbatore City Municipal Corporation, complaining about the problem and requesting immediate action. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: R. Karthik, a resident of the street | Receiver: The Commissioner, Coimbatore City Municipal Corporation | Relationship: citizen to a public official not known personally | Purpose: to complain and request action | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + receiver's designation and address → Subject → Dear Sir/Madam, → Opening (the complaint in brief) → Main paragraph (facts, effects, earlier complaint) → Closing (action requested) → Yours faithfully, → Name → Encl.

15, Bharathi Street,
Ganapathy,
Coimbatore - 641 006

5 October 2026

To
The Commissioner,
Coimbatore City Municipal Corporation,
Coimbatore - 641 001

Subject: Complaint regarding irregular garbage collection and blocked drains in Bharathi Street, Ganapathy

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am a resident of Bharathi Street, Ganapathy, and I wish to bring to your notice the poor sanitary condition of our street. For the past three weeks, garbage has not been collected regularly, and the drains have remained blocked for more than ten days.

Earlier, the conservancy workers collected waste from every house daily, but now they come only once or twice a week. The bins at the street corner overflow, and stray dogs scatter the rubbish across the road. As the drains are choked with plastic waste, dirty water stagnates in front of our houses and gives off a foul smell. Mosquitoes are breeding rapidly, and several residents, including children and elderly people, have fallen ill with fever. We reported the matter in writing to the Sanitary Inspector of our ward on 25 September 2026, but no action has been taken so far.

I therefore request you to direct the officials concerned to restore daily garbage collection, desilt the drains and spray disinfectant in the area at the earliest. Photographs of the present condition are enclosed. As the situation is a threat to public health, I hope you will treat this complaint as urgent.

Yours faithfully,
R. Karthik

Encl.: 1. Photographs of the blocked drains and overflowing bins
2. Copy of our complaint to the Sanitary Inspector dated 25 September 2026

Important vocabulary: *bring to your notice* - formally inform an official about something; *sanitary* - connected with cleanliness and public health; *conservancy workers* - workers who collect garbage and clean streets and drains (Indian usage); *stagnate* - (of water) stop flowing and become foul; *desilt* - remove the mud and waste that has settled in a drain or channel; *disinfectant* - a chemical that kills germs; *officials concerned* - the officers responsible for the matter; *at the earliest* - as soon as possible.

Why this format is correct:

- The letter is addressed by designation ("The Commissioner"), not by name: the Commissioner is the administrative head of the corporation, and the complaint concerns a public service.
- The subject line names both problems and the exact street, so the office can send the letter to the right section at once. It is a short noun phrase with no full stop.
- The body gives checkable facts - how long (three weeks, ten days), the effects (mosquitoes, fever) and the date of the earlier complaint. Facts make a complaint credible; angry words do not.
- The closing paragraph states exactly what is wanted: daily collection, desilting and disinfection. A complaint that asks for no remedy is incomplete.
- "Dear Sir/Madam," is used because the officer's gender is not known, and it pairs with "Yours faithfully,". The numbered Encl. line lists the evidence sent with the letter.

10.13 Letter to the District Collector - Bus Service and Safe Drinking Water

Formal

Question: You are S. Meena of 4/112, Main Road, Pasumaipatti Village, Omalur Taluk, Salem District - 636 455. Your village has no bus service and no safe drinking water. Write a letter to the District Collector, Salem, requesting a bus service and safe drinking water for the village. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: S. Meena, on behalf of the villagers | Receiver: The District Collector, Salem | Relationship: citizen to the head of the district administration | Purpose: to request two basic public facilities | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + receiver's designation and address → Subject (both requests) → Dear Sir/Madam, → Opening (who is writing and why) → Main paragraph 1 (bus service) → Main paragraph 2 (drinking water) → Closing (specific requests) → Yours faithfully, → Name → Encl. → Copy to

4/112, Main Road,
Pasumaipatti Village,
Omalur Taluk,
Salem District - 636 455

7 October 2026

To
The District Collector,
Salem District,
Salem - 636 001

Subject: Request for a bus service and safe drinking water for Pasumaipatti Village, Omalur Taluk

Dear Sir/Madam,

On behalf of the residents of Pasumaipatti Village, I wish to bring to your kind attention two serious problems faced by our village: the absence of a bus service and the lack of safe drinking water.

No bus comes to our village. The nearest bus stop is five kilometres away on the main road. Students, daily-wage workers, patients and elderly people have to walk this distance or pay high fares for private vehicles. Students often reach school late, and in an emergency it is very difficult to take a patient to hospital in time.

The village also lacks safe drinking water. The overhead tank has not been cleaned for months, and the water supplied through the public taps is muddy and smells bad. The hand pump near the school has been out of order since August. Women walk nearly two kilometres to fetch water, and several children have suffered from diarrhoea.

I therefore request you to direct the authorities concerned to introduce a bus service to our village, at least in the morning and evening, and to have the overhead tank cleaned, the water tested and the hand pump repaired, so that we receive a regular supply of safe drinking water. A petition signed by the residents is enclosed. We shall be grateful for your early action.

Yours faithfully,
S. Meena

Encl.: Petition signed by 212 residents of Pasumaipatti Village
Copy to: The Block Development Officer, Omalur Panchayat Union, Salem District

Important vocabulary: *on behalf of* - as the representative of; *bring to your kind attention* - politely inform; *daily-wage workers* - labourers who are paid for each day's work; *overhead tank* - a raised water tank that supplies water by gravity; *out of order* - not working; *diarrhoea* - an illness often caused by unsafe water (British spelling); *petition* - a formal written request, usually signed by many people; *Copy to* - names the other persons who receive a copy of the letter.

Why this format is correct:

- The District Collector heads the district administration and can direct the departments concerned, so a single letter to the Collector can raise both problems.
- The two related requests are handled in two separate main paragraphs, and both are named in the subject line, so the reader sees the structure at a glance.
- "On behalf of the residents" and the enclosed petition show that this is a community request, not a private one, which gives it more weight.
- "Copy to" keeps the Block Development Officer, the officer nearer the village, informed. Encl. and Copy to come after the name, in that order (see Section 7).
- The closing lists concrete actions, and the letter uses the standard pair "Dear Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully,".

10.14 Letter to the Inspector of Police - Loss of a Mobile Phone Formal

Question: You are P. Lakshmi of 18, Kamaraj Street, Palayamkottai, Tirunelveli - 627 002.

You lost your mobile phone near the Palayamkottai bus stand. Write a letter to the Inspector of Police, Palayamkottai Police Station, reporting the loss and requesting that your complaint be registered and an acknowledgement issued. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: P. Lakshmi, owner of the phone | Receiver: The Inspector of Police, Palayamkottai Police Station | Relationship: citizen to a police officer not known personally | Purpose: to report a loss and have the complaint registered and acknowledged | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + receiver's designation and police station → Subject → Dear Sir/Madam, → Opening (what was lost, when, where) → Main paragraphs (how it happened, details of the phone, steps already taken) → Closing (register the complaint, issue an acknowledgement) → Yours faithfully, → Name → Encl.

18, Kamaraj Street,
Palayamkottai,
Tirunelveli - 627 002

14 October 2026

To
The Inspector of Police,

Palayamkottai Police Station,
Tirunelveli - 627 002

Subject: Loss of my mobile phone near Palayamkottai bus stand - request to register complaint

Dear Sir/Madam,

I wish to report that I lost my mobile phone near the Palayamkottai bus stand on 13 October 2026, between 6.00 p.m. and 6.30 p.m., and I request you to register my complaint.

I had boarded a crowded town bus to return home. When I got down at the Kamaraj Street stop, I found that the phone was missing from my handbag. I searched the bus stand and called my number from a friend's phone, but the phone has remained switched off since then. The details of the phone are given below:

Description: black smartphone with a blue back cover

IMEI numbers: 35XXXXXXXXX4821 and 35XXXXXXXXX4839

Mobile number: 98XXXXXX21

Date of purchase: 10 March 2025

I have already asked my mobile service provider to block the SIM card, and I have changed the passwords of my email and banking apps.

I request you to register my complaint and issue me an acknowledgement, which I may need for my records and while dealing with my service provider. Please let me know if the phone is traced.

Yours faithfully,
P. Lakshmi

Encl.: 1. Photocopy of the purchase bill of the phone
2. Photocopy of my Aadhaar card

Important vocabulary: *IMEI* (*International Mobile Equipment Identity*) - a unique 15-digit number that identifies a mobile phone; a dual-SIM phone has two; *register a complaint* - record a complaint officially; *acknowledgement* - written proof that a letter or complaint has been received; *block a SIM card* - stop a SIM card from being used; *traced* - found after a search; *service provider* - the company that provides a mobile or internet connection; *photocopy* - a paper copy of a document; *lost / stolen* - write "stolen" only when you are sure that someone took the item.

Why this format is correct:

- The opening gives the three key facts at once - what was lost, when and where - together with the request.
- The identification details are set out one per line so that they are easy to read and copy. In a real complaint, write the full numbers; the IMEI is printed on the phone's box and often on the purchase bill.
- The letter asks only for what the writer needs - registration of the complaint and an acknowledgement. It does not tell the police how to act, and it does not guess who took the phone.
- Safety: never write a PIN, password or OTP in any letter, and mask long numbers in model answers, as done here.
- "Dear Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully," is correct because the officer is addressed by designation and is not known personally. The Encl. line lists the proof of ownership and identity.

10.15 Letter to the Editor - Traffic Congestion near Schools

Formal

Question: Write a letter to the Editor of a newspaper published from Tiruchirappalli, drawing the attention of the authorities to the traffic congestion near schools in the city during school hours. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: a resident of Tiruchirappalli (no name or address is given, so the exam identity rule applies) | Receiver: The Editor of a newspaper | Relationship: reader to editor;

the real audience is the public and the authorities | Purpose: to have the letter published and prompt the authorities to act | Register: Formal

Correct format: "Examination Hall" (in place of the sender's address) → Date → To + The Editor, name of the newspaper, city → Subject → Sir, → Opening (the issue + request to publish) → Main paragraph (the problem and its effects) → Closing (suggestions + hope for action) → Yours faithfully, → ABC

Examination Hall

9 October 2026

To
The Editor,
The Hindu,
Tiruchirappalli

Subject: Traffic congestion near schools in Tiruchirappalli

Sir,

Through the columns of your widely read newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities concerned to the heavy traffic congestion near schools in Tiruchirappalli during school hours. I request you to publish this letter.

Every morning and evening, the roads near many schools in the city are choked with school vans, autorickshaws, two-wheelers and cars. Parents park their vehicles on both sides of narrow roads, and vans stop in the middle of the road to pick up and drop children. Buses and even ambulances are held up for long periods. Worst of all, small children have to walk between moving vehicles. Near many schools there are no traffic police personnel, zebra crossings or warning signboards.

I suggest that the traffic police deploy personnel near schools during peak hours, that separate pick-up and drop points be marked, and that parking be prohibited close to school gates. Schools can also stagger their closing times and encourage students to use school buses. I hope the authorities concerned will act before a serious accident takes place.

Yours faithfully,
ABC

Important vocabulary: *through the columns of* - by means of the pages of a newspaper; *widely read* - read by a large number of people; *draw the attention of* - make someone notice a problem; *congestion* - overcrowding of vehicles that slows down traffic; *peak hours* - the busiest hours of the day; *deploy* - send people to a place for a particular task; *stagger (timings)* - arrange times so that they do not all fall together; *zebra crossing* - a striped road crossing for pedestrians.

Why this format is correct:

- The question gives no name or address, so the exam identity rule applies: "Examination Hall" as the address and "ABC" as the signature. Never write your real name in an exam answer.
- A letter to the Editor has two audiences: the Editor, who is asked to publish it (first paragraph), and the public and the authorities, who are the real target (the rest of the letter).
- The newspaper is given by name and city only, never a street address. When the question does not name a newspaper, choose a well-known one.
- The tone is public-spirited: the problem, its effects and practical suggestions, with no blame on any school or person.
- "Sir," is the traditional salutation for an Editor ("Dear Sir/Madam," is equally correct); both pair with "Yours faithfully,". "Yours truly," is also seen in letters to the Editor, but model letters use "Yours faithfully,".

10.16 Leave Letter - Sick Leave with Medical Certificate Formal

Question: You are K. Arun of 7, Nehru Street, Erode - 638 001, a Clerk at the Erode Main Branch of Southern Commercial Bank. You have viral fever, and your doctor has advised five days' rest. Write a letter to your Branch Manager requesting sick leave and enclosing a medical certificate. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: K. Arun, Clerk | Receiver: The Branch Manager, his immediate superior | Relationship: employee to superior | Purpose: to request sick leave for a fixed period | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address (home) → Date → To + The Branch Manager, bank, branch, address → Subject (with the leave dates) → Respected Sir, → Opening (leave requested, dates, reason) → Main paragraph (illness, doctor's advice, arrangement for pending work) → Closing (rejoining, fitness certificate, contact, request to sanction) → Yours faithfully, → Name + designation → Encl.

7, Nehru Street,
Erode - 638 001

12 October 2026

To
The Branch Manager,
Southern Commercial Bank,
Erode Main Branch,
Erode - 638 001

Subject: Request for sick leave from 12 October to 16 October 2026

Respected Sir,

I request you to grant me sick leave for five days, from 12 October to 16 October 2026 (both days inclusive), as I am suffering from viral fever and am unable to attend the branch.

I developed a high fever and severe body pain on the night of 10 October 2026. The next morning I consulted Dr. P. Ramesh, M.B.B.S., who diagnosed viral fever, prescribed medicines and advised me to take complete rest for five days. His medical certificate is enclosed. I have informed my colleague, Ms. R. Kavya, about the pending work at my counter, including two customer requests that must be completed this week, so that customers are not inconvenienced in my absence. All the registers under my charge are up to date.

I shall rejoin duty immediately after the leave period and submit a fitness certificate at that time. If any information about my work is needed during my leave, I can be contacted on my mobile phone. I request you to sanction the leave. I regret the inconvenience caused.

Yours faithfully,
K. Arun
Clerk, Employee No. 4521

Encl.: Medical certificate issued by Dr. P. Ramesh, M.B.B.S.

Important vocabulary: *sick leave* - leave granted to an employee who is ill (also called medical leave); *both days inclusive* - counting both the first and the last day; *diagnose* - identify an illness after examination; *medical certificate* - a doctor's written statement of an illness and the rest advised; *fitness certificate* - a doctor's statement that a person is fit to resume work; *rejoin duty* - return to work after leave; *up to date* - complete, with all the latest entries made; *sanction* - officially approve (the noun can also mean a penalty, as in "economic sanctions").

Why this format is correct:

- The sender's address is the home address because the employee is writing from home; his designation and employee number go below the name so that the office can identify him.

- The exact dates appear in the subject line and again in the opening with "both days inclusive", so there is no doubt about the number of days requested.
- The body gives the reason briefly and shows responsibility: the doctor's advice, the certificate and the arrangement made for pending work.
- "Respected Sir," is accepted Indian usage for a superior ("Respected Madam," for a woman manager; "Dear Sir," is also correct), and it pairs with "Yours faithfully,".
- The Encl. line records the medical certificate - the document that supports the request.

10.17 Job Application - Office Assistant in a Cooperative Bank

Formal

Question: You are G. Vignesh of 26, Anna Street, S.S. Colony, Madurai - 625 016. You hold a B.Com. degree and a certificate in computer applications, and you have one year's experience as an accounts assistant. Thendral Cooperative Urban Bank Ltd., Madurai, has advertised the post of Office Assistant in The Hindu dated 5 October 2026. Write a letter of application for the post. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: G. Vignesh, a job seeker | Receiver: The General Manager, Thendral Cooperative Urban Bank Ltd. (a fictional bank) | Relationship: applicant to a prospective employer | Purpose: to apply for an advertised post and obtain an interview | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + receiver's designation and address → Subject (post applied for) → Reference (the advertisement) → Dear Sir/Madam, → Opening (post + where it was advertised) → Main paragraphs (qualifications, experience) → Closing (enclosures, interview, thanks) → Yours faithfully, → Name + mobile + email → Encl. (numbered)

26, Anna Street,
S.S. Colony,
Madurai - 625 016

10 October 2026

To
The General Manager,
Thendral Cooperative Urban Bank Ltd.,
Head Office,
Madurai - 625 001

Subject: Application for the post of Office Assistant

Reference: Your advertisement in The Hindu dated 5 October 2026

Dear Sir/Madam,

In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated 5 October 2026, I wish to apply for the post of Office Assistant in your bank. I believe that my qualifications and experience meet your requirements.

I completed my B.Com. degree in first class in 2025. I have also completed a six-month Certificate Course in Computer Applications and can work confidently with word processing, spreadsheets and accounting software. I can type accurately in both English and Tamil.

For the past year I have been working as an Accounts Assistant at Sri Murugan Stationers, Madurai. My duties include maintaining the cash book, preparing vouchers, depositing cash in the bank and attending to customers. This work has taught me accuracy, punctuality and courtesy, which are essential in a bank.

My resume and copies of my certificates are enclosed. I shall be glad to attend an interview at your convenience. If selected, I shall perform my duties sincerely and to the best of my ability. Thank you for considering my application.

Yours faithfully,
G. Vignesh
Mobile: 98XXXXXX45
Email: vignesh@example.com

- Encl.: 1. Resume
2. Copy of B.Com. degree certificate
3. Copy of the certificate in computer applications
4. Experience certificate from Sri Murugan Stationers
5. Two passport-size photographs

Important vocabulary: *in response to* - as a reply to; *post* - a job or position in an organisation; *resume* - a short summary of a person's education, skills and experience (also called bio-data or curriculum vitae, CV); *vouchers* - documents that support payment or receipt entries in accounts; *experience certificate* - a letter from an employer confirming the period and nature of a person's work; *at your convenience* - at a time that suits you; *prospective employer* - an organisation that may employ you; *covering letter* - a letter sent with a resume or other documents, explaining what is sent and why (also called a cover letter).

Why this format is correct:

- The subject line names the post, and the Reference line gives the source and date of the advertisement - an organisation may be filling several posts at one time.
- Qualifications and experience are stated briefly, one paragraph each; the full details are left to the enclosed resume. Do not copy the whole resume into the letter.
- Every enclosure is numbered, so the recruiter can check that nothing is missing. Send copies of certificates, not the originals.
- The mobile number and email address are written below the name, so the bank can contact the candidate quickly.
- The tone is confident and polite, with no pleading ("I am badly in need of this job") and no exaggeration. The pair used is "Dear Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully,".

10.18 Permission Letter - Blood Donation Camp Formal

Question: You are V. Divya, Secretary, Udhayam Youth Welfare Association, 14, Gandhiji Road, Thanjavur - 613 001. Your association plans to conduct a blood donation camp on Sunday, 25 October 2026. Write a letter to the Headmaster, Bharathi Vidyalaya Higher Secondary School, Medical College Road, Thanjavur - 613 004, seeking permission to use the school ground for the camp. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: V. Divya, an office-bearer writing for her association | Receiver: The Headmaster of a school | Relationship: an outside organisation to the head of an institution | Purpose: to obtain permission to use the school ground for one day | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address (the association) → Date → To + receiver's designation and address → Subject (purpose, place, date) → Dear Sir, → Opening (permission sought: what, where, when) → Main paragraph (organisers, medical team, space needed) → Closing (assurances, enclosure, request for an early reply) → Yours faithfully, → Name + designation → Encl.

Udhayam Youth Welfare Association,
14, Gandhiji Road,
Thanjavur - 613 001

5 October 2026

To
The Headmaster,
Bharathi Vidyalaya Higher Secondary School,
Medical College Road,
Thanjavur - 613 004

Subject: Request for permission to conduct a blood donation camp on the school ground on Sunday, 25 October 2026

Dear Sir,

On behalf of the Udhayam Youth Welfare Association, I request your permission to conduct a voluntary blood donation

camp on your school ground on Sunday, 25 October 2026, from 8.00 a.m. to 2.00 p.m.

Our association has been engaged in social service in Thanjavur for the past six years. The camp will be conducted with the Blood Bank of Thanjavur Medical College Hospital, whose team of doctors and nurses will examine the donors and collect the blood. We expect about 150 donors. Your ground is spacious, easy to reach and close to the hospital, which makes it the most suitable venue. We shall need the ground for a shamiana and registration counters, and two ground-floor classrooms for the medical team. As the camp will be held on a Sunday, school work will not be disturbed.

We assure you that we shall bear all the expenses, arrange drinking water and refreshments for the donors, and ensure that no school property is damaged. Our volunteers will manage the crowd and parking, and the ground will be cleaned and handed back by 4.00 p.m. A copy of the consent letter from the blood bank is enclosed. We request you to grant permission at the earliest so that we can inform the donors in time.

Yours faithfully,
V. Divya
Secretary, Udhayam Youth Welfare Association

Encl.: Copy of the consent letter from the Blood Bank, Thanjavur Medical College Hospital

Important vocabulary: *permission* - official consent to do something; *voluntary* - done willingly and without payment; *venue* - the place where an event is held; *shamiana* - a large tent or canopy put up for functions (Indian English; a similar temporary structure is called a pandal); *refreshments* - light food and drinks; *consent letter* - a letter agreeing to something or to take part in it; *bear the expenses* - pay the costs; *office-bearer* - an elected official of an association, such as the President, Secretary or Treasurer.

Why this format is correct:

- A permission letter must answer what (a blood donation camp), where (the ground and two classrooms), when (date and exact hours), who (the association and the medical team) and why this venue. The subject line carries the purpose, place and date.
- Assurances about expenses, cleanliness, safety of property and a fixed time for handing back remove the Headmaster's likely objections; mentioning that classes will not be disturbed helps too.
- The letter is written for an organisation, so the association's address is at the top and the writer's designation appears below her name.
- The enclosed consent letter from the blood bank shows that the camp is genuine and medically supervised.
- "Dear Sir," suits the designation "Headmaster" ("Dear Madam," for a Headmistress) and pairs with "Yours faithfully,".

10.19 Inquiry Letter - Details of a Diploma Course Formal

Question: You are N. Priya of 3, Thiruvalluvar Street, Katpadi, Vellore - 632 007. You have completed Class 12. Write a letter to the Registrar, Thamarai College of Arts and Science, Vellore - 632 001, asking for details of its Diploma in Computer Applications - eligibility, fees, duration and admission dates. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: N. Priya, a prospective student | Receiver: The Registrar of a college (fictional) | Relationship: member of the public to an institution | Purpose: to obtain information about a course | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + receiver's designation and address → Subject → Dear Sir/Madam, → Opening (who you are, which course) → Main paragraph (numbered questions) → Closing (prospectus, how to reply, thanks) → Yours faithfully, → Name → Encl.

3, Thiruvalluvar Street,
Katpadi,
Vellore - 632 007

8 October 2026

To

The Registrar,
Thamarai College of Arts and Science,
Vellore - 632 001

Subject: Inquiry about the Diploma in Computer Applications course

Dear Sir/Madam,

I have completed my Higher Secondary (Class 12) course in the Commerce group, and I wish to join the Diploma in Computer Applications offered by your college. I request you to send me full details of the course.

I would be grateful if you could let me know the following:

1. the eligibility conditions for admission, including the minimum marks required, if any;
2. the duration of the course and the class timings;
3. the total fee, the mode of payment and whether the fee can be paid in instalments;
4. the dates for the issue and submission of application forms, and the date on which classes will begin.

I would also like to know whether the college offers placement support to students who complete the course. Kindly send me a copy of the prospectus and an application form. A self-addressed stamped envelope is enclosed for your reply; you may also reply by email to priya@example.com. Thank you for your time.

Yours faithfully,
N. Priya

Encl.: Self-addressed stamped envelope

Important vocabulary: *inquiry / enquiry* - a request for information; both spellings are accepted (British tradition: enquiry = asking for information, inquiry = formal investigation); *eligibility* - the conditions a candidate must satisfy to be admitted; *duration* - the length of time a course lasts; *instalment* - one of the parts in which a sum of money is paid over a period (British spelling; American "installment"); *mode of payment* - the way a payment is made, such as cash, demand draft or online transfer; *prospectus* - a booklet giving details of an institution's courses, fees and rules; *self-addressed stamped envelope* - an envelope carrying your own address and a postage stamp, sent so that the receiver can reply easily; *placement* - help given to students to find jobs.

Why this format is correct:

- An inquiry letter asks; it does not complain or demand. The opening says who is writing and what information is needed.
- The questions are numbered, which makes the reply easy and ensures that none of the four points (eligibility, fees, duration, admission dates) is missed.
- The closing tells the college how to reply: the enclosed self-addressed stamped envelope (traditional) and an email address (modern).
- The letter is addressed to "The Registrar" by designation. If an institution has no Registrar, address the Principal or the Admission Officer.
- Polite forms such as "I would be grateful if you could ..." and "Kindly send ..." suit a request to an institution, with the pair "Dear Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully,".

10.20 Letter to a Government Authority - Power Cuts and Low Voltage Formal

Question: You are A. Anitha of 27, Lakshmi Street, Velachery, Chennai - 600 042. For the past month your street has been facing frequent power cuts and low voltage. Write a letter to the Assistant Engineer of the local electricity distribution office, requesting immediate action. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: A. Anitha, an electricity consumer | Receiver: The Assistant Engineer, Electricity Distribution Section Office | Relationship: consumer to the officer in charge of local supply | Purpose: to complain and request a lasting solution | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + receiver's designation and office address → Subject → Reference (earlier complaints) → Dear Sir/Madam, → Opening (the problem + service connection number) → Main paragraph (frequency, timing, effects, likely cause) → Closing (specific action requested) → Yours faithfully, → Name

27, Lakshmi Street,
Velachery,
Chennai - 600 042

15 October 2026

To
The Assistant Engineer,
Electricity Distribution Section Office,
Velachery,
Chennai - 600 042

Subject: Frequent power cuts and low voltage in Lakshmi Street, Velachery

Reference: Complaint Nos. 2716 and 2983 registered on 18 and 25 September 2026

Dear Sir/Madam,

I wish to bring to your notice the frequent power cuts and low voltage that the residents of Lakshmi Street, Velachery, have been facing for the past month. My service connection number is XXXXXXXX452.

Power fails four or five times a day, and each cut lasts from half an hour to two hours, often late at night. No advance notice is given. In the evenings, between 6.00 p.m. and 10.00 p.m., the voltage drops so low that lights become dim, fans run slowly and water pumps do not start. Sudden voltage fluctuations have damaged the refrigerators and television sets of some households. Students preparing for examinations and elderly and sick residents are the worst affected. The transformer serving our street appears to be overloaded, as many new houses and flats have been built here recently. The complaints mentioned above brought only temporary relief.

I therefore request you to inspect the transformer and the overhead lines in our street, take steps to increase the supply capacity, and give advance notice of any planned shutdown for maintenance. I hope you will take early action to restore a regular power supply at the proper voltage.

Yours faithfully,
A. Anitha

Important vocabulary: *power cut* - an interruption in the electricity supply (also called a power outage); *load shedding* - planned power cuts made when the demand for electricity is higher than the supply; *low voltage* - supply below the normal level, so that lights are dim and appliances do not work properly; *voltage fluctuation* - frequent rise and fall in voltage; *transformer* - equipment that changes the voltage of electricity; a distribution transformer lowers it for supply to homes; *overloaded* - carrying more load than its capacity; *shutdown* - a planned stopping of supply for repair or maintenance work; *service connection number* - the number that identifies a consumer's electricity connection (also called consumer number).

Why this format is correct:

- The Assistant Engineer is in charge of the local distribution office, so a street-level problem goes to this officer first; if it is not solved, the writer can then approach higher officers.
- The Reference line quotes the earlier complaint numbers. This proves that the problem is continuing and lets the office trace its own records.
- The service connection number identifies the writer's supply, and the facts (how often, how long, at what time, what damage) help the engineer find the cause.
- The request is specific and practical - inspection, more capacity, advance notice of shutdowns - not a vague "please do something".
- The register stays formal, with no exclamation marks or angry words, even though the writer is inconvenienced; the pair is "Dear Sir/Madam," + "Yours faithfully,".

10.21 Transfer Request through Proper Channel - Medical Grounds of a Parent Formal

Question: You are M. Suresh, Assistant, Office of the Deputy Director of Health Services, Ramanathapuram - 623 501. Your widowed mother, aged 78, lives alone in Madurai and needs constant care. Write a letter to the Director of Public Health and Preventive Medicine, Chennai - 600 006, through proper channel, requesting a transfer to Madurai on medical grounds. (about 150-200 words)

Situation: Writer: M. Suresh, a government employee | Receiver: the Head of Department (the Director), through the immediate superior (the Deputy Director) | Relationship: employee to a senior officer | Purpose: to request a transfer on the medical grounds of an aged parent | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address (office) → Date → To + Head of Department's designation and address → Through: immediate superior → Subject → Respected Sir, → Opening (present post + request) → Main paragraph (the parent's condition, why the transfer is needed) → Closing (place requested + polite request) → Yours faithfully, → Name + designation → Encl.

Office of the Deputy Director of Health Services,
Ramanathapuram - 623 501

22 October 2026

To
The Director of Public Health and Preventive Medicine,
Chennai - 600 006

Through: The Deputy Director of Health Services, Ramanathapuram

Subject: Request for transfer to Madurai on medical grounds of my aged mother

Respected Sir,

I have been working as an Assistant in the Office of the Deputy Director of Health Services, Ramanathapuram, since June 2019. I request you to transfer me to Madurai on the medical grounds of my aged mother.

My mother, Tmt. M. Kamala, is a 78-year-old widow living alone in Madurai. She suffers from heart disease and diabetes, and her doctor has advised regular check-ups and constant care. I am her only son. At present I travel more than 100 kilometres every weekend to look after her, but during the week there is no one to help her in an emergency. Last month she fell at home and had to be taken to hospital by neighbours. Her medical certificate is enclosed.

I therefore request you to transfer me to the Office of the Deputy Director of Health Services, Madurai, or to any other office in Madurai, in my present post, whenever a vacancy arises. I shall be grateful for your kind consideration of my request.

Yours faithfully,
M. Suresh
Assistant

Encl.: Medical certificate of my mother, Tmt. M. Kamala

Important vocabulary: *through proper channel* - sent through one's immediate superior instead of directly to the higher authority; *Head of Department (HoD)* - the officer at the head of a government department; *immediate superior* - the officer directly above an employee; *medical grounds* - reasons based on illness; *compassionate grounds* - reasons based on personal or family hardship; *forward* - send a paper on to the next authority, often with remarks; *whenever a vacancy arises* - as soon as a post falls vacant; *Tmt. (Thirumathi)* - Tamil Nadu Government honorific for a married woman (Mrs.).

Why this format is correct:

- "Through proper channel" means that an employee's application to a higher authority is sent through the immediate superior. The "Through: ..." line below the addressee

shows this route (see Section 6); the Deputy Director forwards the letter with his or her remarks.

- The office address is at the top because this is an official application that passes through that office; the writer's designation appears below his name.
- The grounds are specific and supported by evidence: the mother's age and illnesses, the distance, the recent fall and an enclosed medical certificate. Vague reasons such as "family problems" are weak.
- The request is precise - a named office in Madurai, the present post, "whenever a vacancy arises" - so it is easy to act on.
- "Respected Sir," is accepted Indian usage for a superior ("Respected Madam," for a woman officer) and pairs with "Yours faithfully,". The mother is referred to with the Tamil Nadu honorific "Tmt.".

10.22 Business Inquiry: Prices and Trade Terms Formal

Question: You are S. Senthil, Proprietor of Sri Murugan Stationers, 45, West Masi Street, Madurai - 625 001. Write a letter to the Sales Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills, 8, Industrial Estate, Sivakasi - 626 123, asking for the latest price list, trade discount, delivery terms and payment terms for school notebooks.

Situation: Writer: S. Senthil, Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers (retailer) | Receiver: The Sales Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills (manufacturer and wholesaler) | Relationship: prospective buyer to seller; no earlier dealings | Purpose: to collect prices and terms before deciding to order | Register: Formal

Correct format: Letterhead → Ref. No. → Date → To + inside address → Subject → Salutation → Body (who we are, numbered questions, prospect of business, early reply) → Complimentary close → For firm, name, designation

SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
45, WEST MASI STREET, MADURAI - 625 001
PHONE: 0452 2XXXXXX | EMAIL: murugan@example.com
GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5

Ref. No.: SMS/PUR/2026-27/118

5 October 2026

To
The Sales Manager,
Kaveri Paper Mills,
8, Industrial Estate,
Sivakasi - 626 123

Subject: Inquiry about prices and trade terms for school notebooks

Dear Sir/Madam,

We are a retail stationery shop in Madurai and have been supplying notebooks and stationery to students of more than twenty schools and colleges in the city for the past twelve years. We saw your notebooks at a trade fair in Madurai and were impressed by their quality. We now wish to stock them in our shop.

Please send us your latest price list and let us know the following:

1. The trade discount you allow to retailers, and any extra discount on large orders.
2. Your delivery terms, the time needed to deliver to Madurai, and who bears the freight.
3. Your payment terms, the credit period allowed, and any cash discount for early payment.
4. The minimum quantity you accept for each item.

We are mainly interested in long-size notebooks (200 pages), king-size notebooks (160 pages) and four-line notebooks for primary classes. If your prices and terms are suitable, we expect to place a first order worth about Rs. 1,00,000 and to order regularly every term.

We would be grateful for an early reply, as we plan to replenish our stock this month.

Yours faithfully,
For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
S. Senthil
Proprietor

Important vocabulary: *inquiry / enquiry* - a letter asking for information (both spellings are accepted); *price list* - the seller's list of current prices for each item; *trade discount* - a reduction in the list price allowed to traders who buy goods for resale; *cash discount* - a reduction allowed for payment within a fixed short time; *credit period* - the time allowed to the buyer to pay after delivery; *freight* - the charge for carrying goods; *GSTIN* - Goods and Services Tax Identification Number, a 15-character registration number ("33" is the code for Tamil Nadu).

Why this format is correct:

- It is written on the firm's letterhead (name in capitals, address, phone, email, GSTIN) with a Ref. No. that the seller can quote in the reply.
- The Sales Manager's name is not known, so "Dear Sir/Madam," pairs with "Yours faithfully." The Subject comes before the salutation (house style; the traditional British layout puts it after the salutation - accepted variant).
- The body follows the inquiry pattern: who we are → what we want (numbered questions) → prospect of regular orders → request for an early reply. Numbered questions make the reply easy and complete.
- "For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS" above the name shows that the proprietor signs on behalf of the firm.
- An inquiry does not bind the writer to buy anything; the seller's reply to it is a quotation (see 10.23).

10.23 Quotation in Reply to an Inquiry Formal

Question: As R. Meena, Sales Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills, 8, Industrial Estate, Sivakasi - 626 123, reply to the inquiry of Mr. S. Senthil, Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers, 45, West Masi Street, Madurai - 625 001 (see 10.22). Quote your prices, trade discount, delivery terms and payment terms, and state how long the offer is valid.

Situation: Writer: R. Meena, Sales Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills (seller) | Receiver: Mr. S. Senthil, Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers (prospective buyer) | Relationship: seller replying to a new customer's inquiry | Purpose: to make a firm offer that the buyer can accept by placing an order | Register: Formal

Correct format: Letterhead → Ref. No. → Date → To + inside address (named person) → Subject → Reference → Dear Mr. Senthil, → Body (thanks, prices, terms, validity, invitation to order) → Yours sincerely, → For firm, name, designation → Encl.

KAVERI PAPER MILLS
8, INDUSTRIAL ESTATE, SIVAKASI - 626 123
PHONE: 04562 2XXXXX | EMAIL: sales.kaveri@example.com
GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5

Ref. No.: KPM/SAL/2026-27/204

8 October 2026

To
Mr. S. Senthil,
Proprietor,
Sri Murugan Stationers,
45, West Masi Street,
Madurai - 625 001

Subject: Quotation for school notebooks

Reference: Your letter Ref. No. SMS/PUR/2026-27/118 dated 5 October 2026

Dear Mr. Senthil,

Thank you for your letter and for your interest in our notebooks. We are pleased to quote our prices, which are inclusive of GST:

1. Long-size notebook, 200 pages, ruled (Code LN-200): Rs. 540 per dozen
2. King-size notebook, 160 pages, ruled (Code KS-160): Rs. 420 per dozen
3. Four-line notebook, 80 pages (Code FL-80): Rs. 216 per dozen

Our terms are as follows:

Trade discount: 5% on list prices; 10% on orders of Rs. 50,000 and above.

Delivery: within 7 days of receipt of the order, at your shop in Madurai. Freight and transit insurance will be borne by us.

Payment: within 30 days of the date of invoice, by NEFT or cheque. A cash discount of 2% is allowed if the invoice is paid within 10 days.

Minimum order: 10 dozen for each item. The notebooks are packed 5 dozen to a waterproof carton.

This quotation is valid until 31 October 2026. Orders received after that date will be accepted at the prices ruling on the date of the order.

We enclose our price list and catalogue. We look forward to receiving your order and assure you of prompt and careful execution.

Yours sincerely,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
R. Meena
Sales Manager

Encl.: 1. Price list 2026-27
2. Catalogue

Important vocabulary: *quotation* - the seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions, sent in reply to an inquiry; *firm offer* - an offer that the seller promises to keep open until a stated date; *validity* - the period for which the quoted prices hold good; *list price* - the price in the price list, before any discount; *inclusive of GST* - the tax is already included in the price; *transit insurance* - insurance against loss of or damage to goods on the way; *prices ruling* - the prices in force on a particular date; *execution* (of an order) - carrying out an order by supplying the goods.

Why this format is correct:

- A quotation answers the inquiry point by point - prices, discounts, delivery, payment and minimum order - in the same order as the buyer's numbered questions, and it quotes the buyer's reference number and date.
- The validity date ("valid until 31 October 2026") makes it a firm offer; after that date the seller is free to change the prices.
- It is addressed to a named person, so "Dear Mr. Senthil," pairs with "Yours sincerely,".
- The terms are set out line by line, so the buyer can copy them into the order.
- Do not confuse: a quotation gives firm prices before the order; an estimate gives an approximate cost; a tender is a formal, often sealed, offer made in response to an invitation, usually from a public body.

10.24 Order Letter with a Purchase Order Number Formal

Question: Sri Murugan Stationers, 45, West Masi Street, Madurai - 625 001, accepts the quotation of Kaveri Paper Mills, 8, Industrial Estate, Sivakasi - 626 123 (see 10.23). As S. Senthil, Proprietor, place an order under Purchase Order No. SMS/PO/2026-27/058, addressed to the firm for the kind attention of Ms. R. Meena, Sales Manager. State the quantities, delivery date and payment terms.

Situation: Writer: S. Senthil, Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers (buyer) | Receiver: M/s. Kaveri Paper Mills, for the attention of Ms. R. Meena, Sales Manager (seller) | Relationship: buyer accepting the seller's quotation | Purpose: to place a clear, complete order | Register: Formal

Correct format: Letterhead → Ref. No. (PO number) → Date → To + inside address (M/s. + firm) → Kind Attention line → Subject → Reference → Dear Sir/Madam, → Body (items and amounts, delivery, payment, acknowledgement) → Yours faithfully, → For firm, name, designation

SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
45, WEST MASI STREET, MADURAI - 625 001
PHONE: 0452 2XXXXXX | EMAIL: murugan@example.com
GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5

Ref. No.: SMS/PO/2026-27/058

12 October 2026

To
M/s. Kaveri Paper Mills,
8, Industrial Estate,
Sivakasi - 626 123

Kind Attention: Ms. R. Meena, Sales Manager

Subject: Purchase Order No. SMS/PO/2026-27/058 for school notebooks

Reference: Your quotation Ref. No. KPM/SAL/2026-27/204 dated 8 October 2026

Dear Sir/Madam,

Thank you for your quotation. We are pleased to place the following order at the prices and on the terms stated in it:

1. Long-size notebook, 200 pages (Code LN-200): 100 dozen @ Rs. 540 = Rs. 54,000
2. King-size notebook, 160 pages (Code KS-160): 80 dozen @ Rs. 420 = Rs. 33,600
3. Four-line notebook, 80 pages (Code FL-80): 50 dozen @ Rs. 216 = Rs. 10,800
Total at list prices: Rs. 98,400
Less trade discount at 10%: Rs. 9,840
Net amount payable (inclusive of GST): Rs. 88,560

Please deliver the goods at our shop, at the address given above, on or before 20 October 2026, packed in waterproof cartons as mentioned in your quotation. Timely delivery is essential, as our customers are waiting for these notebooks.

We shall pay the invoice amount by NEFT within 30 days of the date of your invoice. Please quote our Purchase Order number on your invoice, delivery challan and all letters about this order.

Please acknowledge receipt of this order and inform us of the date of dispatch.

Yours faithfully,
For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
S. Senthil
Proprietor

Important vocabulary: *Purchase Order (PO)* - a formal numbered document issued by the buyer to order goods; it becomes binding once the seller accepts it; *M/s.* - Messrs, written before the name of a firm; *Kind Attention* - a line that directs a letter addressed to a firm to a particular person; @ - at the rate of; *net amount* - the amount payable after deducting discounts; *delivery challan* - a document that travels with the goods and lists what is sent; *dispatch* - sending off the goods.

Why this format is correct:

- The PO number appears in the Ref. No. and in the Subject, and the Reference line quotes the quotation, so both firms can trace the deal from inquiry to payment.
- Each item is listed with code, description, quantity, rate and amount, followed by the discount and the net total. An order must be exact about what, how many, at what price, when and where to deliver, and how payment will be made.

- The letter is addressed to the firm (M/s. Kaveri Paper Mills); the Kind Attention line only directs it to Ms. Meena. As the letter is still to the firm, the salutation is "Dear Sir/Madam," with "Yours faithfully,".
- It asks the seller to acknowledge the order and to quote the PO number on the invoice and challan; once accepted, the order binds both sides.

10.25 Complaint and Claim: Damaged and Short Goods Formal

Question: The notebooks ordered by Sri Murugan Stationers, 45, West Masi Street, Madurai - 625 001 (see 10.24) arrived on 19 October 2026 with Invoice No. KPM/INV/2026-27/0412 dated 16 October 2026. Three cartons (15 dozen) of long-size notebooks were soaked with rain water, and 10 dozen king-size notebooks were short. As S. Senthil, Proprietor, write to the Sales Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills, 8, Industrial Estate, Sivakasi - 626 123, complaining and claiming replacement of the damaged goods and supply of the shortage.

Situation: Writer: S. Senthil, Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers (buyer) | Receiver: The Sales Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills (seller) | Relationship: customer to supplier after delivery | Purpose: to report the damage and shortage (complaint) and to demand a specific remedy (claim) | Register: Formal

Correct format: Letterhead → Ref. No. → Date → To + inside address → Subject → Reference → Dear Sir/Madam, → Body (facts of delivery, the problem, the claim with a date, evidence) → Yours faithfully, → For firm, name, designation → Encl.

SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS
45, WEST MASI STREET, MADURAI - 625 001
PHONE: 0452 2XXXXXX | EMAIL: murugan@example.com
GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5

Ref. No.: SMS/PUR/2026-27/131

20 October 2026

To
The Sales Manager,
Kaveri Paper Mills,
8, Industrial Estate,
Sivakasi - 626 123

Subject: Damaged and short supply against our Purchase Order No. SMS/PO/2026-27/058

Reference: Your Invoice No. KPM/INV/2026-27/0412 dated 16 October 2026

Dear Sir/Madam,

We received the consignment against the above order on 19 October 2026 through Vaigai Road Carriers under Lorry Receipt No. VRC/2291. We regret to inform you that it was not in order.

On opening the cartons in the presence of the lorry driver, we found the following:

1. Three cartons of long-size notebooks (Code LN-200), that is 15 dozen, were soaked with rain water. The pages are stuck together, and the notebooks cannot be sold.
2. Only 14 cartons (70 dozen) of king-size notebooks (Code KS-160) were received, although your invoice charges us for 80 dozen. Thus 10 dozen are short.

We recorded both facts on the Lorry Receipt and in our Goods Received Note No. SMS/GRN/231.

As your quotation provided for delivery at our shop, with transit insurance arranged by you, we request you to replace the 15 dozen damaged notebooks and to supply the 10 dozen short notebooks, free of charge, on or before 28 October 2026. The damaged cartons are kept aside for your inspection or collection.

We trust that you will attend to this matter promptly, as our customers need these notebooks for the current school term.

Yours faithfully,
For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS

S. Senthil
Proprietor

Encl.: 1. Copy of Lorry Receipt No. VRC/2291 with our remarks
2. Photographs of the damaged cartons (4)
3. Copy of Goods Received Note No. SMS/GRN/231

Important vocabulary: *consignment* - a batch of goods sent together; *Lorry Receipt (LR)* - the receipt issued by a road transporter for goods accepted for carriage; *Goods Received Note (GRN)* - the buyer's own record of the goods received; *short supply / shortage* - fewer goods received than ordered or invoiced; *complaint* - a letter reporting a problem (defect, delay, shortage, wrong goods); *claim* - a demand for a specific remedy or compensation (replacement, refund, price reduction); *transit* - the journey of goods from the seller to the buyer.

Why this format is correct:

- The first paragraph gives traceable facts: PO number, invoice number and date (in the Reference line), transporter, LR number and date of receipt.
- The problem is stated exactly - item codes, cartons and dozens - not vaguely ("some goods were bad").
- It is both a complaint (it reports the damage and the shortage) and a claim (it demands a specific remedy - replacement and supply of the shortage, free of charge - by a fixed date).
- The evidence is listed under "Encl." - LR with remarks, photographs and GRN - which makes the claim difficult to refuse.
- The tone is firm but polite - no threats, no insulting words - and the damaged goods are kept aside for inspection. The seller's reply is an adjustment letter (see 10.26).

10.26 Adjustment Letter: Replacement and Credit Note Formal

Question: As R. Meena, Sales Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills, 8, Industrial Estate, Sivakasi - 626 123, reply to the claim of Mr. S. Senthil, Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers, 45, West Masi Street, Madurai - 625 001 (see 10.25). Accept the claim, apologise, arrange replacement of the damaged notebooks and supply of the shortage, and issue a credit note for Rs. 1,500 as a special allowance for the inconvenience.

Situation: Writer: R. Meena, Sales Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills (seller) | Receiver: Mr. S. Senthil, Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers (buyer) | Relationship: supplier replying to a customer's claim | Purpose: to settle the claim in full and keep the customer's goodwill | Register: Formal

Correct format: Letterhead → Ref. No. → Date → To + inside address (named person) → Subject → Reference → Dear Mr. Senthil, → Body (thanks and apology, cause, remedy, credit note, prevention) → Yours sincerely, → For firm, name, designation → Encl.

KAVERI PAPER MILLS
8, INDUSTRIAL ESTATE, SIVAKASI - 626 123
PHONE: 04562 2XXXXX | EMAIL: sales.kaveri@example.com
GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5

Ref. No.: KPM/SAL/2026-27/236

23 October 2026

To
Mr. S. Senthil,
Proprietor,
Sri Murugan Stationers,
45, West Masi Street,
Madurai - 625 001

Subject: Replacement of damaged notebooks and supply of shortage

Reference: Your letter Ref. No. SMS/PUR/2026-27/131 dated 20 October 2026

Dear Mr. Senthil,

Thank you for your letter informing us of the damage and shortage in our consignment against your Purchase Order No. SMS/PO/2026-27/058. We are sorry for the inconvenience this has caused you.

On inquiry, we found that rain water entered the lorry through a torn cover, and that two cartons of king-size notebooks were left behind at our godown because of a loading error. We accept your claim in full.

Today we have dispatched 15 dozen long-size notebooks (Code LN-200) and 10 dozen king-size notebooks (Code KS-160), free of charge, through Vaigai Road Carriers under Lorry Receipt No. VRC/2417. They should reach you by 26 October 2026. The carriers will collect the damaged cartons at the same time, and we request you to hand them over.

As a token of our regret, we have also issued Credit Note No. KPM/CN/2026-27/019 for Rs. 1,500 as a special allowance. This reduces the amount due on our Invoice No. KPM/INV/2026-27/0412 from Rs. 88,560 to Rs. 87,060.

We have instructed our dispatch staff to check every consignment against the invoice and to use waterproof covers. We value your business and assure you that your future orders will receive our personal attention.

Yours sincerely,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
R. Meena
Sales Manager

Encl.: Credit Note No. KPM/CN/2026-27/019

Important vocabulary: *adjustment letter* - the seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim (full grant, partial grant, or polite refusal with reasons); *credit note* - a note issued by the seller to the buyer that reduces the amount the buyer owes; *allowance* - a reduction in the amount payable, given for damage, delay or inconvenience; *free of charge* - without any payment; *godown* - warehouse (Indian English); *on inquiry* - after investigation; *goodwill* - the customer's trust in the firm and willingness to deal with it again.

Why this format is correct:

- It is an adjustment letter that grants the claim in full, in the standard order: thank and apologise → explain the cause briefly → state the remedy with details (quantities, LR number, arrival date) → prevent a repeat → goodwill close.
- The credit note is issued by the SELLER and reduces what the buyer owes; the letter shows the new balance (Rs. 88,560 less Rs. 1,500 = Rs. 87,060). Do not confuse: a debit note is issued by the buyer when returning goods or claiming a deduction.
- It explains the cause honestly, without blaming the customer or the transporter, and accepts responsibility in plain words: "We accept your claim in full."
- It is addressed to a named person, so "Dear Mr. Senthil," pairs with "Yours sincerely,".

10.27 Payment Reminder: First Reminder Formal

Question: Invoice No. KPM/INV/2026-27/0412 dated 16 October 2026, sent to Sri Murugan Stationers, 45, West Masi Street, Madurai - 625 001, was due for payment on 15 November 2026. After adjusting Credit Note No. KPM/CN/2026-27/019 for Rs. 1,500 (see 10.26), Rs. 87,060 is still unpaid. As K. Suresh, Accounts Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills, 8, Industrial Estate, Sivakasi - 626 123, write a polite first reminder to the firm for the kind attention of Mr. S. Senthil, Proprietor.

Situation: Writer: K. Suresh, Accounts Manager, Kaveri Paper Mills (seller) | Receiver: M/s. Sri Murugan Stationers, for the attention of Mr. S. Senthil, Proprietor (buyer) | Relationship: supplier to a valued customer whose payment is overdue | Purpose: to obtain payment while keeping the customer's goodwill (collection series, stage 1) | Register: Formal

Correct format: Letterhead → Ref. No. → Date → To + inside address (M/s. + firm) → Kind Attention line → Subject → Dear Sir/Madam, → Body (goodwill opening, exact dues, polite request, "ignore if paid", offer to clarify) → Yours faithfully, → For firm, name, designation → Encl.

KAVERI PAPER MILLS
8, INDUSTRIAL ESTATE, SIVAKASI - 626 123
PHONE: 04562 2XXXXX | EMAIL: accounts.kaveri@example.com
GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5

Ref. No.: KPM/ACC/2026-27/377

1 December 2026

To
M/s. Sri Murugan Stationers,
45, West Masi Street,
Madurai - 625 001

Kind Attention: Mr. S. Senthil, Proprietor

Subject: Reminder - payment due on Invoice No. KPM/INV/2026-27/0412

Dear Sir/Madam,

We thank you for your valued business and hope that our notebooks are selling well in your shop.

This is a friendly reminder that the following amount, which was due for payment on 15 November 2026, remains unpaid according to our records:

Invoice No. KPM/INV/2026-27/0412 dated 16 October 2026: Rs. 88,560

Less Credit Note No. KPM/CN/2026-27/019: Rs. 1,500

Balance due: Rs. 87,060

We are sure that this is only an oversight. We shall be grateful if you arrange the payment by NEFT or cheque at your earliest convenience. Our bank details are printed on the invoice, and a statement of your account is enclosed for easy reference.

If you have already sent the payment, please accept our thanks and ignore this letter. If you have any query about the invoice, please let us know, and we shall clarify it at once.

We look forward to continuing our pleasant business relationship with you.

Yours faithfully,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
K. Suresh
Accounts Manager

Encl.: Statement of account as on 30 November 2026

Important vocabulary: *reminder* - a letter that reminds the buyer of a payment that is due or overdue; *overdue* - not paid by the due date; *balance due / outstanding* - the amount still to be paid; *statement of account* - a summary of invoices, credit notes and payments, showing the balance; *oversight* - a mistake made by not noticing something; *at your earliest convenience* - as soon as you can; *collection series* - first reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer) → final notice or demand (warns of legal action).

Why this format is correct:

- It is stage 1 of the collection series: polite, it assumes an oversight, and it contains no threat, no mention of legal action and no penalty.
- It gives exact facts - invoice number, invoice date, due date, credit note and balance - and encloses a statement of account, so the buyer can check and pay at once.
- It offers two polite ways out: "if already paid, please ignore this letter" and "if you have any query, please let us know". This keeps the customer's goodwill.
- It is addressed to the firm (M/s.) with a Kind Attention line, so "Dear Sir/Madam," pairs with "Yours faithfully,"; the Accounts Manager signs "For KAVERI PAPER MILLS".

10.28 Bank: Stop-Payment of a Lost Cheque Formal

Question: Mrs. P. Lakshmi, 18, Bharathi Park Road, Saibaba Colony, Coimbatore - 641 011, holds Savings Bank Account No. XXXXXXXX4521 at Southern Commercial Bank, R.S. Puram Branch, Coimbatore - 641 002. She has lost Cheque No. 004517 dated 9 October 2026 for Rs. 25,000, drawn in favour of Selvam Furniture Mart, Coimbatore, before handing it over. Write her letter to the Branch Manager asking the bank to stop payment of the cheque.

Situation: Writer: Mrs. P. Lakshmi (account holder, drawer of the cheque) | Receiver: The Branch Manager, Southern Commercial Bank, R.S. Puram Branch | Relationship: customer to her bank | Purpose: to stop payment of a lost cheque before anyone can encash it | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + Branch Manager's address → Subject → Dear Sir/Madam, → Body (account, cheque details, how it was lost, instruction, charges, confirmation) → Yours faithfully, → Name and account number

18, Bharathi Park Road,
Saibaba Colony,
Coimbatore - 641 011

11 October 2026

To
The Branch Manager,
Southern Commercial Bank,
R.S. Puram Branch,
Coimbatore - 641 002

Subject: Urgent - stop payment of lost Cheque No. 004517

Dear Sir/Madam,

I hold Savings Bank Account No. XXXXXXXX4521 at your branch. I request you to stop payment of the following cheque, which I have lost:

Cheque No.: 004517

Date: 9 October 2026

Amount: Rs. 25,000 (Rupees twenty-five thousand only)

Payee: Selvam Furniture Mart, Coimbatore

I had signed this cheque to pay for furniture that I had ordered from the payee. However, it was lost along with my handbag in a city bus on 10 October 2026, before I could hand it over to the payee. My account shows that the cheque has not been paid so far.

Please record this stop-payment instruction immediately and do not pay the cheque if it is presented at any branch or through clearing. I agree to bear the stop-payment charges as per the bank's rules. I have informed the payee, and I shall make the payment by a fresh cheque.

Please confirm in writing, or by email, that my instruction has been recorded against the cheque.

Yours faithfully,
P. Lakshmi
SB Account No. XXXXXXXX4521

Important vocabulary: *stop-payment* - the account holder's instruction to the bank not to pay a particular cheque; *drawer* - the person who writes and signs the cheque (here, Mrs. Lakshmi); *drawee* - the bank on which the cheque is drawn; *payee* - the person or firm to whom the cheque is payable; *clearing* - the process by which a cheque deposited in another bank is sent to the drawee bank for payment; *honour / dishonour* - (of a bank) pay / refuse to pay a cheque; *specimen signature* - the signature kept in the bank's records to verify the customer's signature.

Why this format is correct:

- A letter from an individual has no letterhead; it uses the formal layout: sender's address → date → "To" → The Branch Manager of the branch where the account is kept → Subject → "Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,".
- It gives the four details the bank needs to identify the cheque - number, date, amount and payee - on separate lines, together with the account number (masked as XXXXXXXX4521).
- "Urgent" in the Subject and "immediately" in the body: the instruction works only if it reaches the bank before the cheque is paid. It also asks for written confirmation.
- The charges are accepted "as per the bank's rules" without quoting any amount. Never write a PIN, OTP, CVV or password in any bank letter, and sign exactly as in the bank's records.
- Do not confuse: stop-payment is the drawer's instruction to the bank; dishonour is the bank's refusal to pay a cheque, returned with a return memo.

10.29 Bank: ATM Debit without Cash Formal

Question: Mr. V. Karthik, 27, Thillai Nagar Main Road, Tiruchirappalli - 620 018, holds Savings Bank Account No. XXXXXXXX4521 at Southern Commercial Bank, Thillai Nagar Branch, Tiruchirappalli - 620 018. On 3 November 2026 at 7.45 p.m., he tried to withdraw Rs. 10,000 with his debit card from another bank's ATM at the Chatram Bus Stand, Tiruchirappalli. No cash came out, but his account was debited. Write his complaint to the Branch Manager.

Situation: Writer: Mr. V. Karthik (account holder) | Receiver: The Branch Manager, Southern Commercial Bank, Thillai Nagar Branch (his own, card-issuing bank) | Relationship: customer to his bank | Purpose: to get the wrong debit reversed | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + Branch Manager's address → Subject → Dear Sir/Madam, → Body (account, transaction details, what happened, complaint number, request) → Yours faithfully, → Name and account number → Encl.

27, Thillai Nagar Main Road,
Tiruchirappalli - 620 018

4 November 2026

To
The Branch Manager,
Southern Commercial Bank,
Thillai Nagar Branch,
Tiruchirappalli - 620 018

Subject: Account debited but cash not dispensed at ATM - request for reversal

Dear Sir/Madam,

I hold Savings Bank Account No. XXXXXXXX4521 at your branch. I wish to report a failed ATM transaction in which my account was debited but no cash was dispensed.

The details of the transaction are as follows:
Date and time: 3 November 2026, 7.45 p.m.
ATM: another bank's ATM at the Chatram Bus Stand, Tiruchirappalli (ATM ID: TCH0072)
Card used: my debit card ending in 7788
Amount: Rs. 10,000
Transaction number (as printed on the ATM slip): 6307

The machine printed the slip but did not dispense any cash. A few minutes later, I received an SMS alert that Rs. 10,000 had been debited from my account. I reported the matter the same evening on the bank's customer care number, and my complaint number is SCB/CMP/2026/55810.

I request you to verify the transaction with the ATM records and to reverse the wrong debit by crediting Rs. 10,000 back to my account at the earliest. Please also inform me in writing of the action taken.

Yours faithfully,
V. Karthik
SB Account No. XXXXXXXX4521

Encl.: 1. Copy of the ATM transaction slip
2. Copy of the account statement showing the debit

Important vocabulary: *disburse* - give out (cash from a machine); *failed transaction* - a transaction in which the account is debited but the cash or service is not received; *debit / credit* - an entry that reduces / increases the balance in an account; *reversal* - cancelling a wrong debit by crediting the amount back; *ATM ID* - the identification number of the machine, printed on the slip; *card-issuing bank* - the bank that issued the customer's debit card (the customer's own bank); *SMS alert* - a text message from the bank about a transaction.

Why this format is correct:

- The complaint goes to the customer's own (card-issuing) bank, even though another bank's ATM was used.
- All identifying details are set out line by line - date, time, ATM location and ID, amount, transaction number, and only the last four digits of the card - so that the bank can trace the transaction quickly.
- It mentions the complaint already registered with customer care and lists the evidence (ATM slip, statement) under "Encl.".
- The request is specific: verify, reverse the debit, and inform in writing. Do not quote RBI time limits or compensation amounts in an exam letter unless the question gives them; such rules are revised from time to time.
- Safety: never write the PIN, OTP, CVV or full card number; the account number is masked (XXXXXXX4521).

10.30 Bank: Education Loan Application Formal

Question: Ms. M. Kavya, 7, Bharathi Street, Fairlands, Salem - 636 016, has been admitted to the four-year B.E. (Computer Science and Engineering) course at Thendral College of Engineering, Salem. The total cost of the course is Rs. 6,40,000, and her family can pay Rs. 90,000. Her father, Mr. R. Murugesan, holds Savings Account No. XXXXXXXX4521 at Southern Commercial Bank, Fairlands Branch, Salem - 636 016, and will be the co-borrower. Write her application to the Branch Manager for an education loan of Rs. 5,50,000.

Situation: Writer: Ms. M. Kavya (student, applicant) | Receiver: The Branch Manager, Southern Commercial Bank, Fairlands Branch | Relationship: prospective borrower to the bank where her family banks | Purpose: to apply for a loan with all the facts the bank needs to decide | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + Branch Manager's address → Subject → Dear Sir/Madam, → Body (admission, cost, loan amount, co-borrower, repayment, request) → Yours faithfully, → Name → Encl. (numbered list of documents)

7, Bharathi Street,
Fairlands,
Salem - 636 016

20 July 2026

To
The Branch Manager,
Southern Commercial Bank,
Fairlands Branch,
Salem - 636 016

Subject: Application for an education loan of Rs. 5,50,000 for a B.E. course

Dear Sir/Madam,

I have been admitted on merit to the four-year B.E. (Computer Science and Engineering) course at Thendral College of Engineering, Salem, for the years 2026-2030. I passed the Higher Secondary examination in 2026 with 92 per cent marks. I request you to sanction an education loan to meet the cost of my studies.

The cost of the course, as per the fee structure issued by the college, is:

Tuition and other college fees (4 years): Rs. 4,80,000

Hostel and mess charges (4 years): Rs. 1,60,000

Total: Rs. 6,40,000

My family will meet Rs. 90,000 from its savings. I therefore request a loan of Rs. 5,50,000, to be released year by year directly to the college as the fees fall due. My father, Mr. R. Murugesan, who holds Savings Account No. XXXXXXXX4521 at your branch, will join as co-borrower. The loan will be repaid in monthly instalments after the course, as per the terms of the bank's scheme.

I enclose the documents listed below. As the first-year fees are due on 20 August 2026, I shall be grateful if you process my application early. Please let me know if any other document is required.

Yours faithfully,

M. Kavya

Encl.: 1. Admission letter from the college

2. Fee structure for 2026-2030 issued by the college

3. Higher Secondary mark sheet (copy)

4. Identity and address proof of the applicant and the co-borrower (copies)

5. Income certificate of the co-borrower

6. Passport-size photographs of the applicant and the co-borrower

Important vocabulary: *education loan* - a bank loan to meet the cost of higher studies; *sanction* - official approval of a loan; *disbursement* - release of the loan amount, often in stages and directly to the institution; *co-borrower* - a person (usually a parent) who shares the responsibility for repaying the loan; *margin money* - the part of the cost that the borrower pays from own funds (here, Rs. 90,000); *moratorium* - a period during which repayment is not required, as per the loan scheme; *instalment* - one of the regular part-payments of a loan (British spelling); *collateral security* - property or a deposit pledged as security for a loan.

Why this format is correct:

- A formal application from an individual: sender's address, date, "To The Branch Manager" of the branch where the family banks, Subject, "Dear Sir/Madam," and "Yours faithfully,".
- The body answers the banker's questions in order: course and college → academic record → cost break-up → own contribution and loan amount → co-borrower → repayment → documents.
- The figures are exact and add up (Rs. 4,80,000 + Rs. 1,60,000 = Rs. 6,40,000; Rs. 6,40,000 less Rs. 90,000 = Rs. 5,50,000) and are written in the Indian lakh system with "Rs.".
- Interest rates, subsidies and collateral limits are not quoted - they depend on the bank's current scheme and change from time to time.
- The documents are listed as numbered enclosures, and the co-borrower's account number is masked (XXXXXXX4521).

10.31 Resignation Letter Formal

Question: Mr. S. Vignesh, 14, Kamarajar Salai, Sivakasi - 626 123, is Accounts Executive (Employee No. KPM/E/0147) at Kaveri Paper Mills, 8, Industrial Estate, Sivakasi - 626 123. He has accepted a job in Chennai. His appointment letter requires one month's notice. Write his resignation letter to his manager, Mr. K. Suresh, Accounts Manager, stating his notice period, last working day and handover plan.

Situation: Writer: Mr. S. Vignesh, Accounts Executive (employee) | Receiver: Mr. K. Suresh, Accounts Manager (his reporting manager) | Relationship: employee to a named superior | Purpose: to resign formally, serve the notice period and leave on good terms | Register: Formal

Correct format: Sender's address → Date → To + manager's name and address → Subject
→ Dear Mr. Suresh, → Body (resignation and notice, reason, handover, requests, thanks) →
Yours sincerely, → Name, designation, employee number → Copy to

14, Kamarajar Salai,
Sivakasi - 626 123

2 November 2026

To
Mr. K. Suresh,
Accounts Manager,
Kaveri Paper Mills,
8, Industrial Estate,
Sivakasi - 626 123

Subject: Resignation from the post of Accounts Executive

Dear Mr. Suresh,

Please accept this letter as my resignation from the post of Accounts Executive. As required by my appointment letter, I am giving one month's notice from today, 2 November 2026. My last working day will therefore be 2 December 2026.

I have accepted a position with a firm in Chennai, which will allow me to live with my elderly parents. This was not an easy decision, as I have learnt a great deal here under your guidance for more than four years.

During the notice period, I shall complete the October accounts and the bank reconciliation for November. I shall hand over all pending work, files and records to the colleague you nominate, together with a written handover note listing pending payments and collections. I shall return my laptop, identity card and office keys on my last working day.

I request you to accept my resignation and to arrange my relieving letter, experience certificate and full and final settlement.

Thank you for your support and encouragement. I shall be glad to help in any way during the transition, and I wish Kaveri Paper Mills continued success.

Yours sincerely,
S. Vignesh
Accounts Executive
Employee No. KPM/E/0147

Copy to: The Manager - Human Resources, Kaveri Paper Mills, Sivakasi

Important vocabulary: *resignation* - formally giving up one's job; *notice period* - the time an employee must continue to work after giving notice, as fixed in the appointment letter; *last working day* - the final day of duty; *handover* - passing work, records and company property to another person; *relieving letter* - the employer's letter confirming that the employee has been released from duty; *full and final settlement* - the final payment of all dues (pending salary and other amounts) when an employee leaves; *Copy to* - a line showing who else receives a copy of the letter.

Why this format is correct:

- The first paragraph does the main job at once: the resignation, the notice period and the exact last working day.
- The reason is brief and positive, with no complaints about the employer or colleagues - a resignation letter stays in the employee's service record.
- A clear handover plan (pending work, a written handover note, return of company property) shows responsibility; the letter also asks for the documents needed for the next job.
- It is written to a named manager, so "Dear Mr. Suresh," pairs with "Yours sincerely,"; the name is followed by designation and employee number, and "Copy to" keeps the HR department informed.

10.32 Recommendation Letter for a Former Student

Formal

Question: Dr. N. Anitha is Associate Professor and Head, Department of Commerce, Ponni Arts and Science College, Tiruchirappalli - 620 017. Her former student Mr. P. Arun (B.Com., 2022-2025) has applied for the post of Accounts Assistant at Nila Textiles Private Limited, 22, Avinashi Road, Tiruppur - 641 602. Write her letter of recommendation to the Manager - Human Resources of the company.

Situation: Writer: Dr. N. Anitha, Head of the Department of Commerce | Receiver: The Manager - Human Resources, Nila Textiles Private Limited (name not known) | Relationship: teacher recommending a former student to a possible employer | Purpose: to support the candidate for a particular post with specific evidence | Register: Formal

Correct format: Letterhead (college and department) → Ref. No. → Date → To + inside address → Subject → Dear Sir/Madam, → Body (how the writer knows him, academic record, skills, character, recommendation) → Yours faithfully, → Name and designation

PONNI ARTS AND SCIENCE COLLEGE
DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE
TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - 620 017
PHONE: 0431 2XXXXXX | EMAIL: commerce.ponni@example.com

Ref. No.: PASC/COM/2026-27/042

12 October 2026

To
The Manager - Human Resources,
Nila Textiles Private Limited,
22, Avinashi Road,
Tiruppur - 641 602

Subject: Recommendation of Mr. P. Arun for the post of Accounts Assistant

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am pleased to recommend Mr. P. Arun for the post of Accounts Assistant in your company. I have known him for three years as his teacher and Head of Department, when he studied B.Com. in our college from 2022 to 2025.

Arun was among the best students in his batch and graduated with a CGPA of 8.6 out of 10. I taught him Financial Accounting and Taxation, and he showed a clear understanding of both subjects. For his final-year project, he studied the working capital management of a textile firm in Tiruchirappalli, and his report was rated the best in the department. He is also skilled in accounting software and spreadsheets.

Arun is honest, punctual and hard-working. As class representative in his final year, he dealt courteously with students and staff and handled every responsibility with care.

I am confident that he will be a valuable member of your accounts team, and I recommend him without reservation. Please feel free to contact me at commerce.ponni@example.com if you need any further information about him.

Yours faithfully,
Dr. N. Anitha
Associate Professor and Head
Department of Commerce

Important vocabulary: *recommendation letter* - a letter by someone who knows the candidate well, supporting him or her for a particular post or course; *candidate* - a person applying for a job or course; *batch* - the group of students who study in the same year; *CGPA* - Cumulative Grade Point Average; *courteously* - politely and respectfully; *without reservation* - fully, without any doubt; *testimonial* - an older word for a written statement about a person's character and ability.

Why this format is correct:

- The writer states her position and how long, and in what capacity, she has known the candidate (teacher and Head of Department, three years); this gives the letter weight.
- Specific evidence - CGPA, subjects, project, skills, class representative - is more convincing than general praise such as "He is a very good student".
- It is written for a particular post and sent to a particular employer. The reader is known only by designation, so "Dear Sir/Madam," pairs with "Yours faithfully,".
- The college letterhead and Ref. No. make it official; it ends with a clear recommendation and an offer to give more information.

10.33 Reference Letter: To Whom It May Concern

Formal

Question: Mr. S. Vignesh worked at Kaveri Paper Mills, 8, Industrial Estate, Sivakasi - 626 123, from 1 June 2022 to 2 December 2026 - first as Accounts Assistant and, from 1 April 2024, as Accounts Executive. He resigned to take up a job in Chennai (see 10.31). As Ms. T. Priya, Manager - Human Resources, issue a reference letter headed "To Whom It May Concern" confirming his period of employment, role and conduct.

Situation: Writer: Ms. T. Priya, Manager - Human Resources, Kaveri Paper Mills (employer) | Receiver: any future employer or authority (not known) | Relationship: former employer to unknown readers | Purpose: to confirm the facts of employment and the employee's conduct | Register: Formal

Correct format: Letterhead → Ref. No. → Date → TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN (heading, in place of inside address and salutation) → Body (period and posts, duties, conduct, reason for leaving, "issued at his request") → Yours faithfully, → For firm, name, designation

KAVERI PAPER MILLS
8, INDUSTRIAL ESTATE, SIVAKASI - 626 123
PHONE: 04562 2XXXXX | EMAIL: hr.kaveri@example.com
GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5

Ref. No.: KPM/HR/2026-27/089

4 December 2026

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

This is to certify that Mr. S. Vignesh was employed with Kaveri Paper Mills, Sivakasi, from 1 June 2022 to 2 December 2026. He joined us as Accounts Assistant and was promoted to Accounts Executive on 1 April 2024, the post he held until he left us.

As Accounts Executive, he maintained our books of accounts in the accounting software, handled payments to suppliers and collections from customers, prepared monthly bank reconciliation statements and assisted in preparing data for GST returns. He also trained two junior members of staff.

During his service, he was honest, punctual and hard-working, and he was well liked by his colleagues and our customers. His work and conduct were found to be good throughout.

He resigned of his own accord to take up a position in Chennai and was relieved from duty on 2 December 2026, after completing the handover of his work. No dues are outstanding from him.

This letter is issued at his request. We wish him every success in his career.

Yours faithfully,
For KAVERI PAPER MILLS
T. Priya
Manager - Human Resources

Important vocabulary: *To Whom It May Concern* - a heading used when the letter is meant for any reader; it replaces the inside address and the salutation; *reference letter* - an employer's letter confirming facts about a person's employment and conduct; *employed with* - working for (an organisation); *of his own accord* - by his own choice; *relieved from*

duty - formally released from the job; *dues* - amounts owed; *experience certificate* - a certificate stating the period and nature of a person's employment.

Why this format is correct:

- "TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN" is written in capitals in place of the inside address and the salutation, because the reader is not known; the letter can be shown to any future employer.
- It confirms facts first - full name, period (from and to dates), posts and duties - then conduct, the reason for leaving and the words "issued at his request".
- The letterhead, Ref. No. and date make it verifiable. It is signed by an authorised officer "For KAVERI PAPER MILLS" with designation and closes with "Yours faithfully,".
- The language is factual and measured, not emotional; salary and personal matters are not mentioned.
- Do not confuse: a recommendation letter (10.32) supports a person for a particular post and goes to a particular reader; a reference letter mainly confirms facts and can be shown to anyone.

10.34 Appointment Letter and Joining Report Formal

Question: Nila Textiles Private Limited, 22, Avinashi Road, Tiruppur - 641 602, has selected Mr. P. Arun, 5, Anna Street, Srirangam, Tiruchirappalli - 620 006, as Accounts Assistant after an interview on 5 November 2026. (a) As G. Ramesh, Manager - Human Resources, write the appointment letter asking him to join on 1 December 2026. (b) Write Mr. Arun's joining report to the Manager - Human Resources on the day he reports for duty, giving his local address, 12, Kumaran Road, Tiruppur - 641 601.

Situation: Writer: (a) G. Ramesh, Manager - Human Resources, Nila Textiles Private Limited; (b) Mr. P. Arun | Receiver: (a) Mr. P. Arun (selected candidate); (b) The Manager - Human Resources | Relationship: employer and newly selected employee | Purpose: (a) to appoint him and state the terms of service; (b) to report for duty and place the joining on record | Register: Formal

Correct format: (a) Letterhead → Ref. No. → Date → To + candidate's name and address → Subject → Dear Mr. Arun, → Body (appointment, numbered terms, documents, acceptance, welcome) → Yours sincerely, → For firm, name, designation → Encl. (b) Sender's address → Date → To + receiver's address → Subject → Reference → Dear Sir, → Body (report for duty, documents, contact, request) → Yours faithfully, → Name, new designation → Encl.

(a) Appointment letter - employer to candidate

NILA TEXTILES PRIVATE LIMITED
22, AVINASHI ROAD, TIRUPPUR - 641 602
PHONE: 0421 2XXXXXXX | EMAIL: hr.nila@example.com
GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXX1Z5

Ref. No.: NTPL/HR/APT/2026-27/031

16 November 2026

To
Mr. P. Arun,
5, Anna Street,
Srirangam,
Tiruchirappalli - 620 006

Subject: Appointment as Accounts Assistant

Dear Mr. Arun,

With reference to your application and the interview held on 5 November 2026, we are pleased to appoint you as Accounts Assistant in our Accounts Department at Tiruppur on the following terms:

1. Date of joining: 1 December 2026, at 9.30 a.m. You will report to the Manager - Accounts.
2. Salary: Rs. 24,000 per month (gross), with other benefits as per company rules.
3. Probation: six months from the date of joining. On satisfactory completion, you will be confirmed in writing.

4. Notice period: 15 days during probation and one month after confirmation, on either side.
5. Working hours: 9.30 a.m. to 6.00 p.m., Monday to Saturday.

Please bring your original certificates with one set of copies, an identity proof, two passport-size photographs and a medical fitness certificate when you report for duty.

Please sign the duplicate copy of this letter in token of your acceptance and return it to us by 23 November 2026. If we do not receive your acceptance by that date, this offer will lapse.

We welcome you to Nila Textiles and wish you a successful career with us.

Yours sincerely,
For NILA TEXTILES PRIVATE LIMITED
G. Ramesh
Manager - Human Resources

Encl.: Duplicate copy of this letter (for signature)

(b) Joining report - employee reporting for duty

12, Kumaran Road,
Tiruppur - 641 601

1 December 2026

To
The Manager - Human Resources,
Nila Textiles Private Limited,
22, Avinashi Road,
Tiruppur - 641 602

Subject: Joining report - Accounts Assistant

Reference: Your appointment letter Ref. No. NTPL/HR/APT/2026-27/031 dated 16 November 2026

Dear Sir,

As directed in the letter cited above, I report for duty as Accounts Assistant in the Accounts Department today, 1 December 2026, in the forenoon.

I have already returned the signed duplicate copy of the appointment letter in token of my acceptance of the terms and conditions. I now submit copies of my educational certificates and identity proof, two passport-size photographs and a medical fitness certificate. I have brought the original certificates for verification and request that they be returned to me after verification.

My local address for correspondence is 12, Kumaran Road, Tiruppur - 641 601, and my email address is arun.p@example.com. Please send all official letters to this address until I inform you of any change.

I request you to take my joining report on record and to issue the necessary instructions for my posting under the Manager - Accounts. I assure you that I shall perform my duties sincerely and to the best of my ability.

Yours faithfully,
P. Arun
Accounts Assistant

Encl.: 1. Copies of educational certificates
2. Copy of identity proof
3. Passport-size photographs (2)
4. Medical fitness certificate

Important vocabulary: *appointment letter* - the employer's letter formally appointing a selected candidate and stating the terms of service; *probation* - a trial period after joining,

before confirmation; *confirmation* - making an employee permanent after satisfactory probation; *on either side* - applying to both the employer and the employee; *lapse* - come to an end because it is not accepted or used in time; *joining report* - the employee's written report that he or she has taken up duty; *forenoon (F.N.) / afternoon (A.N.)* - before / after 12 noon, used to record the exact time of joining or relief; *in token of* - as a sign of.

Why this format is correct:

- (a) The appointment letter is on the company letterhead with a Ref. No. It states every key term - post, place, date and time of joining, salary, probation, notice period and working hours - as a numbered list, and asks for written acceptance by a fixed date.
- (a) It is addressed to the named candidate, so "Dear Mr. Arun," pairs with "Yours sincerely,"; the HR manager signs "For NILA TEXTILES PRIVATE LIMITED".
- (b) The joining report is short and factual: it quotes the reference of the appointment letter, states the exact date and time of joining ("in the forenoon") and lists the documents submitted. Offices record the date and time of joining because service is counted from them.
- (b) It is written by an individual, so it starts with the sender's address, not a letterhead. The officer is addressed by designation: "Dear Sir," pairs with "Yours faithfully,".
- Do not confuse: an appointment letter formally appoints a person and states the terms; a joining report confirms that the person has actually taken up duty; a relieving letter confirms release from a job (see 10.31).

11

Common Exam Mistakes

These 15 mistakes appear again and again in exam answers. In every table the **Wrong** column shows what NOT to write. Learn the **Correct** column and the reason. Layout rules are in Sections 1 and 9; register rules are in Section 12.

11.1 Wrong salutation HIGH-FREQUENCY

The salutation must suit the receiver and must match the close (see 13.4). Use one greeting word only and end with a comma.

Wrong	Correct	Why
Dear Respected Sir,	Respected Sir, (or Dear Sir,)	"Dear" and "Respected" are never used together. Choose one.
Hello Sir, (letter to the District Collector)	Sir, / Dear Sir/Madam,	Spoken, informal greeting. Not used in any letter to an official.
Dear Mr. Raman Sir,	Dear Mr. Raman,	Title + surname is enough. Adding "Sir" after a name is spoken style.
Respected Sir, (letter to your friend Arun)	Dear Arun,	Friends are addressed by first name. "Respected" is only for superiors.

11.2 Wrong complimentary close HIGH-FREQUENCY

The close must match the salutation: no name → Yours faithfully; a name → Yours sincerely (see 13.5). Only the first word takes a capital letter.

Wrong	Correct	Why
Your's faithfully,	Yours faithfully,	"Yours" is a possessive pronoun, like "ours" and "hers". It never takes an apostrophe.
Yours Faithfully,	Yours faithfully,	Capital Y, small f. Only the first word of the close is capitalised.
Dear Sir/Madam, ... Yours sincerely,	Dear Sir/Madam, ... Yours faithfully,	No name in the salutation → faithfully.
Dear Mr. Raman, ... Yours faithfully,	Dear Mr. Raman, ... Yours sincerely,	A name in the salutation → sincerely.

11.3 Missing subject

A formal letter without a subject line looks incomplete: the subject tells the reader the purpose at a glance. It is a short noun phrase with no full stop.

Wrong	Correct	Why
(No subject line - the salutation comes straight after the receiver's address)	Subject: Request for a duplicate hall ticket	Every formal and business letter needs a subject line.
Subject: I am writing to request you to kindly issue me a duplicate hall ticket as I have lost the original.	Subject: Request for a duplicate hall ticket	The subject is a short heading (noun phrase), not a full sentence.
Subject: Request	Subject: Request for a duplicate hall ticket	Too vague. The subject must name the exact matter.

Wrong	Correct	Why
Subject: My summer holidays (letter to your friend Priya)	No subject line - begin with Dear Priya,	Informal letters never have a subject line.

11.4 Repetition

Saying the same thing twice wastes the reader's time and your exam time. Make each point once, clearly.

Wrong	Correct	Why
I request you to take action. Please take action immediately. Once again I request you to take action.	I request you to take immediate action.	One clear request is stronger than three weak ones.
Subject: Delay in delivery of chairs - and the first sentence: This letter is about the delay in the delivery of chairs.	The 50 chairs we ordered on 2 September 2026 (Order No. 245) have not yet been delivered.	Do not copy the subject into the first sentence. Add the facts instead.
return back, repeat again, true facts, each and every, revert back	return, repeat, facts, every, reply	The extra word repeats the meaning of the first (redundancy).

11.5 Informal language in formal letters

Words you use with friends sound careless, even rude, in a letter to an official. Replace them with standard formal words (see 13.6).

Wrong	Correct	Why
Thanks a lot for your help.	Thank you for your assistance.	Conversational thanks. Use "Thank you".
There are a lot of problems in our area.	Our area faces several problems.	Informal quantity phrase. Use many, several or a large number of.
The kids in our street have no place to play.	The children in our street have no playground.	Informal word for children.
I want you to fix the road soon.	I request you to repair the road as soon as possible.	Sounds like an order. Request politely and use the formal verb.

11.6 Excessive wording

Long, padded phrases do not make a letter more formal; they make it slow. Use the shortest clear expression.

Wrong	Correct	Why
I am writing this letter to you in order to bring to your kind notice and attention the fact that the bus stop has no shelter.	I wish to bring to your notice that the bus stop has no shelter.	Same meaning in half the words.
Please find enclosed herewith a copy of the receipt for your kind perusal.	I enclose a copy of the receipt. (or: Please find enclosed a copy of the receipt.)	The extra words add nothing. "Enclosed" already means "sent with this letter".
Kindly do the needful in this matter.	Please take the necessary action in this matter.	Outdated, vague office phrase. Say exactly what you want.
I received your letter and I thank you for the same.	Thank you for your letter.	Using "the same" as a pronoun is outdated. Say "it" or name the thing.

11.7 Wrong tense HIGH - FREQUENCY

Tense errors are the commonest grammar errors in letters. Check every verb that says how long a problem has lasted.

Wrong	Correct	Why
The street lights are not working since three weeks.	The street lights have not been working for three weeks.	An action that began in the past and is still going on takes the present perfect continuous. Use "for" + a period, "since" + a starting point.
I have received your letter yesterday.	I received your letter yesterday.	A finished past time (yesterday, last week) takes the simple past.
I did not received the parcel.	I did not receive the parcel.	After did / did not, use the base form of the verb.
I am having a savings account in your branch.	I have a savings account in your branch.	"Have" meaning "own" is not used in the continuous form.

11.8 Wrong punctuation

Letter punctuation follows fixed rules: a comma after the salutation and the close; no full stop after the subject or the pin code; no exclamation marks in formal letters.

Wrong	Correct	Why
Dear Sir/Madam.	Dear Sir/Madam,	The salutation ends with a comma.
Yours faithfully.	Yours faithfully,	The close ends with a comma. The name follows on the next line.
Subject: Request for a transfer certificate.	Subject: Request for a transfer certificate	The subject is a heading, not a sentence. No full stop.
Please act immediately!!!	I request you to take immediate action.	No exclamation marks in formal letters. Firmness comes from clear words.

11.9 Incorrect address format

Each part of an address goes on its own line, ending with a comma; the last (pin-code) line has no punctuation. In the table, " / " marks a new line.

Wrong	Correct	Why
12, Gandhi Road, K.K. Nagar, Madurai - 625 020 (all on one line)	12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai - 625 020	One part of the address per line.
12, Gandhi Road. / K.K. Nagar. / Madurai - 625 020.	12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai - 625 020	Commas at line ends, not full stops. Nothing after the pin code.
12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai.	12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai - 625 020	The pin code is part of every postal address. Style: City - 625 020.
To / Commissioner Sir, / Madurai.	To / The Commissioner, / Madurai City Municipal Corporation, / Madurai - 625 001	"The" + designation, then the office and the pin code. "Sir" belongs in the salutation, not in the address.

EXAM TIP: If the question gives no name or address, write "Examination Hall" as your address and sign as "ABC" or "XYZ". Never reveal your real identity. If the question gives a name and address, use exactly those.

11.10 Incorrect date format HIGH-FREQUENCY

Write the date in one clear style in every letter: **12 October 2026** (day, month in full, year). All-numeric dates are ambiguous.

Wrong	Correct	Why
12/10/2026	12 October 2026	Ambiguous: 12 October (Indian and British reading) or 10 December (American reading)?
12-10-26	12 October 2026	Numbers only and a two-digit year. Unclear.
12 Oct. 2026	12 October 2026	Write the month in full in a letter.
12 october 2026	12 October 2026	The name of a month always begins with a capital letter.

DO NOT CONFUSE: "12th October, 2026" is an acceptable traditional Indian style and "October 12, 2026" is the American style - neither is wrong. This book uses "12 October 2026". Whichever style you choose, use it consistently.

11.11 Using contractions

Contractions (short forms with an apostrophe) belong to speech and informal letters. In formal letters, write the full form.

Wrong	Correct	Why
I'm writing to apply for the post of Junior Assistant.	I am writing to apply for the post of Junior Assistant.	Formal letters use full forms.
We haven't received the goods.	We have not received the goods.	Full form: have not.
I can't attend the interview on 20 October 2026.	I am unable to attend the interview on 20 October 2026.	"Cannot" is written as one word; "I am unable to" is more formal still.
It's been two weeks since I applied.	It has been two weeks since I applied.	The short form stands for "it is" or "it has". Do not confuse it with "its" (belonging to it).

11.12 Using slang

Slang, SMS language and emoticons have no place in a formal letter. They make the writer look careless.

Wrong	Correct	Why
The service in your branch is pathetic.	The service in your branch has been unsatisfactory.	Rude, slangy judgement. State the problem politely and factually.
Pls send the docs ASAP.	Please send the documents as soon as possible.	SMS abbreviations are never used in letters.
Thx for ur quick reply :)	Thank you for your prompt reply.	SMS spellings and smileys are not letter language.

Wrong	Correct	Why
The food in the hostel mess is awesome, but the rooms are gross.	The food in the hostel mess is good, but the rooms are unclean.	Slang words for "very good" and "very bad". Use plain standard words.

11.13 Mixing formal and informal tone

Choose ONE register (Section 12) and keep it from the salutation to the close. A formal opening with a chatty ending, or the reverse, confuses the reader.

Wrong	Correct	Why
(Leave letter to the Principal) Respected Sir, / Hope you're doing great! I need three days' leave.	Respected Sir, / I request you to grant me leave for three days, from 13 to 15 October 2026, to attend my sister's wedding.	A chatty opener does not suit a letter to a superior.
I request you to sanction the loan. Thanks a ton, bye!	I request you to sanction the loan. Thank you for your time.	Formal start, slangy end. Keep one tone throughout.
Dear Priya, / I wish to inform you that I have been admitted to a medical college in Chennai. / Yours faithfully,	Dear Priya, / I am so happy to tell you that I have got a seat in a medical college in Chennai! / Your loving friend,	A letter to a friend should sound warm, not like an official notice.
Dear Mr. Raman, (your former teacher) / Hey, what's up?	Dear Mr. Raman, / I hope you are keeping well.	Semi-formal letters are friendly but respectful, never slangy.

11.14 Writing unnecessary information

Include only the facts the reader needs in order to act. Every extra sentence costs you time and hides your main point.

Wrong	Correct	Why
(Complaint about a faulty mixer grinder) I am a B.Com. graduate and I love shopping online during Deepavali.	The mixer grinder (Order No. 4587, delivered on 3 October 2026) arrived with a cracked jar.	Give the order number, the date and the defect - not your life story.
(Leave letter) My cousin's wedding is at Thanjavur; the reception will be grand, with a famous music troupe and two thousand guests.	I have to attend my cousin's wedding at Thanjavur on 20 October 2026.	One line of reason is enough for a leave letter.
(Job application) My hobbies are watching films and chatting with friends.	I hold a certificate in computer applications and can type in English and Tamil.	Mention only what makes you suitable for the post.
(Letter to your bank) My neighbour also had trouble with another bank last year.	(Leave it out.)	Other people's unrelated problems do not belong in your letter.

11.15 Poor paragraphing

One idea per paragraph. The body of a formal letter normally has three parts: opening (why), details (what) and closing (what next) - see 13.1.

Wrong	Correct	Why
The whole body written as one long block	Three paragraphs: why - what - what next	A single block hides the purpose and looks unplanned.
Every sentence written as a separate paragraph	Related sentences grouped into 3-4 paragraphs	Too many tiny paragraphs break the flow.
Some paragraphs indented, others at the margin; no blank lines between them	Every line at the left margin, one blank line between paragraphs (full block)	Mixing layouts looks careless.
The letter ends after the facts, with no request	A closing paragraph with the action wanted and a polite line (Thank you for your time.)	Without a closing request, the reader does not know what you want.

11.16 Spot all the errors

Question: You are S. Arun of 25, Anna Street, Fairlands, Salem - 636 016. Write a letter to the Commissioner, Salem City Municipal Corporation, complaining that the street lights in your street have not been working for three weeks.

A student wrote the answer below. It contains **10 deliberate errors** from 11.1-11.15. Find them all before you read the corrected version.

WRONG VERSION – do not copy 25, Anna Street, Fairlands, Salem - 636 016 5/10/26

To
The Commissioner,
Salem.

Dear Respected Sir,

I am writing this letter to you in order to humbly bring to your kind notice and attention the fact that the street lights in Anna Street are not working since three weeks.

The whole street is dark after 7 p.m. and it's super scary for women and children. We can't let our children go out after dark. Last week an elderly resident fell in the dark near the water tank. I've lived in this street for twenty years and my daughter's wedding was held in the temple at the end of the street.

I request you to arrange for the repair of the street lights as soon as possible. Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Your's Faithfully,
S. Arun

Corrected version:

25, Anna Street,
Fairlands,
Salem - 636 016

5 October 2026

To
The Commissioner,
Salem City Municipal Corporation,
Salem - 636 001

Subject: Complaint regarding non-functioning street lights in Anna Street, Fairlands

Dear Sir/Madam,

I wish to bring to your notice that the street lights in Anna Street have not been working for the past three weeks.

The whole street is dark after 7 p.m. and it is unsafe for women and children. We cannot let our children go out after dark. Last week an elderly resident fell in the dark near the water tank.

I request you to arrange for the repair of the street lights as soon as possible. Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Yours faithfully,
S. Arun

The 10 errors and their fixes:

1. **Date (11.10):** written only in numbers, with a two-digit year - ambiguous. **Fix:** 5 October 2026
2. **Receiver's address (11.9):** incomplete - no office name, no pin code, and a full stop at the end. **Fix:** The Commissioner, / Salem City Municipal Corporation, / Salem - 636 001
3. **Subject line (11.3):** missing. **Fix:** Subject: Complaint regarding non-functioning street lights in Anna Street, Fairlands
4. **Salutation (11.1):** "Dear" and "Respected" used together. **Fix:** Dear Sir/Madam, (the receiver is an official who is not named)
5. **Excessive wording (11.6):** a padded 21-word lead-in. **Fix:** I wish to bring to your notice that ... (8 words)
6. **Wrong tense (11.7):** present continuous with "since" + a period. **Fix:** have not been working for the past three weeks
7. **Contractions (11.11):** three short forms in a formal letter. **Fix:** it is, cannot (the third goes out with error 9)

8. **Slang (11.12):** a slang phrase for "very frightening"; it also mixes the tone (11.13). **Fix:** unsafe
9. **Unnecessary information (11.14):** years of residence and a family wedding have nothing to do with street lights. **Fix:** delete the sentence
10. **Complimentary close (11.2):** an apostrophe in "Yours" and a capital F. **Fix:** Yours faithfully,

EXAM TIP: Keep the last two minutes of every letter answer for a quick check: address lines and pin code, date in words, "To", subject, the salutation-close pair, three paragraphs, tenses, no contractions or slang, and the name below the close.

12

Formal vs Semi-formal vs Informal

Register = the level of formality of a letter. Decide it FIRST. The salutation, the close, the layout and the vocabulary all follow from it.

12.1 The high-yield comparison table **HIGH-FREQUENCY**

Feature	Formal	Semi-formal	Informal
A. The eight must-know features			
Receiver	Officials, offices, organisations, companies, banks, editors, unknown persons; superiors on official matters	People you know but are not close to: a teacher, neighbour, landlord or a friend's parent	Family members, relatives and close friends
Tone	Impersonal, polite, objective, to the point	Polite and respectful, but personal	Warm, friendly, conversational
Salutation	Dear Sir/Madam, / Sir, / Madam, (no name); Respected Sir, / Respected Madam, (superiors); Dear Mr. Raman, (a named person)	Dear Mr./Mrs./Ms./Dr. + surname, e.g. Dear Mr. Raman,	Dear Priya, / Dear Appa, / My dear Kavin,
Language	Standard formal English; formal words (request, inform, receive); no slang, SMS language or exclamation marks	Simple, courteous standard English; no slang	Everyday conversational English; personal news and feelings
Closing	Yours faithfully, (with Sir/Madam); Yours sincerely, (with a name)	Yours sincerely,	Your loving friend, / Your loving son, / Your loving daughter, / Yours affectionately, / With love,
Contractions	Never: I am, do not, cannot	Avoid them (safer in exams)	Allowed: I'm, can't, don't
Purpose	Official or business matters: applications, complaints, requests, orders, inquiries	Personal matters with people you know formally: thanks, apology, request, invitation, congratulations, condolence	Sharing news, feelings, invitations, advice and good wishes
Example	Complaint to the Commissioner about irregular garbage collection; leave letter to the Principal	Letter thanking your former teacher Mr. Raman for a recommendation letter; request to your landlord for repairs	Letter to your friend Priya about your holiday; letter to Appa asking for money for a school trip
B. Layout and extras			
Subject line	Compulsory (before the salutation in our layout)	Optional	Never
Receiver's address	Yes, after "To": designation, office, pin code	Yes: the receiver's name and address	No
Length	Short and to the point	Short to medium	Flexible; can be longer
Paragraphs	Usually three: why - what - what next (13.1)	Two to four short paragraphs	Free flow: greeting, news, good wishes
Sign-off name	Full name with initial (R. Karthik); designation for office letters; "ABC" / "XYZ" in exams if no name is given	Full name (R. Karthik)	First name only (Kavin)
Postscript (P.S.)	Avoid - put every point in the body	Rare; better avoided	Allowed for an afterthought (P.S. Say hello to Amma.)

DO NOT CONFUSE: A formal letter to a named person and a semi-formal letter both use "Dear Mr. Raman, ... Yours sincerely.". The difference is the PURPOSE: an official or business matter = formal; a personal matter with someone you know formally = semi-formal.

12.2 Decide the register in 10 seconds

Read the question and find the row that fits. The pair to use is given with each register.

Question to ask	If yes → register
Am I writing to an office, an official, a company, a bank or an editor - or to someone whose name I do not know?	Formal Dear Sir/Madam, (or Sir,) → Yours faithfully,
Is it an official or business matter, but the question names the receiver (e.g. Mr. Raman, the Sales Manager)?	Formal (named) Dear Mr. Raman, → Yours sincerely,
Am I a student or an employee asking my Principal or Head of Office for leave or permission?	Formal Respected Sir, / Respected Madam, → Yours faithfully, (students may also use Yours obediently,)
Is it an official matter (loan, admission, complaint) even though the receiver is my relative or friend?	Formal - the purpose decides. Write to the office, not to the person: Dear Sir/Madam, → Yours faithfully,
Am I writing about a personal matter to someone I know but am not close to (teacher, neighbour, landlord, a friend's parent)?	Semi-formal Dear Mr. Raman, → Yours sincerely,
Am I writing to a family member or a close friend about personal news?	Informal Dear Priya, / Dear Appa, → Your loving friend, / Your loving son,
Is one government officer writing personally to another to draw attention or speed up a matter?	Demi-official (D.O.) letter: Dear Shri Kumar, (Tamil Nadu: Dear Thiru Kumar,) → Yours sincerely, (see 13.8)
Is it a government communication between Ministries or Departments, or an order, circular or notice?	O.M. / Office Order / Circular / Notice: no salutation and no close (see Section 6)

12.3 Must-remember points

MUST REMEMBER: The salutation decides the close. No name (Sir/Madam) → Yours faithfully. A name (Dear Mr. Raman) → Yours sincerely. Family and friends → Your loving friend / Your loving son / Yours affectionately / With love.

MUST REMEMBER: Formal = receiver's address AND subject line, both compulsory. Semi-formal = receiver's name and address; subject optional. Informal = neither - only your short address and the date before "Dear Priya,".

MUST REMEMBER: Purpose and relationship decide the register, not the topic. Once chosen, keep ONE register from salutation to close: no contractions, slang or exclamation marks in a formal letter; no official phrases in a letter to a friend.

13 Letter-Writing Tricks

Short memory aids for the points examiners test most. Learn the trick, then check it against the table below it.

13.1 Letter structure: Why - What - What next

Every letter has a top (addresses, date, subject, salutation), a body and a bottom (close, name, Encl.). The top and bottom follow fixed patterns (13.2). The body is where most answers go wrong, so build it in three parts.

MEMORY TRICK: WHY - WHAT - WHAT NEXT. Paragraph 1 says WHY you are writing. The middle paragraph(s) give WHAT happened (the facts). The last paragraph says WHAT NEXT (the action you want). If a sentence answers none of the three, cut it.

Part	Question it answers	Useful starters	Example (street-light complaint)
Opening	WHY am I writing?	I wish to bring to your notice that ... / I am writing to apply for ... / With reference to your letter No. ... dated ...	I wish to bring to your notice that the street lights in Anna Street have not been working for three weeks.
Main (one or two paragraphs)	WHAT are the facts?	Dates, places, numbers, names; one idea per paragraph	The street is dark after 7 p.m. Last week an elderly resident fell in the dark near the water tank.
Closing	WHAT NEXT - what do I want?	I request you to ... / I would be grateful if you could ... / I look forward to your reply. / Thank you for your time.	I request you to arrange for the repair of the street lights as soon as possible.

The same trick works for informal letters: WHY = greeting and reason for writing (a reply, some news); WHAT = your news and feelings; WHAT NEXT = plans, good wishes and regards to the family.

EXAM TIP: Leave one blank line between paragraphs and do not indent (full block). Three clear paragraphs show planning before the examiner reads a word.

13.2 Formal letter sequence HIGH-FREQUENCY

MEMORY TRICK: S-D-R-S-S-B-C-S = "Sunday Dinner Remains Special - Sambar, Biryani, Curd, Sweet". Eight parts, top to bottom.

Letter	Trick word	Part of the letter	Model (/ = new line)
S	Sunday	Sender's address (no name)	12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai - 625 020
D	Dinner	Date	12 October 2026
R	Remains	Receiver's address	To / The Commissioner, / Madurai City Municipal Corporation, / Madurai - 625 001
S	Special	Subject	Subject: Complaint regarding irregular garbage collection in K.K. Nagar
S	Sambar	Salutation	Dear Sir/Madam,
B	Biryani	Body	Why - What - What next (13.1)
C	Curd	Complimentary close	Yours faithfully,
S	Sweet	Signature (name)	R. Karthik

Extras: a **Reference** line goes after the subject, only when you reply to earlier correspondence. **Encl.:** and **Copy to:** go below the name, only when needed.

MEMORY TRICK: Special comes before Sambar: the **Subject** comes before the **Salutation** in our layout. And your NAME is the last dish (Sweet), never the first - only your address goes at the top.

DO NOT CONFUSE: Two accepted variants exist. (1) In the traditional British / commerce-textbook layout, the subject comes AFTER the salutation. (2) The "From-To" format taught in many Tamil Nadu schools: "From" + your name and address, "To" + the receiver's address, salutation, subject, body, "Thanking you," then "Yours faithfully," and your name, with "Place:" and "Date:" at the bottom-left; school exams may also ask for the address on the envelope. Both are accepted. This book's model letters use the full-block S-D-R-S-S-B-C-S order; if a question asks for a particular format, follow the question.

13.3 Business transaction sequence

MEMORY TRICK: "Intelligent Queens Order Costly Diamonds; Delivery Includes Proper Receipts" = Inquiry, Quotation, Order, Confirmation, Dispatch, Delivery, Invoice, Payment, Receipt.

Step	Trick word	Letter or document	From → To	What it does
1	Intelligent	Inquiry	Buyer → Seller	Asks for prices, terms, a catalogue or samples
2	Queens	Quotation	Seller → Buyer	States prices, terms and conditions; valid for a stated period (firm offer)
3	Order	Order letter / Purchase Order (PO)	Buyer → Seller	Places the order; a PO is a formal numbered document
4	Costly	Confirmation (acceptance) of order	Seller → Buyer	Accepts the order and confirms the delivery date; once accepted, the PO is binding
5	Diamonds	Dispatch advice	Seller → Buyer	Says the goods have been sent; gives the LR / RR / B/L / AWB number
6	Delivery	Delivery	Seller (through the transporter) → Buyer	Goods arrive with a delivery challan; the buyer records them in a Goods Received Note (GRN)
7	Includes	Invoice (tax invoice)	Seller → Buyer	The bill: quantity, price, taxes, total and due date
8	Proper	Payment	Buyer → Seller	Pays by cheque or bank transfer, with a covering letter
9	Receipts	Receipt	Seller → Buyer	Acknowledges the payment

EXAM TIP: In real trade the invoice often travels with the goods or the dispatch advice; the trick gives the logical order. A **proforma invoice** is different: a preliminary bill sent BEFORE supply, for advance payment or import formalities.

EXAM TIP: Two side roads. Goods faulty → Complaint → Claim → Adjustment (13.7). Payment late → first reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer) → final notice (warns of legal action).

13.4 Salutations

MEMORY TRICK: Distance decides the salutation. FAR (an office, no name) → Sir/Madam. MIDDLE (you know the name but are not close) → Mr./Mrs./Dr. + surname. NEAR (friends, family) → first name or relation (Appa, Amma). ABOVE you (Principal, boss) → Respected Sir/Madam.

Receiver	Salutation	Close	Register
Unknown person, company or organisation	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Formal
Official by designation (Collector, Commissioner, Branch Manager)	Sir, / Madam, / Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Formal

Receiver	Salutation	Close	Register
Editor of a newspaper	Sir, / Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Formal
Principal or Head of Office (your superior)	Respected Sir, / Respected Madam,	Yours faithfully, (students may also use Yours obediently,)	Formal
Named official or business contact	Dear Mr. Raman,	Yours sincerely,	Formal
Teacher, neighbour, landlord, a friend's parent	Dear Mr. Raman, / Dear Mrs. Raman,	Yours sincerely,	Semi-formal
Friend	Dear Priya, / My dear Kavin,	Your loving friend, / With love,	Informal
Parents	Dear Appa, / Dear Amma,	Your loving son, / Your loving daughter,	Informal
Younger relative	My dear Kavin,	Yours affectionately,	Informal
Government officer to officer (D.O. letter)	Dear Shri Kumar, (Tamil Nadu: Dear Thiru Kumar,)	Yours sincerely,	Demi-official
O.M., Office Order, Order, Notification, government Circular, Notice, internal Memo	None	None	Official forms

DO NOT CONFUSE: "Dear" OR "Respected" - never both together. Put a comma after every salutation; the colon (Dear Sir:) is American business style, not used in Indian exams. "Sir" goes in the salutation, never in the receiver's address.

13.5 Complimentary closes HIGH-FREQUENCY

MEMORY TRICK: Faceless (Sir/Madam) → Faithfully; Surname (Dear Mr. Raman) → Sincerely; Family → Lovingly / Affectionately. F goes with F, S goes with S. "Lovingly" stands for the loving closes: Your loving son, / Your loving daughter, / Your loving friend, / With love,

DO NOT CONFUSE: Faceless and Family both begin with F, but only Faceless gets Faithfully. A letter to Appa or Priya never ends with "Yours faithfully".

Close	Goes with	Used for
Yours faithfully,	Dear Sir/Madam, / Sir, / Madam, / Respected Sir, / Respected Madam,	Officials, organisations, editors, unknown persons, superiors
Yours sincerely,	Dear Mr. Raman, / Dear Shri Kumar,	Named persons in formal letters, all semi-formal letters, D.O. letters
Yours obediently,	Respected Sir, / Respected Madam,	Traditional: school students writing to the Principal
Your loving son, / Your loving daughter,	Dear Appa, / Dear Amma,	Parents
Your loving friend, / With love,	Dear Priya,	Friends
Yours affectionately,	My dear Kavin,	Family, especially elders writing to younger relatives
No close	No salutation	O.M., Office Order, Order, Notification, government Circular, Notice, internal Memo

MUST REMEMBER: Format of the close: capital first letter only, no apostrophe, a comma at the end, and the name on the next line (Yours faithfully, / R. Karthik). Variants you may see but should not use in model answers: "Sincerely yours," and "Sincerely," (American business), "Yours truly," (formal, also seen in letters to the editor).

EXAM TIP: "Thanking you," on a line of its own before the close is accepted Indian usage. The better modern style is a sentence inside the last paragraph: "Thank you for your time." Avoid "Thanking you in anticipation" - it is dated and presumes the answer.

13.6 Formal vocabulary

MEMORY TRICK: Upgrade the verb. In a formal letter, swap the everyday word for its formal partner: get → receive, ask → request, tell → inform. Keep the sentence short - only the word changes.

Informal word	Formal word	Example
get	receive / obtain	We received your quotation dated 2 October 2026.
ask	request / inquire	I request you to issue a duplicate hall ticket.
tell	inform	I wish to inform you that the goods have been dispatched.
need	require	We require 200 reams of A4 paper.
help	assist	Kindly assist us in tracing the missing parcel.
buy	purchase	We wish to purchase ten desktop computers.

Informal word	Formal word	Example
give	provide	Please provide details of your delivery terms.
start	commence	The work will commence on 1 November 2026.
end	conclude	The training programme will conclude on 30 October 2026.
sorry	regret	We regret the inconvenience caused to you.
check	verify	Please verify the entries in my passbook.
fix	rectify / repair	Please rectify the error in my electricity bill.
send	forward / dispatch	I am forwarding my application through proper channel.
about	regarding / concerning	Subject: Complaint regarding delay in delivery
enough	sufficient	The present stock is not sufficient to meet the demand.
try	endeavour / attempt	We shall endeavour to deliver the goods by Friday.
answer	reply / respond	I look forward to your reply.
find out	ascertain	Please ascertain the cause of the delay.
put off	postpone	The meeting has been postponed to 20 October 2026.
keep	retain	Please retain a copy for your records.
mistake	error	We regret the error in our invoice.
money back	refund	Please refund the amount of Rs. 2,500.
job	post / position	I wish to apply for the post of Junior Assistant.
a lot of	many / a large number of	A large number of residents have complained.

13.7 Inquiry vs quotation vs order vs complaint vs claim vs adjustment HIGH-FREQUENCY

MEMORY TRICK: ASK → PRICE → BUY → GRUMBLE → GET PAID → PUT RIGHT. The two P-words, PRICE and PUT RIGHT, are the seller's letters (P = the Provider). The other four come from the buyer.

Letter	Who writes	Trick word	Meaning
Inquiry (enquiry)	Buyer	ASK	Asks for information: prices, terms, a catalogue or samples. "Inquiry letter" and "enquiry letter" are both accepted.
Quotation	Seller	PRICE	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions, sent in reply to an inquiry (before the order). It has a validity period (firm offer).
Order	Buyer	BUY	A letter placing an order. A Purchase Order (PO) is a formal numbered document issued by the buyer; it is binding once the seller accepts it.
Complaint	Buyer	GRUMBLE	Reports a problem: defect, delay, shortage or wrong goods.
Claim	Buyer	GET PAID	Demands a specific remedy or compensation: refund, replacement or price reduction.
Adjustment	Seller	PUT RIGHT	The seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim: full grant, partial grant, or a polite refusal with reasons.

DO NOT CONFUSE: A COMPLAINT only reports the problem; a CLAIM asks for a specific remedy. An ADJUSTMENT letter is written by the SELLER, never by the buyer. A QUOTATION is a firm price; an ESTIMATE is an approximate cost; a TENDER is a formal (often sealed) offer made in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies. More pairs: see Section 15.

EXAM TIP: Spelling: in the British tradition "enquiry" means asking for information and "inquiry" means a formal investigation; American English uses "inquiry" for both. Either spelling is accepted for the letter - use one consistently.

13.8 Government forms tricks

Full formats are in Section 6. These tricks fix the salutation, the close and the key phrase of each form.

Form	Memory trick	Salutation → Close	Key features and use
Official letter	"I am Directed" = Official	Sir, / Madam, → Yours faithfully,	From a Government office to other governments, bodies, officials or the public; begins "I am directed to ..."; signed with designation
Demi-official (D.O.) letter	D.O. = Dear Officer → sincerely	Dear Shri Kumar, (Tamil Nadu: Dear Thiru Kumar,) → Yours sincerely,	Officer to officer; personal, friendly tone; first person singular; to draw personal attention, expedite a matter or exchange views; D.O. No. at the top
Office Memorandum (O.M.)	O.M. = Other Ministry, third person, no salutation	None → None	Between Ministries / Departments (also with attached offices and employees); "The undersigned is directed to ..."; signed with name and designation

Form	Memory trick	Salutation → Close	Key features and use
Office Order	Office Order stays inside the Office	None → None	Internal administrative instructions: distribution of work, grant of leave, postings within the office
Order	Order = M & M: Money and Misconduct	None → None	Financial sanctions, disciplinary matters, etc.
Notification	Notification = in the Gazette	None → None	Publication of rules, orders, appointments, promotions, etc. in the Official Gazette
Resolution	Resolution Resolves policy (also in the Gazette)	None → None	Public announcement of important policy decisions or the appointment of committees or commissions; published in the Gazette
Circular	A Circular goes round in a circle	None → None	The same information sent to many offices or persons
Endorsement	ENDorsement = at the END	Not a letter	Government: a note at the foot of a communication forwarding copies ("Copy forwarded to ... for information / necessary action") or returning a paper to the sender. Banking: a signature on the back of a cheque or other negotiable instrument to transfer it.

MEMORY TRICK: "I am directed" (first person) = **Official letter**. "The undersigned is directed" (third person) = **O.M.**

MEMORY TRICK: Both go to the Gazette, but a **Notification** Names people and rules (appointments, promotions, rules), while a **Resolution** Resolves policy (policy decisions, committees, commissions).

MEMORY TRICK: Tamil Nadu: **G.O.** (Government Order) comes from the Government - the Secretariat departments. **Proceedings** come from Heads of Departments and District officers: "Proceedings of the District Collector, ... Present: Thiru ..., Rc. No. ..., Dated ..., Sub: ..., Ref: ..., ORDER: ...".

MEMORY TRICK: Honorifics: Shri - Smt. - Kumari (Central Government) = Thiru - Thirumathi (Tmt.) - Selvi (Tamil Nadu Government) = Mr. - Mrs. - Miss. "Hon'ble" for Ministers and judges; "M/s." (Messrs) for firms, e.g. M/s. Kaveri Traders.

MUST REMEMBER: Only two government forms carry a salutation and a close: the official letter (Sir → Yours faithfully) and the D.O. letter (Dear Shri Kumar → Yours sincerely). "Through proper channel" = an employee's application to a higher authority goes through the immediate superior, with a "Through: ..." line above or below the addressee.

13.9 One-page cheat card

Situation	Salutation	Close	Key opening phrase
Leave or permission from the Principal / Head of Office	Respected Sir, / Respected Madam,	Yours faithfully, (students: Yours obediently,)	I request you to grant me leave for two days, from ... to ..., as ...
Complaint to a civic authority (Commissioner, Collector, Police)	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	I wish to bring to your notice that ...
Letter to the Editor	Sir, / Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Through the columns of your newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities concerned to ...
Job application	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated ..., I wish to apply for the post of ...
Inquiry or order to a firm	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Please send us your latest price list and terms for ... / Please supply the following items as per your quotation No. ... dated ...
Complaint or claim to a seller	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	We regret to inform you that the goods received against our Order No. ... dated ... are damaged.
Request to your bank (cheque book, stop-payment, change of address)	Dear Sir/Madam, (to the Branch Manager)	Yours faithfully,	I hold a savings account (No. XXXXXXXX4521) in your branch and request you to ...
Government official letter	Sir, / Madam,	Yours faithfully,	I am directed to ...
Named person, semi-formal (teacher, neighbour, landlord)	Dear Mr. Raman,	Yours sincerely,	I am writing to thank you for ...
Friend or family	Dear Priya, / Dear Appa,	Your loving friend, / Your loving son,	I was very happy to receive your letter. / I hope you are all keeping well.

D.O. and O.M. patterns: see 13.8. No name or address in the question? Write "Examination Hall" and sign as "ABC" (11.9).

This section shows **how** letter writing is examined in TNPSC, SSC, banking and UPSC-type exams: the objective (MCQ) angle, the descriptive angle, the areas asked most often, ten question patterns with worked examples, and a step-by-step strategy for writing a full letter in the exam hall. The detailed content is in the earlier sections; the "Revise in" column tells you where to go.

14.1 How Letter Writing Is Tested

Letter writing is tested in two ways. **Objective (MCQ) questions** ask you to recognise the correct form, term, phrase or order. **Descriptive questions** ask you to write a complete letter in the correct format, tone and length. The same rules serve both: if you know the format well, you can answer the MCQ and also write the letter.

Exam type	Objective (MCQ) angle	Descriptive angle
TNPSC (Group 1, 2, 2A, 4)	Where the paper has an English or language component: correct salutation and close, parts of a letter and their order, types of letters, formal phrases, vocabulary and error spotting. Terms such as G.O., O.M., D.O. letter and Notification also help in administration-related questions.	Main (descriptive) papers may include official letter writing, precis or similar writing tasks, in English or Tamil as the notification specifies. Format, tone and relevance all matter.
SSC exams	English language questions: vocabulary, spelling, idioms, error spotting, sentence improvement and cloze tests. Letter words and phrases ("stationery", "with reference to", "look forward to hearing") appear inside these question forms.	Some SSC exams have included a descriptive paper (essay, letter or application) in some years. Check whether the current pattern has one.
Banking and insurance exams	English language: error detection, fill in the blanks, cloze test and sentence rearrangement; banking and business vocabulary (cheque, draft, credit note, Letter of Credit, stop-payment).	Officer-level main exams may include a descriptive test with a letter (complaint, request or formal letter to a bank, company or authority) and an essay.
UPSC and other central exams	English sections of objective exams: vocabulary, usage, error spotting and sentence arrangement.	Descriptive English papers test writing skills such as precis, short essays and usage; the formal tone and clear structure learnt in letter writing apply directly. Official-correspondence terms help in governance topics.
Departmental and promotion tests	Office procedure terms: Office Memorandum, Office Order, Notification, Endorsement, Proceedings, "through proper channel".	Noting and drafting: an official letter, D.O. letter, O.M., circular or office order written in the correct form.

MUST REMEMBER: Always check the latest official notification and syllabus.

14.2 Most Commonly Tested Areas

These areas appear again and again across exams. The example stems are PYQ-style illustrations, not actual previous-year questions.

Area	What is asked	Example stem	Revise in (Section N)
Salutation and complimentary close HIGH-FREQUENCY	The correct pair for a given receiver; capital letters and commas	"Which close follows 'Dear Sir/Madam,?'"	Sections 1, 12
Parts of a letter and their order HIGH-FREQUENCY	Name, position and order of each part	"Where is the subject line placed in a formal letter?"	Sections 1, 9
Types of letters HIGH-FREQUENCY	Identify the type from the writer, the receiver and the purpose	"A seller's reply that settles a buyer's complaint is called a/an ____ letter."	Sections 2, 3
Register and tone	Formal, semi-formal or informal for a given situation	"A letter to your neighbour, Mr. Raman, about his car blocking your gate is ____."	Section 12
Formal phrases	The correct, modern phrase for a given purpose	"Choose the modern form of 'Please find enclosed herewith'."	Section 8
Common errors and outdated expressions	Spot the error and give the correct form	"Spot the error: 'Kindly revert back at the earliest.'"	Section 11
Terminology and abbreviations	Meaning of Encl., CC, Ref., P.S., M/s., E&OE	"'Encl.' at the foot of a letter means ____."	Section 7
Government correspondence HIGH-FREQUENCY	Features of the official letter, D.O. letter, O.M., Office Order, Notification, Resolution and Circular	"Which communication is written in the third person and has no salutation?"	Section 6
Business and transactional letters	Inquiry, quotation, order, invoice, complaint, claim, adjustment, credit note and debit note	"A seller's statement of prices and terms sent in reply to an inquiry is a ____."	Sections 3, 5
Banking letters and terms	Stop-payment, cheque dishonour, Letter of Credit, bank reference, credit and debit advice	"An account holder's instruction to the bank not to pay a cheque is called ____."	Section 4

Area	What is asked	Example stem	Revise in (Section N)
Grammar inside letter sentences	Prepositions, gerunds, tenses and articles in fixed phrases	"I look forward to ____ from you. (hear / hearing)"	Sections 8, 11
Full letter (descriptive)	A complete letter in the correct format and tone, within the word limit	"Write a letter to the Commissioner complaining about irregular garbage collection in your area."	Sections 9, 10 and 14.7

14.3 Important Definitions

Term	One-line definition
Formal letter	A letter to an official, an organisation or an unknown person for an official or business purpose, in a fixed format and formal language.
Semi-formal letter	A letter to a known person (teacher, neighbour, landlord) on a personal or partly official matter; polite but personal: "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,".
Informal letter	A personal letter to family or friends in a friendly tone; no subject line and no receiver's address.
Salutation	The greeting that begins the letter, e.g. "Dear Sir/Madam,"; always followed by a comma.
Complimentary close	The polite closing phrase written before the signature, e.g. "Yours faithfully,".
Subject line	A short noun phrase that states the purpose; begins "Subject:," comes before the salutation and has no full stop.
Enclosure (Encl.)	A document sent with the letter, listed below the signature, e.g. "Encl.: 1. Copy of the bill".
Official letter	A letter from a Government office to other governments, bodies, officials or the public; begins "I am directed to ..."; signed with designation.
Demi-official (D.O.) letter	An officer-to-officer letter in a personal, friendly tone and the first person, used to draw personal attention, expedite a matter, or exchange views or information.
Office Memorandum (O.M.)	A communication between Ministries/Departments (also with attached offices and employees), written in the third person, with no salutation and no close.
Notification	Publication of rules, orders, appointments, promotions, etc. in the Official Gazette.
Circular	The same information sent to many offices or persons.
Quotation	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions, sent in reply to an inquiry and valid for a stated period.
Adjustment letter	The seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim: full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons.
Letter of Credit (L/C)	A bank's written undertaking, issued at the buyer's request, to pay the seller when specified documents are presented; used mainly in foreign trade.

14.4 Frequently Confused Terms

One line per pair for quick recall. Full comparison tables are in Section 15.

- **Yours faithfully vs Yours sincerely** - "Yours faithfully," follows "Dear Sir/Madam," / "Sir," / "Respected Sir,"; "Yours sincerely," follows a named person ("Dear Mr. Raman,") and is used in D.O. letters.
- **Enquiry vs Inquiry** - British tradition: enquiry = asking for information, inquiry = formal investigation; American English uses "inquiry" for both; "inquiry letter" and "enquiry letter" are both accepted.
- **Quotation vs Estimate** - a quotation gives firm prices and terms with a validity period; an estimate gives only an approximate cost.
- **Quotation vs Tender** - a quotation is the seller's reply to a buyer's inquiry; a tender is a formal (often sealed) offer in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies.
- **Complaint letter vs Claim letter** - a complaint reports a problem (defect, delay, shortage, wrong goods); a claim demands a specific remedy (refund, replacement, price reduction).
- **Claim letter vs Adjustment letter** - the buyer writes the claim; the seller writes the adjustment letter that settles it.
- **Credit note vs Debit note** - a credit note is issued by the seller and reduces what the buyer owes; a debit note is issued by the buyer when returning goods or claiming a deduction (a seller may also send one for an undercharge).
- **Proforma invoice vs Invoice** - a proforma invoice is a preliminary bill sent before supply; an invoice is the bill for goods actually supplied.
- **Letter of Credit vs Credit letter** - an L/C is a bank's undertaking to pay the seller against specified documents; a credit letter is a business letter about credit (opening a credit account, status inquiry, granting or refusing credit).

- **Official letter vs D.O. letter** - official: "Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully," begins "I am directed to ..."; D.O.: "Dear Shri Kumar," → "Yours sincerely," personal tone, first person.
- **Office Memorandum vs Office Order** - an O.M. passes between Ministries/Departments in the third person; an Office Order gives internal instructions within an office (distribution of work, leave, postings).
- **Notification vs Resolution** - a notification publishes rules, orders, appointments and promotions in the Gazette; a resolution announces important policy decisions or the appointment of committees or commissions (also in the Gazette).
- **Endorsement (government) vs Endorsement (banking)** - government: a note at the foot of a communication forwarding copies ("Copy forwarded to ... for information") or returning a paper; banking: a signature on the back of a cheque to transfer it.
- **Complimentary vs Complementary** - complimentary (as in "complimentary close") = polite, expressing respect; complementary = completing something.
- **Stationery vs Stationary** - stationery = paper, envelopes and other writing materials; stationary = not moving.

MEMORY TRICK: stationEry - E for Envelopes; compllment - I say something polite; Credit note - Cuts what the buyer owes.

14.5 One-Word Distinctions

Description	One word
A letter sent to many people with the same content	Circular
The closing phrase before the signature	Complimentary close
A document added at the end of a report and referred to in it	Annexure
The greeting at the beginning of a letter	Salutation
A document sent along with a letter	Enclosure
A short note added below the signature, beginning "P.S."	Postscript
The person to whom a letter is addressed	Addressee
The level of formality of the language in a letter	Register
Publication of rules, orders or appointments in the Official Gazette	Notification
A public announcement of an important policy decision, published in the Gazette	Resolution
A formal, often sealed, offer made in response to an invitation, usually from a public body	Tender
The seller's statement of prices and terms sent in reply to an inquiry	Quotation
A preliminary bill sent before the goods are supplied	Proforma invoice
A document issued by the seller that reduces the amount the buyer owes	Credit note
A signature on the back of a cheque to transfer it	Endorsement
An account holder's instruction to the bank not to pay a particular cheque	Stop-payment
The person who writes and signs a cheque	Drawer
The person named on a cheque to receive the money	Payee
Paper, envelopes and other writing materials	Stationery
The title written before the name of a firm (___ Kaveri Traders)	Messrs (M/s.)

14.6 Question Patterns with Worked Examples

All 20 questions below are PYQ-style: written in the style of exam questions for practice. They are NOT actual previous-year questions. For each pattern, read the "How to attack" line first, try the two questions, then open the answer.

Pattern 1: Match the following

How to attack: Fix the one or two pairs you are surest of, then strike out every option that contradicts them; usually only one option survives.

PQ1. (PYQ-style) Match List I (communication) with List II (feature) and choose the correct code.

List I	List II
A. Office Memorandum	1. Published in the Official Gazette
B. Demi-official letter	2. Same information sent to many offices or persons
C. Notification	3. Third person; no salutation and no close
D. Circular	4. Personal tone; "Dear Shri Kumar," and "Yours sincerely,"

- a. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
- b. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
- c. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
- d. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2

Answer: (c) - O.M. = third person with no salutation or close; D.O. = personal tone; Notification = Gazette; Circular = same information to many.

PQ2. (PYQ-style) Match List I (document) with List II (description) and choose the correct code.

List I	List II
A. Quotation	1. Formal numbered document issued by the buyer to place an order
B. Purchase Order	2. Seller's statement of prices and terms in reply to an inquiry
C. Credit note	3. Bank's undertaking to pay the seller against specified documents
D. Letter of Credit	4. Issued by the seller; reduces the amount the buyer owes

- a. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
- b. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
- c. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
- d. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

Answer: (b) - the seller quotes, the buyer issues the PO, the seller issues the credit note, and the bank gives the L/C undertaking.

Pattern 2: Fill in the blanks

How to attack: Read the whole sentence, decide what the blank needs (preposition, verb form or noun), then check that the completed sentence is formal and idiomatic.

PQ3. (PYQ-style) Fill in the blank: "I look forward to _____ from you."

- a. hear
- b. heard
- c. have heard
- d. hearing

Answer: (d) - in "look forward to", "to" is a preposition, so it takes the -ing form: "look forward to hearing".

PQ4. (PYQ-style) Fill in the blank: "With reference _____ your letter No. 245 dated 5 October 2026, we wish to inform you that the goods have been dispatched."

- a. of
- b. for
- c. to
- d. about

Answer: (c) - the fixed phrase is "with reference to".

Pattern 3: Sentence correction

How to attack: Check the usual suspects in order: redundant or outdated words ("revert back", "herewith"), tense with time words ("since" / "for"), the verb form after fixed phrases, and informal words; the answer must be both correct and formal.

PQ5. (PYQ-style) Choose the correct and most formal version of: "Kindly revert back at your earliest convenience."

- a. Please reply at your earliest convenience.
- b. Kindly revert back to us at your earliest convenience.
- c. Please revert back soon.
- d. Kindly revert back with the same at your earliest convenience.

Answer: (a) - "revert back" is redundant and outdated; use "reply" or "respond". "The same" used as a pronoun is also outdated.

PQ6. (PYQ-style) Choose the correct replacement for the part in bold: "The road in our street **is not repaired since two years.**"

- a. was not repaired since two years
- b. is not being repaired for two years
- c. has not been repaired for two years
- d. has not been repaired since two years

Answer: (c) - an action continuing up to now needs the present perfect; "for" goes with a period (two years), "since" with a point of time (since 2024).

Pattern 4: Choose the correct phrase

How to attack: Prefer the short, modern, polite form; reject redundant words ("herewith"), dated expressions ("do the needful", "the same" as a pronoun) and anything informal.

PQ7. (PYQ-style) Which is the most appropriate modern replacement for the outdated request "Please do the needful"?

- a. Kindly do the needful at the earliest.
- b. Do whatever is needful.
- c. Please do the needful immediately.
- d. Please take the necessary action.

Answer: (d) - "do the needful" is outdated Indian office usage; "take the necessary action" is the clear modern form.

PQ8. (PYQ-style) Choose the best sentence to mention an enclosure in a formal letter.

- a. Please find enclosed herewith the bill.
- b. I enclose a copy of the bill.
- c. Enclosed herewith please find the same.
- d. The bill is enclosed herewith for your needful.

Answer: (b) - "I enclose" (or "Please find enclosed") is modern; "herewith" is redundant, and "the same" as a pronoun and "needful" are outdated.

Pattern 5: Identify the type of letter

How to attack: Ask three questions - who writes, to whom, and why; the purpose word (ask, quote, order, complain, claim, settle, remind) usually names the letter.

PQ9. (PYQ-style) A stationery shop in Salem writes to a paper mill asking for its latest price list, trade discount and delivery terms. This letter is a/an:

- a. Inquiry letter
- b. Order letter
- c. Quotation
- d. Adjustment letter

Answer: (a) - asking for information on prices and terms is an inquiry (enquiry) letter; the mill's reply with prices will be the quotation.

PQ10. (PYQ-style) A company replies to a customer's complaint about damaged goods, apologises and agrees to replace the goods free of cost. This reply is a/an:

- a. Claim letter
- b. Complaint letter
- c. Adjustment letter
- d. Collection letter

Answer: (c) - the seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim is an adjustment letter.

Pattern 6: Identify the appropriate salutation

How to attack: Decide the relationship first: unknown person or office → "Dear Sir/Madam,"; named person → "Dear Mr. Raman,"; family or friend → "Dear Priya,"; officer to officer (D.O.) → "Dear Shri Kumar,".

PQ11. (PYQ-style) You are writing to the Editor of a newspaper about the poor condition of a public park. The most appropriate salutation is:

- a. Hi Editor,
- b. My dear Editor,
- c. Dear Editor Sir,
- d. Dear Sir/Madam,

Answer: (d) - an editor is addressed "Dear Sir/Madam," (or "Sir,"), and the letter closes with "Yours faithfully,".

PQ12. (PYQ-style) A Deputy Secretary writes a demi-official letter to Thiru R. Kumar, Joint Director, asking him to expedite a pending file. The correct salutation is:

- a. Sir,
- b. Dear Thiru Kumar,
- c. Respected Sir,
- d. Dear Sir/Madam,

Answer: (b) - a D.O. letter uses honorific + name ("Dear Shri Kumar," in Central usage, "Dear Thiru Kumar," in Tamil Nadu) and closes with "Yours sincerely,".

Pattern 7: Identify the appropriate complimentary close

How to attack: Read the salutation, then pair it: Sir/Madam forms → "Yours faithfully,"; named person or D.O. letter → "Yours sincerely,"; family and friends → "Your loving ..."; O.M., Office Order, Notification and government Circular have no close at all.

PQ13. (PYQ-style) A formal letter begins "Dear Mr. Raman,". The correct complimentary close is:

- a. Yours sincerely,
- b. Yours faithfully,
- c. Your loving friend,
- d. Yours affectionately,

Answer: (a) - a named person takes "Yours sincerely,"; "Yours faithfully," follows "Dear Sir/Madam,".

PQ14. (PYQ-style) A student writes a leave letter to the Principal beginning "Respected Sir,". The correct complimentary close is:

- a. With love,
- b. Yours affectionately,
- c. Yours faithfully,
- d. Your loving student,

Answer: (c) - "Respected Sir," pairs with "Yours faithfully,"; school students may also use the traditional "Yours obediently,".

Pattern 8: Arrange the parts of a letter

How to attack: Fix the first and the last parts, then fill the middle in the fixed order: date → receiver's address → subject → salutation → body → close.

PQ15. (PYQ-style) Arrange these parts of a formal letter (full-block format, as used in this book) in the correct order. They come after the sender's address: **P** Salutation; **Q** Date; **R** Subject; **S** Receiver's address; **T** Complimentary close.

- a. S Q R P T
- b. Q R S P T
- c. R Q S P T
- d. Q S R P T

Answer: (d) - date → receiver's address → subject → salutation → (body) → close; the older British layout that puts the subject after the salutation is an accepted variant.

PQ16. (PYQ-style) Arrange the parts of an informal letter in the correct order: **P** Body; **Q** Salutation; **R** Sender's address; **S** Date; **T** Close and first name.

- a. R S Q P T
- b. R Q S P T
- c. S R Q P T
- d. R S P Q T

Answer: (a) - sender's address (short) → date → salutation → body → close → first name; an informal letter has no subject line and no receiver's address.

Pattern 9: Vocabulary-based

How to attack: Watch for look-alike spellings (stationery / stationary, complimentary / complementary, principal / principle) and choose the meaning that fits the letter context, not just any dictionary meaning.

PQ17. (PYQ-style) Choose the correctly spelt word: "Please send us your catalogue of office _____."

- a. stationary
- b. stationery
- c. stationarie
- d. stationery's

Answer: (b) - stationery = paper, envelopes and writing materials; stationary = not moving.

PQ18. (PYQ-style) In the term "complimentary close", the word "complimentary" means:

- a. completing or making whole
- b. free of charge
- c. final or concluding
- d. polite; expressing respect

Answer: (d) - it comes from "compliment" (a polite expression); "complementary" (with e) means completing. "Free of charge" is another meaning of the word, but not the meaning here.

Pattern 10: Statement-based ("Which of the following statements is/are correct?")

How to attack: Judge each statement alone as true or false, then pick the option; a single wrong word (buyer for seller, faithfully for sincerely, first person for third person) makes the whole statement false.

PQ19. (PYQ-style) Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1. An Office Memorandum is written in the third person and has no salutation.
 - 2. A demi-official letter ends with "Yours faithfully,".
 - 3. A Notification publishes rules, orders or appointments in the Official Gazette.
- a. 1 and 2 only
 - b. 1 and 3 only
 - c. 2 and 3 only
 - d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) - statement 2 is wrong: a D.O. letter ends with "Yours sincerely,".

PQ20. (PYQ-style) Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1. "Yours faithfully," is the correct close for a letter beginning "Dear Mr. Raman,".
 - 2. The subject line of a formal letter is a short phrase and does not end with a full stop.
 - 3. Contractions such as "don't" and "can't" should be avoided in formal letters.
- a. 2 and 3 only
 - b. 1 and 2 only
 - c. 1 and 3 only
 - d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) - statement 1 is wrong: a letter to a named person closes with "Yours sincerely,".

14.7 Strategy for Descriptive Letter Questions

A descriptive letter is marked on format, content, language and length together. A good plan and a quick final check protect marks that are otherwise lost to small slips.

Time plan

The time you can give a letter depends on the paper. Whatever it is, split it roughly in this ratio. The 20-minute column is only an example.

Stage	Share of time	Example: 20-minute letter	What you do
Plan	About 15%	3 minutes	Read the question; note who you are, the receiver, the purpose and the word limit; choose the register and the salutation-close pair; jot 3-4 content points.
Write	About 70%	14 minutes	Write the format lines, then the opening, main and closing paragraphs, all in full-block form.
Check	About 15%	3 minutes	Run the 10-point checklist below; correct spelling, tense, punctuation and word count.

Plan - Write - Check: step by step

1. **Plan:** Underline the key facts in the question - your role, the receiver, the problem or purpose, dates, places and the word limit.
2. **Plan:** Decide the register: official or unknown receiver = formal; known person (not close) on a personal or partly official matter = semi-formal; family or friend = informal.
3. **Plan:** Fix the salutation-close pair and your identity. If the question gives no name or address, use "Examination Hall" as the address and sign as "ABC"; if it gives them, use exactly those.
4. **Plan:** Jot 3-4 content points in the order you will use them: purpose, facts, effect, request.
5. **Write:** Format lines first, every line at the left margin: address, date, "To", receiver's designation and address, subject, salutation.
6. **Write:** Opening paragraph - one or two sentences stating why you are writing.
7. **Write:** Main paragraph(s) - facts in logical order: what happened, when, where, and its effect.
8. **Write:** Closing paragraph - the exact action you want, ending with a polite sentence such as "Thank you for your time." inside the same paragraph.
9. **Write:** Complimentary close and name, then "Encl.:" or "Copy to:" only if needed.
10. **Check:** Run the 10-point checklist below. Correct a mistake neatly with a single line through the word; do not overwrite.

Handling the word limit

- Follow the instruction exactly. If the question says "not exceeding 150 words", stay within 150.
- If the question does not say whether the address, date and other format lines are counted, keep the **body** close to the limit and still write all the format lines in full.
- Budget by paragraph. For a 150-word body: opening about 25 words, main paragraph(s) about 95 words, closing about 30 words.
- Count quickly: count the words in three lines of your handwriting, take the average per line and multiply by the number of lines.
- Too short: add a relevant fact (a date, a place, the effect on people, a specific request) - never filler sentences.
- Too long: cut repeated points, long greetings and background stories; keep the facts and the request.
- Do not drop any format part to save words; the format is part of the answer.

10-point format checklist (run it before moving on)

1. Sender's address at the top-left (or "Examination Hall"); no name at the top.
2. Date written as "12 October 2026".
3. "To" on its own line, then the receiver's designation and full address, with the pin code written as "Madurai - 625 001".
4. "Subject:" + a short noun phrase, placed before the salutation, with no full stop.
5. "Reference:" line only if you are replying to earlier correspondence.

6. Salutation suits the receiver and ends with a comma; never combine "Dear" and "Respected" in one salutation.
7. Body in three parts - purpose → details → request or action - and on one purpose only.
8. Close pairs with the salutation ("Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"; "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,"): capital Y, small f or s, no apostrophe, comma after.
9. Name below the close ("ABC" if no name is given), designation where relevant, and "Encl.:" or "Copy to:" only if needed.
10. Language: no contractions, slang, exclamation marks or outdated phrases; names, designations, figures and word count checked.

MUST REMEMBER: Plan → Write → Check; the salutation decides the close; the question decides your identity - never write your real name or address in an exam answer.



High-Yield Differences

Each pair below is compared in a Basis table and ends with one memory trick. The ten pairs marked **HIGH-FREQUENCY** should be revised first. 15.22 puts all 21 pairs in one table for last-minute revision. Related sections: business and transactional letters - Sections 3 and 5; banking letters - Section 4; government forms - Section 6; formal, semi-formal and informal letters in full - Section 12.

How to write a "distinguish between" answer: give a one-line definition of each term; then write 4 to 6 points of difference, each point on the SAME basis for both terms (meaning, sender, receiver, stage, purpose, format, effect); end with one example of each. A two-column table is the clearest layout. For a short answer, the one-line difference in 15.22 is enough.

15.1 Inquiry vs Enquiry **HIGH-FREQUENCY**

Basis	Inquiry	Enquiry
Meaning (British tradition)	A formal investigation into a matter, usually ordered by an authority; serious and official - it may end in findings, a report or punishment	Asking for information; a simple, routine question with no official consequence
Common phrases	order / hold / conduct an inquiry; an inquiry into the matter; an inquiry report	make an enquiry; reply to an enquiry; "Thank you for your enquiry of 5 October 2026."
Who makes it	A court, commission, committee, the police or a government department	Anyone - a customer, buyer, student or traveller who wants to know something
Verb	<i>inquire into</i> = investigate: "The committee will inquire into the accident."	<i>enquire about</i> = ask about: "She enquired about the train timings."
American English	"Inquiry" is used for BOTH meanings	Rare - "enquiry" is chiefly British
Examples	A judicial inquiry into a fire accident; a Commission of Inquiry; a departmental inquiry against an officer	A price enquiry to a supplier; an enquiry about admission; the enquiry counter at a railway station
In letter writing	"Inquiry letter" - accepted; this book uses it	"Enquiry letter" - equally accepted (British and Indian usage)

MEMORY TRICK: Inquiry = INvestigation; Enquiry = Everyday asking - but "inquiry letter" and "enquiry letter" are both correct.

15.2 Inquiry letter vs Quotation letter

Basis	Inquiry letter	Quotation letter
Meaning	A letter asking a supplier for information - price list, catalogue, samples, discount, delivery and payment terms	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions for the goods asked about
Written by → sent to	Prospective buyer (a trader, institution or individual) → manufacturer, wholesaler or other seller	Seller → prospective buyer
Stage	First step of a business deal	Second step - sent in reply to the inquiry, before the order
Purpose	To collect information and compare suppliers before buying	To offer the goods clearly and attractively and win the order
Main contents	Goods needed, approximate quantity, date required, questions on price, discount, delivery and payment terms; a request for a catalogue or samples	Price per unit, trade discount, cash discount, taxes, packing and delivery terms (Ex-works, FOR, FOB, CIF), payment terms, delivery period, validity period
Effect	No commitment on either side - the buyer is not bound to buy	A firm offer - the seller commits to the quoted prices for the validity period; the buyer is still free not to order

Basis	Inquiry letter	Quotation letter
Example line	"Please send us your latest price list for A4 notebooks and your terms of payment."	"We quote Rs. 45 per notebook, less 10% trade discount. This quotation is valid for 30 days."

MEMORY TRICK: I comes before Q - the buyer's Inquiry asks, the seller's Quotation answers.

15.3 Quotation vs Invoice HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Quotation	Invoice
Meaning	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions offered to a prospective buyer	The bill issued by the seller for goods supplied (or services rendered)
Stage	BEFORE the order - in reply to an inquiry	AFTER the order - when the goods are supplied or dispatched (it often travels with the goods or follows by post or e-mail)
Issued by → to	Seller → prospective buyer	Seller → buyer (customer)
Purpose	To offer goods and win the order	To state the amount due and ask for payment; it is also the seller's record of the sale and the buyer's proof of purchase
Main contents	Prices, discounts, taxes, delivery and payment terms, validity period	Invoice number and date, names and addresses of seller and buyer (with GSTIN), description, quantity, rate, taxes, total amount, due date; often "E&OE" (Errors and Omissions Excepted)
Financial effect	Nothing is payable; the buyer may accept it or ignore it	Payment becomes due by the stated due date; both parties enter it in their accounts
Related terms	Estimate = approximate cost; Tender = formal (often sealed) offer made in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies	Proforma invoice = preliminary bill sent BEFORE supply (for advance payment or import formalities); it does not replace the final invoice

MEMORY TRICK: Quotation = "this is what it WILL cost" (before the order); Invoice = "this is what you OWE" (after supply).

15.4 Order vs Purchase Order

Basis	Order (order letter)	Purchase Order (PO)
Meaning	A letter in which the buyer places an order for goods	A formal, numbered document issued by the buyer to order goods
Form	Ordinary business letter - salutation, paragraphs, complimentary close	Printed or computer-generated form - PO number, date, table of items, printed terms and conditions, authorised signature
Used by	Small firms, shopkeepers, individual buyers; one-off orders	Companies, government offices and institutions that have a purchase department; large or repeated orders
How items are shown	In sentences or a short list inside the letter	In a fixed table: item, description, quantity, unit price, amount, total
Identification	May carry a Ref. No.; later letters refer to "our order dated ..."	Unique PO number, quoted on the invoice, the delivery challan and all later letters
Legal / record value	The buyer's offer to buy; binding once the seller accepts it or supplies the goods	Binding once accepted by the seller; also the buyer's official record - matched with the invoice and the Goods Received Note (GRN) before payment
Example	"Please supply 500 A4 notebooks at Rs. 45 each as per your quotation dated 5 October 2026."	"PO No. 2026/117 dated 12 October 2026 - A4 notebooks, 500 nos. @ Rs. 45 = Rs. 22,500 - delivery by 30 October 2026"

MEMORY TRICK: An order letter TALKS in paragraphs; a PO LISTS in a numbered form - every PO is an order, but not every order is a PO.

15.5 Complaint vs Claim

Basis	Complaint letter	Claim letter
Meaning	The buyer reports a problem - defect, delay, shortage, wrong goods, poor service	The buyer demands a specific remedy or compensation for a loss
Focus	The PROBLEM - what went wrong	The REMEDY - refund, replacement, price reduction or compensation
Written by → sent to	Buyer/customer → seller; also a citizen → an authority (civic complaint)	Buyer → seller; also consignee → carrier (transport company), insured person → insurance company
Timing	As soon as the problem is noticed	With or after the complaint, once the loss is known and can be valued; insurance and carrier claims must be made within the time allowed in the policy or contract
Main contents	Order/invoice details, nature of the problem, a request to look into it	Order/invoice details, loss suffered, the exact remedy or amount demanded, proof (invoice copy, photographs, survey report)

Basis	Complaint letter	Claim letter
Tone	Firm but polite; states facts without anger, insults or threats	Firm, precise and specific; may fix a reasonable time limit for settlement
Example line	"Twenty of the 500 notebooks supplied against our order No. 117 were water-damaged."	"Please replace the 20 damaged notebooks or credit Rs. 900 to our account."

MEMORY TRICK: Complaint says WHAT went wrong; Claim says WHAT you want - in practice one letter often does both.

15.6 Complaint vs Adjustment

Basis	Complaint letter	Adjustment letter
Meaning	A letter reporting a problem with goods or service	The seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim
Written by → sent to	Buyer/customer → seller	Seller → the buyer/customer who complained
Stage	Opens the matter - after faulty, late or short goods are received	Closes the matter - after the seller has checked the complaint
Purpose	To get the problem corrected	To settle the matter fairly, keep the customer's goodwill and avoid losing future business
Main contents	Order/invoice details, the problem, the action requested	Thanks for the letter, regret or apology, cause of the problem, the decision - full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons - and an assurance for the future
Tone	Firm, factual and polite	Courteous and positive; a refusal is explained tactfully, never rudely
Example line	"Twenty notebooks in your consignment of 12 October 2026 were water-damaged."	"We regret the damage. Twenty fresh notebooks are being sent to you today at our cost."

MEMORY TRICK: The buyer COMPLAINS, the seller ADJUSTS - the complaint is the problem, the adjustment is the settlement.

15.7 Credit note vs Debit note HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Credit note	Debit note
Meaning	A note telling the buyer that his account has been CREDITED - the amount he owes is REDUCED	A note telling the other party that his account has been DEBITED
Issued by → to	SELLER → buyer	BUYER → seller, when returning goods or claiming a deduction; a seller may also send one to the buyer to charge an extra amount
Common reasons	Goods returned by the buyer; overcharge in the invoice; allowance for damaged or short goods; a discount or rebate allowed after the invoice	Goods returned to the seller; overcharge or shortage claimed; (seller's debit note) undercharge in the invoice
Effect on the buyer's dues	REDUCES the amount the buyer owes	Buyer's debit note: claims a deduction from the amount payable. Seller's debit note: INCREASES the amount the buyer owes
Entry in the issuer's books (goods returned)	Seller debits Sales Returns (Returns Inward) and credits the buyer's account; recorded in the Sales Returns Book	Buyer debits the seller's account and credits Purchases Returns (Returns Outward); recorded in the Purchases Returns Book
Side note: GST law	Issued by the supplier when the invoice charged too much or goods are returned	Also issued by the supplier - when the invoice charged too little
Example	"Credit Note No. CN-45: your account has been credited with Rs. 900 for 20 damaged notebooks returned."	"Debit Note No. DN-12: your account has been debited with Rs. 900 for 20 damaged notebooks returned to you."

MEMORY TRICK: Goods go back: the Buyer sends a Debit note, the Seller sends a Credit note ("B-D, S-C") - and a credit note always cuts the buyer's bill.

15.8 Credit letter vs Letter of Credit HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Credit letter	Letter of Credit (L/C)
Meaning	Any business letter ABOUT credit - asking for, checking, granting or refusing credit	A BANK's written undertaking to pay the seller when specified documents are presented
Written / issued by	A buyer, a seller or a trade referee	The issuing bank, at the request of the buyer/importer (the applicant)
Sent to	A supplier, customer, trade referee or bank	The seller/exporter (the beneficiary), usually through an advising bank in the seller's country

Basis	Credit letter	Letter of Credit (L/C)
Purpose	To obtain or decide on trade credit - e.g. 30 or 60 days to pay	To assure payment to a seller who does not know the buyer well - used mainly in foreign trade (e.g. an importer in Chennai buying machines from a German exporter)
Kinds	Request to open a credit account; credit (status) inquiry to referees; letter granting credit; letter refusing credit. (A bank's "credit advice" only tells a customer that his account has been credited.)	Irrevocable, confirmed, sight (paid when the documents are presented), usance (paid after a fixed period)
Parties	Buyer and seller (plus referees)	Applicant, issuing bank, beneficiary, advising / confirming bank
Financial effect	No guarantee of payment - only a request, information or a decision	The bank's own promise to pay against documents - the seller relies on the bank, not on the buyer

MEMORY TRICK: A credit letter TALKS about credit; a Letter of Credit is a BANK'S PROMISE to pay.

15.9 Reference letter vs Recommendation letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Reference letter	Recommendation letter
Meaning	A general statement of facts about a person's character, conduct or work	A letter that actively endorses (supports) a person for a SPECIFIC job, admission, scholarship or award
Written by → addressed to	A former employer, principal or teacher → often "To Whom It May Concern" - no particular reader	A teacher, guide or supervisor who knows the candidate's work closely → a specific recipient - an employer, a selection committee or an admissions office
Purpose	To confirm facts - period of work or study, duties, conduct	To persuade the reader to select the person
Tone	Neutral and factual	Warm, positive and persuasive
Content	Dates, post or class, main duties, general character and conduct; usually no comparison with others	Specific achievements and qualities matched to the post or course, often with a comparison ("one of the best students I have taught"); a clear statement such as "I strongly recommend her"
Use	General - the same letter can be shown for many purposes	Written for one purpose - one post, course or award
Example line	"Mr. S. Arun worked in our office as an Assistant from June 2022 to May 2026. His work and conduct were satisfactory."	"I strongly recommend Ms. R. Kavya for admission to your M.A. English programme; she was the best student in her batch."

MEMORY TRICK: Reference = "this is what she is" (facts, for anyone); Recommendation = "please select her" (support, for someone specific).

15.10 Bank reference vs Credit reference

Basis	Bank reference	Credit reference
Meaning	A bank's statement about its customer's account and general standing	Information about a person's or firm's creditworthiness - the ability and willingness to pay debts
Given by	The customer's own bank	Trade referees (other suppliers who have given credit) or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL)
Given when	Only on request - a bank keeps its customer's affairs confidential	On request, when a supplier or lender is deciding whether to give credit
Based on	How the bank account has been maintained and operated	Actual payment record - credit allowed, dues, delays or defaults; a credit report or score
Nature of the reply	Brief, general and cautious; balances and confidential details are not disclosed	More specific - credit limit allowed, payment habits, amounts outstanding
Used for	Checking the general standing of a new customer or business partner, e.g. before opening a credit account	Deciding whether to grant credit or a loan, how much and for how long
Example line	"The firm has maintained a current account with us since 2015; its dealings have been satisfactory."	"They have bought from us on 30 days' credit for five years and have always paid on time."

MEMORY TRICK: Bank reference = what your BANK says about your account; Credit reference = what your CREDITORS (suppliers, CIBIL) say about your paying habits.

15.11 Circular vs Notice HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Circular	Notice
Meaning	The same information sent (circulated) to many individual recipients	A formal announcement displayed publicly, or a formal legal intimation to a person

Basis	Circular	Notice
How it reaches people	Each recipient gets a copy - by post, by e-mail, or in a file passed round for signature	Put up on a notice board or published in a newspaper or on a website; a legal notice is served on the person concerned
Audience	A defined group - offices, staff, members, customers (often a distribution list)	The public or everyone concerned; a legal notice - one specific person
Issued by	Government offices, heads of institutions, companies (to branches, dealers or customers)	Institutions, offices, companies, courts; an advocate on behalf of a client (legal notice)
Purpose	To pass on instructions, information or changes - e.g. new office timings, change of address, opening of a new branch	To announce a meeting, event, holiday, tender, auction or examination schedule; a legal notice demands or warns
Format	Government circular: number, date, "CIRCULAR", subject, body, signature and designation - no salutation, no close. A business circular letter has "Dear Sir/Madam," and "Yours faithfully,"	Public notice: name of the institution, heading "NOTICE", date, title, short body, signature, name and designation - no salutation, no close
Example line	"All Heads of Department are requested to send the staff attendance statement for October 2026 by 5 November 2026."	"The college will remain closed on 2 October 2026 on account of Gandhi Jayanti."

MEMORY TRICK: A Circular CIRCULATES - a copy goes round to each person; a Notice is NOTICED - one copy is put up for all to see.

15.12 Memorandum vs Office Memorandum HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Memorandum (memo)	Office Memorandum (O.M.)
Meaning	A short internal communication within an organisation	The formal government form for communication between Ministries/Departments
Used in	Any organisation - company, bank, school, hospital, office	Government - Ministries and Departments
Direction	Inside one organisation - manager to staff, section to section, staff to manager	Between Ministries/Departments; also with attached offices and with employees
Person and style	Direct and brief; first person or plain instructions	Third person - "The undersigned is directed to ..."
Format	Heading MEMO; To, From, Date and Subject lines; short body; initials or signature; no salutation, no close	O.M. No., name of the Ministry/Department, place and date, heading "OFFICE MEMORANDUM", subject, body; signed with name and designation; addressee at the bottom-left; no salutation, no close
Typical uses	Instructions, reminders, requests, short reports, asking a staff member for an explanation	Asking for or supplying information; conveying decisions and instructions of the Government to other Departments and to employees
Example line	"To: All Branch Staff; From: Branch Manager; Date: 12 October 2026; Subject: Working hours during audit week"	"The undersigned is directed to refer to this Ministry's O.M. of even number dated ... and to say that ..."

MEMORY TRICK: A memo stays INSIDE one organisation; an O.M. travels BETWEEN government departments, in the third person.

15.13 Memorandum vs Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Memorandum (memo)	Letter
Meaning	A short internal communication within an organisation	A written message usually sent OUTSIDE the organisation - to firms, customers, officials, the public or friends
Audience	Colleagues and staff of the same organisation	Outsiders - customers, suppliers, government offices, individuals
Format	MEMO heading; To / From / Date / Subject block; no inside address, no salutation, no complimentary close	Sender's address or letterhead, date, inside address, subject, salutation, body, complimentary close, signature
Length and tone	Short and direct; often in numbered points; one topic per memo	Can be longer; complete and courteous; tone depends on the type (formal, semi-formal or informal)
Signature	Initials or signature of the sender	Full signature with name (and designation) below the complimentary close
Delivery	Internal mail, office file or e-mail - no envelope or postage needed	Post, courier, hand delivery or e-mail
Example opening	"All section heads will attend a staff meeting on 16 October 2026 at 4 p.m. in the conference hall." (no "Dear", no "Yours")	"Dear Sir/Madam, Thank you for your order No. 117 dated 12 October 2026."

MEMORY TRICK: Memo = IN-house, with no "Dear" and no "Yours"; Letter = goes OUT, with salutation and close.

15.14 Petition vs Representation

Basis	Petition	Representation
Meaning	A formal request to an authority for redress (remedy) or action; also a legal application to a court	An individual's formal statement to an authority presenting a grievance or seeking reconsideration of a decision
Made by	Often signed by many - residents, villagers, members of an association (one person may also petition)	Usually one individual - often an employee about his own service matter
Addressed to	An authority - Collector, Commissioner, Minister, the Government; a court (e.g. a writ petition)	A higher authority - usually in the writer's own department or organisation, or the Government
Subject matter	Common or public problems - road, water supply, street lights, bus service; legal relief in a court	Personal grievance - seniority, promotion, transfer, pay fixation; a request to reconsider an order
Route	Submitted directly to the authority (e.g. at the Collector's grievance day meeting); in a court, filed as per the court's rules	Through proper channel - via the immediate superior (a "Through: ..." line)
Structure	Facts of the problem, the relief requested (in a court: the "prayer"), names, addresses and signatures of all petitioners	Facts, reference to the order or rule, grounds for reconsideration, the specific relief requested; one signature with designation
Example line	"We, the undersigned residents of Anna Nagar, request that street lights be provided on 4th Main Road."	"I request that my seniority be refixed and my case for promotion be reconsidered."

MEMORY TRICK: Petition = many People, a Public problem; Representation = one person's own case, sent through proper channel.

15.15 Application vs Request

Basis	Application	Request
Meaning	A formal request for something one is eligible for - job, leave, admission, loan, licence	Any asking for information, permission, help or action
Scope	Narrow - one special kind of request	Wide - includes applications and many other kinds of asking
Format	Often a prescribed form or fixed format; certificates, ID proof or photographs enclosed; an employee's application to a higher authority goes through proper channel	Any suitable letter or e-mail; usually no prescribed form
Eligibility	The applicant must meet stated conditions - age, qualification, service, income	No eligibility conditions; the receiver may agree or decline
Outcome	A formal decision - selection, sanction, admission, grant of leave, or rejection	Information, permission, help or action - as the receiver decides
Examples	Job application, leave application, application for admission, loan application, application for a licence or scholarship	Request for a catalogue, for an extension of time, for permission to use the school ground, for a meeting
Example line	"I wish to apply for the post of Junior Assistant advertised in The Hindu."	"I request you to extend the last date for fee payment by one week."

MEMORY TRICK: Every application is a request, but not every request is an application - you APPLY only for what you are ELIGIBLE for.

15.16 Enclosure vs Annexure

Basis	Enclosure	Annexure
Meaning	A separate document sent in the same envelope with a letter	A document added at the end of a main document, numbered and forming part of it
Relation to the main document	Separate - it travels with the letter but stands on its own	Part of the main document - the two are read together
Used with	Letters and applications sent by post or by hand	Reports, agreements, tenders, government orders, project proposals
Numbering / marking	Listed below the signature as "Encl.: 1. ... 2. ..."; the body says "I enclose ..."	Numbered and titled - Annexure I, Annexure II (or A, B); the text refers to it: "(see Annexure II)"
Position	Loose sheets placed with the letter; the Encl. list is at the bottom-left of the letter	After the last page of the main document, each annexure starting on a new page with its heading
Typical items	Copies of certificates, a cheque or demand draft, an invoice copy, photographs	Tables, statements, lists of names, maps, specimen forms, copies of earlier orders
Example	"Encl.: 1. Copy of SSLC mark sheet 2. Demand draft for Rs. 500"	"The list of selected candidates is given in Annexure I."

MEMORY TRICK: ENclosure = ENclosed in the ENvelope (separate); ANNEXure = ANNEXed, joined to the document (part of it).

15.17 Attachment vs Enclosure

Basis	Attachment	Enclosure
Meaning	A file sent with an e-mail (or a paper clipped or stapled to a document)	A separate document sent in the same envelope with a letter
Medium	Mostly electronic - a digital file travels with the e-mail	Paper - placed loose in the envelope with the letter
Typical items	Resume (PDF), scanned certificates, photographs, spreadsheets, presentations	Certificate copies, a cheque or demand draft, photographs, a brochure
How it is mentioned	"Please find attached ..." / "I have attached ..."; an "Attachment:" line may be added	"Please find enclosed ..." / "I enclose ..."; an "Encl.:" line below the signature
Check before sending	Right file, readable format (PDF is safest for documents), reasonable size, clear file name	Every item in the Encl. list is actually inside the envelope
Common mistake	Writing "please find attached" and forgetting to attach the file	"Please find enclosed herewith" - outdated; write "Please find enclosed" or "I enclose"
Example	"Please find attached my resume in PDF format."	"I enclose a demand draft for Rs. 500 and two passport-size photographs."

MEMORY TRICK: The e-mail ATTACHES; the envelope ENCLOSES.

15.18 Acknowledgement vs Confirmation

Basis	Acknowledgement	Confirmation
Meaning	Confirms RECEIPT only - of a letter, order, payment, application or goods. (Spelling: acknowledgement - British; acknowledgment - American; both correct.)	Confirms AGREEMENT - that something will go ahead as stated (an order, booking, meeting or arrangement)
Commitment	None on the matter itself - "received; under consideration"	Commits the sender - the terms, date or arrangement are now fixed
Timing	Immediately on receiving something	After a decision is taken or the terms are agreed
Purpose	To assure the sender that the item has arrived safely; avoids doubt, delay and repeat sending	To remove uncertainty and put the agreed terms on record
Typical phrases	"We acknowledge with thanks the receipt of your letter dated ..."; "This is to acknowledge receipt of ..."	"We are pleased to confirm your order No. ..."; "This is to confirm that ..."
Common forms	Acknowledgement slip for an application; receipt for a payment; acknowledgement of an order	Order confirmation; hotel or ticket booking confirmation; confirmation of a meeting or interview date
Example line	"We have received your order No. 117 dated 12 October 2026; it is being processed."	"We confirm your order No. 117 for 500 notebooks at Rs. 45 each, for delivery by 30 October 2026."

MEMORY TRICK: Acknowledgement = "we GOT it"; Confirmation = "it is ON - agreed".

15.19 Reminder vs Notice

Basis	Reminder	Notice (final / demand notice)
Meaning	A polite follow-up about a pending action, payment or reply	A formal, firmer intimation that may carry legal consequences
Stage (collection series)	First reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer)	Final notice / demand - sent when the reminders have failed
Tone	Courteous; assumes the delay is an oversight	Firm, serious and formal; states the consequence clearly but stays polite
Contents	Reference to the earlier letter or invoice, what is pending, a request to act	Exact amount or action demanded, a final deadline, the consequence (legal action, stoppage of credit or supply)
Sent by	Seller, creditor, office or anyone awaiting a reply	Creditor, bank or landlord - often through an advocate (legal notice)
Legal effect	None - it keeps the relationship friendly	May be the first step to legal action - e.g. the demand notice for a dishonoured cheque under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881, sent within 30 days of receiving the bank's return memo
Example line	"This is a reminder that our invoice No. 245 for Rs. 22,500, due on 30 September 2026, is still unpaid."	"Unless Rs. 22,500 is paid within 15 days of receipt of this notice, we shall be compelled to take legal action."

MEMORY TRICK: A Reminder REQUESTS (a polite nudge); a Notice WARNS (the last chance before action).

15.20 Formal vs Semi-formal HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Formal letter	Semi-formal letter
Meaning	A letter written for an official, business or public purpose	A letter to a person we know, but not closely, on a matter that is partly personal and partly official
Written to	Officials, offices, companies, editors, unknown persons - usually by designation	Known persons in a respectful relationship - a former teacher, neighbour, landlord, colleague, a friend's parent
Salutation	"Dear Sir/Madam," / "Sir," / "Respected Sir,"	"Dear Mr. Raman," / "Dear Mrs. Sundaram," (title + surname)
Complimentary close	"Yours faithfully," ("Yours sincerely," when a named person is addressed as "Dear Mr. Raman,")	"Yours sincerely,"
Subject line and address	Subject line needed; receiver's designation and full address	Subject line optional; receiver's name and address
Tone and language	Impersonal and precise; no personal news, no contractions	Respectful but warm; a short personal touch is allowed; no slang, contractions avoided
Examples	Job application, complaint to the Corporation Commissioner, letter to the editor, letter to a bank manager	Letter to a former teacher seeking advice, to a landlord about repairs, to a neighbour about a shared problem, thanking a friend's father

MEMORY TRICK: Formal writes to a POST ("Sir/Madam ... Yours faithfully"); semi-formal writes to a PERSON you know ("Dear Mr. Raman ... Yours sincerely").

15.21 D.O. letter vs Official letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	D.O. (demi-official) letter	Official letter
Meaning	A personal, friendly letter from one officer to another on an official matter - "demi" means half: half official, half personal	A formal letter from a Government office to other governments, bodies, officials or the public
Addressed to	An officer by name (officer to officer)	An authority by designation, another government, an organisation or a member of the public
Purpose	To draw personal attention, to expedite (speed up) a matter, or to exchange views or information	To convey decisions, sanctions, instructions, replies and information formally - the normal form for Government correspondence with other governments, bodies and the public
Person and tone	First person singular ("I"); personal, friendly tone	Formal and impersonal; the officer writes for the Government - "I am directed to ..."
Salutation → close	"Dear Shri Kumar," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru Kumar,") → "Yours sincerely,"	"Sir," / "Madam," / "Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"
Layout	"D.O. No." and the writer's name and designation at the top; addressee's name and address at the bottom-left; signed personally	Letter number at the top; "To" and the addressee's designation and address at the top; subject line; signed with name and designation
Example opening	"I am writing to seek your personal help in completing the land records for the new bus stand at Erode."	"I am directed to inform you that the Government has sanctioned Rs. 5 lakh for the repair of the school building."

MEMORY TRICK: D.O. = "Dear Shri" + "I" + "Yours sincerely" (officer to officer); Official = "Sir" + "I am directed" + "Yours faithfully".

15.22 Master summary table

One line per pair - enough for a short answer. For self-testing, cover the right-hand column and recall each difference aloud.

Pair	One-line difference
Inquiry vs Enquiry	Inquiry = formal investigation; enquiry = asking for information (British tradition); American English uses "inquiry" for both.
Inquiry letter vs Quotation letter	Inquiry = the buyer asks for prices and terms; quotation = the seller's reply giving prices, terms and a validity period, before the order.
Quotation vs Invoice	Quotation = price offer BEFORE the order; invoice = the bill AFTER supply, which makes payment due.
Order vs Purchase Order	Order letter = an order placed in letter form; PO = the buyer's formal numbered document, binding once accepted by the seller.
Complaint vs Claim	Complaint reports the problem; claim demands a specific remedy - refund, replacement, price reduction or compensation.
Complaint vs Adjustment	Complaint = the buyer's letter about a problem; adjustment = the seller's reply that settles it (full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons).
Credit note vs Debit note	Credit note = seller to buyer, reduces what the buyer owes; debit note = buyer to seller for returns or deductions (a seller's debit note charges an undercharge).
Credit letter vs Letter of Credit	Credit letter = any letter about trade credit; L/C = a bank's written undertaking to pay the seller against specified documents.

Pair	One-line difference
Reference letter vs Recommendation letter	Reference = neutral statement of facts, often "To Whom It May Concern"; recommendation = persuasive endorsement for a specific post, admission or award, to a specific reader.
Bank reference vs Credit reference	Bank reference = a bank's statement on its customer's account and standing; credit reference = creditworthiness report from trade referees or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL).
Circular vs Notice	Circular = copies sent to many individual recipients; notice = displayed publicly, or served as a formal legal intimation.
Memorandum vs Office Memorandum	Memo = short internal note in any organisation; O.M. = the formal government form between Ministries/Departments - third person, no salutation, no close.
Memorandum vs Letter	Memo = internal, To/From/Subject block, no salutation or close; letter = usually external, full format with salutation and close.
Petition vs Representation	Petition = request for redress or action, often signed by many (also to a court); representation = one person's grievance or plea for reconsideration, through proper channel.
Application vs Request	Application = formal request for something one is eligible for, often in a prescribed format; request = any asking - every application is a request, not the reverse.
Enclosure vs Annexure	Enclosure = separate document in the same envelope; annexure = numbered document at the end of a main document, forming part of it.
Attachment vs Enclosure	Attachment = file sent with an e-mail (or clipped); enclosure = separate document sent in the same envelope with a letter.
Acknowledgement vs Confirmation	Acknowledgement confirms RECEIPT only; confirmation confirms AGREEMENT - that it will go ahead as stated.
Reminder vs Notice	Reminder = polite follow-up on a pending matter; notice = firm, formal intimation that may lead to legal action (final demand).
Formal vs Semi-formal	Formal = official purpose, "Dear Sir/Madam ... Yours faithfully"; semi-formal = a known person, "Dear Mr. Raman ... Yours sincerely".
D.O. letter vs Official letter	D.O. = officer to officer, personal, "Dear Shri Kumar ... Yours sincerely"; official = "Sir ... I am directed to ... Yours faithfully".

MUST REMEMBER: Who sends what in trade - Buyer → Seller: inquiry, order / purchase order, complaint, claim, debit note (for goods returned). Seller → Buyer: quotation, invoice, adjustment letter, credit note. Issuing bank → Seller (beneficiary): letter of credit. Normal sequence: Inquiry → Quotation → Order → Invoice; if something goes wrong: Complaint / Claim → Adjustment.

MUST REMEMBER: Salutation test - NO salutation and NO close: Office Memorandum, internal memo, government circular, public notice (also Office Order, Order, Notification). "Sir," / "Madam," (official letter) or "Dear Sir/Madam," (other formal letters) + "Yours faithfully," "Dear Shri Kumar," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru Kumar,") + "Yours sincerely,"; D.O. letter. "Dear Mr. Raman," + "Yours sincerely,"; semi-formal letter, and a formal letter to a named person.



Practice Section

All questions in this section are PYQ-style: modelled on competitive-exam patterns, not actual previous-year questions.

16.1 Multiple Choice Questions (25)

Choose the correct option. Each answer gives the rule behind it.

MCQ1. Which salutation and complimentary close are correctly paired? (PYQ-style)

- Dear Sir/Madam, ... Yours sincerely,
- Dear Mr. Raman, ... Yours sincerely,
- Respected Sir, ... Yours lovingly,
- My dear Kavim, ... Yours faithfully,

Answer: (b) - A salutation that names the person ("Dear Mr./Mrs./Dr. + Surname,") takes "Yours sincerely,"; "Dear Sir/Madam," and "Respected Sir," take "Yours faithfully," and a friend ("My dear Kavim,") gets an informal close such as "Your loving friend,".

MCQ2. A Tamil Nadu Government officer writes a demi-official (D.O.) letter to a fellow officer, Thiru S. Kumar, to speed up a pending file. Which opening and close are correct? (PYQ-style)

- a. Sir, ... Yours faithfully,
- b. Respected Sir, ... Yours obediently,
- c. Dear Sir/Madam, ... Yours truly,
- d. Dear Thiru Kumar, ... Yours sincerely,

Answer: (d) - A D.O. letter is personal in tone and written in the first person, so it names the officer ("Dear Thiru Kumar,"); Central Government: "Dear Shri Kumar,") and closes "Yours sincerely,;" option (a) is the pattern of an ordinary official letter.

MCQ3. In a formal letter written in full-block format, which is the correct order of the opening parts? (PYQ-style)

- a. Sender's address → Date → Receiver's address → Subject → Salutation
- b. Date → Sender's address → Salutation → Receiver's address → Subject
- c. Sender's address → Receiver's address → Salutation → Date → Subject
- d. Receiver's address → Date → Sender's address → Subject → Salutation

Answer: (a) - The standard exam layout is sender's address, date, "To" with the receiver's address, subject and then salutation; the traditional British/commerce-textbook layout that puts the subject after the salutation is an accepted variant, but none of the other options is valid in any layout.

MCQ4. Which is a correctly written subject line for a formal letter to the Municipal Commissioner? (PYQ-style)

- a. Subject: I am writing to complain that garbage is not collected regularly in our area.
- b. SUBJECT - GARBAGE PROBLEM!!!
- c. Subject: Irregular garbage collection in K.K. Nagar
- d. Subject: Regarding garbage, kindly do the needful

Answer: (c) - A subject line is a short noun phrase that begins with "Subject:" and has no full stop; (a) is a full sentence, (b) shouts with capitals and exclamation marks, and (d) is a request that uses an outdated phrase.

MCQ5. Why should an all-numeric date such as 04/05/2026 be avoided in a formal letter? (PYQ-style)

- a. Numbers are not permitted anywhere in a formal letter.
- b. It is ambiguous: it may be read as 4 May 2026 or as April 5, 2026.
- c. It does not show the day of the week.
- d. It does not show the year in full.

Answer: (b) - Indian and British usage reads day-month but American usage reads month-day, so write "4 May 2026" ("4th May, 2026" is an acceptable traditional Indian style and "May 4, 2026" is the American style).

MCQ6. Consider the following statements about an informal (personal) letter:

- 1. It has no subject line.
- 2. It has no receiver's address.
- 3. It ends with the writer's full name and designation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct? (PYQ-style)

- a. 1 and 2 only
- b. 2 and 3 only
- c. 1 and 3 only
- d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a) - An informal letter has a short sender's address, date, salutation, body, close and only the writer's first name; it has no subject line, no receiver's address and no designation.

MCQ7. In traditional British usage, which statement about "enquiry" and "inquiry" is correct? (PYQ-style)

- a. "Enquiry" means a formal investigation; "inquiry" means a request for information.
- b. Both words mean only a formal investigation.
- c. "Enquiry" means a request for information; "inquiry" means a formal investigation.
- d. "Inquiry" is used only in British English, never in American English.

Answer: (c) - British tradition uses "enquiry" for asking for information and "inquiry" for a formal investigation, while American English uses "inquiry" for both; hence "enquiry letter" and "inquiry letter" are both accepted.

MCQ8. Sri Murugan Stationers asked Kaveri Paper Mills for its rates. Kaveri Paper Mills replied with prices, trade discount and delivery terms, adding: "This offer is valid for 30 days." The reply is a/an: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Tender
- b. Estimate
- c. Proforma invoice
- d. Quotation

Answer: (d) - A quotation is the seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions sent in reply to an inquiry, valid for a stated period (a firm offer); an estimate is only an approximate cost, a tender answers a formal invitation, and a proforma invoice is a preliminary bill sent before supply.

MCQ9. Which document is issued by the BUYER and becomes binding once the seller accepts it? *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Quotation
- b. Purchase Order
- c. Proforma invoice
- d. Tax invoice

Answer: (b) - A Purchase Order (PO) is a formal numbered document issued by the buyer and binding once the seller accepts it; the quotation, proforma invoice and tax invoice all come from the seller.

MCQ10. Consider the following statements:

1. A complaint letter reports a problem such as a defect, delay, shortage or wrong goods.
2. A claim letter demands a specific remedy such as a refund, replacement or price reduction.
3. An adjustment letter is written by the buyer to settle his own claim.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct? *(PYQ-style)*

- a. 1 only
- b. 1 and 2 only
- c. 2 and 3 only
- d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b) - Statement 3 is wrong: an adjustment letter is the SELLER's reply that settles a complaint or claim by full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons.

MCQ11. Arrange these extracts from a collection series in the order in which they would be sent: *(PYQ-style)*

1. "Unless the amount is received within seven days, we shall be compelled to take legal action."
 2. "This is a reminder that our Invoice No. 214 dated 2 August 2026 is still unpaid; perhaps it has escaped your notice."
 3. "We are disappointed that our earlier reminder has not been answered. Please settle the amount without further delay."
- a. 1 → 3 → 2
 - b. 3 → 2 → 1
 - c. 2 → 1 → 3
 - d. 2 → 3 → 1

Answer: (d) - A collection series moves from a polite first reminder (2) to a firmer second reminder (3) and then to a final notice that warns of legal action (1).

MCQ12. M/s. Kaveri Traders sends one identical letter to all its customers announcing that its office will move to a new address from 1 November 2026. Such a letter is a: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Circular letter
- b. Sales letter
- c. Status inquiry
- d. Memorandum

Answer: (a) - A circular carries the same information to many persons or offices at once (change of address, opening of a branch, a new partner); a sales letter tries to sell, a status inquiry asks referees about a customer's creditworthiness, and a memorandum is an internal note.

MCQ13. In a Letter of Credit (L/C) transaction, the "beneficiary" is: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. the buyer/importer at whose request the L/C is opened
- b. the seller/exporter who is paid on presenting the specified documents
- c. the bank that issues the L/C
- d. the bank that advises the L/C to the seller

Answer: (b) - The issuing bank opens the L/C at the request of the buyer/importer (applicant) and undertakes to pay the seller/exporter (beneficiary) when the specified documents are presented; the advising bank informs the seller that the L/C has been opened.

MCQ14. Kaveri Paper Mills (seller) overcharged Sri Murugan Stationers (buyer) by Rs. 2,000 in an invoice. To correct the error, Kaveri Paper Mills should send: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. a debit note
- b. a proforma invoice
- c. a credit note
- d. a debit advice

Answer: (c) - A credit note is issued by the seller and reduces the amount the buyer owes (goods returned, overcharge or allowance); a seller's debit note does the opposite, charging an extra amount for an undercharge.

MCQ15. A buyer returns defective goods worth Rs. 5,000 and informs the seller that the seller's account in the buyer's books has been debited by that amount. This intimation is a: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Credit note
- b. Delivery challan
- c. Goods Received Note
- d. Debit note

Answer: (d) - A debit note is issued by the buyer when returning goods or claiming a deduction and tells the seller that his account has been debited (side note: under GST law both credit and debit notes are issued by the supplier).

MCQ16. Which details should a stop-payment letter to a bank contain? *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Cheque number, date, amount and payee's name
- b. The account holder's ATM PIN, for verification
- c. The OTP received on the registered mobile number
- d. Only the account holder's name and signature

Answer: (a) - The bank needs the cheque number, date, amount and payee to identify the cheque and stop it; no letter should ever contain a PIN, OTP, CVV or password.

MCQ17. Before supplying goods on credit to a new customer, a firm asks the customer's BANK for a statement about the customer's account and general standing. The bank's reply is a: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Credit advice
- b. Trade reference
- c. Bank reference
- d. Letter of Credit

Answer: (c) - A bank reference is a bank's statement about its customer's account and general standing, given on request; a trade reference comes from other suppliers, and a credit advice only reports that an account has been credited.

MCQ18. Which statement about an Office Memorandum (O.M.) is correct? *(PYQ-style)*

- a. It is written in the third person and has no salutation or complimentary close.
- b. It begins "Dear Shri ...," and ends "Yours sincerely,".
- c. It is used to publish rules and appointments in the Official Gazette.
- d. It announces important policy decisions to the public.

Answer: (a) - An O.M. (used mainly between Ministries and Departments) is written in the third person, "The undersigned is directed to ...", with no salutation or close; (b) describes a D.O. letter, (c) a notification and (d) a resolution.

MCQ19. An Additional Secretary wants to draw the personal attention of an officer in another department to a matter pending for several months and to get it expedited. The most suitable form is a/an: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Notification
- b. Office Order
- c. Resolution
- d. Demi-official letter

Answer: (d) - A D.O. letter goes from officer to officer in a personal, friendly tone and is used to draw personal attention, expedite a matter or exchange views and information.

MCQ20. Rules framed under an Act are to be published in the Official Gazette. The form of communication used is a: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Resolution
- b. Notification
- c. Office Memorandum
- d. Circular

Answer: (b) - A notification publishes rules, orders, appointments and promotions in the Official Gazette; a resolution also appears in the Gazette but announces important policy decisions or the appointment of committees and commissions.

MCQ21. Consider the following statements about the word "endorsement":

1. In government correspondence, it is a note at the foot of a communication that forwards copies to others or returns a paper to the sender.
2. In banking, it is a signature on the back of a cheque or other negotiable instrument to transfer it.
3. In business correspondence, it is the seller's reply that settles a buyer's complaint.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct? *(PYQ-style)*

- a. 1 only
- b. 2 only
- c. 1 and 2 only
- d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c) - "Endorsement" has both the government meaning and the banking meaning; statement 3 describes an adjustment letter.

MCQ22. The head of an office wants to redistribute work among the assistants of a section and to grant leave to two clerks. The proper form of communication is a/an: *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Resolution
- b. Office Order
- c. Notification
- d. Demi-official letter

Answer: (b) - An Office Order carries internal administrative instructions such as distribution of work, grant of leave and postings within the office.

MCQ23. Which is the most appropriate opening sentence for a formal reply? *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Got your letter - thanks a lot!
- b. Please be informed that your letter has been received and the same is under examination.
- c. As per your letter, kindly do the needful.
- d. With reference to your letter No. 45/2026 dated 12 October 2026, I wish to inform you that the matter is under examination.

Answer: (d) - A formal reply refers to the earlier letter by number and date and uses plain formal language; (a) is informal with an exclamation mark, while (b) and (c) use outdated phrases ("Please be informed", "the same", "do the needful").

MCQ24. Choose the best modern replacement for "Kindly do the needful." *(PYQ-style)*

- a. Please take the necessary action.
- b. Kindly revert back on this.
- c. Please do the necessary.
- d. Kindly be informed and act.

Answer: (a) - "Do the needful" is outdated; the modern formal form is "take the necessary action". "Do the necessary" in (c) is the same outdated idiom, "revert back" in (b) should be "reply", and "Kindly be informed" in (d) should be "This is to inform you".

MCQ25. Which sentence is written in acceptable modern formal style? (PYQ-style)

- a. Please find enclosed herewith a copy of the receipt.
- b. Kindly revert back after verifying the same.
- c. I enclose a copy of the receipt.
- d. Please be informed that the same has been paid.

Answer: (c) - "I enclose" (or "Please find enclosed") is correct; "enclosed herewith" is redundant, "revert back" should be "reply", "the same" used as a pronoun should be "it", and "Please be informed" should be "This is to inform you".

16.2 Fill in the Blanks (25)

Fill in each blank with the correct word or phrase.

FB1. A formal letter that begins "Dear Sir/Madam," should end with the complimentary close "_____". (PYQ-style)

Answer: Yours faithfully, - "Dear Sir/Madam," addresses an official, an organisation or an unknown person, and such letters close with "Yours faithfully," (capital Y, small f, no apostrophe, comma after).

FB2. An Office Memorandum is written in the third person and usually begins: "The _____ is directed to state that ..." (PYQ-style)

Answer: undersigned - An O.M. does not use "I"; the signing officer is referred to as "the undersigned", and the O.M. has no salutation or close.

FB3. "_____ the orders of the District Collector dated 3 September 2026, a special camp will be held on 10 October 2026." (A formal linking phrase formed from the verb "pursue", meaning "in accordance with".) (PYQ-style)

Answer: Pursuant to (also "In pursuance of") - it means "in accordance with / following" and links an action to an earlier order, letter or rule.

FB4. A seller's preliminary bill, sent before supply so that the buyer can make an advance payment or complete import formalities, is called a _____. (PYQ-style)

Answer: proforma invoice - It comes before supply, whereas the tax invoice is the actual bill for goods supplied (quantity, price, taxes, total and due date).

FB5. A formal letter to a named person that begins "Dear Mrs. Raman," should end with "_____". (PYQ-style)

Answer: Yours sincerely, - When the salutation names the person ("Dear Mr./Mrs./Ms./Dr. + Surname,"), the close is "Yours sincerely,".

FB6. "The fee of Rs. 500 was paid _____ Receipt No. 4521 dated 5 October 2026." (A Latin word used to cite a document.) (PYQ-style)

Answer: vide - Latin for "see"; official writing uses it to cite a document by its number and date (plainer English: "see" or "as shown in").

FB7. An official letter from a Government office to a member of the public usually begins: "I am _____ to inform you that ..." (The word shows that the officer writes on the orders of the Government.) (PYQ-style)

Answer: directed - The officer writes on behalf of the Government, so an official letter begins "I am directed to ..." and ends "Yours faithfully," with the designation.

FB8. The document that travels with the goods from the seller's godown to the buyer's premises, listing the goods sent (it is not a bill), is called the _____. (PYQ-style)

Answer: delivery challan (also called a delivery note) - It accompanies the goods; on receiving and checking them, the buyer records their receipt in a Goods Received Note (GRN).

FB9. A letter to "The Manager, Southern Commercial Bank, Salem - 636 001", whose name and gender you do not know, should begin with the salutation "_____". (PYQ-style)

Answer: Dear Sir/Madam, - Use it when the receiver's name and gender are not known; it pairs with "Yours faithfully,".

FB10. A formal letter uses "cannot" and "I am" instead of "can't" and "I'm" because _____ are not used in formal letters. (PYQ-style)

Answer: contractions - Formal letters avoid contractions, slang, exclamation marks and SMS language; contractions are allowed only in informal letters.

FB11. "Two copies of the audited accounts are sent _____ for your verification." (One word meaning "with this letter".) (PYQ-style)

Answer: herewith - It means "with this letter"; never combine it with "enclosed" ("Please find enclosed herewith" is redundant, so write "I enclose").

FB12. The buyer's own document recording that the goods have arrived and have been checked is the _____. (PYQ-style)

Answer: Goods Received Note (GRN) - The buyer prepares it on receipt of the goods, while the delivery challan travels with the goods from the seller.

FB13. A D.O. letter from a Central Government officer to Shri R. K. Verma begins "Dear _____ Verma," and ends "Yours sincerely,". (PYQ-style)

Answer: Shri - Because a D.O. letter is personal in tone, it names the officer with the honorific "Shri" (Tamil Nadu Government usage: "Thiru").

FB14. The line "Copy forwarded to the Tahsildar, Vellore, for information and necessary action." at the foot of a government letter is called an _____. (PYQ-style)

Answer: endorsement - In government correspondence, an endorsement forwards copies of a communication to others (or returns a paper to the sender).

FB15. A school student writing to the Principal with "Respected Sir," may close with "Yours faithfully," or with the traditional "_____". (PYQ-style)

Answer: Yours obediently, - This traditional close is accepted for a student writing to the Principal; "Yours faithfully," is equally correct.

FB16. "Any breach of these conditions, or of any part _____, will lead to cancellation of the licence." (One word meaning "of it" or "of them".) (PYQ-style)

Answer: thereof - It means "of it / of them", referring to the thing or things just mentioned (here, the conditions).

FB17. The informal "Can you tell me the fee?" becomes formal as "I would be _____ if you could inform me of the fee." (PYQ-style)

Answer: grateful (also "obliged") - Formal requests are softened with "I would be grateful if you could ..." instead of a direct question.

FB18. In Tamil Nadu, the Secretariat departments issue their decisions as a "G.O.", which stands for _____. (PYQ-style)

Answer: Government Order - G.O.s are issued by the Secretariat departments, while Heads of Departments and District officers issue orders in the "Proceedings" format.

FB19. Kavin's letter to his father begins "Dear Appa," and ends "Your loving _____," followed by his first name. (PYQ-style)

Answer: son - Informal letters to family members end with a close such as "Your loving son," and only the writer's first name.

FB20. When a cheque is dishonoured, the payee may send a legal demand notice under Section _____ of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881. (PYQ-style)

Answer: 138 - The notice is sent within 30 days of receiving the bank's return memo, and the drawer then has 15 days to pay.

FB21. Instead of the outdated "Kindly revert back", a modern formal letter says "Please _____ by 20 October 2026." (PYQ-style)

Answer: reply (or "respond") - "Revert back" is outdated and redundant; "reply" or "respond" is the correct formal word.

FB22. An employee's application to the Director is forwarded through the immediate superior officer. This is called sending it "through _____". (PYQ-style)

Answer: proper channel - The application goes through the immediate superior, and a "Through: ..." line is written above or below the addressee.

FB23. "We have received your cheque and will deposit the same tomorrow" is better written as "We have received your cheque and will deposit _____ tomorrow." (PYQ-style)

Answer: it - "The same" used as a pronoun is outdated; modern formal English uses "it".

FB24. Orders issued by a District Collector in Tamil Nadu in the format "Present: Thiru ..., Rc. No. ..., Dated ..., Sub: ..., Ref: ..., ORDER: ..." are called _____. (PYQ-style)

Answer: Proceedings - Heads of Departments and District officers in Tamil Nadu issue orders in the "Proceedings" format, while Secretariat departments issue G.O.s.

FB25. The prefix written before the name of a firm, as in "_____ Kaveri Traders, Erode", is short for "Messrs". (PYQ-style)

Answer: M/s. - "M/s." (Messrs) is written before the name of a firm; individuals get Mr./Mrs. or, in Tamil Nadu Government usage, Thiru/Tmt./Selvi.

16.3 Match the Following (20)

Match List I with List II and choose the correct code from options (a) to (d).

M1. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Letter)	List II (Purpose)
A. Inquiry letter	1. Seller states prices, terms and a validity period
B. Quotation	2. Seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim
C. Complaint letter	3. Prospective buyer asks for prices, terms or samples
D. Adjustment letter	4. Buyer reports a defect, delay, shortage or wrong goods

a. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
b. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2
c. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
d. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

Answer: (c) - The buyer asks (inquiry), the seller answers with prices (quotation), the buyer reports a problem (complaint) and the seller settles it (adjustment).

M2. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Letter)	List II (Purpose)
A. Order letter	1. Asks a customer to pay an overdue amount
B. Claim letter	2. Places an order, stating quantity, price and delivery terms
C. Collection letter	3. Gives the same information to many customers at once
D. Circular letter	4. Demands a specific remedy such as a refund, replacement or price reduction

a. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
b. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
c. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
d. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: (a) - An order letter places the order, a claim letter demands a specific remedy, a collection letter asks for an overdue payment, and a circular sends one message to many readers.

M3. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Salutation)	List II (Complimentary close)
A. "Dear Sir/Madam," (to the Manager of a bank)	1. Your loving son,
B. "Dear Mr. Raman," (formal letter to a named person)	2. Yours obediently,
C. "Dear Appa," (son to father)	3. Yours sincerely,
D. "Respected Madam," (school student to the Principal)	4. Yours faithfully,

- a. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
- b. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
- c. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- d. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2

Answer: (d) - "Dear Sir/Madam," can take only "Yours faithfully," so the student's "Respected Madam," takes the traditional "Yours obediently,"; the named person gets "Yours sincerely," and the son writes "Your loving son,".

M4. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Communication)	List II (Complimentary close)
A. Letter to the Editor, The Hindu, Chennai, beginning "Sir,"	1. Your loving friend,
B. D.O. letter beginning "Dear Thiru Kumar,"	2. None: no salutation and no complimentary close
C. Office Order	3. Yours faithfully,
D. Letter to a friend beginning "Dear Priya,"	4. Yours sincerely,

- a. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
- b. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
- c. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
- d. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2

Answer: (b) - A letter to the editor takes "Yours faithfully," a D.O. letter "Yours sincerely," a letter to a friend an informal close, and an Office Order has neither salutation nor close.

M5. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Government form)	List II (Feature)
A. Office Memorandum	1. First person, personal tone; "Dear Shri ...," and "Yours sincerely,"
B. Demi-official letter	2. Third person ("The undersigned is directed to ..."); no salutation or close
C. Notification	3. Note at the foot forwarding copies: "Copy forwarded to ..."
D. Endorsement	4. Published in the Official Gazette: rules, appointments, promotions

- a. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
- b. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
- c. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
- d. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: (a) - O.M. = third person with no salutation or close; D.O. = first person and personal tone; notification = Official Gazette; endorsement = "Copy forwarded to ...".

M6. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Government form)	List II (Used for)
A. Office Order	1. Financial sanctions and disciplinary matters
B. Order	2. Public announcement of important policy decisions or of the appointment of committees and commissions, published in the Gazette
C. Resolution	3. The same information sent to many offices or persons
D. Circular	4. Internal instructions such as distribution of work, grant of leave and postings within the office

- a. A-1, B-4, C-2, D-3
- b. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2
- c. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3
- d. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

Answer: (c) - Office Order = internal instructions; Order = financial sanctions and disciplinary matters; Resolution = policy decisions and committees (in the Gazette); Circular = the same message to many.

M7. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Banking term)	List II (Meaning)
A. Letter of Credit (L/C)	1. Bank's written undertaking to pay the seller/exporter when specified documents are presented
B. Bank reference	2. Intimation, usually from a bank, that an account has been credited
C. Stop-payment letter	3. Bank's statement about its customer's account and general standing, given on request
D. Credit advice	4. Account holder's instruction to the bank not to pay a particular cheque

- a. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
- b. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
- c. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
- d. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2

Answer: (d) - L/C = bank's undertaking to pay the exporter against documents; bank reference = the bank's report on its customer; stop-payment = do not pay this cheque; credit advice = the account has been credited.

M8. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Document)	List II (Description)
A. Credit note	1. Seller's bill for goods supplied, showing quantity, price, taxes, total and due date
B. Debit note	2. Issued by the seller; reduces the amount the buyer owes
C. Proforma invoice	3. Issued by the buyer when returning goods or claiming a deduction
D. Tax invoice	4. Preliminary bill sent before supply, for advance payment or import formalities

- a. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
- b. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
- c. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- d. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

Answer: (b) - The credit note (seller) reduces the buyer's dues, the debit note (buyer) goes with returns or deductions, the proforma invoice comes before supply and the tax invoice after it.

M9. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Stage)	List II (Document)
A. Buyer asks for prices and terms	1. Goods Received Note
B. Seller replies with prices, terms and a validity period	2. Quotation
C. Buyer confirms the purchase with a formal numbered document	3. Inquiry letter
D. Buyer checks the goods on arrival and records their receipt	4. Purchase Order

- a. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
- b. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
- c. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
- d. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2

Answer: (b) - The trade cycle runs inquiry → quotation → purchase order → goods sent with a delivery challan → Goods Received Note.

M10. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Mode of dispatch)	List II (Transport document)
A. By road (lorry)	1. RR
B. By rail	2. AWB
C. By sea	3. B/L
D. By air	4. LR

- a. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2
- b. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3
- c. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
- d. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2

Answer: (d) - LR = Lorry Receipt (road), RR = Railway Receipt (rail), B/L = Bill of Lading (sea) and AWB = Airway Bill (air).

M11. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Stage)	List II (Document)
A. Payment is overdue; first letter to the customer	1. Legal demand notice under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881
B. Two reminders have been ignored	2. Polite first reminder
C. The bank returns a cheque unpaid	3. Return memo
D. The payee takes action on the dishonoured cheque	4. Final notice warning of legal action

- a. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
- b. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1
- c. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
- d. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Answer: (a) - Collection moves from a polite reminder to a final notice; on dishonour the bank gives a return memo, and the payee may send a Section 138 demand notice within 30 days of receiving it.

M12. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Abbreviation)	List II (Expansion)
A. CC	1. Postscript: a short afterthought added below the signature
B. BCC	2. Blind carbon copy: a copy sent without the main receiver knowing
C. P.S.	3. Enclosure(s): papers sent with the letter
D. Encl.	4. Carbon copy: a copy sent to another person, named on the letter

- a. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
- b. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1
- c. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
- d. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2

Answer: (c) - CC = carbon copy (named on the letter), BCC = blind carbon copy (hidden from the main receiver), P.S. = postscript and Encl. = enclosure(s).

M13. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Abbreviation)	List II (Expansion)
A. E&OE	1. Errors and Omissions Excepted
B. w.e.f.	2. per procuracionem: signing on behalf of another person
C. p.p.	3. Letter of Credit
D. L/C	4. with effect from

- a. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
- b. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3
- c. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
- d. A-1, B-4, C-2, D-3

Answer: (d) - E&OE (printed on invoices) = Errors and Omissions Excepted; w.e.f. = with effect from; p.p. = per procuracionem (on behalf of); L/C = Letter of Credit.

M14. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Abbreviation)	List II (Expansion)
A. PO	1. Demi-official: an officer-to-officer letter in a personal tone
B. GRN	2. Office Memorandum: a third-person communication between departments
C. D.O.	3. Purchase Order: a formal numbered order issued by the buyer
D. O.M.	4. Goods Received Note: the buyer's record of goods received

- a. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
- b. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
- c. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
- d. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

Answer: (a) - PO = Purchase Order and GRN = Goods Received Note are trade documents; D.O. = Demi-official and O.M. = Office Memorandum are government forms.

M15. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Phrase)	List II (Function)
A. "With reference to your letter No. 45/2026 dated 12 October 2026, ..."	1. Conveys unwelcome news politely
B. "I shall be grateful if you could ..."	2. Links the letter to earlier correspondence
C. "I regret to inform you that ..."	3. Makes a polite request
D. "I look forward to your early reply."	4. Closes the letter by asking for a response

- a. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
b. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
c. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
d. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1

Answer: (b) - "With reference to" links, "I shall be grateful if" requests, "I regret to inform you" gives bad news politely, and "I look forward to" closes by inviting a reply.

M16. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Expression)	List II (Function)
A. "I am directed to ..."	1. Marks a demi-official letter
B. "The undersigned is directed to ..."	2. Endorsement forwarding a copy
C. "Copy forwarded to the Tahsildar, Salem, for information."	3. Opening of an Office Memorandum (third person)
D. "D.O. No. 12/2026" written at the top	4. Opening of an official letter from a Government office

- a. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
b. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
c. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
d. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

Answer: (c) - "I am directed to" opens an official letter, "The undersigned is directed to" opens an O.M., "Copy forwarded to" is an endorsement, and a D.O. No. at the top marks a D.O. letter.

M17. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Outdated expression)	List II (Modern form)
A. "Please do the needful."	1. "Please reply."
B. "Kindly revert back."	2. "I enclose ..."
C. "Please find enclosed herewith ..."	3. "Please take the necessary action."
D. "Kindly be informed that ..."	4. "This is to inform you that ..."

- a. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
b. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
c. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
d. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

Answer: (a) - "Do the needful" becomes "take the necessary action", "revert back" becomes "reply", "enclosed herewith" becomes "I enclose", and "Kindly be informed" becomes "This is to inform you".

M18. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Letter)	List II (Purpose)
A. Letter of condolence	1. Expresses views on a public issue, for publication
B. Letter of acknowledgement	2. Expresses sympathy on a death
C. Letter to the editor	3. Expresses regret for a mistake and offers to set it right
D. Letter of apology	4. Confirms that a letter, goods or a payment has been received

- a. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
- b. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
- c. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
- d. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3

Answer: (d) - Condolence = sympathy on a death; acknowledgement = confirms receipt; letter to the editor = views on a public issue for publication; apology = regret plus a remedy.

M19. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Delivery term)	List II (Meaning)
A. Ex-works	1. Seller pays cost, insurance and freight up to the destination port
B. FOR	2. Seller's cost and risk end when the goods are loaded on board the ship at the port of shipment
C. FOB	3. Buyer collects the goods from the seller's premises
D. CIF	4. Free on Rail

- a. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
- b. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
- c. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
- d. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

Answer: (c) - Ex-works = the buyer collects at the seller's premises; FOR = Free on Rail; FOB = the seller's cost and risk end on loading on board the ship; CIF = the seller pays cost, insurance and freight to the destination port.

M20. Match List I with List II: (PYQ-style)

List I (Honorific)	List II (Used for)
A. Selvi	1. A firm (short for "Messrs")
B. Hon'ble	2. A married woman ("Mrs.") in Tamil Nadu Government usage
C. M/s.	3. Ministers and judges
D. Tmt.	4. An unmarried woman ("Miss") in Tamil Nadu Government usage

- a. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- b. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
- c. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2
- d. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

Answer: (b) - In Tamil Nadu Government usage Selvi = Miss and Tmt. (Thirumathi) = Mrs.; "Hon'ble" is used for Ministers and judges, and "M/s." (Messrs) for firms.

16.4 Identify the Letter Type (20)

ID1. Identify the type of letter: "Dear Kavın, It was wonderful to get your letter after so long. Amma and I can't wait to see you in Chennai this summer!" (PYQ-style)

- a. Semi-formal letter
- b. Personal (informal) letter
- c. Formal letter
- d. Demi-official letter

Answer: (b) - A first-name salutation, family news, a contraction (can't) and an exclamation mark show a personal letter to a friend or relative.

ID2. A tenant writes to the house owner: "Dear Mr. Raman, I am writing to inform you that the water tank on the terrace has been leaking since last week. I would be grateful if you could arrange for a plumber." The letter ends "Yours sincerely, Arun Kumar". Identify the type of letter. (PYQ-style)

- a. Informal letter
- b. Official letter
- c. Office Memorandum
- d. Semi-formal letter

Answer: (d) - A known person addressed politely as "Dear Mr. + Surname," with "Yours sincerely," is a semi-formal letter.

ID3. A resident writes to the Commissioner, Madurai City Municipal Corporation: "Dear Sir/Madam, I wish to bring to your notice that garbage has not been collected in our street for the past ten days." Identify the type of letter. (PYQ-style)

- a. Formal letter (complaint to a public authority)
- b. Semi-formal letter
- c. Demi-official letter
- d. Office Memorandum

Answer: (a) - A citizen writing to an official about a public problem uses the formal register: "Dear Sir/Madam," with "Yours faithfully,".

ID4. Identify the letter type: "We are a stationery shop in Salem and wish to stock your notebooks. Please send us your latest price list, trade discount and terms of delivery." (PYQ-style)

- a. Order letter
- b. Quotation
- c. Inquiry letter
- d. Sales letter

Answer: (c) - A prospective buyer asks for information (prices, discount, terms) before buying - an inquiry (enquiry) letter.

ID5. Identify the letter type: "Thank you for your inquiry of 5 October 2026. We are pleased to quote Rs. 45 per notebook (200 pages), inclusive of GST, with delivery within 10 days. This offer is valid for 30 days." (PYQ-style)

- a. Inquiry letter
- b. Order letter
- c. Adjustment letter
- d. Quotation

Answer: (d) - The seller's reply to an inquiry, stating prices and terms with a validity period (firm offer), is a quotation.

ID6. Identify the letter type: "Please supply the following as per your quotation No. KPM/Q/214 dated 8 October 2026: 500 notebooks (200 pages) at Rs. 45 each. Payment will be made within 30 days of delivery." (PYQ-style)

- a. Order letter
- b. Quotation
- c. Inquiry letter
- d. Credit letter

Answer: (a) - The buyer places an order, quoting the seller's quotation, the quantity, price and payment terms.

ID7. Identify the MOST suitable letter type: "Of the 50 cartons of floor tiles received on 14 October 2026, six were broken in transit. We therefore claim replacement of the six cartons or a credit of Rs. 4,800." (PYQ-style)

- a. Complaint letter
- b. Claim letter
- c. Adjustment letter
- d. Collection letter

Answer: (b) - The buyer demands a specific remedy (replacement or credit); a complaint letter only reports the problem.

ID8. Identify the letter type: "We are sorry that six cartons of tiles in our consignment of 12 October 2026 reached you broken. Replacements have been dispatched today, free of cost." (PYQ-style)

- a. Claim letter
- b. Sales letter
- c. Adjustment letter
- d. Complaint letter

Answer: (c) - It is the seller's reply that settles the buyer's claim (here a full grant) - an adjustment letter.

ID9. Identify the letter type: "This is our second reminder. Our invoice No. 318 for Rs. 36,500, due on 30 August 2026, is still unpaid. Please send your payment within seven days." (PYQ-style)

- a. Collection letter
- b. Order letter
- c. Credit letter
- d. Circular letter

Answer: (a) - The seller asks for an overdue payment; this is the firmer second reminder of the collection series (first reminder → second reminder → final notice).

ID10. A firm posts the same letter to 400 customers and suppliers: "We are pleased to inform you that we have opened a new branch at Gandhipuram, Coimbatore, from 1 November 2026." Identify the letter type. (PYQ-style)

- a. Sales letter
- b. Inquiry letter
- c. Office Order
- d. Circular letter

Answer: (d) - The same information (a new branch) sent to many persons at once is a (business) circular letter.

ID11. Identify the letter type: "Tired of power cuts? Our new home inverter keeps your fans and lights running for up to four hours. Order before 30 November 2026 and get free installation." (PYQ-style)

- a. Circular letter
- b. Quotation
- c. Sales letter
- d. Order letter

Answer: (c) - It catches Attention, builds Interest and Desire, and urges Action (AIDA) to persuade the reader to buy - a sales letter.

ID12. Identify the letter type: "I request you to stop payment of cheque No. 452178 dated 10 October 2026 for Rs. 25,000, drawn in favour of Sri Murugan Stationers, as the cheque has been lost." (PYQ-style)

- a. Request for a Letter of Credit
- b. Stop-payment letter
- c. Cheque dishonour notice
- d. Bank reference letter

Answer: (b) - The account holder instructs the bank not to pay a cheque, giving its number, date, amount and payee.

ID13. An importer writes to its bank: "Please open an irrevocable Letter of Credit for USD 40,000 in favour of Island Spice Exports, Colombo, valid for 90 days, payable against the bill of lading, invoice and certificate of origin." Identify the letter type. (PYQ-style)

- a. Stop-payment letter
- b. Bank reference letter
- c. Proforma invoice
- d. Request (application) for a Letter of Credit

Answer: (d) - The importer (applicant) asks its bank to issue an L/C - the bank's undertaking to pay the exporter (beneficiary) when the stated documents are presented.

ID14. Identify the government communication: "The undersigned is directed to say that all Ministries/Departments should send their budget estimates for 2027-28 to this Ministry by 15 November 2026." It has no salutation and no complimentary close. (PYQ-style)

- a. Office Memorandum
- b. Demi-official letter
- c. Office Order
- d. Notification

Answer: (a) - Third person ("The undersigned is directed ..."), no salutation or close, addressed to Ministries/Departments - an Office Memorandum (O.M.).

ID15. Identify the communication: "D.O. No. 45/Edn/2026 ... Dear Thiru Kumar, I would like to draw your personal attention to the delay in the supply of free textbooks to schools in your district." (PYQ-style)

- a. Official letter
- b. Office Memorandum
- c. Demi-official (D.O.) letter
- d. Circular

Answer: (c) - Officer to officer, first person singular, seeking personal attention, "Dear Thiru Kumar," (closed with "Yours sincerely,") and a D.O. No. - a demi-official letter.

ID16. Identify the communication: "Thiru R. Suresh, Assistant, is posted to Section C with immediate effect. Selvi M. Divya, Assistant, will attend to the work of Section A in addition to her own duties." (PYQ-style)

- a. Notification
- b. Office Order
- c. Office Memorandum
- d. Circular letter

Answer: (b) - Internal administrative instructions (postings and distribution of work within the office) are issued as an Office Order.

ID17. A communication to be published in the Tamil Nadu Government Gazette reads: "Thiru S. Arun, Deputy Collector, is appointed as District Revenue Officer, Salem." Identify it. (PYQ-style)

- a. Notification
- b. Office Order
- c. Resolution
- d. Endorsement

Answer: (a) - Rules, orders, appointments and promotions published in the Official Gazette are Notifications; a Resolution announces policy decisions or the appointment of committees.

ID18. At the foot of a letter from the District Collector, Erode, this line appears: "Copy forwarded to the Tahsildar, Erode, for information and necessary action." Identify this form of communication. (PYQ-style)

- a. Office Order
- b. Notification
- c. Demi-official letter
- d. Endorsement

Answer: (d) - A note at the foot of a communication forwarding copies to others "for information / necessary action" is an endorsement.

ID19. Identify the MOST suitable letter type: "Through: The Superintendent, Accounts Section. Sir, I, K. Anitha, Junior Assistant, respectfully submit that my annual increment due in April 2026 has not been sanctioned so far." (PYQ-style)

- a. Petition
- b. Office Memorandum
- c. Representation (through proper channel)
- d. Letter to the editor

Answer: (c) - An employee's formal request to a higher authority about a service grievance, sent through the immediate superior, is a representation; a petition is usually a collective request, often signed by many people.

ID20. A letter to the District Collector, signed by 85 residents, begins: "We, the undersigned residents of Gandhi Nagar, Vellore, humbly request that a bus stop be provided near our colony." Identify the letter type. (PYQ-style)

- a. Representation by an employee
- b. Petition
- c. Circular letter
- d. Letter to the editor

Answer: (b) - A formal request to an authority signed by many people ("We, the undersigned ...") is a petition.

16.5 Error Detection (15)

Each snippet contains exactly ONE error. In the snippets, " / " marks a new line.

ED1. Find the error and correct it. (Letter to the Branch Manager of a bank; the manager's name is not known.) "Dear Sir/Madam, ... Yours sincerely, / R. Karthik" (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Dear Sir/Madam, ... Yours faithfully, / R. Karthik". Rule: "Dear Sir/Madam," (reader not named) pairs with "Yours faithfully,"; "Yours sincerely," goes with a named reader ("Dear Mr. Raman,").

ED2. Find the error and correct it. "Your's faithfully, / S. Meena" (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Yours faithfully,". Rule: "Yours" is a possessive pronoun (like hers, ours, its) and never takes an apostrophe.

ED3. Find the error and correct it. "Yours Faithfully, / V. Lakshmi" (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Yours faithfully,". Rule: only the first word of the complimentary close takes a capital letter (Yours faithfully, / Yours sincerely,), and a comma follows it.

ED4. Find the error and correct it. "Dear Mr. Raman / I am writing to thank you for the guidance you gave my son during his college admission." (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Dear Mr. Raman,". Rule: a comma follows every salutation (and every complimentary close).

ED5. Find the error and correct it. (Date line of a formal letter) "12/10/2026" (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "12 October 2026". Rule: all-numeric dates are ambiguous (12 October in India and Britain, but December 10 in the USA); write the month in words. "12th October, 2026" is an acceptable traditional Indian style.

ED6. Find the error and correct it. (Letter to the Controller of Examinations) "I'm writing to request a duplicate mark sheet." (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "I am writing to request a duplicate mark sheet." Rule: no contractions (I'm, don't, can't) in formal letters; they are allowed only in informal letters.

ED7. Find the error and correct it. (Letter to a bank) "I request you to do the needful." (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "I request you to take the necessary action." (Better still, name the action: "I request you to issue a duplicate passbook.") Rule: "do the needful" is outdated; state clearly what you want done.

ED8. Find the error and correct it. "Please revert back to me by 20 October 2026." (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Please reply by 20 October 2026." Rule: "revert back" is outdated and redundant; use "reply" or "respond".

ED9. Find the error and correct it. "I would like to meet you to discuss about the delay in the supply of books." (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "I would like to meet you to discuss the delay in the supply of books." Rule: "discuss" takes a direct object without "about" (but "a discussion about" is correct).

ED10. Find the error and correct it. "Subject: I am writing this letter to request you to repair the street lights in K.K. Nagar." (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Subject: Request for repair of street lights in K.K. Nagar". Rule: the subject line is a short noun phrase with no full stop, not a full sentence.

ED11. Find the error and correct it. (Opening lines of a full-block formal letter) "R. Karthik, / 12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai - 625 020" (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai - 625 020". Rule: only the sender's address goes at the top; the name is written below the complimentary close ("Yours faithfully, / R. Karthik"). (The From-To school format, where the name follows "From", is an accepted variant.)

ED12. Find the error and correct it. (End of a formal letter) "Encl.: 1. Copy of the receipt / Yours faithfully, / R. Karthik" (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Yours faithfully, / R. Karthik / Encl.: 1. Copy of the receipt". Rule: the enclosure line comes after the name (signature block), at the left margin; "Copy to" (if any) comes after "Encl.".

ED13. Find the error and correct it. (Letter to a company) "Thanks a lot for your prompt reply to my inquiry." (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Thank you for your prompt reply to my inquiry." Rule: "Thanks a lot" is conversational; formal letters use "Thank you" or "I am grateful".

ED14. Find the error and correct it. (Inside address) "To / M/s. Priya Raman, / Branch Manager, / Southern Commercial Bank, / Coimbatore - 641 002" (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Ms. Priya Raman,". Rule: "M/s." (Messrs) is used only before the name of a firm, e.g. "M/s. Kaveri Traders"; before a person's name use Mr./Ms./Mrs./Dr. (Tamil Nadu Government usage: Thiru/Tmt./Selvi).

ED15. Find the error and correct it. "Please find enclosed herewith a copy of my transfer certificate." (PYQ-style)

Answer: Correct form: "Please find enclosed a copy of my transfer certificate." or "I enclose a copy of my transfer certificate." Rule: "enclosed" already means "sent with this letter", so "herewith" is redundant.

16.6 Arrange the Parts of a Letter (10)

EXAM TIP: Fix the two ends first - the sender's address (or letterhead / File No.) opens the letter and the name (or Encl.) closes it - then eliminate options. Inside a part, " / " marks a new line.

AR1. Arrange the parts of a formal letter of complaint (body omitted) in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** Dear Sir/Madam,
- **Q:** 12 October 2026
- **R:** Subject: Complaint regarding irregular garbage collection in K.K. Nagar
- **S:** 12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai - 625 020
- **T:** Yours faithfully, / R. Karthik
- **U:** To / The Commissioner, / Madurai City Municipal Corporation, / Madurai - 625 001

- a. Q S U R P T
- b. S Q R U P T
- c. S Q U R P T
- d. S U Q P R T

Answer: (c) - Sender's address → date → "To" + receiver → subject → salutation → (body) → close and name.

AR2. Arrange the parts of an informal letter in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** Your loving friend, / Kavya
- **Q:** Dear Priya,
- **R:** 5, Park Street, / Salem - 636 007
- **S:** 3 October 2026
- **T:** I was so happy to read about your prize in the essay competition! ... (body)

- a. R S Q T P
- b. S R Q T P
- c. R Q S T P
- d. Q R S T P

Answer: (a) - Informal layout: short address → date → salutation → body → close + first name. There is no subject line and no receiver's address.

AR3. Arrange the parts of a semi-formal letter to a landlord (body omitted) in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** Yours sincerely, / Arun Kumar
- **Q:** Dear Mr. Raman,
- **R:** 14 October 2026
- **S:** 8, Lake View Road, / Tiruchirappalli - 620 017
- **T:** Mr. S. Raman, / 22, Temple Street, / Tiruchirappalli - 620 002
- **U:** Subject: Repair of the leaking water tank

- a. S R U T Q P
- b. R S T U Q P
- c. S T R U Q P
- d. S R T U Q P

Answer: (d) - Sender's address → date → receiver's name and address → subject (optional in semi-formal letters) → "Dear Mr. Raman," → (body) → "Yours sincerely," + full name.

AR4. Arrange the parts of a business order letter (body omitted) in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** Ref. No. SMS/PUR/112
- **Q:** SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS (letterhead with address, phone, email and GSTIN)
- **R:** Subject: Order for 500 notebooks
- **S:** Dear Sir/Madam,
- **T:** The Sales Manager, / Kaveri Paper Mills, / Sivakasi - 626 123
- **U:** 15 October 2026
- **V:** Yours faithfully, / For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS / S. Senthil / Proprietor

- a. Q T P U R S V
- b. Q P U T R S V
- c. P Q U T R S V
- d. Q P U R T S V

Answer: (b) - Letterhead → Ref. No. → date → inside address → subject → salutation → (body) → close, "For FIRM NAME", name and designation.

AR5. Arrange the parts of a letter to the editor in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** To / The Editor, / The Hindu, / Chennai
- **Q:** Subject: Poor condition of roads in Velachery
- **R:** Sir,
- **S:** 10, Bharathi Street, / Velachery, / Chennai - 600 042
- **T:** Yours faithfully, / V. Lakshmi
- **U:** 20 October 2026
- **V:** Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to ... (body)

- a. S U P Q R V T
- b. U S P Q R V T
- c. S U Q P R V T
- d. S P U Q R V T

Answer: (a) - Sender's address → date → "To The Editor" → subject → "Sir," → body → "Yours faithfully," + name.

AR6. Arrange the parts of a letter to a bank (body omitted) in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** To / The Branch Manager, / Southern Commercial Bank, / Anna Nagar Branch, / Chennai - 600 040
- **Q:** Subject: Change of address in Savings Bank Account No. XXXXXXXX4521
- **R:** Dear Sir/Madam,
- **S:** 18, Nehru Street, / Anna Nagar, / Chennai - 600 040
- **T:** 16 October 2026
- **U:** Yours faithfully, / M. Divya
- **V:** Encl.: 1. Self-attested copy of Aadhaar card

- a. S T P Q R V U
- b. T S P Q R U V
- c. S T P Q R U V
- d. S T Q P R U V

Answer: (c) - Formal layout: sender's address → date → receiver → subject → salutation → (body) → close + name → Encl. (after the name; only a "Copy to" line, if any, follows it). Note the masked account number.

AR7. Arrange the parts of an Office Memorandum in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** OFFICE MEMORANDUM
- **Q:** No. 12/4/2026-Admn.
- **R:** The undersigned is directed to say that ... (body)
- **S:** Government of India / Ministry of Rural Development
- **T:** (R. Vignesh) / Under Secretary to the Government of India
- **U:** Subject: Submission of monthly progress reports
- **V:** New Delhi, 20 October 2026

- a. Q S V U R P T
- b. Q S V P U R T
- c. Q S V P R U T
- d. T Q S V P U R

Answer: (b) - File No. → Government/Ministry → place and date → title → subject → third-person body → signature with name and designation. An O.M. has no salutation and no complimentary close.

AR8. Arrange the parts of a demi-official (D.O.) letter in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** Yours sincerely,
- **Q:** Dear Thiru Kumar,
- **R:** D.O. No. 45/Edn/2026
- **S:** I am writing to draw your personal attention to the delay in ... (body)
- **T:** 22 October 2026
- **U:** (S. Arun)

- a. Q R T S P U
- b. R T S Q P U
- c. R T Q S U P
- d. R T Q S P U

Answer: (d) - D.O. No. at the top → date → "Dear Thiru Kumar," → first-person body → "Yours sincerely," → name (signature).

AR9. The sender's address and the date of a job application are already written. Arrange the remaining parts in the correct order. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** Yours faithfully, / S. Vignesh
- **Q:** Reference: Your advertisement in The Hindu dated 18 October 2026
- **R:** To / The Manager (HR), / Kaveri Paper Mills, / Sivakasi - 626 123
- **S:** Encl.: 1. Resume 2. Copies of certificates
- **T:** Dear Sir/Madam,
- **U:** Subject: Application for the post of Junior Accountant
- **V:** In response to your advertisement, I wish to apply for the post of Junior Accountant. I hold a B.Com. degree ... (body)

- a. R U Q T V P S
- b. R U T Q V P S
- c. U R Q T V P S
- d. R U Q T V S P

Answer: (a) - Receiver → subject → reference (the advertisement) → salutation → body → close + name → Encl.

AR10. Arrange the letters and documents of a business transaction in the order in which they are normally exchanged. (PYQ-style)

- **P:** Order letter - the buyer places the order
- **Q:** Quotation - the seller states prices and terms
- **R:** Inquiry - the buyer asks for prices and terms
- **S:** Payment - the buyer remits the amount due
- **T:** Invoice - the seller dispatches the goods and bills the buyer
- **U:** Receipt - the seller acknowledges the payment

- a. R P Q T S U
- b. R Q P T S U
- c. Q R P T S U
- d. R Q P T U S

Answer: (b) - Inquiry → Quotation → Order → Invoice (with the goods) → Payment → Receipt. A complaint and an adjustment come in between only if something goes wrong (see Section 5).

16.7 Short-Answer Questions (10)

SA1. Distinguish a demi-official (D.O.) letter from an official letter. (PYQ-style)

An **official letter** goes from a Government office to other governments, bodies, officials or the public; it is impersonal, begins "I am directed to ...", uses "Sir/Madam" with "Yours faithfully" and is signed with the designation. A **D.O. letter** goes from one officer to another by name; it is personal and friendly, written in the first person singular to draw personal attention or expedite a matter, uses "Dear Shri X," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru X,") with "Yours sincerely" and carries a D.O. No. at the top.

SA2. What is a subject line and where is it placed? *(PYQ-style)*

It is a short noun phrase that tells the reader at a glance what the letter is about, e.g. "Subject: Request for a duplicate mark sheet". It starts with "Subject:" (or "Sub:") and has no full stop. In our full-block layout it comes after the receiver's address and before the salutation; the traditional British layout places it after the salutation (accepted variant). Informal letters have no subject line.

SA3. Why should all-numeric dates such as 12/10/2026 be avoided in letters? *(PYQ-style)*

They are ambiguous: in India and Britain 12/10/2026 means 12 October 2026, but in the USA it means December 10, 2026. Writing the month in words ("12 October 2026") removes all doubt, which matters in official, legal and banking letters. "12th October, 2026" is an acceptable traditional Indian style; "October 12, 2026" is the American style.

SA4. What is meant by "through proper channel"? *(PYQ-style)*

An employee's application or representation to a higher authority is not sent directly; it is sent through the employee's immediate superior, who forwards it. A "Through: ..." line naming the immediate superior is written above or below the addressee, e.g. "Through: The Superintendent, Accounts Section".

SA5. When do you use "Yours faithfully" and when "Yours sincerely"? *(PYQ-style)*

"Yours faithfully," follows "Dear Sir/Madam," "Sir," "Madam," or "Respected Sir," - letters to officials, organisations, editors and unknown persons. "Yours sincerely," follows a named salutation such as "Dear Mr. Raman," - formal letters to a named person, all semi-formal letters and D.O. letters. Both take a capital Y, a small f/s, no apostrophe and a comma after.

SA6. Distinguish a complaint letter, a claim letter and an adjustment letter. *(PYQ-style)*

A **complaint letter** is written by the buyer to report a problem (defect, delay, shortage, wrong goods). A **claim letter** is written by the buyer to demand a specific remedy or compensation (refund, replacement, price reduction). An **adjustment letter** is the seller's reply that settles the complaint or claim - full grant, partial grant, or polite refusal with reasons.

SA7. What is an Office Memorandum (O.M.)? State its main features. *(PYQ-style)*

An O.M. is a communication between Ministries/Departments (also used with attached offices and employees). It is written in the third person ("The undersigned is directed to ..."), has no salutation and no complimentary close, and is signed with the officer's name and designation.

SA8. What is a Letter of Credit (L/C)? Name its parties. *(PYQ-style)*

A Letter of Credit is a bank's written undertaking, issued at the request of the buyer/importer (applicant), to pay the seller/exporter (beneficiary) when specified documents are presented; it is used mainly in foreign trade. Parties: applicant, issuing bank, beneficiary and advising / confirming bank.

SA9. What does "Encl." mean, and where is it written? *(PYQ-style)*

"Encl." (enclosure) lists the documents sent with the letter, e.g. "Encl.: 1. Copy of the bill". It is written at the left margin after the name (signature block) and before "Copy to". In the body, write "Please find enclosed ..." or "I enclose ..."; avoid "enclosed herewith".

SA10. What should you write as the address and the name when an exam question does not give them? *(PYQ-style)*

Write "Examination Hall" as the address and sign as "ABC" or "XYZ"; never reveal your real identity in an exam answer. If the question gives a name and address, use exactly those.

16.8 Letter-Writing Questions (10)

EXAM TIP: Each answer below is an outline, not a full letter (for complete model letters see Section 10). Before you write, fix four things: the layout, the subject line, the salutation-close pair and a three-paragraph plan.

LW1. You are R. Karthik of 12, Gandhi Road, K.K. Nagar, Madurai - 625 020. Write a letter to the Commissioner, Madurai City Municipal Corporation, complaining about irregular garbage collection and blocked drains in your street. (About 150 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Formal

Format checklist: Sender's address (12, Gandhi Road, K.K. Nagar, Madurai - 625 020; no name at the top) → Date (e.g. 12 October 2026) → To / The Commissioner, / Madurai City Municipal Corporation, / Madurai - 625 001 → Subject → Salutation → Body (3 paragraphs) → Close → R. Karthik

Subject line: Subject: Complaint regarding irregular garbage collection and blocked drains in K.K. Nagar

Salutation and close: "Dear Sir/Madam," ... "Yours faithfully,"

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** State the purpose - to bring to the Commissioner's notice the irregular garbage collection and blocked drains in Gandhi Road, K.K. Nagar.
- **Main:** Give facts - garbage not cleared for about ten days; drains overflowing; foul smell and mosquitoes; risk of dengue and other diseases; earlier complaints to the ward office not acted upon.
- **Closing:** Request immediate clearance, desilting of the drains and regular collection; thank the Commissioner in the last sentence.

Useful phrases:

- I wish to bring to your notice the ...
- The residents of our street are facing great hardship because ...
- Despite repeated complaints to the ward office, no action has been taken.
- This poses a serious threat to public health.
- I request you to take immediate action to ...
- Thank you for your time and attention.

LW2. You are V. Lakshmi of 10, Bharathi Street, Thanjavur - 613 001. Write a letter to the Editor, The Hindu, Chennai, about the increasing use of single-use plastic bags in your town and its effects. (Not exceeding 200 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Formal

Format checklist: Sender's address → Date → To / The Editor, / The Hindu, / Chennai → Subject → Salutation → Body (3-4 paragraphs) → Close → V. Lakshmi

Subject line: Subject: Increasing use of plastic bags in Thanjavur

Salutation and close: "Sir," (or "Dear Sir/Madam,") ... "Yours faithfully,"

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** Through the columns of the newspaper, draw the attention of the public and the authorities to the problem.
- **Main:** Describe the problem - plastic bags in markets and shops; blocked drains and waterlogging; cattle eating plastic; burning of plastic waste; causes such as convenience and weak enforcement.
- **Closing:** Suggest remedies - strict enforcement, cloth and jute bags, awareness drives in schools; hope that the letter will create awareness.

Useful phrases:

- Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of ...
- It is distressing to note that ...
- This has led to ...
- The authorities concerned should ...
- Citizens, too, must ...
- I hope this letter will create awareness among the public.

LW3. You are M. Divya of 18, Nehru Street, Anna Nagar, Chennai - 600 040, and hold a savings bank account with Southern Commercial Bank, Anna Nagar Branch, Chennai - 600 040. A cheque you issued to Sri Murugan Stationers has been lost. Write a letter to the Branch Manager requesting stop payment. (About 120 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Formal

Format checklist: Sender's address → Date → To / The Branch Manager, / Southern Commercial Bank, / Anna Nagar Branch, / Chennai - 600 040 → Subject → Salutation → Body (3 short paragraphs) → Close → M. Divya / SB Account No. XXXXXXXX4521

Subject line: Subject: Request to stop payment of cheque No. 452178

Salutation and close: "Dear Sir/Madam," ... "Yours faithfully,"

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** State that you hold Savings Bank Account No. XXXXXXXX4521 in the branch and request stop payment of a cheque.
- **Main:** Give the cheque details - number, date, amount and payee (e.g. No. 452178 dated 10 October 2026 for Rs. 25,000 in favour of Sri Murugan Stationers); it was lost and has not been presented.
- **Closing:** Request that the instruction be recorded at once and confirmed; authorise the bank to debit the stop-payment charges, if any.

Useful phrases:

- I request you to stop payment of the following cheque issued by me.
- The cheque has been lost and has not been presented for payment so far.
- Please record this instruction immediately and confirm it in writing.
- You may debit the charges, if any, to my account.
- I shall be grateful for your prompt action.

MUST REMEMBER: Never write a PIN, OTP, CVV or password in a bank letter; mask the account number.

LW4. You are S. Senthil, Proprietor, Sri Murugan Stationers, 45, East Masi Street, Madurai - 625 001. Write a letter to Kaveri Paper Mills, Sivakasi - 626 123, placing an order for notebooks and A4 paper with reference to their quotation No. KPM/Q/214 dated 8 October 2026. (About 150 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Formal

Format checklist: Letterhead (SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS, address, phone, email, GSTIN) → Ref. No. → Date → Inside address (The Sales Manager, / Kaveri Paper Mills, / Sivakasi - 626 123) → Subject → Salutation → Body (with a list of items) → Close → For SRI MURUGAN STATIONERS → S. Senthil → Proprietor

Subject line: Subject: Order for notebooks and A4 paper - your quotation No. KPM/Q/214

Salutation and close: "Dear Sir/Madam," ... "Yours faithfully,"

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** Refer to the quotation (number and date) and place the order.
- **Main:** List the items - description, quantity, rate and amount (e.g. 500 notebooks of 200 pages at Rs. 45 = Rs. 22,500; 50 reams of A4 paper at Rs. 260 = Rs. 13,000); state the delivery date, mode of transport, packing and payment terms (e.g. within 30 days of the invoice).
- **Closing:** Ask for an acknowledgement of the order and an invoice showing the GSTIN; express hope of prompt delivery.

Useful phrases:

- With reference to your quotation No. ... dated ..., we are pleased to place an order for the following items.
- Please supply the goods as per the specifications given below.
- The goods should reach us not later than ...
- Please pack the goods carefully to avoid damage in transit.
- Payment will be made within 30 days of receipt of your invoice.
- Kindly acknowledge receipt of this order.

LW5. You have seen an advertisement in The Hindu for the post of Junior Accountant in Kaveri Paper Mills, Sivakasi - 626 123. Write a letter of application. Use "Examination Hall" as your address and sign as ABC. (About 200 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Formal

Format checklist: Examination Hall → Date → To / The Manager (HR), / Kaveri Paper Mills, / Sivakasi - 626 123 → Subject → Reference (the advertisement) → Salutation → Body (3 paragraphs) → Close → ABC → Encl.: 1. Resume 2. Copies of certificates

Subject line: Subject: Application for the post of Junior Accountant

Salutation and close: "Dear Sir/Madam," ... "Yours faithfully,"

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** Name the post and where you saw it advertised (The Hindu, with the date); the same advertisement is cited in the Reference line above the salutation.
- **Main:** Give your qualifications (e.g. B.Com.), skills (accounting software, GST returns, spreadsheets), experience, and why you suit the post.
- **Closing:** Mention the enclosed resume and certificates, your availability for an interview, and thank the reader.

Useful phrases:

- In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated ..., I wish to apply for the post of ...
- I hold a B.Com. degree from ...
- I have two years' experience as ...
- I am confident that my skills will be useful to your organisation.
- I enclose my resume and copies of my certificates.
- I shall be glad to attend an interview at your convenience.

LW6. You are S. Kavya of Class XII-A, Sri Vidya Higher Secondary School, Vellore, living at 14, Kamarajar Street, Sathuvachari, Vellore - 632 009. Write a letter to your Principal requesting leave for three days to attend your sister's wedding. (About 100 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Formal

Format checklist: Sender's address → Date → To / The Principal, / Sri Vidya Higher Secondary School, / Vellore → Subject → Salutation → Body (2-3 short paragraphs) → Close → S. Kavya / Class XII-A

Subject line: Subject: Request for leave from 15 to 17 October 2026

Salutation and close: "Respected Sir," or "Respected Madam," ... "Yours faithfully," (school students may also use the traditional "Yours obediently,")

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** Introduce yourself (name, class, section) and request leave for three days, giving the exact dates.
- **Main:** Give the reason - your elder sister's wedding at Thanjavur; you must travel with your family.
- **Closing:** Promise to complete the lessons and assignments you miss; request the Principal to grant leave; thank.

Useful phrases:

- I am S. Kavya, a student of Class XII-A.
- I request you to grant me leave for three days, from ... to ...
- ... as I have to attend my sister's wedding at ...
- I shall complete the lessons and assignments that I miss.
- I shall be grateful if you grant me leave for these days.
- Thank you for your kind consideration.

LW7. Write a letter to your friend Priya inviting her to the house-warming ceremony of your family's new house in Coimbatore. Use "Examination Hall" as your address and sign as ABC. (About 120 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Informal

Format checklist: Examination Hall (short sender's address) → Date → Salutation → Body (3 short paragraphs) → Close → ABC. No receiver's address.

Subject line: None - an informal letter has no subject line.

Salutation and close: "Dear Priya," ... "Your loving friend," (or "With love,")

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** Greet her warmly; ask about her and her family.
- **Main:** Share the news - your family's new house; the date, time and place of the function (e.g. 8 November 2026, 7 a.m., at the new house in Coimbatore); what is planned; how to reach.
- **Closing:** Insist that she come (a day early if possible); send regards to her parents; say you look forward to meeting her.

Useful phrases:

- How are you and everyone at home?
- I'm delighted to tell you that ...
- We'd love to have you with us on ...
- Please do come a day early so that we can spend some time together.
- Convey my regards to your parents.
- Looking forward to seeing you soon.

LW8. You are Arun Kumar, a tenant living at 8, Lake View Road, Tiruchirappalli - 620 017. Write a letter to your landlord, Mr. S. Raman, 22, Temple Street, Tiruchirappalli - 620 002, requesting him to repair the leaking water tank of the house. (About 150 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Semi-formal

Format checklist: Sender's address → Date → Mr. S. Raman, / 22, Temple Street, / Tiruchirappalli - 620 002 → Subject (optional) → Salutation → Body (3 paragraphs) → Close → Arun Kumar (full name)

Subject line: Subject: Repair of the leaking water tank (optional in a semi-formal letter)

Salutation and close: "Dear Mr. Raman," ... "Yours sincerely,"

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** Greet him politely and state the purpose - the water tank of the house is leaking.
- **Main:** Give details - since when (e.g. 1 October 2026); water wastage, damp walls and damage to the ceiling; a plumber's opinion that the tank needs repair.
- **Closing:** Request repairs within a week; offer to arrange a plumber if he approves; thank him for his cooperation.

Useful phrases:

- I am writing to inform you that ...
- The problem has become worse over the past week.
- I would be grateful if you could arrange for the repairs as soon as possible.
- If you wish, I can arrange for a plumber with your approval.
- Thank you for your understanding.
- I look forward to hearing from you.

LW9. You are R. Meena, Customer Care Manager, Kaveri Home Appliances, 12, Avinashi Road, Coimbatore - 641 018. A customer, Ms. Divya Krishnan, has complained that the washing machine she bought was delivered ten days late with a damaged panel. Write a letter of apology offering a suitable remedy. (About 150 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Formal

Format checklist: Letterhead (KAVERI HOME APPLIANCES, address, phone, email, GSTIN) → Ref. No. → Date → Inside address (Ms. Divya Krishnan and her address) → Subject → Salutation → Body (3 paragraphs) → Close → R. Meena → Customer Care Manager

Subject line: Subject: Apology for the delayed delivery and damaged panel of your washing machine

Salutation and close: "Dear Ms. Krishnan," ... "Yours sincerely," (the customer is named)

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** Thank her for her letter and apologise sincerely for the delay and the damage.
- **Main:** Give a brief reason without excuses (e.g. a transport delay at the warehouse) and the remedy - a technician will replace the damaged panel free of cost within 48 hours, or the machine will be replaced if she prefers; add a goodwill gesture (e.g. one free service visit). This is an adjustment letter (full grant).
- **Closing:** Mention the steps taken to prevent a repeat; give a contact person and phone number; thank her for her patience.

Useful phrases:

- Thank you for bringing this matter to our notice.
- We sincerely apologise for the inconvenience caused to you.
- We have arranged for ... free of cost.
- We have taken steps to ensure that this does not happen again.
- Please contact me at ... if you need any further help.
- We value your trust in our products.

LW10. You are K. Anitha, Junior Assistant, Accounts Section, Office of the District Collector, Salem - 636 001. Your annual increment due on 1 April 2026 has not been sanctioned. Write a representation to the District Revenue Officer, Salem, through proper channel. (About 150 words) (PYQ-style)

Model answer outline Formal

Format checklist: Sender's address (Accounts Section, / Office of the District Collector, / Salem - 636 001) → Date → To / The District Revenue Officer, / Office of the District Collector, / Salem - 636 001 → Through: The Superintendent, Accounts Section (below or above the addressee) → Subject → Salutation → Body (3 paragraphs) → Close → K. Anitha → Junior Assistant

Subject line: Subject: Representation regarding non-sanction of annual increment due on 1 April 2026

Salutation and close: "Sir," (or "Respected Sir," / "Respected Madam,") ... "Yours faithfully,"

Paragraph plan:

- **Opening:** Introduce yourself (name, designation, section, date of joining) and state that you are submitting a representation about your increment.
- **Main:** Give the facts - increment due on 1 April 2026; satisfactory service; no disciplinary proceedings pending; earlier requests (with dates) not answered; financial hardship.
- **Closing:** Request sanction of the increment with arrears; thank the officer; keep a respectful tone throughout.

Useful phrases:

- I respectfully submit the following for your kind consideration.
- My annual increment, due on 1 April 2026, has not been sanctioned so far.
- My service has been satisfactory, and no disciplinary proceedings are pending against me.
- I request you to sanction the increment with arrears.
- I shall be grateful for your kind consideration.

17.1 50 Most Important Letter-Writing Terms

Parts of a letter (1-16), registers and letter types (17-19), government correspondence (20-32), business and banking (33-50). Details: Sections 1, 4, 6 and 7.

No.	Term	One-line meaning
1	Letterhead	The printed heading of a firm or office: name, address, phone and email (and GSTIN for a firm).
2	Sender's address	The writer's address at the top-left; the name is NOT written here but below the close.
3	Date line	The date of writing, in the style "12 October 2026".
4	Ref. No.	The sender's file or letter number, written above the date in business letters and used to trace correspondence.
5	Inside address	The receiver's name or designation and full address, written below "To".
6	Attention line	"Kind Attention: ..." - directs a letter addressed to a firm to a particular person or department.
7	Subject line	"Subject:" + a short noun phrase stating the purpose; before the salutation; no full stop ("Sub:" is accepted).
8	Reference line	"Reference: Your letter No. ... dated ..." - used only when referring to earlier correspondence.
9	Salutation	The greeting before the body, e.g. "Dear Sir/Madam,"; always followed by a comma.
10	Complimentary close	The polite phrase before the signature, e.g. "Yours faithfully,".
11	Signature block	Signature, name and, in official or business letters, designation.
12	Enclosure (Encl.)	A document sent with the letter, listed below the signature.
13	Copy to / CC	Other persons who receive a copy of the letter (CC = carbon copy or courtesy copy).
14	Postscript (P.S.)	A short note added below the signature; avoid it in formal letters.
15	Full-block format	A layout in which every line starts at the left margin; used for all model letters in this book.
16	Register	The level of formality of a letter: formal, semi-formal or informal.
17	Formal letter	A letter to an official, an organisation or an unknown person, in a fixed format and formal language.
18	Semi-formal letter	A letter to a known person (not close) on a personal or partly official matter: "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,".
19	Informal letter	A personal letter to family or friends; no subject line and no receiver's address; contractions allowed.
20	Official letter	From a Government office to other governments, bodies, officials or the public; begins "I am directed to ..."; signed with designation.
21	Demi-official (D.O.) letter	An officer-to-officer letter in a personal tone and the first person; D.O. No. at the top; "Dear Shri Kumar," → "Yours sincerely,".
22	Office Memorandum (O.M.)	Communication between Ministries/Departments; third person ("The undersigned is directed to ..."); no salutation, no close.
23	Office Order	Internal administrative instructions: distribution of work, grant of leave, postings within the office.
24	Order	Used for financial sanctions, disciplinary matters, etc.
25	Notification	Publication of rules, orders, appointments, promotions, etc. in the Official Gazette.
26	Resolution	Public announcement of important policy decisions or of the appointment of committees or commissions; published in the Gazette.
27	Circular	The same information sent to many offices or persons.
28	Notice	An announcement displayed or published for the information of a group or the public; no salutation, no close.
29	Endorsement	Government: a note at the foot forwarding copies or returning a paper to the sender. Banking: a signature on the back of a cheque to transfer it.
30	Government Order (G.O.)	An order issued by a Secretariat department of the Tamil Nadu Government.
31	Proceedings	The format used by Heads of Departments and District officers in Tamil Nadu: Present, Rc. No., Dated, Sub, Ref, ORDER.
32	Through proper channel	An employee's application to a higher authority, sent through the immediate superior (a "Through: ..." line).
33	Inquiry / enquiry letter	A letter asking for information such as prices, terms or availability; both spellings are accepted.
34	Quotation	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions in reply to an inquiry; valid for a stated period (firm offer).
35	Tender	A formal (often sealed) offer in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies.
36	Purchase Order (PO)	A formal numbered document issued by the buyer; binding once accepted by the seller.
37	Proforma invoice	A preliminary bill sent before supply, for advance payment or import formalities.
38	Invoice (tax invoice)	The seller's bill for goods supplied: quantity, price, taxes, total and due date.
39	Complaint letter	The buyer reports a problem: defect, delay, shortage or wrong goods.
40	Claim letter	The buyer demands a specific remedy: refund, replacement or price reduction.
41	Adjustment letter	The seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim: full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons.
42	Credit note	Issued by the seller; reduces the amount the buyer owes (goods returned, overcharge, allowance).

No.	Term	One-line meaning
43	Debit note	Issued by the buyer when returning goods or claiming a deduction; a seller may also send one to charge an undercharged amount.
44	Letter of Credit (L/C)	A bank's written undertaking, issued at the buyer's request, to pay the seller when specified documents are presented.
45	Bank reference	A bank's statement about its customer's account and general standing, given on request.
46	Credit reference	Information about creditworthiness from trade referees or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL).
47	Collection series	First reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer) → final notice (warns of legal action).
48	Stop-payment	The account holder's instruction to the bank not to pay a cheque; give the cheque number, date, amount and payee.
49	E&OE	Errors and Omissions Excepted - printed on invoices and similar documents so that errors can be corrected later.
50	M/s.	Messrs - written before the name of a firm, e.g. "M/s. Kaveri Traders".

17.2 50 Most Useful Formal Phrases

Modern, correct phrases only: openings (1-15), requests (16-25), enclosures and references (26-30), complaints (31-35), business replies (36-43), government (44-45) and closings (46-50). Details: Section 8.

No.	Phrase	Use
1	I am writing to inform you that ...	Opening: giving information
2	I am writing to request ...	Opening: making a request
3	I am writing to bring to your notice ...	Opening: reporting a problem (complaint)
4	I wish to draw your attention to ...	Pointing out an issue to an authority
5	This is to inform you that ...	Giving formal information or an announcement
6	With reference to your letter No. ... dated ...,	Replying to earlier correspondence
7	Thank you for your letter dated ...	Opening a reply politely
8	In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated ..., I wish to apply for the post of ...	Job application
9	Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to ...	Letter to the Editor
10	On behalf of the residents of ..., I wish to ...	Writing on behalf of a group
11	I am directed to ...	Official letter from a Government office
12	The undersigned is directed to ...	Office Memorandum (third person)
13	We acknowledge receipt of your letter dated ...	Confirming that a letter has arrived
14	We are pleased to inform you that ...	Conveying good news
15	We regret to inform you that ...	Conveying bad news or a refusal
16	I would be grateful if you could ...	Polite request
17	I would appreciate it if you could ...	Polite request (modern)
18	I request you to ...	Direct formal request
19	Please take the necessary action.	Asking an office to act
20	I request you to look into the matter and take suitable action.	Complaint: asking for action
21	Please treat this matter as urgent.	Stressing urgency
22	Please let me know whether ...	Asking for information
23	Please send us your latest price list and terms of payment.	Business inquiry
24	I request you to grant me leave for ... days, from ... to ...	Leave letter
25	I request you to stop payment of cheque No. ... dated ... for Rs. ...	Stop-payment letter to a bank
26	Please find enclosed ...	Mentioning an enclosure
27	I enclose ...	Mentioning an enclosure (shortest modern form)
28	A copy of ... is enclosed for your reference.	Enclosure with its purpose
29	As stated in my letter dated ...,	Referring to your own earlier letter
30	Further to our telephone conversation today,	Following up a phone call in writing
31	I regret to state that ...	Stating a problem politely
32	Despite repeated requests, ...	Showing that a problem continues
33	Some of the goods were found damaged on arrival.	Business complaint about goods
34	We request you to replace the damaged items as early as possible.	Claim: asking for a remedy

No.	Phrase	Use
35	I hope this matter will receive your prompt attention.	Ending a complaint politely but firmly
36	We apologise for the inconvenience caused.	Apology (adjustment letter)
37	We regret the delay in ...	Apologising for a delay
38	We have arranged to replace the damaged goods free of cost.	Adjustment: granting a claim
39	We are pleased to place an order for the following items:	Order letter
40	Our terms of payment are 30 days from the date of invoice.	Stating credit terms
41	This quotation is valid for 30 days from its date.	Validity of a quotation (firm offer)
42	This is to remind you that our invoice No. ... dated ... remains unpaid.	First reminder (collection series)
43	Unless the amount is received by ..., we shall be compelled to take legal action.	Final notice (collection series)
44	Copy forwarded to ... for information and necessary action.	Endorsement (government)
45	Receipt of this letter may be acknowledged.	Official letter: asking for an acknowledgement
46	I look forward to hearing from you.	Closing: expecting a reply
47	Thank you for your time and consideration.	Closing thanks inside the last paragraph
48	Please do not hesitate to contact me if you need any further information.	Offering further help
49	I hope you will consider my request favourably.	Closing a request
50	I would be grateful for an early reply.	Asking for a quick reply

17.3 25 Most Important Letter Types

Register, salutation-close pair and a key opening phrase for each type. Details: Sections 2-6 and 12.

No.	Letter type	Register	Salutation → Close	Key opening phrase
1	Letter to a friend	Informal	"Dear Priya," → "Your loving friend,"	"I was delighted to receive your letter."
2	Letter to a parent	Informal	"Dear Appa," → "Your loving son," / "Your loving daughter,"	"I am doing well here and hope everyone at home is fine."
3	Letter to a teacher or neighbour (known person)	Semi-formal	"Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,"	"I am writing to thank you for ..."
4	Letter of congratulations to a known person	Semi-formal	"Dear Mrs. Narayanan," → "Yours sincerely,"	"Please accept my warm congratulations on ..."
5	Leave letter to the Principal or Head of Office	Formal	"Respected Sir," → "Yours faithfully," (school students may also use "Yours obediently,")	"I request you to grant me leave for two days, from 14 to 15 October 2026, as ..."
6	Job application	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated ..., I wish to apply for the post of ..."
7	Resignation letter (to a named manager)	Formal	"Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,"	"I wish to resign from my post of ... with effect from ..."
8	Complaint to a civic authority	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"I am writing to bring to your notice the ..."
9	Letter to the Editor	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," (or "Sir,") → "Yours faithfully,"	"Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to ..."
10	Business inquiry letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"We are interested in ... and request your latest price list and terms of payment."
11	Quotation	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"Thank you for your inquiry dated ... We are pleased to quote as follows:"
12	Order letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"We are pleased to place an order for the following items:"
13	Complaint letter (buyer to seller)	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"We regret to inform you that some of the goods received on ... are damaged."
14	Claim letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"We request you to replace the damaged items or refund Rs. ..."
15	Adjustment letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully," (named customer: "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,")	"Thank you for your letter dated ... We apologise for the inconvenience caused."
16	Collection (reminder) letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"This is to remind you that our invoice No. ... dated ... for Rs. ... remains unpaid."

No.	Letter type	Register	Salutation → Close	Key opening phrase
17	Bank letter: stop-payment	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"I request you to stop payment of cheque No. ... dated ... for Rs. ..."
18	Bank letter: request (change of address, new cheque book)	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"I request you to update the address in my savings account No. XXXXXXXX4521."
19	Official letter (Government)	Formal	"Sir," or "Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"I am directed to ..."
20	Demi-official (D.O.) letter	Formal (personal tone)	"Dear Shri Kumar," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru Kumar,") → "Yours sincerely,"	"I would like to draw your personal attention to ..."
21	Office Memorandum	Formal	No salutation / no close	"The undersigned is directed to ..."
22	Office Order	Formal	No salutation / no close	"The following distribution of work is ordered with immediate effect:"
23	Circular (government)	Formal	No salutation / no close	"All Heads of Departments are requested to ..."
24	Notification	Formal	No salutation / no close	"In exercise of the powers conferred by section ... of the ... Act, ..."
25	Notice	Formal	No salutation / no close	"This is to inform all ... that ..."

17.4 20 Most Confusing Terms

The key difference in one cell. Full comparison tables: Section 15.

No.	Pair	Key difference
1	Yours faithfully vs Yours sincerely	Faithfully: after "Dear Sir/Madam,", "Sir," or "Respected Sir," (officials, organisations, editors, unknown persons). Sincerely: after "Dear Mr. Raman," (named person), in all semi-formal letters and in D.O. letters.
2	Enquiry vs Inquiry	British tradition: enquiry = asking for information; inquiry = formal investigation. American English uses "inquiry" for both; "inquiry letter" and "enquiry letter" are both accepted.
3	Quotation vs Estimate	Quotation: firm prices, terms and conditions with a validity period. Estimate: approximate cost only.
4	Quotation vs Tender	Quotation: the seller's reply to a buyer's inquiry. Tender: a formal (often sealed) offer in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies.
5	Order letter vs Purchase Order	Order letter: a letter placing an order. Purchase Order: a formal numbered document issued by the buyer; binding once accepted by the seller.
6	Proforma invoice vs Invoice	Proforma invoice: a preliminary bill sent before supply (for advance payment or import formalities). Invoice: the bill for goods supplied - quantity, price, taxes, total and due date.
7	Complaint letter vs Claim letter	Complaint: reports a problem (defect, delay, shortage, wrong goods). Claim: demands a specific remedy (refund, replacement, price reduction).
8	Claim letter vs Adjustment letter	Claim: written by the buyer. Adjustment: the seller's reply that settles it (full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons).
9	Credit note vs Debit note	Credit note: issued by the seller; reduces what the buyer owes. Debit note: issued by the buyer when returning goods or claiming a deduction (a seller may also send one for an undercharge). Side note: under GST law both are issued by the supplier.
10	Credit letter vs Letter of Credit	Credit letter: a business letter about credit (opening a credit account, status inquiry, granting or refusing credit). Letter of Credit: a bank's undertaking to pay the seller against specified documents.
11	Credit advice vs Debit advice	Intimation, usually from a bank, that an account has been credited (credit advice) or debited (debit advice).
12	Bank reference vs Credit reference	Bank reference: a bank's statement on its customer's account and general standing. Credit reference: creditworthiness information from trade referees or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL).
13	Stop-payment vs Cheque dishonour	Stop-payment: the account holder tells the bank not to pay a cheque. Dishonour: the bank returns the cheque unpaid with a return memo; the payee may then send a legal demand notice under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881, within 30 days of receiving the memo.
14	FOB vs CIF	FOB: the seller's cost and risk end when the goods are loaded on board the ship at the port of shipment. CIF: the seller pays cost, insurance and freight up to the destination port.
15	Official letter vs D.O. letter	Official: "Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"; begins "I am directed to ..."; signed with designation. D.O.: "Dear Shri Kumar," → "Yours sincerely,"; personal tone, first person; D.O. No. at the top.
16	Office Memorandum vs Office Order	O.M.: communication between Ministries/Departments, in the third person. Office Order: internal instructions within an office (distribution of work, leave, postings).
17	Office Order vs Order	Office Order: internal administrative matters. Order: financial sanctions, disciplinary matters, etc.
18	Notification vs Resolution	Notification: rules, orders, appointments and promotions published in the Gazette. Resolution: important policy decisions or the appointment of committees or commissions (also published in the Gazette).
19	Circular vs Notice	Circular: the same information sent to many offices or persons. Notice: displayed or published for the information of a group or the public. Neither a government circular nor a notice has a salutation or a close.

No.	Pair	Key difference
20	Endorsement (government) vs Endorsement (banking)	Government: a note at the foot forwarding copies ("Copy forwarded to ... for information / necessary action") or returning a paper to the sender. Banking: a signature on the back of a cheque or other negotiable instrument to transfer it.

17.5 10 Letter Formats to Memorise

Read each line from left to right; every model letter in this book is in full-block format with one blank line between blocks. Details: Sections 6 and 9.

No.	Letter	Order of parts
1	Formal letter	Sender's address → Date → To → Receiver's designation and address → Subject → Reference (only if needed) → "Dear Sir/Madam," → Opening paragraph → Main paragraph(s) → Closing paragraph → "Yours faithfully," → Name → Encl. / Copy to (if any)
2	Semi-formal letter	Sender's address → Date → Receiver's name and address → Subject (optional) → "Dear Mr./Mrs. Surname," → Body → "Yours sincerely," → Full name
3	Informal letter	Sender's address (short) → Date → Salutation ("Dear Priya,") → Body → Close ("Your loving friend,") → First name (no subject line, no receiver's address)
4	Business letter	Letterhead (firm name in capitals, address, phone, email, GSTIN) → Ref. No. → Date → Inside address → Kind Attention (optional) → Subject → Salutation → Body → Complimentary close → "For FIRM NAME" (optional) → Name → Designation → Encl. → CC
5	Letter to the Editor	Sender's address → Date → To → The Editor, newspaper, city → Subject → "Dear Sir/Madam," (or "Sir,") → Body (issue, facts, suggestions) → "Yours faithfully," → Name
6	Job application	Sender's address → Date → To → Employer's designation and address → Subject: Application for the post of ... → "Dear Sir/Madam," → Body (post and advertisement, qualifications and experience, request for an interview) → "Yours faithfully," → Name → Encl.: CV and copies of certificates
7	Bank letter	Sender's address → Date → To → The Branch Manager, bank and branch address → Subject (with the masked account number) → "Dear Sir/Madam," → Body (account details, request, reason) → "Yours faithfully," → Name (signature as in bank records) → Encl. (if any)
8	D.O. letter	Sender's name, designation and office with D.O. No. (at the top) → Date → "Dear Shri Kumar," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru Kumar,") → Body (first person, personal tone) → "Yours sincerely," → Signature and name → Addressee's name and address (bottom-left)
9	Office Memorandum (no salutation, no close)	File No. → Government of India, Ministry / Department → Place and date → OFFICE MEMORANDUM → Subject → Body in the third person ("The undersigned is directed to ...") → Signature, name and designation → To: addressee(s) (bottom-left) → Copy to
10	Leave letter	Sender's address → Date → To → The Principal / Head of Office, with address → Subject: Request for leave → "Respected Sir," (or "Dear Sir/Madam,") → Body (dates, reason, request) → "Yours faithfully," (school students may also use "Yours obediently,") → Name (with class or designation)

17.6 10 Golden Rules of Formal Letter Writing

- Exam identity rule.** If the question gives no name or address, write "Examination Hall" as the address and sign as "ABC" (or "XYZ"); if the question gives them, use exactly those. Never reveal your real identity.
- Pair the salutation and the close.** "Dear Sir/Madam," / "Sir," / "Respected Sir," → "Yours faithfully,,"; "Dear Mr. Raman," and D.O. letters → "Yours sincerely,,"; family and friends → "Your loving ...". Write "Yours" with a capital Y and no apostrophe, and put a comma after both the salutation and the close.
- Write a precise subject line before the salutation.** "Subject:" + a short noun phrase with no full stop, e.g. "Subject: Complaint regarding irregular garbage collection in K.K. Nagar".
- Build a three-part body.** Opening (why you are writing) → main (facts and details) → closing (the action you want).
- No contractions or slang.** Also no exclamation marks, SMS language or emoji in a formal letter; use modern phrases, not outdated ones.
- Write the date as "12 October 2026".** Avoid all-numeric dates such as 12/10/2026, which are ambiguous.
- One purpose per letter.** Do not mix a complaint with an unrelated request; write a separate letter for each.
- Polite but firm tone.** State facts, not anger; even a final reminder or a strong complaint stays courteous.
- Check names, designations and addresses.** Use the receiver's exact designation, office, city and pin code ("Madurai - 625 001"), and spell every name correctly.

10. **End with a clear request or action.** Say exactly what you want done and, where relevant, by when.

17.7 Final MUST REMEMBER Box

MUST REMEMBER: "Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully," but "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,"; the subject line comes before the salutation and has no full stop; O.M., Office Order, Notification, government Circular and Notice have no salutation and no close; the credit note is issued by the seller and reduces what the buyer owes; date every letter "12 October 2026"; no name in the question → "Examination Hall" and "ABC".

Letter Writing Master Notes — TNPSC General English. Model letters use the full-block exam format; where textbooks differ, the accepted variant is noted.

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